

Kaysender

Welcome to a “Dungeons & Dragons 5 Edition”: Expansion and Setting module.
Created and prepared by Christopher Vardeman

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Kaysender An introduction.

The world of Kaysender is a realm of boundless skies, where colossal floating continents drift serenely through the heavens. Airships glide through vast expanses of open sky, their crews harnessing magic and the power of golems to maintain their course, while dragons soar through the air, ruling over personal fiefdoms spread across the floating islands. These dragons, powerful and often merciless, command regions of the sky, keeping their territories under tight control. Yet, despite this, Kaysender remains a place of wild chaos and opportunity, where thieves, bandits, pirates, and scoundrels roam freely, taking advantage of the unpredictability that comes with a world constantly in motion.

The continents themselves are of unimaginable size, their bottoms lost to time and countless attempts to explore their depths. The true nature of the land below remains a mystery, and no one has yet discovered what lies beneath the vast void that separates the floating realms above. Most of the people of Kaysender live on the numerous islands that drift and wander across the skies, many small and others vast, each with its own culture and people. Life on these islands is a delicate balance, as stability and safety are rare commodities, often shattered by unexpected raids from roving bands of airship brigands. Villages on small, peaceful islands can be razed in moments, their few inhabitants preyed upon by both sky pirates and the wild, menacing creatures that inhabit the heavens.

In this chaotic environment, a few brave shepherds tend to flocks of "sheffels"—floating, woolly creatures that resemble massive, ethereal sheep. These beings glide through the air with a grace that belies their size, their bodies composed of a giant, fluffy cloud of fur and fuzz. Their herders must constantly be on guard, protecting them from the predators that stalk the skies, as these creatures are sought after both for their wool and for the strange magic they seem to generate in the air around them.

In the lower atmosphere, a unique form of life exists in the form of the Grays—tiny floating organisms that live among the plankton-like plants drifting through the air. These plants, sustained by pure magic, grow and thrive in the floating clouds, their delicate roots drawing sustenance from the arcane energies that permeate the world. Together, these elements create a world full of wonder and peril, a place where the line between freedom and danger is thin, and where every journey through the skies is an adventure waiting to happen.

In the world of Kaysender, the skies are teeming with a myriad of species uniquely adapted to life among the clouds. These aeronautical creatures have evolved to thrive in the ever-changing currents of the air, their bodies and very essence attuned to the magic of the sky. Some of these beings possess innate magical abilities or special glands that allow them to float or levitate, while others are imbued with fields of otherworldly energy that buoy their existence, suspending them effortlessly in the air.

One of the most common and intriguing types of sky-dwelling creatures are those with natural levitation abilities. Some of these creatures are small, such as floating insects with wings that hum with magical energy, their bodies sustained by delicate enchantments or natural levitation fluid within them. Others are much larger, like majestic floating whales whose size defies the laws of gravity, their bodies supported by vast fields of arcane energy that radiate from their massive forms, bending the air around them.

Many of these creatures also have specialized adaptations that enable them to produce or secrete materials vital for their survival. For example, certain species of birds or insects have unique glands that secrete a viscous, buoyant substance, allowing them to control their altitude and drift gracefully through the skies. Some even release magical particles into the air, which are absorbed by the surrounding environment, creating fields of magic that assist in the creature's levitation.

In addition to natural levitation, there are creatures whose very essence is connected to the magical forces of Kaysender. These beings can tap into the fundamental energies of the world, drawing upon the ethereal forces that permeate the atmosphere to sustain themselves. For these creatures, the air itself is a source of life, with their spirits or forms being partly composed of these magical fields, making them inherently bound to the skies. These entities are often revered or feared, as they can manipulate the winds, currents, or even weather itself in certain cases, bending the skies to their will.

Some of these aeronautical species are prized for the materials they produce—magical oils, rare feathers, or substances that have potent properties. Others are considered symbols of the untamed beauty and danger of Kaysender's skies, their presence a constant reminder of the forces that govern the heavens. Whether predators, prey, or companions, these sky-dwelling creatures add a layer of complexity and mystique to a world that is already teeming with magic and unpredictability.

In the world of Kaysender, the sky-dwelling creatures may rule the heavens, but the land-bound races are the heart of civilization. These races, whose bodies are far heavier than air, have carved their existence on the floating islands and the colossal continents below. Though they are rooted to the ground, their presence is no less formidable, and they bring their unique cultures and traditions to the world of Kaysender.

In the diverse lands of Kaysender, the various races each bring unique traits and traditions that shape their societies.

Dwager (Dwarves) are revered for their unparalleled skill in crafting and mining. Known for their ability to carve cities and fortresses out of stone and metal, the Dwager's work ethic is rooted in centuries of tradition. Their stonework extends beyond the earthly realms, symbolizing their deep connection to the land. A culture built on strict honor codes and tight-knit communities, the Dwager focus on family, craftsmanship, and preserving ancient practices. Their

love for the earth is evident in every facet of their society, from the intricate carvings adorning their holds to the sturdy fortresses that endure through the ages.

Dragon Kin (Dragonborn) are a proud, formidable people, their bloodline tracing back to the great dragons of the skies. With immense physical strength, long lifespans, and a natural affinity for fire and magic, the Dragon Kin have forged their own powerful kingdoms. Their warrior cultures are founded on principles of strength, leadership, and honor, reflecting the fiery, unyielding nature of their dragon ancestors. Feared and respected across Kaysender, the Dragon Kin are relentless in defending their territories, their fierce temperaments a reflection of the mighty beasts they descend from.

Lizzzefaire (Lizardfolk) are a smaller but resilient race, known for their agility and survival skills in the harshest environments. Adaptable hunters and gatherers, the Lizzzefaire thrive in the wilds of Kaysender, their tribes forming close-knit communities across the floating islands. Their culture is deeply connected to the natural world, emphasizing resourcefulness and strength. Revered for their cunning and ability to endure where others falter, the Lizzzefaire are both feared and respected in the untamed corners of the world.

Hume (Humans) are a race defined by their boundless curiosity and ambition. While physically less imposing than other races, the Hume's ingenuity and adaptability have allowed them to spread throughout Kaysender, establishing themselves in nearly every corner of the world. From bustling merchant cities to isolated farming communities, Hume societies are as diverse as they are widespread. Known for their knack for forging alliances and advancing through both diplomacy and conflict, humans are often the catalysts of change in the ever-evolving world of Kaysender.

Fae (Elves) bring their ancient wisdom and graceful mastery over magic to Kaysender. With lifespans that stretch into centuries, the Fae are scholars of the arcane and stewards of nature, their deep knowledge of both magic and the natural world shaping their society. Primarily residing on the floating islands, the Fae are seen as the guardians of the old ways, blending magic and nature in ways few can comprehend. Their culture is one of quiet reverence for the world around them, and their magical prowess is both revered and respected by all.

Halflings are small in stature but resilient in spirit, bringing warmth, hospitality, and practicality to the communities they inhabit. Known for their hearty appetites and jovial nature, Halflings excel as merchants, farmers, and innkeepers, often serving as the glue that holds diverse communities together. Their adaptability allows them to thrive in any environment, and their close-knit families and festive celebrations make them beloved throughout Kaysender. Though they may be small, their presence is larger than life.

Gezistack (Gnomes) are the inventive geniuses behind many of Kaysender's greatest technological feats. Though often overlooked due to their diminutive size, the Gnomes are

unmatched in their ability to create intricate machines, magical contraptions, and technological marvels. Their societies are filled with laboratories, workshops, and libraries, all driven by an insatiable curiosity and a love for discovery. With a focus on innovation and the exploration of both magic and technology, the Gnomes' influence on Kaysender is far-reaching and invaluable.

In the ever-changing, chaotic landscape of Kaysender, where floating islands drift through the skies and natural disasters are frequent, each race has developed unique methods of coping with the unpredictable environment.

Dwager (Dwarves) are experts in stability, both in architecture and in attitude. The Dwager have long been accustomed to the unpredictable nature of the floating islands, often building their cities and fortresses with reinforced foundations that can withstand both the violent storms and tremors that shake the islands. Their underground holds are designed to be self-sustaining, offering them protection from the harsh weather above. Their deep respect for the earth and its stability manifests in their ability to dig into the very rock of the islands, creating secure havens beneath the surface. The Dwager also value close-knit community bonds, helping them to endure the chaos with a collective sense of purpose and resilience.

Dragon Kin (Dragonborn) have adapted to the volatile nature of Kaysender with a fierce independence and natural leadership. Their affinity for fire and magic allows them to manipulate the environment around them, controlling the destructive forces when necessary. They've established their powerful kingdoms in the more stable and defensible regions of the islands, often building cities high above the clouds or in remote mountain peaks where they can observe and defend themselves from threats. Their warrior cultures place a premium on adaptability, and they embrace the volatility of the world as a test of strength and leadership. They've learned to ride the winds of chaos, using the sky as their battlefield and their territories as a base for ensuring their dominion.

Lizzefaire (Lizardfolk) thrive in the ever-changing landscape of floating islands through their natural survival instincts and adaptability. With their keen connection to the land and water, the Lizzefaire have developed the ability to navigate the shifting islands with ease, using their agility to scale cliffs or dive into rivers that appear and disappear with the changing tides of the sky. Their societies are built around movement and flexibility, allowing them to migrate as needed when an island becomes too dangerous or inhospitable. Their deep understanding of nature and survival skills make them invaluable in times of crisis, and they often serve as guides or scouts for those navigating the unpredictable wilderness.

Hume (Humans) face the chaos of Kaysender with innovation and resilience. Humans are known for their ability to adapt to new circumstances, and this is reflected in how they approach the challenges of a world that is constantly shifting. They've learned to build floating cities, harnessing the power of magic and technology to stabilize structures and ensure they don't drift aimlessly into the sky. Their diverse societies often prioritize exploration, seeking out new territories and building bridges between islands when the old ones fall into disrepair. Humans are also skilled diplomats, negotiating alliances and adapting their strategies to navigate the ever-present challenges of living in a constantly changing world. Their drive to explore and conquer the unknown is often their greatest asset in facing the sky's uncertainties.

Fae (Elves) are attuned to the natural cycles of the world, using their deep knowledge of magic to maintain balance in the chaotic environment of Kaysender. Their long lives give them a sense of continuity, allowing them to see the larger patterns of the shifting islands and harness magic to influence those patterns when necessary. They've developed powerful wards and enchantments that help stabilize their floating cities, protecting them from the worst of the storms and tremors. Their magic is often tied to the very fabric of nature, and they use their connection to the floating islands' flora and fauna to maintain harmony. The Fae have mastered the art of patience, waiting for the natural world to realign itself before making their move, and they act as stabilizing forces in the more volatile regions of Kaysender.

Halflings have mastered the art of thriving in chaos by maintaining a lighthearted and adaptable approach to life. Their small stature and practical mindset allow them to move quickly and efficiently, adapting to new environments with ease. Halflings are known for their ability to make a home in any place, no matter how unstable the ground beneath their feet might be. They've created portable communities that can be moved when necessary, and their skills as farmers, innkeepers, and merchants allow them to establish a sense of normalcy wherever they go. Their jovial nature and ability to find joy in the smallest things help them cope with the uncertainty of their world, and they are often the first to extend a hand to others, offering shelter and food to those displaced by disaster.

Gezistack (Gnomes) embrace the chaotic nature of Kaysender with boundless curiosity and inventive spirit. The unpredictable sky islands present endless opportunities for discovery, and the Gnomes have developed a variety of magical and mechanical devices designed to withstand the shifting environment. Floating cities and airships powered by a combination of magic and engineering are common in Gezistack societies, and their technological prowess allows them to invent tools that can adapt to the changing landscape. Gnomes are also skilled at predicting the movements of the islands, using their knowledge of both magic and mechanical engineering to create devices that help stabilize or navigate through the chaotic skies. For them, the volatility of Kaysender is simply another puzzle to solve, and they approach it with a relentless drive for innovation.

Dwager (Dwarves)

Cultural History:

The Dwager's origins trace back to a time before the floating islands were fully formed. Ancient Dwager were among the first to forge their cities in the stone of the islands, driven by a desire for permanence in a world that constantly shifted. Their culture is centered on craftsmanship and community, passed down through generations of master builders and miners. Dwager history is marked by wars of survival, particularly when invading forces from other races sought to plunder their rich stone and metal resources. The Dwager's ability to build formidable fortresses, often deeply embedded within the islands' rock, has made them one of the most resilient races.

Wars and Animus:

The Dwager have been involved in numerous conflicts, often defending their lands against the Dragon Kin, who sought to claim the mountainous regions the Dwager hold sacred. Ancient grudges run deep, as the Dragon Kin saw the Dwager's underground holds as valuable strategic positions, while the Dwager viewed the Dragon Kin as arrogant invaders. This animosity remains today, though occasional alliances have been formed to deal with common threats. The Dwager have also been known to clash with the Lizzzeffaire over hunting grounds and territorial boundaries in the wilds of the floating islands.

Societal Backgrounds and Viewpoints:

Dwager society is structured around clans, with each clan vying for prominence through skill and honor in craftsmanship. These clans are highly protective of their heritage, with individuals often choosing professions based on family tradition. The Dwager place great importance on their ancestors, and their halls are filled with intricate carvings and relics that honor those who came before them. Dwager honor codes are strict, and a breach of these codes can lead to exile or even death. Though they are slow to trust outsiders, they form deep and lasting bonds with those they deem worthy, viewing loyalty and duty as the highest virtues.

Dragon Kin (Dragonborn)

Cultural History:

The Dragon Kin's history is a reflection of their dragon ancestors' pride and power. Once scattered across the sky islands, they eventually unified under powerful warlords who sought to emulate the dragons in both strength and majesty. Their civilizations were built upon conquest and the consolidation of territories, leading to the creation of powerful kingdoms centered on ancient bloodlines. The Dragon Kin value their connection to the dragons, seeing themselves as

the earthly representatives of their mighty forebears. Their history is rife with tales of battles fought for dominance and the preservation of their royal lineage.

Wars and Animus:

The Dragon Kin have had a contentious relationship with the Dwager for centuries, as both races vie for control over the more stable regions of the islands. The most notable conflict was the Great Sky War, a long and brutal conflict where the Dragon Kin sought to seize Dwager mountain strongholds, leading to a war that nearly devastated both peoples. While there is an uneasy peace now, the tensions remain, with the Dragon Kin viewing the Dwager as rivals, and the Dwager viewing the Dragon Kin as proud invaders. The Dragon Kin also have a history of conflict with the Fae, who view the Dragon Kin's destructive nature as a threat to the natural balance they strive to maintain. The Dragon Kin's connection to fire and magic has earned them a reputation for being unpredictable and dangerous, leading to distrust from the more cautious races.

Societal Backgrounds and Viewpoints:

Dragon Kin society is heavily influenced by the ideals of strength, leadership, and honor. Their kings and queens are often selected based on their ability to demonstrate exceptional power and leadership in combat, and their warriors are expected to follow the ancient traditions of battle. The Dragon Kin value family and lineage above all else, with each individual's status often determined by their bloodline. While they are fiercely loyal to their kin, they are also extremely competitive, often engaging in contests of strength and leadership. The Dragon Kin's worldview is shaped by the belief that only the strong should rule, and they are often dismissive of the perceived weakness of other races.

Lizzzefaire (Lizardfolk)

Cultural History:

The Lizzzefaire have always been a nomadic people, wandering the floating islands in small, tight-knit tribes. Their culture is one of survival, and their history is marked by a constant struggle to adapt to the ever-changing environment of Kaysender. Ancient Lizzzefaire legends tell of great floods and storms that shaped their way of life, leading them to develop extraordinary skills in hunting, gathering, and navigating the perilous terrain. Over time, the Lizzzefaire have learned to live in harmony with the shifting islands, their society built on flexibility and resourcefulness.

Wars and Animus:

While the Lizzzefaire are not an expansionist race, they have been involved in numerous territorial disputes, particularly with the Dwager, who view the wilds as their domain. The Lizzzefaire's hunting grounds and nomadic nature often bring them into conflict with the

Dwager, whose settlements disrupt the natural ecosystems that the Lizzzefaire rely on. There is also a long-standing rivalry with the Dragon Kin, who, in their pride, often see the Lizzzefaire as beneath them and unworthy of the islands' bounty. The Lizzzefaire are often marginalized by the other races but fiercely defend their right to live freely and independently.

Societal Backgrounds and Viewpoints:

Lizzzefaire culture is centered on survival, adaptability, and respect for nature. Their tribes are led by the wisest and most experienced members, known as the "Elder Serpents," who guide the community based on instinct and knowledge of the natural world. The Lizzzefaire value strength, resourcefulness, and cunning, with each tribe having its own unique set of traditions and rituals tied to their environment. They are generally distrustful of outsiders, but once a bond of respect is formed, they are fiercely loyal. The Lizzzefaire place little value on material wealth, instead focusing on maintaining balance with the world around them.

Hume (Humans)

Cultural History:

Human history is defined by a relentless drive for exploration, conquest, and innovation. Unlike other races, who often remain isolated within their own territories, the Hume have spread across every corner of Kaysender, establishing societies wherever they can. From the earliest days of wandering tribes to the establishment of sprawling cities and floating islands, humans have adapted to every environment. Their history is filled with tales of discovery and exploration, as well as conquest and colonization. However, they also have a dark history of conflict with other races, particularly over resources and territory.

Wars and Animus:

Humans have been involved in a number of conflicts throughout Kaysender's history, most notably with the Dragon Kin and the Fae. The Dragon Kin, seeing the Hume as a threat to their dominance, have clashed with them over territorial control. The Fae, who see humans as reckless and short-sighted, have often acted as guardians against human expansion. However, humans have also forged alliances with various races, using diplomacy, trade, and their technological prowess to influence the balance of power. The Dwager and Lizzzefaire, although not always trusting of humans, have also found themselves relying on human ingenuity in times of need.

Societal Backgrounds and Viewpoints:

Human society is incredibly diverse, with cultures ranging from nomadic tribes to sophisticated merchant cities. Humans are defined by their adaptability, able to thrive in nearly any environment. They value exploration and discovery, always seeking to expand their knowledge and influence. However, human societies can also be highly competitive, and their political systems often lead to factionalism and internal strife. Despite this, humans are known for their

resilience and drive to overcome any obstacle, often using diplomacy and technology to achieve their goals.

Fae (Elves)

Cultural History:

The Fae are one of the oldest races in Kaysender, their history stretching back thousands of years. They have seen the rise and fall of countless civilizations, and their long lives allow them to maintain a deep connection to the natural world. The Fae's culture is one of preservation, seeking to protect the ancient ways and balance of nature. Their society is built on knowledge, magic, and tradition, with a focus on maintaining harmony between the natural world and the magical forces that shape it. Their history is marked by periods of isolation and contemplation, as they often retreat from the turmoil of the world to safeguard the environment.

Wars and Animus:

The Fae have had a complex relationship with the other races, often viewing them with a mix of curiosity and caution. They have a long-standing animosity with the Dragon Kin, who, with their destructive nature, threaten the delicate balance the Fae strive to maintain. There have been several conflicts over the centuries between the two races, with the Fae often acting as defenders of nature against the fiery wrath of the Dragon Kin. The Dwager, on the other hand, are generally viewed with respect, though there are tensions over mining and resource extraction, which the Fae see as a threat to the natural world. The Lizzzefaire are often allies of the Fae, as both races share a deep respect for nature.

Societal Backgrounds and Viewpoints:

Fae society is centered around wisdom, magic, and the preservation of the natural world. They are deeply spiritual, with many Fae dedicating their lives to studying the ancient ways and maintaining the balance of magic in the world. Their society is hierarchical, with the oldest and wisest often holding the most power. The Fae value grace, patience, and harmony, and their long lives allow them to take a long-term view of the world, often acting as stewards of nature rather than conquerors. They see themselves as protectors of the balance and are often wary of the more impulsive and expansionist tendencies of other races.

Gezistack (Gnomes)

Cultural History:

Gnomish history is one of invention and discovery. Unlike the other races, who often focus on strength or tradition, the Gnomes have always been driven by a thirst for knowledge and an

unyielding curiosity. They were once a wandering people, seeking out new frontiers of magic and technology. Over time, they established cities and laboratories, pushing the boundaries of both arcane and mechanical invention. Gnome society has often been in the background of major conflicts, providing technological support to the other races but remaining largely neutral in warfare.

Wars and Animus:

The Gnomes tend to avoid direct involvement in wars, preferring instead to use their inventions to mediate conflicts or provide technological solutions. However, there have been times when their creations have been used as weapons, leading to unintended consequences. The Dragon Kin have often seen Gnomish inventions as a threat to their dominance, while the Lizzzefaire and Dwager view the Gnomes as oddities, sometimes useful but often distrusted. Despite this, the Gnomes have played a pivotal role in the technological progress of Kaysender, often working behind the scenes to develop devices that help mitigate the chaos of the floating islands.

Societal Backgrounds and Viewpoints:

Gnomish society is built on curiosity, invention, and discovery. They are driven by a desire to learn and understand the world around them, often working together in collaborative environments like workshops and laboratories. Their societies are egalitarian, with individuals encouraged to pursue their passions and ideas. However, Gnomes can be insular, focusing so intensely on their inventions that they sometimes neglect the outside world. Despite this, they are generally seen as friendly and helpful, with a tendency to form alliances with those who share their thirst for knowledge.

Each of these races, while bound to the land, has created their own unique culture and identity within the sky-bound world of Kaysender. Though they may differ in appearance, abilities, and traditions, they all share the desire to carve out their place in a world that is as unpredictable as the winds that sweep across the skies. For the players, these diverse and vibrant cultures will form the foundation of their journey, offering both allies and enemies, as well as countless opportunities for adventure and discovery.

The continent of Messara, the largest known landmass in Kaysender, is a land marked by ceaseless turmoil and strife. Its jagged mountain ranges, towering mesas, and treacherous valleys are scarred by the fires of endless conflict. The land itself seems as unforgiving as the battles fought upon it, with every horizon filled with craggy peaks and rugged terrain that have withstood centuries of warfare. Deep, foreboding ravines and chasms stretch across the continent, leading into abyssal depths where oceans and rivers plunge into oblivion, seemingly vanishing into eternity. These natural features are as much a part of Messara's identity as the brutal conflicts that rage across its surface.

In the high reaches of Messara, snow-capped mountains pierce the sky, their peaks home to deadly predators and harsh, unyielding climates. Mighty creatures, like the elusive hymaces—beasts with sharp claws and razor teeth—roam the highlands, preying on those unfortunate enough to wander too far into the wilderness. Tigers, swift and deadly, stalk the forests and jungles, their keen senses honed by generations of living in the continent's vast and varied ecosystems. These creatures, alongside the harsh environment, make life in Messara a constant struggle for survival, whether against the elements or the ever-present threat of violence from one's fellow inhabitants.

As the largest and most populous continent in Kaysender, Messara is also one of the most fiercely contested lands. Its dense population is a patchwork of conflicting factions, each vying for power, resources, and dominance. The land is dotted with a web of enclave settlements, scattered farmsteads, and fortified communities, each existing within the constant shadow of war. Large cities and smaller villages alike are fortified against the constant threat of invasion or sabotage, their residents living on the edge, where survival often depends on the strength of one's allies and the sharpness of one's blade.

The conflict that defines Messara is eternal, as old as the land itself. Alliances form and fracture with each passing season, as rival factions engage in bitter struggles for control. For a time, a fragile peace may break out—temporary ceasefires that allow the warring factions to rebuild, regroup, and fortify their holdings. In these moments of uneasy truce, factions spend their time strengthening their ties to potential allies, spying on their enemies, and preparing for the inevitable next clash. These tenuous periods of peace rarely last long, as old grudges and ambitions stir once again, sending the continent spiraling back into the chaos of war.

The land's endless conflict is a defining characteristic of Messara, shaping its people and its cultures. While some factions engage in direct combat, others rely on espionage, trade wars, and political maneuvering to outlast their rivals. In this tumultuous world, the strong thrive, the clever endure, and the weak are consumed by the tides of warfare. The residents of Messara live with the constant knowledge that at any moment, their settlement could be the next target of a raid or a siege. Yet, despite the constant threat of violence, the people of Messara are remarkably resilient, forging new alliances, expanding their territories, and seeking new opportunities in a world where conflict is never far behind.

For those from the land-bound races, Messara represents both a land of opportunity and a battleground where survival depends on one's ability to navigate the complex web of alliances, rivalries, and ever-shifting loyalties. It is a place where the constant clash of cultures, factions, and peoples gives rise to both moments of great achievement and unimaginable destruction.

In a world like Kaysender, where the very land heaves itself into the sky and drifts aimlessly through the heavens, stability is a fleeting illusion. The floating continents, islands, and landmasses constantly shift, drifting like leaves on the wind, their paths unpredictable and often

uncharted. The earth beneath one's feet may seem solid one moment, only for it to break free from its anchor in the next, leaving entire regions suspended in the air or veering off into uncharted territories. The laws of nature themselves seem in flux, with gravity sometimes bending to the whims of ancient forces, and the ground beneath shifting as if in response to some unseen cosmic pulse.

This instability is reflected in the lives of those who call Kaysender home. Societies are built on the constant awareness that nothing is ever truly permanent. Cities, once thriving hubs of culture and commerce, may suddenly find themselves floating into unknown regions, their inhabitants forced to adapt or risk being lost forever. Islands that once formed a tight-knit chain of settlements may break apart, separating families, friends, and entire communities. Trade routes that once felt reliable may become inaccessible, or worse, swallowed by chasms that open unexpectedly in the ground. It is a world where everything is subject to change, and where the next shift in the land could bring both opportunity and disaster in equal measure.

For the people of Kaysender, the only certainty is uncertainty. Survival depends not only on strength and resourcefulness but also on the ability to adapt to the ever-changing world around them. Factions rise and fall with the shifting tides of geography, alliances are forged and broken on the whim of the wind, and the very landscapes of entire regions can be reshaped overnight. In a world where even the ground beneath your feet can suddenly abandon you, the only real constant is the need to keep moving forward, to forge new paths, and to make peace with the chaos that defines life in Kaysender.

The Continent of Messara

Messara is a sprawling landmass teeming with diverse nations, each with its unique economic, cultural, and political characteristics. Here are the key nations and their relative standings in various sectors:

1. Valeria (The Kingdom of Valeria)

Economic Position:

Valeria is one of the wealthiest nations on Messara, with a highly developed economy centered around trade, agriculture, and craftsmanship. The nation benefits from fertile lands, thriving merchant cities, and access to key trade routes. Valeria is known for its high-quality textiles,

spices, and fine metalwork. It has extensive maritime trade networks, making it a commercial hub of the continent.

Cultural Status:

Valeria is culturally prosperous, with a rich history of art, music, and literature. The people of Valeria value education and intellectual pursuit, leading to the establishment of prestigious academies and cultural institutions. The nation is also known for its vibrant festivals and strong patronage of the arts. While Valeria has experienced cultural expansion, particularly in the fields of philosophy and the arts, there is a tendency to maintain traditional customs.

Religious Influence:

Valeria is predominantly monotheistic, with a religion that worships the Great Light, a deity of justice, order, and knowledge. The priesthood holds significant influence, guiding the cultural and ethical standards of society. Religion plays a pivotal role in daily life, with the state often working in concert with the clergy to maintain law and order.

Government and Military:

Valeria operates under a monarchy, though it has a council of advisors who hold significant political power. The monarchy is strong, but internal strife between noble families occasionally threatens stability. Valeria's military is highly disciplined, with an impressive navy that dominates the seas. On land, their military is formidable, though they rely heavily on mercenaries for larger campaigns. The military remains well-funded, though it has been in a slow decline in terms of innovation compared to neighboring nations.

Overall Status:

Ascendant: Valeria's economy, military, and cultural influence are all in a period of growth, bolstered by thriving trade and cultural expansion. However, internal political struggles may threaten future stability.

2. Faelenor (The Republic of Faelenor)

Economic Position:

Faelenor has experienced significant economic growth in recent decades, thanks to its flourishing agricultural sector and rapidly expanding industries. The nation is renowned for its vast forests, providing timber, furs, and natural resources for export. Its cities are home to large factories that produce goods for both domestic and international markets, positioning Faelenor as an emerging industrial power.

Cultural Status:

Faelenor prides itself on being a land of liberty and progress. It is a republic, and its people are

dedicated to intellectual freedom and egalitarianism. The culture of Faelenor is heavily influenced by rationalism and scientific inquiry, with a growing emphasis on education. While there is a strong respect for innovation, traditional customs are sometimes at odds with the rapidly changing urban culture. However, the arts and literature have thrived in the cities, making Faelenor a center of intellectual exchange.

Religious Influence:

Faelenor is a secular nation, with religion having little impact on the daily functioning of society. The state maintains neutrality in religious matters, and various religious groups co-exist without significant conflict. While the majority of the population follows the traditional polytheistic pantheon, newer spiritual movements are gaining traction, particularly among the intellectual elite.

Government and Military:

Faelenor's government is a republic led by a council elected by the people. The political structure is heavily democratic, with frequent elections and direct participation from citizens. The military is relatively new compared to older nations, having grown quickly in response to external threats. While the military has a solid foundation, it is still in the process of modernizing its forces. Faelenor's strength lies in its defensive capabilities, bolstered by well-fortified cities and an expanding army.

Overall Status:

In Ascension: Faelenor is experiencing rapid industrial and cultural growth, but it is still consolidating its position as a world power. Its secular, progressive nature positions it well for future success, though it faces internal challenges related to balancing tradition with modernization.

3. Teralon (The Empire of Teralon)

Economic Position:

Teralon has a mixed economy, with a strong base in mining, agriculture, and the lucrative trade of precious gems and metals. Its vast mountain ranges provide access to rich mineral deposits, which have driven the economy for centuries. However, over-reliance on mining has led to environmental degradation, and the economy has stagnated in some regions. Trade with other nations is essential for the survival of Teralon's cities, and many of its elite class gain wealth through trade agreements rather than local production.

Cultural Status:

Teralon's culture is deeply rooted in its imperial past. It is a highly stratified society, with a powerful nobility that controls much of the wealth and resources. The empire's nobility sees

itself as the inheritor of the ancient empires that once spanned the continent. While the lower classes are largely ignored by the elite, Teralon boasts impressive monuments and a rich historical tradition. Recent efforts to revitalize the empire's cultural influence have met with mixed results, as many citizens long for a return to former glory, while others push for a more egalitarian society.

Religious Influence:

Teralon is a highly religious nation, with the worship of the divine emperors taking precedence over other deities. The imperial family is seen as divinely chosen, and the emperor is considered the earthly representative of the gods. The church and state are deeply intertwined, and the church plays a significant role in dictating the moral and ethical direction of society. The current emperor's grip on power is strong but fragile, as factions within the clergy vie for influence.

Government and Military:

Teralon is an autocratic empire ruled by a monarch who holds absolute power. The emperor's rule is reinforced by the clergy, which holds sway over both the political and military sectors. The military is large, well-equipped, and highly disciplined, but much of its strength is rooted in tradition and old tactics. Though formidable on the battlefield, the empire's resources are stretched thin by its internal struggles and the need to defend its borders from increasingly aggressive neighbors. The military has recently undergone reforms, but the effectiveness of these changes remains to be seen.

Overall Status:

Declining: Teralon's glory days are behind it, and while its military and religious influence are still formidable, the empire struggles with internal decay, resource depletion, and challenges from other growing nations. The future of the empire seems uncertain unless significant reforms are made.

4. Silvalis (The Confederacy of Silvalis)

Economic Position:

Silvalis is a coalition of independent city-states, united under a loose confederation. It has a highly diversified economy, driven by agriculture, crafts, and trade. The confederacy is known for its highly skilled artisans, particularly in textiles, leatherwork, and pottery. Though not as wealthy as the largest empires, Silvalis thrives on the trade of fine goods and has established itself as a commercial power through its merchant guilds. Its economy, while not growing as rapidly as its neighbors, remains stable.

Cultural Status:

Silvalis has a rich and diverse culture, shaped by the many city-states that make up the

confederacy. Each city-state maintains its own customs, languages, and traditions, but there is a unifying respect for art, trade, and personal liberty. Silvalis is a hub for intellectual pursuits, with universities and academies that draw scholars from all over the continent. Though there is a strong sense of individuality, the confederacy is united in its commitment to the principles of trade, negotiation, and peaceful coexistence.

Religious Influence:

Silvalis is a polytheistic society, with a variety of religious beliefs and practices. The nation is tolerant of all faiths, and many different temples and shrines are scattered across its city-states. However, religion is generally not as influential as in other nations, as the people of Silvalis value personal freedom and the pursuit of knowledge above religious devotion. The religious landscape is diverse, with cults dedicated to everything from trade gods to those who venerate the natural world.

Government and Military:

Silvalis is a decentralized confederation, with each city-state retaining significant autonomy. There is no centralized government, and decisions are made through a series of councils and assemblies. This structure has allowed the city-states to flourish independently, but it also means that Silvalis is often slow to act as a united force. The military is small, consisting primarily of mercenaries and volunteer militias. Silvalis relies heavily on diplomacy and trade to maintain its influence, but its lack of a standing army makes it vulnerable to external threats.

Overall Status:

Stable: Silvalis is not in a period of significant growth or decline. It is a nation of artisans, traders, and intellectuals, but its lack of military strength and decentralized government structure could make it vulnerable in the long term.

5. Vornak (The Vornak Tribes)

Economic Position:

Vornak is a collection of warrior tribes rather than a unified nation. Its economy is largely based on raiding, hunting, and the gathering of resources from the land. While it is not a major economic power on the continent, the Vornak control vast swaths of territory rich in natural resources such as furs, timber, and herbs. However, their nomadic lifestyle means they do not have the same level of trade influence as other nations.

Cultural Status:

The Vornak are a proud and fiercely independent people, with a culture based on strength, honor, and survival. Their society is deeply connected to the land, and they value martial prowess above all else. Vornak society is organized around clan leaders, and each tribe has its own traditions and

rituals. The Vornak are not interested in luxury or wealth but prefer a life of freedom and personal strength.

Religious Influence:

The Vornak believe in a pantheon of spirits and deities that embody various aspects of nature, strength, and the hunt. Their religious practices are rooted in shamanism and animism, with spiritual leaders guiding the tribes in their rituals. Though religion is central to their worldview, the Vornak do not allow it to control their actions, and they see it more as a means of maintaining harmony with the land.

Government and Military:

The Vornak have no centralized government; instead, leadership is determined by strength and respect within each tribe. The tribes are highly militaristic, with warriors forming the backbone of their society. While the Vornak do not have the same level of organization as other nations, their warriors are formidable, and their raids on neighboring territories have earned them a fearsome reputation. Their military strength lies in their ability to mobilize quickly and strike with overwhelming force.

Overall Status:

In Decline: While the Vornak remain strong, their nomadic nature and lack of infrastructure have made it difficult for them to adapt to the changing world. Their raids and territorial disputes are often met with retaliation from more organized nations, and their once-feared strength is beginning to wane as other nations grow more powerful.

6. Rylune (The Kingdom of Rylune)**Economic Position:**

Rylune is an agrarian kingdom known for its fertile plains and expansive agricultural output. The nation's economy is centered around farming, livestock, and the production of essential foodstuffs, making it a cornerstone for neighboring nations. However, the kingdom has faced economic challenges in recent years due to recurring droughts and floods, which have disrupted crop production. Rylune is heavily reliant on trade, exporting grains and meat to other nations, but its economy has suffered from periodic famines and the rising influence of industrialized nations.

Cultural Status:

Rylune holds onto a rich, ancient cultural tradition deeply intertwined with the land. Its people revere nature and the seasons, celebrating agricultural festivals and honoring harvest gods. The kingdom has a strong feudal structure, with a deeply rooted sense of duty to landowners and lords. The sense of unity within Rylune is grounded in family, loyalty, and a close connection to the earth, and the arts are generally practical, revolving around craftsmanship, literature, and the

maintenance of agricultural knowledge. Modernization is slow in Rylune, as the people remain wary of industrialization that might disrupt their way of life.

Religious Influence:

Rylune is predominantly polytheistic, with a pantheon focused on nature and agricultural gods, as well as ancestral spirits. Religion plays a vital role in shaping everyday life, with villagers offering prayers and sacrifices at seasonal festivals. The monarchy maintains a close relationship with the priesthood, and many lords are expected to uphold religious traditions in their holdings. Despite the strong religious presence, there are signs of growing secularism among the younger generations who seek broader horizons beyond their rural roots.

Government and Military:

Rylune operates under a monarchy with a strong feudal structure. The king's power is often constrained by the influence of powerful noble families who own large swaths of land. Local lords often rule with considerable autonomy, and power struggles between the monarchy and noble families are not uncommon. The military is largely composed of conscripts from the peasantry, with a small, professional core of knights and elite warriors. Though Rylune's military is adept at defending its borders, it struggles to maintain an organized, modern force that can compete with industrialized nations. Its reliance on outdated tactics and technology has made it vulnerable to external threats.

Overall Status:

In Decline: Rylune faces economic instability, declining military power, and growing internal divisions. Though still a center of agricultural production, it is becoming increasingly vulnerable to the changing landscape of the continent, where industrialization and urbanization are reshaping the power dynamics.

7. Zarovar (The Federation of Zarovar)

Economic Position:

Zarovar is a burgeoning industrial power with a rapidly developing economy based on mining, steel production, and heavy industry. The nation has vast deposits of precious metals and coal, which have allowed it to build massive factories and power plants. The rise of mechanized production has propelled Zarovar to the forefront of industrial innovation, and it is now considered one of the most economically influential nations on Messara. Despite its economic success, Zarovar faces challenges with pollution and labor unrest, particularly in its urban centers.

Cultural Status:

Zarovar's culture is shaped by its industrial revolution, with a growing divide between the rich

elite and the working class. The nation's cities are filled with factories, railways, and smog-filled skies. A new, utilitarian culture has emerged in response to the rapid changes, valuing progress, efficiency, and productivity. The arts in Zarovar are often focused on industrial themes and practical applications, though the older traditions of music and literature still hold sway in the rural areas. While the elites live in opulent city centers, the working class lives in harsh conditions, leading to widespread social unrest.

Religious Influence:

Zarovar has a highly secular government, with religion playing a minimal role in politics. Most of the population follows a form of animism, believing in spirits of nature and machines, as the nation's industrialization has sparked a unique blend of belief systems. A growing number of citizens are beginning to embrace atheism, particularly among the urban intellectuals and factory workers. Despite the decline in religious observance, some factions continue to promote traditional faiths, which are occasionally in conflict with the emerging modern, rationalist worldview.

Government and Military:

Zarovar is governed by a coalition of technocrats and industrial moguls, with power concentrated in the hands of a small group of wealthy elites. The government is heavily focused on technological innovation, economic growth, and maintaining social order. Militarily, Zarovar has invested heavily in mechanized warfare, developing advanced war machines, airships, and heavy artillery. The nation boasts one of the most formidable and modern armies on the continent, though its reliance on industrial production for military strength makes it vulnerable to resource shortages and labor strikes. Zarovar is increasingly positioning itself as a global power, though its imperialist ambitions are tempered by internal social unrest.

Overall Status:

Ascendant: Zarovar's rapid industrialization and economic growth make it a dominant force in the continent, though it faces challenges related to inequality, labor unrest, and environmental damage. If it can maintain social stability and secure its resources, it has the potential to lead the continent into a new era of technological dominance.

8. Eldrath (The Union of Eldrath)

Economic Position:

Eldrath is a trade-based republic that thrives on its extensive trade routes, serving as a bridge between various nations and continents. The nation's economy is largely driven by commerce, banking, and shipbuilding. It has become one of the most important maritime powers on Messara, with its fleets controlling key ports and shipping lanes. However, Eldrath faces a crisis

of over-dependence on trade, as political instability in neighboring nations disrupts its markets. Despite this, Eldrath remains wealthy due to its established trade routes and merchant guilds.

Cultural Status:

Eldrath's culture is cosmopolitan, shaped by centuries of interaction with foreign cultures through trade and diplomacy. The people of Eldrath value commerce, individualism, and innovation. The nation has a strong merchant class that dictates much of the cultural and political landscape. There is a notable emphasis on foreign languages, cultures, and goods, and Eldrath is a hub for art, fashion, and philosophy. However, this reliance on trade has created a society that values wealth over tradition, with the younger generations showing less interest in the old ways of their ancestors.

Religious Influence:

Eldrath is religiously pluralistic, with various sects coexisting peacefully. While the majority of the population follows a form of pantheism, there is a notable presence of worshippers of trade gods, as well as an increasing number of secular citizens. The government is highly secular, and religious institutions are largely separated from political power, though they hold significant sway over social and moral issues.

Government and Military:

Eldrath is governed by a republic with a strong emphasis on trade and diplomacy. Its government is a mix of elected officials and appointed guild leaders, all of whom have a hand in shaping policies related to commerce, foreign relations, and internal infrastructure. Militarily, Eldrath relies on mercenaries, privateers, and naval forces to protect its interests. The military is not as large as other nations, but its navy is among the most advanced on the continent, and its fleet of merchant ships gives it a unique advantage in protecting its trade routes. Eldrath's navy often acts as a neutral force, ensuring that sea lanes remain open to all nations.

Overall Status:

Stable: Eldrath's economy remains strong, bolstered by its control of key trade routes and its cultural reputation as a center for commerce and innovation. While it faces some political instability from the changing global markets, it continues to thrive as a trading power, though its reliance on maritime trade makes it vulnerable to piracy and conflicts at sea.

9. Imbria (The Theocracy of Imbria)

Economic Position:

Imbria is a theocratic nation, and its economy is primarily agrarian, with a heavy focus on religious pilgrimages and sacred artifacts. The land is arid but fertile in certain regions, and its people rely on agriculture, especially vineyards and olive groves. Despite its natural beauty and

religious significance, Imbria has a relatively weak economy when compared to its neighbors, as its religious focus limits industrial development. Still, its position as a religious center allows it to maintain steady trade, particularly in relics, manuscripts, and sacred goods.

Cultural Status:

Imbria's culture is steeped in religious tradition. Its people are devoted to the divine, and their lives revolve around religious observances and the pursuit of spiritual enlightenment. The nation's capital is a massive cathedral city, home to the highest seats of religious authority. Art, literature, and music in Imbria are deeply influenced by faith, with works of devotion being the highest form of cultural expression. The Imbrians are intensely insular, and they view outsiders with suspicion. Only those who are deemed worthy are allowed to participate in their religious practices.

Religious Influence:

Religion is everything in Imbria. The entire nation is governed by the High Priest, who is believed to be the direct representative of the divine on Earth. The nation's laws and social structures are based on sacred texts, and all actions must align with divine will. The Imbrians believe they are chosen to safeguard the world's spiritual balance, and their devotion to their faith has made them a powerful force in the spiritual realm.

Government and Military:

Theocratic rule defines Imbria, with the High Priest serving as both the spiritual and political leader. There is no separation between church and state, and all government policies are dictated by religious doctrine. The military is small but highly disciplined, acting as both a force of spiritual defense and a means of enforcing the will of the divine. While Imbria's forces are not as large as other nations, they possess powerful divine magic, and their military is seen as both an army and a religious order.

Overall Status:

Stable but Isolated: Imbria's religious devotion and control over spiritual matters provide a strong sense of unity, but its economic and technological isolation puts it at a disadvantage compared to more secular, industrialized nations. Imbria is not in decline, but it is not rising as quickly as its neighbors. It remains a potent spiritual force, though its role in the broader geopolitical sphere is limited.

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National capitals

1. Valeria (Kingdom of Valeria)

- **Capital: Valthorn**
 - **Description:**
 - **Valthorn** is an imposing city, nestled between towering cliffs and the sea. It boasts a **grand palace** with marble walls and gold-inlaid ceilings. The city is a hub of **wealth and diplomacy**, with high spires, intricate statues, and lush gardens that reflect its regal culture.
 - Known for its **noble houses**, **mercantile strength**, and **military presence**, Valthorn serves as both the center of **political power** and a **cultural beacon** of Valeria. The streets are lined with **elegant shops**, **theaters**, and **grand marketplaces**.
 - **Notable Features:**
 - **The Royal Palace:** Home to the ruling monarch, with elaborate courts, guarded by elite soldiers.
 - **The Market District:** A bustling area for luxury goods, including silks, gemstones, and fine wines.
 - **The Arcane Council Hall:** Where magical practitioners meet to discuss matters of state and governance.
 - **Challenges:**
 - Tensions between the **ruling families** and rising **mercantile factions**.
 - Underlying social unrest due to the **concentration of wealth** and political instability.
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2. Faelenor (Republic of Faelenor)

- **Capital: Mirathen**
- **Description:**
 - **Mirathen** is a city of **innovation and industry**, with sprawling factories, open-air markets, and **research institutions**. The city has a distinct **Republican spirit**, with **elected leaders**, public debates, and **scientific advancements** leading the way. The streets are lined with **stone buildings** and **towering spires**, all crowned with lush greenery and gardens.
 - The **heart of scientific progress**, Mirathen is an intellectual hub, with a focus on agriculture, **engineering**, and **mechanical innovations**.
- **Notable Features:**
 - **The Grand Assembly:** The building where elected officials meet to debate and create laws.
 - **The Academy of Progress:** A renowned institution where **scientists** and **engineers** develop new technologies.
 - **The Iron Forge District:** A booming industrial area, full of steam-powered machinery, that produces all manner of goods.
- **Challenges:**

- The clash between **traditionalists** and **reformists** over the direction of the Republic.
 - Rising **economic disparity** as industrialization begins to separate the wealthy from the poor.
-

3. Teralon (Empire of Teralon)

- **Capital: Vorrik**
 - **Description:**
 - **Vorrik** is a **grand imperial city**, a symbol of the Empire's former glory. Its **ancient stone walls** and **imperial palaces** loom over the land, giving the city an imposing presence. The architecture is classical and **fortress-like**, reflecting the Empire's military and religious influence.
 - Despite its **decaying power**, Vorrik remains a center of **religion** and **tradition**, where **priests** and **military commanders** maintain strong control.
 - **Notable Features:**
 - **The Imperial Citadel:** Home to the Emperor and his high command, an enormous fortress overseeing the city.
 - **The Temple of the Divine Fire:** The largest temple in the Empire, dedicated to the gods of war and conquest.
 - **The Barracks of the First Legion:** The home of the Empire's once-feared military forces, now in decline.
 - **Challenges:**
 - **Internal decay** as the Empire crumbles and outside powers eye its weakening grip on the region.
 - Religious strife and rebellion within the city as the masses grow weary of the Emperor's divine mandate.
-

4. Silvalis (Confederacy of Silvalis)

- **Capital: Neylithar**
- **Description:**
 - **Neylithar** is a city of great **intellectual and cultural diversity**, an amalgamation of **city-states** and independent thinkers. The city is divided into several districts, each representing different **factions**, **guilds**, or **schools of thought**. Narrow, cobbled streets wind between **architectural marvels** blending **elven**, **dwarven**, and **human influences**.
 - A city of free thinkers and traders, **Neylithar** is a **melting pot** where knowledge and goods flow freely. Scholars, merchants, and craftsmen from across the continent come here to **exchange ideas** and **build alliances**.
- **Notable Features:**

- **The Arcane Forum:** A prestigious academic institution where the brightest minds meet to debate magic and philosophy.
 - **The Grand Bazaar:** A labyrinthine market offering everything from **rare artifacts** to **exotic spices**.
 - **The Forum of Guilds:** Where representatives of various guilds and factions gather to discuss business and form alliances.
 - **Challenges:**
 - The lack of **centralized leadership** creates ongoing conflicts between the various **independent city-states**.
 - **Power struggles** between guilds and factions for dominance over the Confederacy's wealth and resources.
-

5. Vornak (Vornak Tribes)

- **Capital:** Grimhold
 - **Description:**
 - **Grimhold** is a **nomadic capital** built around a central stronghold, a massive **stone fortress**. The city is home to various **tribal chieftains** and their followers, each contributing to the defense and survival of the region. **Grimhold** is a place of **barbaric glory**, a symbol of the tribes' ability to **survive** and **dominate**.
 - The city is often on the move, shifting locations based on the changing seasons or the **tribal needs**.
 - **Notable Features:**
 - **The Great Arena:** Where tribal leaders settle disputes through combat, showcasing strength and valor.
 - **The Iron Wastes:** The home of the forges, where the tribes produce weapons and armor to defend themselves against external threats.
 - **The High Council Tent:** Where the tribe's leaders meet to discuss important matters, offering a rare sense of unity among the otherwise fragmented tribes.
 - **Challenges:**
 - **Disunity** among the tribes leads to internal conflicts and the occasional rebellion against the central authority of the chief.
 - Pressure from neighboring nations as the tribal factions grow weaker and more susceptible to external influences.
-

6. Rylune (Kingdom of Rylune)

- **Capital:** Falyris
- **Description:**
 - **Falyris** is a **peaceful and agrarian city**, known for its rolling hills and **lush farmlands**. The city itself is **quaint**, with **wooden cottages** and **flower-lined**

streets. The capital embodies the **rural nature** of Rylune, its residents highly focused on **agriculture** and **peaceful living**.

- Despite the idyllic setting, **Falyris** is marked by **economic instability**, as food shortages and old customs clash with the need for modernization.

- **Notable Features:**

- **The Harvest Hall:** Where farmers and traders meet to discuss agricultural matters and exchange goods.
- **The Royal Gardens:** The serene and peaceful grounds of the royal family, where the royals spend their time cultivating and reflecting on the land's bounty.
- **The Central Market:** A marketplace for **grains**, **livestock**, and **local produce**, as well as artisans' goods.

- **Challenges:**

- **Famine** and the ever-growing need to find new ways to feed the population as agriculture becomes less predictable.
 - **Political infighting** between old nobility who want to maintain traditional rule and the new merchants who push for more industrialization.
-

7. Zarovar (Federation of Zarovar)

- **Capital: Kalthor**

- **Description:**

- **Kalthor** is a **bustling industrial city** with towering smokestacks, massive factories, and sprawling slums. It is the heart of Zarovar's **mining** and **steel** industries. The city is heavily focused on production, with an economy driven by raw materials and manufacturing. The **cluttered** streets are filled with workers, merchants, and engineers, all vying to make a name for themselves in a society that values **progress and hard work**.

- **Notable Features:**

- **The Foundries:** Giant factories where raw materials are smelted into weapons, armor, and tools, providing the backbone of the nation's economy.
- **The Steel Coliseum:** Where gladiators and warriors fight for the amusement of the public and as part of **honoring the working class**.
- **The Merchant's Guildhall:** A towering building where influential industrialists and merchants make their deals.

- **Challenges:**

- The city is rife with **poverty** and **overcrowding**, with workers living in terrible conditions.
 - Rising **social unrest** among the working class who demand better conditions and higher pay for their labor.
-

8. Eldrath (Union of Eldrath)

- **Capital:** Druun
 - **Description:**
 - **Druun** is a **commercial hub**, a thriving city on the edge of the seas, built on trade and innovation. The city is adorned with intricate docks and **vast warehouses**, and it thrives on its **merchant routes**. The city's wealth comes from **sea trade**, and it has a cosmopolitan feel, welcoming all kinds of **travelers** and **adventurers**.
 - **Notable Features:**
 - **The Grand Dockyards:** Where ships from all over Kaysender arrive, unloading exotic goods from distant lands.
 - **The Market of Wonders:** A diverse bazaar known for its rare and **exotic items**, from magical artifacts to rare spices and silks.
 - **The Hall of Commerce:** A central building where the **guildmasters** meet to discuss trade agreements and policies.
 - **Challenges:**
 - **Piracy** and other maritime threats have led to unstable trading routes, threatening the city's economy.
 - Political infighting as the **Guilds** and the ruling class attempt to maintain control over the growing wealth and influence.
-

9. Imbria (Theocracy of Imbria)

- **Capital:** Solaar
- **Description:**
 - **Solaar** is a **devout city**, a place where the power of religion governs every aspect of life. Its **sacred temples**, **golden towers**, and **gleaming statues** fill the city, as worship and ritual reign supreme. It is built around the **central temple**, where the **Priests** dictate the laws and conduct of the land.
 - Solaar is a **soulful** city where the **spiritual** is prioritized above all else, and its economy is based on **divine offerings** and sacred relics.
- **Notable Features:**
 - **The Eternal Temple:** A vast religious complex at the heart of the city, dedicated to the gods of Imbria.
 - **The Sacred Gardens:** An area of peace and reflection where citizens come to meditate and commune with the divine.
 - **The Divine Market:** A market where **sacred relics**, **healing potions**, and religious texts are traded.
- **Challenges:**
 - **Isolationism** has left Solaar vulnerable to external threats, and the **limited technology** makes it difficult to defend against outside forces.

- **Clerical corruption** and the growing divide between the **masses** and the **priests** threaten the stability of the theocracy.
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The Grim Realities of Survival in Kaysender

In the world of Kaysender, survival is an unrelenting battle against scarcity, danger, and the unpredictable nature of the floating isles. Food, water, and basic necessities are not guaranteed, leading to stark contrasts in population density and living conditions across the skies.

The Struggle for Basic Needs

1. Food Scarcity:

- **Limited Arable Land:** Most floating islands are small and lack fertile soil, making large-scale farming nearly impossible. Crops must be carefully cultivated in magically-enhanced soils or hydroponic systems maintained by alchemists and druids.
- **Skybeasts as Livestock:** Skyfaring creatures like *sheffels* (floating sheep-like beasts) are essential sources of food. Shepherds tend to these creatures, but the constant threat of predators, sky pirates, or harsh weather makes their work perilous.
- **Fishing the Sky:** Some communities rely on "skyfishing," catching large, magically buoyant creatures that drift through the endless air. However, these hunts are dangerous, as some skybeasts are far more predator than prey.

2. Water Supply:

- **Rain Catching:** Most islands depend on elaborate rain-harvesting systems, using enchanted cisterns and reservoirs to capture and store water during storms. Droughts can spell disaster for smaller settlements.
- **Magic-Enhanced Purification:** Wealthier regions utilize magical filtration systems to convert brackish or stagnant water into drinkable resources. Poorer areas, however, often suffer from tainted supplies, leading to disease.
- **Trade Dependency:** Some islands rely entirely on imported water, making them vulnerable to supply chain disruptions caused by piracy or conflict.

3. Shelter and Security:

- **Safe Zones:** "Safe" islands—those with stable terrain, adequate resources, and minimal threat from predators or raiders—are rare and fiercely contested.
 - **Defensive Measures:** Many settlements build fortifications, magical wards, or maintain armed militias to protect their communities from sky pirates, bandits, and rival factions.
-

The Densely Crowded Mainlands

The major continent of **Messara**, with its vast, jagged landscapes, is the most populous region in the skies. While the land is treacherous and often scarred by warfare, it offers more stability than the drifting islands.

1. Population Density:

- **Urban Sprawl:** Massive cities, fortified towns, and sprawling slums dominate the continent's surface. Towering structures are built into cliffsides or rise from mesas, creating layers of habitation. Space is at a premium, and overcrowding is a constant issue.
- **Resource Competition:** The availability of water, food, and land for farming is stretched to the limit. Conflict is frequent, as factions vie for control over these critical resources.

2. Life in the Cities:

- **Class Divide:** The wealthy live in walled districts with access to fresh food and clean water, while the poor cram into filthy slums. Disease spreads rapidly in these overcrowded areas, and the weak are often left to fend for themselves.
- **Employment:** Many individuals work as laborers in dangerous industries—quarrying skystone, mining magical ores, or crafting skyships. Others take up service to wealthy lords or join mercenary bands.

3. Safety in Numbers:

- Despite the challenges, people flock to the continent because its sheer size offers a measure of security. The presence of organized armies, trade networks, and stronger governance makes life there more predictable than on the drifting islands.
-

The Freedom of the Outer Islands

In stark contrast, the **outer islands** attract those who value freedom over security, despite the myriad risks.

1. The Pioneer Spirit:

- **Self-Sufficiency:** Settlers on the outer islands live off the land, cultivating small plots of magically-enhanced soil, raising skybeasts, or foraging for floating flora. They rely on ingenuity and hard work to survive.
 - **Isolation:** These islands are far removed from the influence of the Dragon Lords, major merchant guilds, or centralized governments, allowing their inhabitants to escape the rigid hierarchies of the mainland.
2. **Communal Living:**
- Small, tight-knit communities form on these islands, often united by shared beliefs or the desire for independence. Cooperation is essential, as resources are limited and dangers abound.
3. **Constant Peril:**
- **Wild Beasts and Raiders:** Outer islands are more exposed to attacks from predatory skybeasts and pirate factions like the **Black Fleet**. Without the protection of larger armies or guilds, these communities must fend for themselves.
 - **Environmental Hazards:** Some islands drift perilously close to the eternal abyss, while others are plagued by magical storms, volcanic activity, or unstable terrain.
4. **Unpredictable Freedom:**
- Life on the outer islands offers unparalleled autonomy, but at a steep cost. The lack of organized trade and protection makes survival a daily struggle. For many, the risks are worth it to escape the oppressive conditions of the mainland.
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A World Shaped by Necessity

The dichotomy between the densely packed mainland and the remote, lawless outer islands reflects the harsh realities of survival in Kaysender. The quest for food, water, and security dictates every aspect of life, from the formation of societies to the individual choices of those who seek either safety in numbers or freedom in the wilds.

For the majority, life is an unending struggle against scarcity, where even a single bad harvest or a disrupted trade route can spell disaster. Those who thrive in this world are either remarkably resourceful, unflinchingly ruthless, or lucky enough to cling to the stability of the safer regions. Yet, in every corner of the skies, the promise of survival is a fragile one, as unpredictable as the islands themselves.

The Black Fleet

The Black Fleet is the most infamous bandit faction in the skies of Kaysender. Though its name conjures fear and respect across the floating continents, the reality of the organization is a chaotic patchwork of vagabonds, opportunists, and ruthless pirates.

Structure and Organization

- **Loose Confederation:**

The Black Fleet is more a *banner of convenience* than a centralized organization. Hundreds of airships and rogue captains claim allegiance to the Fleet to bolster their reputation, strike fear into their enemies, and leverage the Fleet's fearsome reputation. Most of these "members" have no direct ties to the true Black Fleet and rarely take orders from its leaders.

- **True Membership:**

At the heart of the Fleet is a core group of about **20 vessels** that form the actual backbone of the organization. These ships answer to **Sky Captain Verek Drakemoor**, the self-styled Sky Pirate King, and adhere to his commands and the Fleet's rules.

- **False Flag Operations:**

Many independent pirates claim to be part of the Black Fleet without any real connection, using the name to gain leverage, intimidate rivals, or attract mercenaries. This muddles the Fleet's influence, as enemies often find themselves facing "Black Fleet pirates" who have no true loyalty to the faction.

Key Members and Ships

1. **Sky Captain Verek Drakemoor ("The Hellflame King")**

- **Role:** Leader of the Black Fleet and feared Sky Pirate King.
- **Personality:** Charismatic, ruthless, and ambitious, Verek balances his lust for treasure with an almost religious devotion to chaos in the skies.
- **Appearance:** A towering man with bronzed skin, jet-black hair streaked with gray, and a smoldering red gaze. He wields the enchanted saber *Bloodwake*, which is said to ignite with flames in combat.
- **Goal:** To create a permanent empire in the skies and control major trade routes while keeping his enemies guessing.

2. **The Abyss Harbinger**

- **Flagship:** A massive, jet-black airship built with reinforced ironwood and enchanted obsidian plating. It is armed with explosive mana-cannons that can rain destruction on floating islands or other airships.
- **Crew:** Known for their loyalty and unmatched brutality, the Abyss Harbinger's crew are seasoned raiders who live and die by Verek's orders.

3. **The Shadow Gale**

- **Captain:** Ilraya Windshadow, a former noblewoman-turned-pirate with a knack for assassinations and precision strikes.

- **Specialty:** Acts as the Fleet's scout and infiltrator ship, often striking first during raids.
4. **The Emberclaw**
- **Captain:** Darrek "Ironjaw" Blightmoor, a dragonkin pirate with a terrifying presence and unmatched strength.
 - **Specialty:** Heavy assault, particularly against fortified skyports or merchant flotillas.
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Base of Operations: Spire "The Hellrod"

- **Description:**

The Hellrod is a cursed sky island of jagged black obsidian peaks and volcanic mountains. Constantly cloaked in a thick veil of soot and smoke, the island radiates an ominous, fiery glow visible from miles away.

 1. **Location:** The island drifts erratically through the skies, seemingly at random. Only those familiar with its pattern—or equipped with specific magical charts—can find it.
 - **Features:**
 1. **Blackstone Fortress:** A sprawling obsidian stronghold at the island's highest peak serves as the Black Fleet's main base.
 2. **Volcanic Forges:** The island's molten heart powers forges where weapons, airship parts, and arcane engines are crafted or repaired.
 3. **Soot-Swept Docks:** Hidden docks carved into the mountains provide anchorage for the Fleet's ships.
 - **Legends:**

Some say the Hellrod is alive, a cursed remnant of a long-dead dragon god whose malevolence lingers. Others claim it is tethered to an ancient magical device hidden in its depths, allowing Vereck to control its movement.
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Activities and Notoriety

- **Primary Operations:**
 - **Raiding Merchant Ships:** The Fleet's most common activity, targeting trade routes and merchant vessels for supplies, wealth, and captives.
 - **Skyport Extortion:** Forcing small settlements or independent skyports to pay tribute in exchange for "protection."
 - **Rogue Mage Recruitment:** Recruiting rogue spellcasters and alchemists to create powerful weapons and spells for their fleet.

- **Ruin Plundering:** Utilizing their mobility to reach sky ruins and floating island relics before others can claim them.
 - **Tactics:**
 - **Lightning Raids:** Quick, devastating attacks designed to cause chaos and extract wealth before defenders can mobilize.
 - **Scattered Operations:** Individual ships often operate independently, making the Fleet's movements unpredictable.
 - **Feigned Alliances:** Pretending to work with smaller factions only to betray them at the worst possible moment.
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Reputation in Kaysender

1. **Among the Wealthy:**
 - The Black Fleet is both feared and loathed by merchants, nobles, and governments. Bounties on members of the true Fleet are exorbitant, though few bounty hunters dare to collect.
 2. **Among the Poor:**
 - In contrast, some downtrodden communities see the Black Fleet as folk heroes. Stories of the Fleet distributing stolen goods to oppressed villagers or dismantling tyrannical skylords circulate among the disenfranchised.
 3. **Among Other Pirates:**
 - Verek Drakemoor commands respect, envy, and hatred in equal measure. Many pirate factions begrudgingly pay tribute or avoid crossing him.
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Faction Weaknesses

- **Internal Divisions:**

The Fleet's loose confederation makes it vulnerable to infighting and treachery. Many so-called "members" are opportunists who would abandon the Fleet or betray it if the rewards were great enough.
 - **Vague Allegiances:**

The sheer number of unaffiliated pirates claiming to be part of the Black Fleet dilutes its true power, leading to conflicts and misunderstandings.
 - **Logistical Challenges:**

The drifting nature of Spire "The Hellrod" makes resupplying and coordinating the Fleet difficult, forcing them to raid frequently.
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The Black Fleet remains a force of chaos, terror, and legend, forever changing the balance of power in the skies of Kaysender. Only the bravest—or the most foolish—would dare cross them.

The Dragon Lords and Their Hierarchy

In the chaotic lands of **Kaysender**, the **Dragon Lords** represent an ancient and fearsome system of rule. These immensely powerful beings serve as both protectors and tyrants of their respective territories, enforcing order in their own brutal fashion. However, even these mighty rulers bow to a higher authority: **His Imperial Majesty, the Draconic Emperor**, whose rule stretches across the skies and wildlands. The Dragon Lords maintain a delicate balance of chaos and allegiance, ensuring their continued dominance while upholding the broader hierarchy of draconic power.

The Hierarchy of the Dragon Lords

1. The Draconic Emperor ("His Imperial Majesty")

- **Title:** Emperor Trazintharix the Eternal Flame
- **Nature:** A colossal, ancient red dragon whose power is said to rival the gods themselves. He has ruled for millennia, unchallenged by lesser dragons.
- **Role:**
 - Oversees the territories ruled by Dragon Lords, ensuring they pay their **tithes** in wealth, magic, or rare artifacts.
 - Enforces draconic law across his dominion, sending emissaries or enforcers to deal with rebellious or negligent Dragon Lords.
 - Holds court in the **Skyhold Citadel**, a fortress perched atop a floating mountain encased in molten gold and perpetual storms.

2. The High Lords of Flame (Draconic Vassals)

- These dragons are the **direct lieutenants of the Emperor**, ruling vast swathes of territory and maintaining order among the lesser Dragon Lords.
- **Number:** Typically **7 to 10 High Lords**, each representing a different elemental or draconic lineage.
- **Key Figures:**
 - **Ixaryth the Storm-Winged:** A tempestuous blue dragon ruling over the coastal wildlands and oceanic floating islands.
 - **Krorithyx the Iron-Hide:** An ancient black dragon who oversees the marshy, corrupted lowlands.
 - **Sylvekar the Verdant Keeper:** A green dragon who jealously guards the sprawling jungles and their hidden treasures.

3. The Dragon Lords (Territorial Rulers)

- The majority of dragons ruling the **wildlands** fall into this category. They are lesser than the High Lords but wield immense power within their domains.
- **Role:**
 - Each Dragon Lord governs a specific **territory** in the wildlands, from jagged mountains and dense forests to volcanic fields and desert wastelands.
 - They are responsible for ensuring the safety and stability of their lands—though their methods are often brutal and self-serving.
 - **Tithes:** They must deliver tributes to their respective High Lords (and ultimately to the Emperor), often extracted through taxes, raids, or forced labor.

4. The Lesser Dragons and Wyrmlords (Subordinates)

- **Wyrmlords** are dragonkin, half-dragons, or powerful humanoids who serve directly under Dragon Lords. They act as generals, enforcers, or emissaries.
 - **Lesser Dragons** (young or subordinate dragons) serve as knights, messengers, or guardians of specific locations within a Dragon Lord's territory.
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The Wildlands Under Their Rule

The lands ruled by Dragon Lords are known collectively as **The Wildlands**—a chaotic, untamed expanse where civilization struggles to survive. Despite the chaos, the Dragon Lords provide a tenuous form of stability, ensuring that certain rules are upheld.

Characteristics of the Wildlands

1. **Chaotic Beauty:**
 - The Wildlands are often breathtaking yet perilous: jagged peaks, sprawling jungles, burning deserts, and mysterious ruins dot the landscape.
 - The terrain often reflects the temperament or elemental affinity of its ruling Dragon Lord.
2. **Lawless Chaos:**
 - While Dragon Lords maintain dominion, their rule is arbitrary and harsh. Stability exists only insofar as it suits their interests.
 - Bandits, monsters, and warlords are common threats, though they rarely challenge a Dragon Lord directly.
3. **Tithes as Protection:**

- Villages, towns, and cities in these lands must pay **tithes**—in wealth, rare goods, or labor—to their Dragon Lord. In return, they gain some measure of protection from raiders, monsters, and rival dragons.
- Those who fail to meet their quotas are often **destroyed as an example** or left to fend for themselves.

4. **Draconic Justice:**

- Dragon Lords act as judge, jury, and executioner within their domains. Their justice is swift and absolute, leaving no room for appeal.
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Tithes and Allegiance to the Emperor

The System of Tribute

- **What Is Required:**

Dragon Lords must send a portion of their wealth, magical artifacts, and treasures to their respective High Lord. These tributes are ultimately delivered to the Emperor at **Skyhold Citadel**.

- **Frequency:**

Tributes are typically paid every **ten years**, though the Emperor may demand additional offerings in times of war or strife.

Failure to Pay Tithes

- A Dragon Lord who fails to deliver their tribute faces **dire consequences**, such as:
 1. **Enforcer Dragons** being sent to their territory to reclaim the Emperor's due by force.
 2. The offending Dragon Lord being **stripped of their title** or even **executed**.
 3. Their territory being seized by a rival Dragon Lord or High Lord.
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Dragon Lords' Relationship with Mortals

Protector and Tyrant

- For many mortals, their Dragon Lord is both a savior and a nightmare.
 - **Protection:** Villages under a Dragon Lord's wing are often spared from outside threats, as few dare to provoke their wrath.
 - **Exploitation:** However, these same villages are taxed heavily, with the best resources and treasures taken as tribute.

Worship and Fear

- Some Dragon Lords demand **worship**, positioning themselves as gods in the eyes of their subjects. Temples and shrines dedicated to them are common in their territories.

Adventurers and Heroes

- The Wildlands attract **adventurers** and treasure-seekers, many of whom seek to challenge the Dragon Lords or plunder their hoards. Such individuals are either swiftly crushed or granted an audience if their exploits impress the dragon ruler.
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Notable Dragon Lords and Their Domains

1. **Kaldryxis the Infernal Sovereign**
 - **Type:** Red Dragon
 - **Domain:** Volcanic badlands filled with rivers of molten lava and ash storms.
 2. **Vaelyth the Frostfang**
 - **Type:** White Dragon
 - **Domain:** A tundra of frozen lakes, glacial peaks, and icy caverns.
 3. **Zephyros the Stormcaller**
 - **Type:** Blue Dragon
 - **Domain:** A vast desert with perpetual sandstorms and ancient ruins.
 4. **Myrilth the Verdant Tyrant**
 - **Type:** Green Dragon
 - **Domain:** A sprawling jungle teeming with dangerous wildlife and poisonous flora.
 5. **Tharvix the Shadow-Wing**
 - **Type:** Black Dragon
 - **Domain:** A murky swamp of acidic waters, hidden bogs, and crumbling ruins.
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The **Dragon Lords of Kaysender** epitomize power and chaos. Their rule is one of might, ambition, and fear, bound together by a fragile allegiance to the Draconic Emperor. For mortals caught in their web, survival often means servitude, cunning, or the hope of catching the attention of a dragon ruler who values them enough to spare their lives.

The Collection of Tithes in the Lands of the Dragon Lords

The tithe system in the territories ruled by Dragon Lords is a meticulously structured yet fear-inducing process, showcasing both the organizational might of the dragons and their reliance

on loyal subordinates. The methods vary depending on the size of the territory, the personality of the Dragon Lord, and the local infrastructure, but all share a singular purpose: to maintain the flow of wealth, resources, and obedience up the chain of draconic hierarchy.

1. The Tithe Fleet: The Skyborne Collectors

- **Overview:**

The **Tithe Fleet** is a well-organized network of airships, manned by loyal servants of the Dragon Lord, tasked with traveling from floating island to floating island within the dragon's domain. These ships act as mobile tax collectors, ensuring that no corner of the territory evades their ruler's demands.

- **Composition:**

- The fleet typically consists of **heavily armed vessels**, both to intimidate reluctant tributaries and to defend against opportunistic pirates or rival factions.
- **Flagships:** The largest ship of the fleet is often draped in the Dragon Lord's colors or sigils, serving as a visible reminder of their power.

- **Crew:**

- The fleet is manned by **dragonkin**, loyal humanoid servants, and mercenaries employed for their strength or organizational skills.
- At least one **lesser dragon** or **wyrmlord** oversees the fleet, acting as the Dragon Lord's direct enforcer.

- **Collection Process:**

- The fleet follows a **set schedule**, moving from settlement to settlement and island to island.
 - **Villages and towns** are required to have their tithes ready upon the fleet's arrival. If they fail to meet the required quota, the consequences are severe:
 - **Confiscation** of goods, livestock, or even people as punishment.
 - A **warning attack** to burn fields or destroy a small portion of the settlement as a message.
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2. Minor Lords as Regional Collectors

- **Role of Minor Lords:**

- Dragon Lords rarely oversee the collection of tithes directly. Instead, they rely on **Minor Lords**—local rulers or enforcers who govern smaller regions on their behalf.
- These Minor Lords are often lesser dragons, wyrmlords, or influential mortal leaders granted power in exchange for loyalty.

- **Collection Duty:**
 - Minor Lords traverse their assigned territories, going from island to island, village to village, personally overseeing the gathering of tithes.
 - They ensure that the goods are properly accounted for before forwarding them to the **Tithe Fleet** or directly to the Dragon Lord's lair.
 - **Presence and Fear:**
 - Minor Lords often travel with a small entourage of **warriors, beasts, or magical creatures**, ensuring compliance.
 - Their arrival is marked by the ringing of bells, drums, or magical signals, giving villages time to prepare—or flee.
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3. Ritualistic Tribute Gatherings

In some territories, especially those ruled by more traditionalist Dragon Lords, the collection of tithes becomes a **ritualized event**, reinforcing the divine or kingly status of the dragon ruler.

- **The Process:**
 - Villages and towns gather at a central location—a temple, platform, or open field—designated for tithe collection.
 - The **Dragon Lord** or their representative often **appears in person**, either in the sky or through a magical projection, to oversee the ritual.
 - The tithe is presented with great ceremony, often involving music, prayers, and offerings meant to appease the Dragon Lord.
 - **Symbolism:**
 - This approach emphasizes the dragon's role as a **divine protector**, ensuring compliance through awe and reverence rather than brute force alone.
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4. The Floating Vaults: Tithes in Storage

Once collected, tithes are stored in massive **floating vaults** or **hidden hoards**, depending on the preferences of the Dragon Lord.

- **Floating Vaults:**
 - These are immense airships or fortified islands, guarded by lesser dragons, dragonkin, and magical wards. They act as mobile treasure troves, making them harder to raid.
- **Lair Hoards:**

- Some Dragon Lords prefer to keep their wealth in their **personal lairs**, deep within mountain ranges, volcanic caverns, or floating fortresses. These hoards are heavily guarded, accessible only to the Dragon Lord and their most trusted servants.
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5. Consequences of Failure

The Dragon Lords enforce their tithe system with terrifying efficiency. Failure to meet their demands results in:

- **Swift Retribution:**
 - Villages unable to pay their tithes may face destruction by fire or magical attacks.
 - Inhabitants might be taken as **slaves** or food for the dragon's kin.
 - **Marking of Rebellion:**
 - A **mark of rebellion** may be placed on a village—an enchanted sigil visible from the sky, warning other dragons and creatures to avoid or destroy it.
 - **Replacement of Leadership:**
 - Local leaders who fail to ensure their village's compliance may be publicly punished or replaced with more loyal (and brutal) enforcers.
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Key Notes on Tithe Culture

- **Symbol of Power:**

The act of tithing is as much about control as it is about wealth. By demanding regular tribute, Dragon Lords reinforce their dominance and remind their subjects of their place in the hierarchy.
- **Adaptability:**

Some Dragon Lords are more lenient or pragmatic than others, accepting alternate forms of tribute, such as **magical knowledge**, **rare artifacts**, or **personal service** in lieu of goods or currency.
- **Fear and Compliance:**

For the inhabitants of the Dragon Lords' territories, the tithe system is both a burden and a reminder of their precarious existence. Most comply out of fear, while others seek ways to exploit or manipulate the system to their advantage.

Merchant Fleets and Organizations of the World of Kaysender

Trade and communication in the world of Kaysender rely on vast networks of merchant fleets and specialized organizations that traverse the skies, braving pirates, storms, and the ever-present dangers of the drifting abyss. These fleets each have their own unique identity, purpose, and reputation, playing a vital role in the stability and economy of the floating islands.

1. The Surveyor's Guild

Purpose:

The Surveyor's Guild is an ancient organization tasked with mapping the ever-shifting skies, cataloging resources, and discovering new islands. Their work is essential for the safety of navigation and the prosperity of trade routes.

Fleet Details:

Ships of the Surveyor's Guild are easily identifiable by their green and gold sails, symbolizing the wealth of knowledge and the promise of fertile lands.

These vessels are sleek and agile, equipped with magical instruments to detect changes in air currents, locate hidden islands, and navigate through chaotic skies.

Personnel:

Crews consist of cartographers, naturalists, arcanists, and airship engineers.

Their captains are revered figures, often chosen for their ability to make rapid decisions in uncharted skies.

Reputation:

The Guild is respected across all territories for its neutrality and dedication to exploration. However, its maps are often sold at a high price, making them accessible primarily to wealthier merchants and lords.

2. The Whisper Web

Purpose:

The Whisper Web is a network of airships and magical devices that maintain long-distance communication across the scattered isles. They deliver enchanted messages, maintain magical relay towers, and provide emergency communication services.

Fleet Details:

Whisper Web ships are slow, bulky vessels painted in orange and blue, symbolizing stability and the flow of information.

Each ship is outfitted with magical amplifiers and communication nodes, allowing them to project and receive messages across vast distances.

The ships are heavily shielded to protect the delicate magical machinery onboard.

Personnel:

The crews are made up of message mages, engineers, and relay technicians.

Their communication experts are colloquially known as “Whisperers,” skilled in encoding and deciphering magical signals.

Reputation:

The Whisper Web is a lifeline for many, allowing settlements and fleets to stay connected. However, their reliance on rare magical components makes their services expensive, and delays can occur during times of crisis.

3. The Skyweaver Consortium

Purpose:

The Skyweaver Consortium is the largest merchant fleet in Kaysender, handling everything from luxury goods to basic supplies. They are known for their red and white striped sails, a mark of their dominance in the skies.

Fleet Details:

Their ships vary in size, from massive freighters carrying tons of cargo to swift couriers delivering high-value items.

They are equipped with defensive weaponry to fend off pirates and have dedicated escort ships for protection.

Personnel:

Crews include merchants, navigators, and mercenary guards.

Their captains are often shrewd negotiators, skilled in both diplomacy and combat.

Reputation:

The Consortium is respected but not beloved—its focus on profit has earned it a reputation for opportunism. They are known to price-gouge during shortages and have been accused of monopolizing certain trade routes.

4. The Aetherbound Company

Purpose:

The Aetherbound Company specializes in transporting rare magical goods, artifacts, and exotic creatures. Their ships are adorned with iridescent sails that shimmer in the sunlight, marking their elite status.

Fleet Details:

These ships are smaller but heavily enchanted for speed and protection, often surrounded by a faint magical aura.

Each vessel carries specialized containment units to safely store volatile magical items or dangerous creatures.

Personnel:

The crews are comprised of arcane specialists, beast tamers, and alchemical engineers.

Their captains are usually experienced mages with a deep understanding of the cargo they transport.

Reputation:

The Aetherbound Company is seen as mysterious and elite. Their services are only available to those who can afford exorbitant fees, but their reliability is unmatched.

5. The Free Flotilla

Purpose:

A loose coalition of independent merchants and traders, the Free Flotilla operates outside the control of larger organizations. Their ships are diverse in appearance, often cobbled together or adorned with unique personal markings.

Fleet Details:

The Free Flotilla's ships are small to medium-sized, prioritizing adaptability and speed over cargo capacity.

They often fly under flags of vibrant patchwork colors, symbolizing their independence and resourcefulness.

Personnel:

Crews are made up of freelancers, opportunists, and adventurers seeking to make a living without being tied to a larger organization.

Reputation:

While the Flotilla offers cheaper services, their reliability can vary. They are seen as both a lifeline for smaller settlements and a potential risk due to their lack of oversight.

6. The Ember Guild

Purpose:

The Ember Guild is a fiery organization that focuses on transporting fuel, explosives, and industrial goods. Their black and orange sails are a warning to others to keep a safe distance.

Fleet Details:

Their ships are reinforced with heavy plating to protect against accidental explosions. Specialized cargo holds are enchanted to prevent fires and stabilize volatile materials.

Personnel:

Crews consist of fireproofed engineers, alchemists, and tinkers trained to handle hazardous materials.

Captains are chosen for their cool-headedness and ability to manage dangerous situations.

Reputation:

The Ember Guild is respected for its efficiency but feared for the danger its ships pose. Many settlements keep their docks clear when an Ember Guild vessel arrives.

7. The Gilded Current

Purpose:

The Gilded Current is a luxury fleet catering to the wealthy, transporting fine goods, precious metals, and noble passengers. Their golden sails and polished hulls are a symbol of opulence.

Fleet Details:

Ships are lavishly decorated, with onboard amenities like private cabins, dining halls, and magical entertainment.

They are equipped with defensive wards and employ elite mercenaries for protection.

Personnel:

Crews are handpicked for their professionalism and discretion, ensuring the comfort and safety of their elite clientele.

Captains are often former nobility or retired military officers.

Reputation:

The Gilded Current is synonymous with wealth and exclusivity. Their services are unattainable for most, but their presence is admired from afar.

The World Whispering Web, or Sending stone network

Explanation:

The World Whispering Web is a sophisticated network of interconnected sending stones that operate much like modern-day cell phones. It was invented by a guild of ingenious arcane engineers and artificers known as The Resonant Concord (An impartial group of sages). Their goal was to revolutionize long-distance communication for adventurers, merchants, scholars, and rulers alike.

How It Works:

1. **Harmonic Hubs:** Large, immovable anchor stones called Harmonic Hubs are placed in major cities, towns, and key locations. These serve as the central nodes of the network, amplifying and distributing messages across vast distances.
2. **Relay Crystals:** To bridge the gaps between Harmonic Hubs, Relay Crystals are mounted on towers, in caves, or hidden in ancient ruins. These crystals channel magical energy, acting as the "towers" that sustain the network.
3. **Personal Sending Stones:** Individual users carry smaller, handheld sending stones attuned to the network. These stones are carved with unique resonance glyphs that act as a magical signature (similar to phone numbers). Each user can link their stone to another by exchanging these glyphs.
4. **Charging and Maintenance:**
 - The stones are powered by mana batteries that recharge when exposed to sunlight, moonlight, or nearby ley lines. Artificers in the Concord regularly maintain the Harmonic Hubs and Relay Crystals to ensure uninterrupted service.
 - Adventurers can also recharge their stones at Arcane Stations located in settlements.
5. **Communication Features:**
 - **Sending Voice:** Users can send messages via voice (like a phone call) or as written text (via light glyph projections).

- Limited Range Off-Grid: If users are out of the network's coverage area, the stones can still send messages to nearby stones within 500 feet (or a specified distance determined by your campaign).
 - Emergency Scrying: High-tier stones allow for limited-duration scrying or image transmission, useful for emergencies or VIP users.
6. Limitations:
- Magic Interference: Areas with heavy anti-magic effects, wild magic zones, or certain types of magical storms can disrupt the network.
 - Costs: Users must pay a fee to the Resonant Concord for the upkeep of the network, with premium services (e.g., scrying, larger message storage) costing more.

World Whispering Web

The World Whispering Web is a relatively new invention, Created and funded by A network of sages and clerics Called the Resonant Concord, seeking to streamline trade and improve emergency response times. While the network has helped unite kingdoms and revolutionize communication, it has also drawn the ire of isolationist factions and those wary of its potential for surveillance or control. Whispers abound of rogue groups attempting to hack or sabotage the network for nefarious purposes.

Section: Independent Networks and Organizational Autonomy

To address the concerns of interference, subversion, and the potential for centralized control, the governing body overseeing arcane communication—The Resonant Concord—has established the following legal framework regarding major organizations seeking to establish and operate their own independent sending stone networks:

1. Charter for Independent Networks

Any organization—be it a kingdom, guild, temple, or other entity—that seeks to establish an independent sending stone network must first apply for a Charter of Autonomy from the Resonant Concord. This charter grants the organization the right to:

- Build and operate their own Harmonic Hubs and Relay Crystals.
 - Develop private resonance frequencies (unique magical bandwidths) inaccessible to other networks.
 - Regulate and secure their own network traffic within their jurisdiction.
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3. Non-Interference Clause

Independent networks must adhere to strict non-interference policies:

- Independent networks are forbidden from jamming, redirecting, or otherwise tampering with the Whispering Web or other private networks.
 - Violations of this clause will result in severe penalties, including fines, mandatory dismantling of illegal components, or magical sanctions.
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4. Privacy Protections

To protect against espionage or subversion:

- Independent networks are required to encrypt their resonance frequencies using licensed arcane methods approved by the Concord Council.
 - Unauthorized interception or decoding of another network's messages is classified as magical espionage, a crime punishable by imprisonment, fines, or expulsion from the Concord Council's jurisdiction.
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5. Emergency Integration Protocol

While independent networks maintain autonomy, they are required to integrate with the Whispering Web during emergencies that threaten public safety. These emergencies include, but are not limited to:

- Natural disasters.
- Large-scale invasions or warfare.
- Magical anomalies disrupting communication.

During such times, the Council may temporarily requisition independent networks to facilitate wider communication, with fair compensation provided to the network's operators.

6. Oversight and Penalties

Organizations granted a Charter of Autonomy are subject to periodic inspections by Concord Auditors to ensure compliance with the law. Failure to meet the following standards may result in penalties:

- Network Security: Ensuring no unauthorized access to other networks.
- Public Safety Compliance: Adhering to emergency integration protocols.
- Fair Use: Maintaining non-interference with public and private communications.

Violators of these laws may face:

- Heavy fines payable to the Concord Council.
 - Revocation of their Charter of Autonomy.
 - Permanent ban from operating sending stone networks.
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7. Special Exceptions for National Security

In cases where national security is at risk, kingdoms or governments may request classified frequencies from the Concord Council. These frequencies are shielded against external interference by advanced arcane wards and are strictly monitored for misuse. Such frequencies may not be used for offensive or espionage purposes against other networks without explicit Council approval.

Feature: Locator Glyphs

The Whispering Web incorporates an optional feature called **Locator Glyphs**, allowing two users to track each other's location when mutually agreed upon. This functionality is particularly useful for adventurers, merchants, and loved ones who wish to stay connected beyond simple communication.

How It Works:

1. Exchanging the Center Glyph:

- During a meeting or with mutual consent, two users can exchange a special glyph called a **Center Glyph**.
- This glyph links the two sending stones in a way that creates a unique resonance, allowing the stones to magically "point" to one another.

2. Activation:

- By holding their sending stone and focusing on the connection, the user can activate the Locator Glyph feature.
- The stone will emit a soft, glowing arrow of light (or a similar magical marker) that hovers above it and points in the direction of the other linked stone.

- The arrow grows brighter and pulses faster as the user gets closer to the other stone, allowing for easy navigation even in complex terrains.

3. **Range and Limitations:**

- The feature functions within the **network's coverage area** (connected to Relay Crystals or Harmonic Hubs).
- Outside the network, the stones maintain a **reduced tracking range** of up to 1 mile, powered by their internal resonance.
- Magical interference, such as anti-magic fields or wards, can temporarily block the Locator Glyph's signal.
- Each stone can only maintain one linked connection at a time.
- Tracking can be consented to during a linked conversation or in person With stone to stone contact.

4. **Consent-Based Use:**

- The feature can only be activated if **both users consent** by exchanging Center Glyphs.
- Either party can deactivate the tracking connection at any time by issuing a simple **"Sever" command** to their stone.

5. **Privacy Safeguards:**

- Locator Glyphs are encrypted and cannot be intercepted or used by third parties without an **authorized decryption spell**, which is heavily regulated by the Concord Council of Resonance.
- Unauthorized tampering or tracking without consent is classified as **arcane trespassing**, punishable by law.

Use Cases:

- **Adventurers:** Stay connected during dungeon delves or large-scale battles by ensuring no one gets lost or separated.
- **Merchants:** Monitor the location of trade caravans or shipments to ensure safe deliveries.
- **Families:** Provide peace of mind by letting loved ones track each other in times of crisis or travel.
- **Search and Rescue:** Expedite missions to find lost individuals or recover stolen sending stones.

Military Sending Stone (Model: "Tracker's Beacon")

Description:

The "Tracker's Beacon" is a specialized, military-grade variant of the standard sending stone, developed to provide strategic tracking capabilities in high-stakes situations. This device is

heavily enchanted to allow the user to attempt a forced location trace on the sending stone it is communicating with. Designed for use in espionage, warfare, or high-priority operations, the Tracker's Beacon is a double-edged sword—effective but requiring patience and skill to operate successfully.

Key Features

1. Forced Tracking Ability

- **Process:**

When engaged in communication, the Tracker's Beacon can initiate a forced location trace on the connected sending stone.

- This involves activating a secondary enchantment that taps into the Whispering Web's arcane network.
- The tracking process is akin to sending a magical "ping" through the network to triangulate the target stone's resonance signature.
- You're required to be actively connected to the stone in question requiring that the tracker know the runic number of the sending stone being tracked.
- The descending stone being tracked must be reachable on the same network.

- **Slow and Methodical:**

The process requires **15 minutes to 45 minutes**, depending on the distance and magical interference. It is not instantaneous and demands uninterrupted focus during this period.

- **Arcana Skill Checks:**

To successfully establish a location, the operator must succeed on a series of **Arcana checks**:

- **DC 15 (Initial Calibration):** Aligning the stone's resonance frequency with the target, Providing a 45° cone of direction.
- **DC 18 (Triangulation):** Pinpointing the target stone's location within a mile-wide radius, Narrowing the cone of direction to 25°
- **DC 20 (Exact Fixation):** Narrowing the location to within 100 feet, Exact directional fix.
- Each check represents 5-15 minutes of work(Roll A D10 And add +4) . Failing a check results in partial progress, while failing by 5 or more scrambles the process, requiring the user to start over.

2. Location Output

- Upon successful tracking, the Tracker's Beacon reveals the target stone's location through one of two methods:
 - A **holographic map** appears above the stone, marking the target's position.

- The stone's surface glows with **arcane coordinates** encoded in a runic format, decipherable with another DC 15 Arcana check.
- A vague cone of direction indicator, that refines with each success.

3. Emergency Shutdown

- The device's forced tracking capabilities can be detected by the target stone if its user succeeds on a **DC 15 Arcana or Perception check** during the process. If discovered, the target's stone can be triggered to scramble its resonance signature, halting the trace.
 - To prevent enemy forces from exploiting the Tracker's Beacon return signal, the device includes an **emergency self-destruct enchantment** that can destroy its internal mechanisms (but not harm the wielder).
-

Challenges and Drawbacks

- **Interference:**
The process is highly susceptible to magical interference, especially in areas with anti-divination wards, wild magic zones, or near ley line disruptions. These factors can impose additional penalties to Arcana checks or increase the tracking time.
 - **Time-Consuming:**
In the heat of battle, the time required to establish a trace can render the Tracker's Beacon impractical for immediate tactical use. It is best suited for recon or long-term surveillance.
 - **Operator Expertise:**
Only highly trained mages or artificers can effectively use the Tracker's Beacon. Without proficiency in Arcana, the DCs for the required checks increase by 5.
 - **Cost:**
The intricate enchantments make this device prohibitively expensive, limiting its distribution to elite military units or high-ranking officials.
 - Cost: 1,000–2,000 gold pieces per stone.
 - Maintenance: Periodic recalibration by an enchanter (costing 100 GP/month) is required to keep the tracking features functional.
-

Scenario Use Cases

- **Espionage Missions:**
A covert operative uses the Tracker's Beacon to pinpoint the location of an enemy

commander communicating through a standard sending stone, uncovering their hidden base.

- **Hostage Recovery:**

The party intercepts a sending stone call from captors and uses the device to slowly trace their location, balancing the urgency of the rescue with the time needed to complete the trace.

- **Battlefield Coordination:**

Military strategists use Tracker's Beacons to locate lost friendly units or track enemy forces attempting to coordinate movements over the Whispering Web.

Unsavory Merchant Guilds, Trade Groups, and Slaver Organizations in Kaysender

Not all trade and commerce in Kaysender operates above board. Beneath the veneer of reputable merchant fleets lies a shadowy network of rogue traders, exploitative guilds, and slaver organizations that thrive in the chaos of the floating islands. These groups are notorious for their morally ambiguous or outright criminal dealings, preying on the vulnerabilities of a fractured world.

1. The Black Chain Consortium

- **Purpose:**

The **Black Chain Consortium** is a sprawling slaver network operating in secret across the skies. They specialize in trafficking humanoid slaves, rare magical creatures, and even sentient constructs.

- **Fleet Details:**

- Ships are dull gray and unmarked, blending easily into the misty skies. Some vessels are reinforced with iron cages and barred windows to hold their living cargo.
- Their flagship, the "**Iron Maw**," is a heavily armored prison ship, capable of holding hundreds of captives in its reinforced holds.

- **Operations:**

- They target remote islands and vulnerable settlements, raiding under the cover of night and abducting entire populations.
- Slave auctions are held on secretive floating platforms, known as **Chain Havens**, hidden within turbulent air currents or protected by powerful magic.

- **Reputation:**

Feared and despised by most, the Consortium operates with ruthless efficiency. Despite widespread disdain, they often find buyers among the wealthy elite and certain Dragon Lords who seek cheap labor or exotic pets.

2. The Rusted Compass Company

- **Purpose:**

The **Rusted Compass Company** is a group of underhanded merchants and scavengers who profit from salvaging wrecked airships, plundering ruins, and smuggling illegal goods.

- **Fleet Details:**

- Their ships are cobbled together from scavenged parts, bearing mismatched sails and patchwork hulls. Many vessels display the titular **rusted compass** emblem painted on their sides.
- They often fly false flags to disguise their allegiance, allowing them to operate in both lawful and lawless territories.

- **Operations:**

- They scavenge battlefields and shipwrecks, often arriving suspiciously quickly after a conflict or storm.
- Their cargo includes contraband items like banned magical artifacts, cursed relics, and stolen goods.

- **Reputation:**

Known as opportunistic scavengers, the Rusted Compass Company is tolerated in some areas due to their willingness to sell hard-to-find items but reviled in others for their blatant disregard for laws and property rights.

3. The Crimson Fog Cartel

- **Purpose:**

The **Crimson Fog Cartel** is a smuggling and drug-running operation dealing in addictive magical substances, alchemical poisons, and illegal enchantments.

- **Fleet Details:**

- Their ships are sleek and fast, designed for evading pursuit. They use magical cloaks of crimson mist to obscure their movements, giving the Cartel its name.
- Ships are equipped with hidden compartments and enchanted holds to conceal their illicit cargo.

- **Operations:**

- The Cartel supplies black-market potions, cursed alchemical concoctions, and addictive magical powders to desperate or morally dubious buyers.
 - They operate out of hidden bases in the **Scarlet Veil**, a fog-shrouded region of drifting islands.
 - **Reputation:**

The Crimson Fog Cartel is infamous for ruining lives through addiction and their ruthless enforcement of loyalty among clients and suppliers. They are considered one of the most dangerous organizations to cross.
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4. The Bonehold Syndicate

- **Purpose:**

The **Bonehold Syndicate** trades in necromantic goods and forbidden magics, including undead labor, cursed artifacts, and enchanted bones.
 - **Fleet Details:**
 - Their ships are ominous and grim, with black sails stitched from hide and hulls adorned with skeletal motifs.
 - The flagship, “**The Wailing Gale**,” is said to carry a cursed crew of revenants and wraiths.
 - **Operations:**
 - The Syndicate supplies undead workers to mine dangerous sky minerals or perform other perilous tasks.
 - They harvest bones and artifacts from ancient ruins, often desecrating sacred sites in the process.
 - **Reputation:**

Feared for their macabre dealings, the Bonehold Syndicate is shunned by most civilized societies. However, their goods are prized by necromancers, warlords, and desperate Dragon Lords.
-

5. The Broken Coin Guild

- **Purpose:**

A guild of counterfeiters, forgers, and deceptive traders, the **Broken Coin Guild** undermines economies by flooding the market with fake goods, counterfeit currency, and fraudulent magical items.
- **Fleet Details:**
 - Their ships are modest and unassuming, often disguised as legitimate merchant vessels.

- Each ship carries a hidden workshop where counterfeit goods and enchanted forgeries are produced.
 - **Operations:**
 - They sell fake magical items and counterfeit potions, often disguised as high-quality goods from reputable guilds.
 - The Guild also manipulates local economies, destabilizing regions to profit from the chaos.
 - **Reputation:**

Reviled by merchants and adventurers alike, the Broken Coin Guild is seen as a blight on commerce. Their goods are often indistinguishable from the real thing until it's too late.
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6. The Sable Tide

- **Purpose:**

The **Sable Tide** is a shadowy network of spies and assassins masquerading as a trade guild. They offer services ranging from espionage to sabotage, often targeting rival merchant fleets or political figures.
 - **Fleet Details:**
 - Their ships are sleek, painted black with no visible markings. They often travel under the guise of independent traders.
 - Vessels are equipped with stealth enchantments, allowing them to slip past patrols and infiltrate enemy ports.
 - **Operations:**
 - The Sable Tide infiltrates merchant fleets and governments, planting agents to gather information or disrupt operations.
 - They also smuggle assassins and spies into secure locations, ensuring their clients' rivals are neutralized.
 - **Reputation:**

The Sable Tide operates in secrecy, and few know their true extent. Their name is whispered in fear, and their involvement in any disaster is often suspected but rarely proven.
-

7. The Chainwing Exchange

- **Purpose:**

The **Chainwing Exchange** trades in rare, often illegal, creatures, including endangered skybeasts and intelligent species. They are the black-market equivalent of the Aetherbound Company.

- **Fleet Details:**
 - Their ships are reinforced for carrying dangerous creatures, with massive containment pods suspended beneath their hulls.
 - The “**Iron Feather**,” their largest ship, is a flying fortress capable of housing entire herds of captured skybeasts.
 - **Operations:**
 - The Exchange captures creatures through illegal hunts, poaching from protected reserves, or breeding in cruel conditions.
 - Auctions are held in remote locations, attracting buyers seeking exotic pets, mounts, or biological weapons.
 - **Reputation:**

Detested by conservationists and skybeast shepherds, the Chainwing Exchange is notorious for driving species to the brink of extinction. Despite this, their goods are highly sought after by the wealthy and powerful.
-

8. The Tarnished Veil

- **Purpose:**

The **Tarnished Veil** is a shadowy network of merchants dealing in secrets, blackmail, and forbidden knowledge. They are the ultimate brokers of information.
- **Fleet Details:**
 - Their ships are nondescript and change appearances regularly, using illusory magic to evade detection.
 - The “**Ebon Whisper**” is their mobile headquarters, constantly relocating to avoid discovery.
- **Operations:**
 - The Tarnished Veil trades in political secrets, blackmail material, and classified maps or documents.
 - They often collaborate with other unsavory groups, acting as intermediaries for delicate negotiations.
- **Reputation:**

Feared and mistrusted by all, the Tarnished Veil wields immense power due to the sensitive information they possess. No one is safe from their prying eyes.

Indentured Servitude and Slavery in Kaysender: A Grim Reality

In the chaotic skies of Kaysender, where survival often outweighs morality, the lines between indentured servitude and outright slavery blur uncomfortably. Economic disparity, political unrest, and the unregulated wilds of the floating islands have created fertile ground for

exploitation. These systems persist not only due to the greed of the powerful but also because of societal norms that allow the practice to thrive under different guises.

Indentured Servitude: The Gilded Cage

Indentured servitude in Kaysender is often portrayed as a "lesser evil" compared to outright slavery, but in truth, it is a thinly veiled form of bondage.

How It Works:

- **Debt Contracts:** Many individuals, often from the landbound territories or impoverished sky islands, fall into servitude by taking out loans they cannot repay. These contracts are bought and sold like commodities, binding the debtor to years—or even a lifetime—of unpaid labor.
- **Work Assignments:** Servants are forced into grueling labor, such as working in hazardous mines that extract sky minerals, toiling aboard merchant fleets, or maintaining skybeast ranches. Escape is nearly impossible, as contracts are magically sealed, and fleeing results in severe punishments.
- **Generational Burden:** In some cases, the debts are inherited, binding entire families into perpetual servitude. Children born into these arrangements are often considered the "property" of their creditor until they can buy their freedom—a near impossibility for most.

Justifications:

- Merchant guilds, particularly unsavory ones like the **Rusted Compass Company**, argue that servitude is a necessary evil to maintain the economy.
 - Wealthy Dragon Lords and minor sky rulers enforce these systems to ensure a steady flow of labor for their industries.
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Slavery: The Darkest Chain

Slavery is a far starker and more brutal institution, operating both in the shadows and openly in certain lawless territories or under despotic rulers.

Key Practices:

- **Raiding and Kidnapping:** Sky pirates, like those loosely affiliated with the **Black Fleet**, regularly raid villages and isolated islands to capture slaves. These individuals are then sold to slavers or directly to wealthy buyers.
- **Auction Houses:** Secretive floating platforms serve as hubs for the slave trade, where humanoid captives, rare magical creatures, and sentient constructs are sold to the highest bidder. The **Black Chain Consortium** is infamous for organizing these markets.
- **Brutal Labor Camps:** Slaves are often sent to the most dangerous parts of the world—quarries on jagged floating rocks, toxic alchemical refineries, or regions plagued by wild skybeasts—to toil under inhumane conditions.

The Enslaved:

- **Humanoids:** Dwarves, elves, humans, and even dragonkin are all at risk of enslavement, especially in border regions where law enforcement is weak.
- **Skybeasts:** Intelligent magical creatures are captured, broken, and sold as tools of war or status symbols for the wealthy.
- **Constructs:** Sentient golems, bound by magic to serve their masters, are treated no better than objects despite their awareness.

Reputation and Fear:

- Slavery is an open secret among the Dragon Lords, many of whom rely on it to maintain their lavish lifestyles and armies.
- While some islands and territories outlaw the practice, enforcement is weak, and clandestine operations continue unabated.

Life of the Oppressed

The lives of those trapped in these systems are bleak, defined by relentless toil, constant fear, and a lack of autonomy. Punishments for disobedience are brutal and often public, designed to deter uprisings or escape attempts.

Conditions:

- Slaves are housed in cramped, unsanitary conditions aboard ships or in holding pens on floating islands. Diseases are rampant, and death is common.
- Magical collars, brands, or tattoos are frequently used to mark and control slaves, inflicting pain or paralysis if they disobey.

Resistance and Hope:

- Some slaves dream of freedom, spurred on by whispered tales of secret organizations like the **Free Sky Brotherhood**, which works to smuggle the oppressed to safe havens.
 - Rare uprisings occur, but they are often brutally suppressed, leaving survivors to face even harsher conditions.
-

The Thin Veil of Morality

The wealthy and powerful justify these practices with twisted logic:

- **“It’s better than starvation.”** Poor individuals often accept servitude because the alternative is death by hunger or exposure.
- **“They’re criminals.”** Some rulers enforce enslavement as punishment for crimes, real or fabricated, creating a system ripe for abuse.
- **“It’s tradition.”** In regions under the control of Dragon Lords or warlords, slavery is framed as an ancient custom, a necessary component of maintaining order.

Even the more "civilized" factions, such as the Surveyor’s Guild or Whisper Web teams, are known to turn a blind eye to these practices, so long as they profit.

Cultural Divide and the Fight for Abolition

Not everyone accepts this grim status quo.

- Certain sky islands, particularly those aligned with reformist factions, have declared themselves sanctuaries for escaped slaves and outlawed indentured servitude.
- Resistance movements are growing, with some adventurers and mercenaries dedicating their lives to disrupting slaver networks and freeing captives.

However, these efforts are met with fierce opposition, as the systems of exploitation are deeply entrenched, and those who profit from them will fight to preserve their power.

POTION GUILDS

1. The Gilded Flask Guild

Renowned for their luxurious and potent potions, the Gilded Flask specializes in high-end alchemy marketed to nobility, adventurers, and wealthy merchants.

Potions:

- **Elixir of Vital Resurgence**

Effect: Restores health and alleviates exhaustion. Grants 2d6+1 health

Flavor & Scent: A rich, honeyed flavor with hints of citrus; smells like fresh spring blossoms.

Container: Tall, slender crystal vials with gold filigree around the neck, sealed with a gilded cork.

Manufacturing Method: Cold distillation of rare herbs combined with a proprietary infusion of celestial honey, aged in crystal basins under moonlight for purity.

- **Liquid Courage**

Effect: Grants resistance to fear(+1 v Fear) and boosts charisma by +1. For 2d6 hours

Flavor & Scent: Warm, spiced apple with a faint kick of cinnamon; smells like a hearth fire on a winter night.

Container: Rounded glass flasks with a gold-stamped emblem of a roaring lion, sealed with a wax cap.

Manufacturing Method: Fermented extracts of courage blossoms mixed with distilled amber spirits, finished with a magical warming charm.

2. Iron Cauldron Consortium

Specializes in affordable, durable potions for adventurers, soldiers, and common folk.

Potions:

- **Ironhide Tonic**

Effect: Temporarily toughens the skin, increasing durability.+1 ac for 1d6 hours

Flavor & Scent: Bitter, metallic taste with a faint earthy undertone; smells like freshly turned soil.

Container: Sturdy iron flasks with riveted edges and a screw-top lid.

Manufacturing Method: Boiled roots and iron filings infused with volcanic ash in cast-iron cauldrons.

- **Fleetfoot Brew**

Effect: Increases speed(+10 move speed) and agility(+1 dex) for a short time.for 2d6 turns

Flavor & Scent: Tangy lime with a sharp peppermint aftertaste; smells like rain on stone.

Container: Sleek, blackened steel vials with etched lightning motifs, corked and secured with a metal band.

Manufacturing Method: A rapid infusion process combining windblossom petals and quicksilver, cooled in running water to capture the essence of speed.

3. Verdant Circle Collective

An eco-conscious guild producing potions with natural and sustainable methods, appealing to druids, rangers, and herbalists.

Potions:

- **Verdant Restoration Draught**
Effect: Heals minor wounds and revitalizes energy. Roll 1d4+2 to determine how many hit points are restored.
Flavor & Scent: Fresh mint with a hint of cucumber; smells like dew-covered grass.
Container: Recycled glass bottles wrapped in biodegradable twine, with hand-written labels.
Manufacturing Method: Sun-dried healing herbs brewed in spring water and enchanted with a growth charm.
 - **Beastbinder's Tonic**
Effect: Enhances affinity with animals, aiding in taming and communication. Roll 1d6 to determine the bonus (1-2 grants a minor boost+1, 3-4 a moderate boost+2, 5-6 a major boost +3 to animal handling).
Flavor & Scent: Earthy with notes of wild berries; smells like damp forest moss.
Container: Small, clay urns with carved runes, sealed with beeswax.
Manufacturing Method: A slow fermentation process using crushed berries, enchanted tree sap, and animal pheromones, brewed in wooden barrels.
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4. Emberforge Alchemists

Masters of volatile, fire-based concoctions, favored by warriors and demolitionists.

Potions:

- **Blazing Fury Serum**
Effect: Enhances strength and grants fire resistance.(+2 Strength) and grants fire resistance. Roll 1d6 for the duration of the strength boost (e.g., 1 means 1 turn, 6 means 6 turns).
Flavor & Scent: Spicy chili with smoky undertones; smells like burnt cedar.
Container: Short, thick glass bottles with red-tinted glass, sealed with an iron cap

and wrapped in fireproof cloth.

Manufacturing Method: Heated blending of flame orchid petals and volcanic ember powder, tempered with molten steel.

- **Ignition Oil**

Effect: Creates a short burst of fire when thrown or applied to weapons. Roll 1d4 to determine the fire damage (e.g., 1 means 1d6, 4 means 4d6 fire damage).

Flavor & Scent: Acrid and unpalatable; smells strongly of sulfur and burning wood.

Container: Rounded flasks with flame-shaped stoppers, designed with shatter-on-impact glass.

Manufacturing Method: Mixed through controlled combustion of flammable herbs and minerals in a sealed crucible.

5. Starlight Elixirs Guild

Famed for mystical potions imbued with arcane energy, catering to mages, scholars, and explorers of the unknown.

Potions:

- **Astral Sight Decoction**

Effect: Enhances vision, allowing the user to see magical auras and invisible entities. Roll 1d6 to determine the range of vision (e.g., 1 means 30 ft, 6 means 120 ft).

Flavor & Scent: Sweet and effervescent with hints of lavender; smells like a clear, starlit night.

Container: Tall, cylindrical vials with star-shaped stoppers and glowing liquid that swirls softly within.

Manufacturing Method: Brewed under starlight with moonflower petals and stardust, stirred with an enchanted crystal rod.

- **Ethereal Drift Potion**

Effect: Grants temporary weightlessness and slow fall. Roll 1d4 to determine the duration (e.g., 1 means 5 rounds, 4 means 4 minutes).

Flavor & Scent: Light and airy, with a subtle vanilla and lemon taste; smells like cool mountain air.

Container: Iridescent, spherical bottles with silver caps, faintly glowing with a soft blue hue.

Manufacturing Method: Concocted from cloudberry nectar and powdered levitation crystals, distilled in glass spheres suspended mid-air during brewing.

Mercenaries

1. The Iron Vanguard

“Strength in Iron, Victory in Resolve.”

- **Headquarters:** Fortress City of Blackstone Keep, located on a heavily fortified floating island.
 - **Specialties:**
 - Caravan protection across hostile territories.
 - Large-scale private security operations for cities and nobles.
 - Monster elimination, specializing in giant and dragon threats.
 - **Reputation:** Known for their discipline, efficiency, and no-nonsense attitude, the Iron Vanguard operates with military precision. Their emblem, a crossed sword and shield encased in iron, is a symbol of reliability.
 - **Notable Features:** Their recruits undergo rigorous training and wear distinct steel-plated armor marked with their crest. They are often contracted by governments and powerful merchants.
-

2. The Silver Fangs

“Silent, Swift, Sure.”

- **Headquarters:** Hidden within the forests of the continent of Messara.
 - **Specialties:**
 - High-risk bounty hunting.
 - Assassinations and discrete personal protection.
 - Scouting and ruins exploration.
 - **Reputation:** A stealth-oriented guild, the Silver Fangs are known for their subtlety and effectiveness. They’re often hired for jobs that require precision and discretion rather than brute force.
 - **Notable Features:** Operatives are experts in survival and tracking, recognizable by their silvered daggers and wolf-pelt cloaks. Their membership is rumored to include beast-folk who use heightened senses to track prey.
-

3. The Emberhawks

“Where fire meets fury.”

- **Headquarters:** Skyship base, Ember's Roost, drifting above the trade routes.
 - **Specialties:**
 - Airship protection and sky piracy deterrence.
 - Large-scale mercenary battles.
 - Monster hunting, particularly airborne threats.
 - **Reputation:** Brash and daring, the Emberhawks are a sky-focused guild that excels in aerial combat and fast-paced operations. Their emblem is a flaming hawk in flight, symbolizing their swift and devastating tactics.
 - **Notable Features:** Known for their modified airships outfitted with alchemical weaponry. Their fiery red uniforms and flare gun signals are unmistakable.
-

4. The Stone Shields

"Your safety, set in stone."

- **Headquarters:** Deep within the dwarven stronghold of Granite Hearth.
 - **Specialties:**
 - Personal protection for nobles and wealthy merchants.
 - Caravan support through dangerous mountain passes.
 - Fortification and defense of critical locations.
 - **Reputation:** Renowned for their unshakable loyalty and ability to hold the line in the most dire situations, the Stone Shields are the go-to guild for defense-oriented missions.
 - **Notable Features:** Members are dwarves and heavy infantry experts. They use rune-inscribed shields and armor and are skilled in defensive magic and engineering.
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5. The Gilded Gauntlet

"Glory, Gold, and Victory."

- **Headquarters:** Lavish guildhall in the trading hub of Aetherspire.
- **Specialties:**
 - High-profile personal security for elites.
 - Treasure hunting and ruins exploration.
 - Recovery of rare artifacts and relics.
- **Reputation:** A flashy and extravagant organization, the Gilded Gauntlet is known for prioritizing high-paying clients and glamorous jobs. Their crest, a golden gauntlet clutching a crown, represents their ambition and pursuit of wealth.

- **Notable Features:** Members are required to wear polished armor adorned with gilded accents. They have a reputation for showmanship and are often accompanied by heralds to announce their deeds.
-

6. The Black Scales

“No beast too fierce, no man too strong.”

- **Headquarters:** A sprawling jungle fortress in the southern reaches of Kaysender.
 - **Specialties:**
 - Monster elimination, including apex predators and magical beasts.
 - Bounty hunting for dangerous criminals.
 - Jungle and wilderness navigation.
 - **Reputation:** Known for their ferocity and adaptability, the Black Scales thrive in dangerous, untamed regions. Their name strikes fear into beasts and men alike.
 - **Notable Features:** Members often use dragon-scale armor and weapons crafted from the creatures they hunt. Many members are lizardfolk or dragonkin.
-

7. The Wandering Blades

“No land too far, no job too small.”

- **Headquarters:** None (nomadic, with scattered outposts).
 - **Specialties:**
 - General adventuring services, including monster hunting and ruins exploration.
 - Guard duties for wandering caravans and small settlements.
 - Contracted aid for warzones or disaster relief.
 - **Reputation:** Known for their flexibility and willingness to take on almost any job, the Wandering Blades are a jack-of-all-trades organization. Their insignia, a crossed sword and quill, reflects their adaptability.
 - **Notable Features:** Operatives are highly diverse in skills and background, often traveling in small, self-sufficient teams. They are well-loved by common folk for their approachability and reasonable prices.
-

8. The Night Wardens

“Watchers in the dark, keepers of the light.”

- **Headquarters:** The Obsidian Spire, located in a shadowy mountain range.
 - **Specialties:**
 - Nighttime security and patrols.
 - Monster hunting, particularly nocturnal and undead threats.
 - Guarding ancient ruins and cursed locations.
 - **Reputation:** The Night Wardens are shrouded in mystery, known for their vigilance and their willingness to confront supernatural horrors. Their emblem, a crescent moon encircled by chains, symbolizes their role as protectors against darkness.
 - **Notable Features:** Members wear dark, lightweight armor and carry lanterns enchanted to reveal hidden creatures. They are experts in dealing with curses and dark magic.
-

9. The Azure Striders

“Fleet of foot, quick to aid.”

- **Headquarters:** Floating fortress, Skyreach Citadel, located near major trade winds.
- **Specialties:**
 - Escort missions for skyships and caravans.
 - Emergency rapid-response services.
 - Delivering urgent messages or goods across perilous regions.
- **Reputation:** Known for their speed and reliability, the Azure Striders are often the first choice for missions requiring swift action. Their emblem, a winged boot over a lightning bolt, reflects their speed.
- **Notable Features:** Members wear light, sky-blue uniforms with enchanted boots that grant increased speed and agility.

How to stop the fall?

In a world that floats how do you not die from falling off?

Affordable Options (For the Destitute or Common Folk)

Air Sailor’s Rope Harness

Category: Standard Airship Equipment

Price: 10 gp

Description:

An essential piece of safety gear for any air sailor working the rigging, the **Air Sailor's Rope Harness** is a **reinforced leather and canvas harness** designed to **prevent crew members from plummeting into the abyss** during high-altitude maneuvers, storms, or combat. The harness features a series of adjustable straps, ensuring a snug fit across the chest, waist, and thighs, while **sturdy metal buckles** provide quick-release functionality in emergencies.

Attached to the back of the harness is a **40-foot enchanted rope lanyard**, woven with alchemically treated fibers to resist fraying and snapping. The rope is secured to the ship via a **heavy-duty clasp** that locks into designated anchor points along the deck and masts.

Game Mechanics (D&D 5e):

- **Safety Tether:** While wearing the harness and properly attached to the ship, a creature **cannot fall more than 10 feet** before the rope pulls them back. This prevents accidental freefall but allows enough movement to maneuver through the rigging.
- **Stability Bonus:** While secured, the wearer has **advantage on Strength (Athletics) checks** made to **climb, balance, or brace against high winds** while working aloft.
- **Emergency Release:** As an action, the wearer can disengage from the anchor point if they need to move freely. The harness can be reattached using an action.

Variants & Upgrades:

- **Stormproof Harness (25 gp)** – Includes **lightning-resistant threading**, granting **resistance to lightning damage** from environmental sources while tethered.
- **Grappling Harness (50 gp)** – Replaces the standard rope with a **self-winding, retractable enchanted cord** that can **latch onto surfaces up to 60 feet away**, functioning like a **grappling hook** (range 30/60 ft).
- **Mageweave Harness (75 gp)** – Designed for **spellcasters**, this version allows the wearer to **hover in place** for 5 rounds once per long rest if they fall, negating descent entirely.

Usage & Cultural Significance:

The **Air Sailor's Rope Harness** is a mandatory piece of gear aboard many fleets, particularly those navigating **turbulent storm corridors** or engaging in **high-altitude combat**. Some experienced sailors scoff at the need for a harness, but even the most daring sky captains acknowledge that a single misstep without one can mean certain death. Many airships have **superstitions surrounding lost harnesses**, believing that a discarded harness invites disaster upon the crew.

Sky Bloon Harness

Description: Simple, reusable balloons filled with a buoyant magical gas. Activated by pulling a string to inflate instantly. Worn like a backpack or a satchel

Cost: Inexpensive; crafted from basic canvas and sealed with enchanted resin. Filled with float fish oil, And spark powder when crushed Spark powder burns and ignites the float fish oil
Inflating the resin balloon

Effectiveness: Slows descent but requires manual activation. Best suited for short falls. Enables flotation for a few hours

Drawback: Limited capacity—may not stop falls from extreme heights. Relatively quick activation but limited duration.

Feather Charms

Description: A one-use, feather-shaped wooden trinket imbued with a basic feather fall spell and flight spell, Incredibly short duration a few rounds at most It is a wooden feather token imbued by a local priest.

Cost: Affordable; commonly sold by street vendors.

Effectiveness: Slows the fall for 30 seconds Turning into a gentle hover, long enough to reach a floating platform or air currents.

Drawback: Must be held or pinned to clothing to activate. The tokens lose their magic after a few days It must be renewed, When activated lasts for a day at most keeping the character hovering in place, Downside every town or homestead is slightly different requiring a new token.

Mid-Tier Options (For Merchants, Adventurers, and Soldiers)

5. Cloudcatch Cloaks

- *Description:* A durable cloak with enchantments that generate a buoyant cushion of air. Activates automatically when falling. reduces falling speed to 1 foot per round With limited glide control.
- *Cost:* Moderate; widely available from alchemy guilds.
- *Effectiveness:* Reduces fall speed significantly and can redirect the wearer toward safety. has a one time use 60 foot launch function to shoot you straight up into the air it must be refilled with blast powder in a tube at the nape of the neck
- *Drawback:* Bulky to wear; limited glide control.

6. Levitation safety Band

- *Description:* A silver bracelet that casts a levitate spell on the wearer for 60 hours when activated. It provides no means of motion merely levitation in place when activated.
- *Cost:* Moderately priced and reliable.

- *Effectiveness:* Halts descent completely but doesn't provide lateral movement. Has a bright green bar on the side of the band that shows the remaining time left on the safety band
- *Drawback:* Limited duration; requires another means of reaching solid ground.

7. Sky Whistle

- *Description:* A magical whistle that summons a small enchanted air elemental to carry the wearer to safety. The elemental called by such a spell lasts until dismissed even if the journey requires several days, But note they are only compelled to bring you to the nearest solid ground.
- *Cost:* Mid-tier; crafted by elemental summoners.
- *Effectiveness:* Highly reliable but requires a free hand to blow the whistle.
- *Drawback:* Elementals can be slow and struggle in high winds. and only take you to the nearest solid ground.

8. Parachuting Wurm Kits

- *Description:* A compact container holding a magically summoned miniature wurm that unfolds into a gliding harness.
- *Cost:* Moderate; popular among adventurers.
- *Effectiveness:* Provides a steady glide to the nearest platform or safe area. In the "throat" of the wurm glider, There is a container holding a day's worth of propulsion magic Which the person flying can see Easily by looking up when using the glider, Which allows the user To gracefully change elevations at a rate of 40 feet a minute.
- *Drawback:* Requires a brief setup period during freefall. As the container magically expands and decompats.

Luxury Options (For Nobility and the Wealthy)

9. Featherlight Parasol

- *Description:* An ornate parasol that automatically opens and casts a slow fall spell when the user begins to plummet. The spell is indifferent and lasts as long as the parachute is deployed.
- *Cost:* Expensive; favored by the aristocracy.
- *Effectiveness:* Offers a graceful and stylish descent.
- *Drawback:* Fragile and impractical for combat situations.

10. Phoenix Pendant

- *Description:* A golden pendant inlaid with a phoenix feather. Upon activation, it conjures a fiery phoenix that carries the wearer to safety. The illusory phoenix Drags you towards the nearest solid ground at high speed at a rate of 120 feet a round.

- *Cost:* Very high; crafted by master enchanter.
- *Effectiveness:* Instant rescue with a stunning visual display.
- *Drawback:* Single-use before requiring recharging by a skilled mage. When used the feather inside vibrates madly attempting to escape the container if left long enough it will fracture its container and escape into the ether, The container is recharged to contain the feather.

11. Aether Wings Harness

- *Description:* A custom-fit, gilded harness with foldable magical wings that allow full flight control. Activates automatically during freefall. The device bears the appearance of an elaborate backpack, Magical enchanted stones thrum with glowing letters Enchanted script in parchment flutters From emblems stamped in various places about the backpack harness, When active large magical glowing wings enable endless true flight For up to seven continuous days.
- *Cost:* Extremely high; reserved for royalty and elite adventurers.
- *Effectiveness:* Provides true flight capabilities.
- *Drawback:* Requires regular maintenance by expert artificers. Works for seven days on a single charge.

12. Eternal Drift Boots

- *Description:* Elegant boots enchanted with an advanced levitation spell that stops the wearer mid-air and allows controlled hovering for several minutes.
- *Cost:* Luxurious; only available through premier magical artisans.
- *Effectiveness:* Highly reliable and stylish.
- *Drawback:* Requires attunement, limiting their use to one person at a time.

Unique Artifacts (Rare and Priceless)

13. Skyweaver's Sphere

- *Description:* A small crystal orb that, when thrown, creates a floating magical platform beneath the user. The platform persists for up to 10 days.
- *Cost:* Priceless; ancient relics from the First Sky Mages.
- *Effectiveness:* Provides a stable resting point mid-air, allowing for strategic planning.
- *Drawback:* Rare and almost impossible to replicate.

14. The Abyssal Amulet

- *Description:* A mysterious artifact that teleports the wearer to the nearest safe surface when crushed, The few of this amulets that are spoken of in tales and legend Are described As a jet black chalk That seems to throng with an otherworldly power. They have taken many forms Small figurines, coins, tokens

amulets, It is known that the devices themselves crumble away to ash when activated The remaining powder is no different than burnt charcoal.

- *Cost:* rare; often found in ruins.
 - *Effectiveness:* Instant and reliable rescue.
 - *Drawback:* Activation is unpredictable, occasionally teleporting users miles away.
-

From humble sky bloons to luxurious phoenix pendants, these items ensure that every inhabitant of Kaysender has access to some form of protection against the eternal abyss. However, the quality, reliability, and flair of these solutions vary widely based on wealth and resources.

Emergency equipment

Dwarven Flare Guns

“Lighting the sky with unyielding resolve.”

- **Description:** Compact, rune-etched firearms designed to launch magical flares into the sky. Each flare emits a specific color, signifying different emergencies (e.g., red for danger, blue for medical aid, green for rescue).
 - **Craftsmanship:** Made from reinforced steel and brass, featuring ornate carvings of mountains or hammers, these devices are as durable as they are reliable.
 - **Operation:** Easy to use, requiring only a trigger pull. The flares are powered by alchemical powder stored in replaceable cartridges.
 - **Common Use:** Popular among miners, merchants, and airship crews, especially in the rugged terrain of Messara.
 - **Limitations:** Limited visibility in heavy fog or storms; requires reloading after each use.
-

Elven Sending Stones

“A whisper carried on the winds.”

- **Description:** Smooth, palm-sized crystals imbued with magic that allow the user to send a short, spoken message to a pre-linked stone.
- **Craftsmanship:** Crafted from polished gemstones or enchanted quartz, often adorned with natural motifs like vines or leaves.

- **Operation:** Activated by touch and a spoken incantation, the stones transmit the user's message and location to their pair.
 - **Common Use:** Favored by travelers, diplomats, and guardians of elven settlements. Often pre-linked to emergency responders or allied forces.
 - **Limitations:** Limited range (up to 10 miles) unless enhanced by a mage, and only works with its paired stone.
-

Gnomish Safety Signal Reflectors

"Simple, practical, brilliant."

- **Description:** A foldable contraption of mirrored panels that reflect sunlight or moonlight in specific patterns, akin to Morse code. Enhanced versions include a small mana crystal to emit light in the absence of natural illumination.
 - **Craftsmanship:** Made from lightweight metal alloys and polished mirrors, with an intricate folding mechanism that makes them compact and portable.
 - **Operation:** Users can manipulate the mirrors to flash signals, often pre-learned codes for distress or location identification.
 - **Common Use:** Widely used in open-sky environments like floating islands or airship decks. Popular among gnomish engineers and tinkers.
 - **Limitations:** Ineffective in poor weather or heavy cloud cover; requires manual operation.
-

Human Signal Flares

"Quick and loud for all to see."

- **Description:** Alchemical torches or handheld flare sticks that emit bright, colorful light and loud whistles when ignited.
 - **Craftsmanship:** Basic in design, often consisting of wooden or metal casings filled with alchemical powders.
 - **Operation:** Activated by striking a flint or pulling a cord to ignite the flare.
 - **Common Use:** Commonly carried by caravan guards and adventurers. Red is for danger, yellow for caution, and white for safety.
 - **Limitations:** Limited burn time and relatively short visibility range compared to more advanced methods.
-

Dragonkin Fire Orbs

“Our breath shall call for aid.”

- **Description:** Spherical devices infused with the essence of dragonkin flame, capable of producing a large, magical burst of light and fire in the air.
 - **Craftsmanship:** Resembling miniature dragon eggs, these orbs are ornate and often etched with runic designs or draconic glyphs.
 - **Operation:** Shattered against the ground or thrown into the air to create a radiant explosion of light visible for miles.
 - **Common Use:** Carried by dragonkin warriors and scouts as a mark of honor.
 - **Limitations:** Single-use and expensive to produce.
-

Halfling Sky Lanterns

“Even in darkness, there is light.”

- **Description:** Small, enchanted lanterns that float upward when lit, leaving a glowing trail of light behind them.
 - **Craftsmanship:** Made from lightweight paper infused with magical runes and mounted on a small alchemical burner.
 - **Operation:** Lighting the burner activates the magic, allowing the lantern to ascend steadily into the sky.
 - **Common Use:** Used in both emergencies and celebrations, making them a versatile tool in halfling communities.
 - **Limitations:** Vulnerable to strong winds and heavy rain.
-

Orcish War Horns

“A call that shakes the heavens.”

- **Description:** Large, intricately carved horns that produce a thunderous, resonating sound when blown. The tone and rhythm signal specific types of emergencies.
- **Craftsmanship:** Made from hollowed animal horns or metal, often adorned with tribal patterns and battle scars.
- **Operation:** Simple to use, requiring only a strong breath to produce a sound.
- **Common Use:** Often used in remote or dangerous areas to summon reinforcements or alert nearby allies.

- **Limitations:** Audible but not visible, making them unsuitable for signaling over long distances without listeners.
-

Luxury Options for the Wealthy

1. Aetherflare Globes

- *Description:* Crystal orbs that emit a brilliant, magical display of light and sound when activated. The display can be customized to include visual symbols (like house crests) or even recorded messages.
- *Craftsmanship:* Elegant and extravagant, often gilded and inlaid with precious gems.
- *Cost:* High; used by nobles and skyship captains.

2. Arcane Beacons

- *Description:* Portable devices that emit a continuous beam of light and magic that can be seen for miles. Often embedded with enchantments that relay the user's location to nearby mages.
- *Craftsmanship:* Made from advanced arcane machinery, often requiring a mage to activate.
- *Cost:* Expensive but highly reliable.

3. Windcall Amulets

- *Description:* Enchanted necklaces that summon an air elemental when crushed, which then carries a message to a pre-determined recipient or organization.
 - *Craftsmanship:* Intricately designed pendants with embedded elemental crystals.
 - *Cost:* Very high; used by royalty and elite adventurers.
-

Cargo

1-Ton Cargo Load (*Small Shipment / Personal or Specialty Goods*)

A 1-ton cargo load typically consists of compact, high-value, or essential supplies. These shipments are often stored in reinforced crates, barrels, or tightly secured pallets. Examples include:

- **Luxury goods** (fine textiles, spices, rare metals, or magical components)
- **Specialty rations** for a small crew or passengers
- **Ammunition and small arms** for security or mercenary use
- **Medical supplies**, including alchemical potions and herbs

- **Magical artifacts or enchanted items** carefully contained for transport
- **Industrial tools** or repair kits for ship maintenance

Ships carrying a 1-ton load tend to have extra space for maneuverability and can make quick stops at various ports, making this an ideal weight for fast couriers and high-value merchants.

5-Ton Cargo Load (*Standard Trade Shipment / Merchant Stock*)

A 5-ton cargo load represents the standard shipment for most mid-sized airships, comprising bulk trade goods, consumables, and essential supplies. The cargo is often packed in reinforced crates, large barrels, or secured chests, depending on the contents. Examples include:

- **Dried foodstuffs and preserved rations** for an extended crew or multiple settlements
- **Mid-size weapons cache** (ballista bolts, cannon ammunition, standard blades)
- **Machinery components and ship parts**, including sails, rigging, or alchemical engines
- **Barrels of water or spirits**, necessary for long voyages
- **General trade goods**, such as textiles, ores, and processed materials
- **Moderate magical cargo**, such as mana batteries, bottled potions, or simple enchanted items

A 5-ton cargo load is common among merchant fleets, skyports, and small military resupply operations. While manageable by most airships, it requires careful storage to maintain flight balance.

10-Ton Cargo Load (*Large Shipment / Bulk Freight*)

A 10-ton cargo load is a major freight shipment, often requiring dedicated cargo ships or larger merchant vessels. These shipments are typically secured in massive reinforced crates, secured to the hull with heavy chains, or stored in large cargo bays. Examples include:

- **Heavy industrial materials**, such as raw ore, lumber, and processed metals
- **Livestock or exotic creatures**, transported in reinforced cages or containment wards
- **Large-scale weaponry**, including siege ballistae, cannons, and armored plating
- **Mass water reserves or fuel stores**, essential for skyports and fleets
- **Luxury goods in bulk**, such as expensive wines, exotic silks, and rare herbs
- **Magical artifacts of significant power**, often requiring enchanted containment

A 10-ton cargo load is best suited for dedicated trade fleets, military transport vessels, or major skyport supply runs. Airships carrying this much weight require reinforced hulls, strong lift systems, and careful distribution to prevent instability during flight.

General Cargo Wrapping and Security Measures

In the skies of Kaysender, cargo meant for shipment is carefully wrapped and secured to withstand the rigors of air travel, prevent spoilage or damage, and deter theft or tampering. Most

standard shipments follow a common wrapping process that ensures goods arrive intact at their destination.

Cargo Wrapping and Packaging

- **Burlap Sacks & Heavy Cloth Wrapping** – Most bulk goods, including grains, spices, dried meats, and textiles, are packed into **large, reinforced burlap sacks**. These are woven from durable fibers to resist tearing from rough handling or turbulent winds. For more fragile cargo, layers of **padded cloth or canvas wrapping** are used to cushion against shocks during flight.
- **Wax-Sealed Security Tablets** – To prevent tampering, **each burlap sack or crate is sealed with a large wax tablet**, stamped with the insignia of the merchant, fleet, or port authority. These wax seals serve as both proof of authenticity and a deterrent against thieves—if broken, it is clear the shipment has been tampered with.
- **Ropes and Twine Binding** – Cargo sacks are tightly bound with **thick ropes or alchemically treated twine** that resists fraying and moisture, ensuring the bundles stay secure.
- **Tarred Canvas or Oilcloth Coating** – For shipments sensitive to the elements, such as dried goods, books, or alchemical substances, a **layer of tarred canvas or oiled cloth** is wrapped around the containers to repel moisture and airborne dust.

Crates, Barrels, and Secured Pallets

- **Wooden Crates (Iron-Banded for Heavy Goods)** – Sturdier shipments, such as machinery, weapons, or enchanted artifacts, are encased in **reinforced wooden crates**, often bound with **iron bands** for extra durability. These crates are further marked with merchant sigils and weight indicators.
- **Sealed Barrels for Liquids and Perishables** – Water, alcohol, and fragile goods are stored in **airtight barrels**, the lids secured with **wax seals** and heavy rope bindings. Certain barrels, especially those containing valuable liquids, may have **rune-etched lids** to prevent unauthorized opening.
- **Stacked and Net-Secured Pallets** – Bulk shipments are often **stacked onto wooden pallets**, which are then tightly secured with **cargo netting** and affixed to the ship's hull to prevent shifting during flight. These nets are woven from strong, lightweight fibers, designed to endure the strain of aerial turbulence.

Tamper Prevention and Security Measures

- **Inspected Seals and Signatures** – Every shipment includes **merchant or fleet insignias**, stamped on wax seals or carved onto the crate itself. Port officials or receiving merchants will check for unbroken seals upon delivery.
- **Arcane Security Wards** – Some valuable shipments feature **magical deterrents**, such as **illusory script seals**, minor **shocking runes**, or simple enchantments that alert the sender if tampered with.

- **Weight Verification and Counterfeit Prevention** – Cargo is weighed before departure, and discrepancies at arrival may indicate theft or substitution. Some merchants use **false-bottom crates** to deter smugglers and spies.

This system of packaging and security ensures that shipments in Kaysender's skies remain **well-protected, intact, and unspoiled**, whether they are mundane trade goods or highly valuable magical artifacts.

General items

Simple Wooden Hoe

Category: Simple Tool / Improvised Weapon

Price: 2 sp

Weight: 3 lbs

A **sturdy wooden hoe** with a worn handle and a flat, slightly curved blade, used primarily for **turning soil in skyborne gardens and floating isles**. Though not designed for combat, in the hands of a desperate farmer or airship laborer, it serves as a functional bludgeoning weapon.

Mechanics:

- **Weapon Type:** Improvised Weapon (treated as a Club)
- **Damage:** 1d4 bludgeoning
- **Properties:** Light
- **Use in Farming:** Grants **advantage on Strength (Athletics) checks** made to till soil or break apart packed earth.

Thrown Sky Fishing Net

Category: Airship Equipment

Price: 10 gp

Weight: 8 lbs

A **wide-mouthed, weighted net** designed for catching **skyfish, drifting creatures, or floating debris**, the Thrown Sky Fishing Net is a vital tool for airship crews harvesting from the open skies. The net is **woven from lightweight but durable fibers**, reinforced with alchemically treated cords to withstand strong winds and sudden tugs.

The net is attached to **50 feet of sturdy rope**, allowing it to be cast far and pulled back with ease. The **other end of the rope is left free**, meaning a user **must secure it to the ship or**

their harness if they wish to keep their catch—or risk losing both the net and whatever it ensnares to the abyss.

Mechanics:

- **Range:** 20/50 ft
- **On a hit**, a **Large or smaller** creature is **restrained** until freed (DC 12 Strength check or 5 slashing damage to escape).
- **Used for skyfishing**, it can catch **floating skyfish, rare drifting spores, or airborne debris**, as determined by the DM.

Foodstuffs

Air sailors from different backgrounds carry unique rations suited to their physiology, culture, and travel needs. Below is a list of common rations found among various peoples.

These are generally abstracted as a standard ration tin But the contents vary widely depending on who made it and when.

Standard Ration Tin (5 gp)

Adventuring Gear

A compact, durable tin designed for easy transport and long-term preservation of basic meals. Each tin is tightly sealed, preventing spoilage and keeping the contents dry and edible for weeks, if not months. Inside, you'll find a mix of dried meats, hardtack biscuits, salted vegetables, and a small pouch of powdered broth, all designed to sustain you through harsh conditions.

Mechanics:

- Provides enough food for one creature for one day.
- Requires water or heat to prepare, though it can be eaten cold in an emergency.
- The tin is reusable, though the contents are bland and lack flavor, providing only minimal enjoyment.

Ideal for long journeys where supplies may be scarce, these ration tins are a staple for adventurers and sailors alike.

Pallet of Ration Tins (300 gp)

Adventuring Gear

This sturdy wooden pallet holds 60 sealed ration tins, each containing a day's worth of sustenance. The tins are neatly stacked, wrapped in protective burlap to withstand the rigors of transport. Each tin contains a simple, but filling meal of dried meats, hardtack, salted

vegetables, and powdered broth. The pallet is designed for large expeditions, merchant caravans, or air sailor fleets that need bulk supplies for long trips through unpredictable territories.

Mechanics:

- Contains 60 tins, each providing enough food for one creature for one day.
- The pallet weighs 120 pounds, making it impractical for single travelers but ideal for larger groups.
- The tins remain fresh and edible for up to 6 months if stored properly.
- The pallet can be broken down into individual tins as needed.

Perfect for outfitting a crew or ensuring a supply of reliable food for a lengthy journey, this pallet is both practical and cost-effective for long-term expeditions.

Dwarven Rations – *Dense & Long-Lasting*

Dwarves prefer preserved, nutrient-dense foods that last for months without spoiling. These rations are heavy but sustaining.

- **Stonebread** – A rock-hard, spiced loaf that softens when soaked in ale.
- **Pemmican Slabs** – Dried meat and fat pressed into compact bricks for long-lasting energy.
- **Nut-Stuffed Cheese Wheels** – Aged cheese encased in wax, filled with spiced nuts and dried fruit.
- **Deepforge Jerky** – Salted, smoked meats (goat, boar, or cave lizard) designed to last through extended mining expeditions.

Elven Rations – *Light, Fresh & Herbal*

Elves favor natural, minimally processed foods wrapped in leaves or delicate breadings, meant to be nourishing without feeling heavy.

- **Mistfruit Bundles** – Dehydrated berries and edible flowers wrapped in broad leaves.
- **Moonbloom Pastries** – Delicate croissant-like rolls filled with honeyed nuts and spiced nectar.
- **Sylvan Trail Mix** – Roasted nuts, dried figs, and honey-coated seeds stored in a silk pouch.
- **Herbal Waybread** – Light, crisp wafers infused with natural herbs that keep the body energized.

Human Rations – *Practical & Preserved*

Humans rely on cured, salted, and dried foods that are easy to store and require minimal preparation.

- **Hardtack** – Thick, near-indestructible crackers requiring soaking to eat.
- **Salted Meat Strips** – Heavily salted beef, pork, or fish to withstand long voyages.
- **Pickled Vegetables** – Jars of preserved onions, carrots, and cabbage, packed in brine.
- **Travel Sausages** – Dried, smoked, or cured sausages stored in waxed paper for easy consumption.

Gnomish Rations – *Cleverly Preserved & Compact*

Gnomes favor small, efficient foods that often come in tins or jars for easy access.

- **Canned Mushroom Stew** – A hearty mix of earthy mushrooms, onions, and root vegetables.
- **Miniature Cheese Wheels** – Small, wax-sealed cheeses perfect for quick meals.
- **Compressed Nut Cakes** – Dense bars of roasted nuts, honey, and oat flour packed for long-term travel.
- **Gearsnap Biscuits** – Crunchy biscuits with crystallized fruit, ideal for dunking in tea or broth.

Orcish Rations – *Hearty & High-Protein*

Orc raiders and warriors rely on robust, protein-rich meals that fuel endurance and combat readiness.

- **Blood Sausages** – Preserved in thick casings, often smoked or dried for longevity.
- **Battle Jerky** – Tough, spicy meat strips meant to be chewed over time to maintain energy.
- **Rootstarch Cakes** – Dense cakes of mashed tubers and dried insects, highly nutritious.
- **Fermented Bone Broth** – Concentrated broth stored in clay bottles, mixed with water for a sustaining drink.

Halfling Rations – *Comforting & Flavorful*

Halflings enjoy flavorful, homey rations, often emphasizing taste and enjoyment over efficiency.

- **Sweetberry Tarts** – Hand-sized, fruit-filled pastries that last a week when stored properly.
 - **Herbed Meat Pies** – Small, buttery-crusts pies filled with spiced meats and gravy.
 - **Honeyed Oat Cakes** – Soft, chewy cakes made with honey and nuts, providing slow-burning energy.
 - **Dried Apple Rings** – Thin slices of apple spiced with cinnamon and lightly sugared for a refreshing snack.
-

Dragonborn Rations – *High-Heat & Protein-Rich*

Dragonborn often prefer strong, spicy flavors and protein-heavy meals that sustain their powerful frames.

- **Spice-Cured Meat Rolls** – Heavily seasoned meat, cured with fire salts and wrapped in thin dough.
 - **Smoked Dragonpeppers** – Dried and preserved fiery-hot peppers, eaten for warmth and energy.
 - **Flame-Roasted Nuts** – Spiced, charred nuts stored in waxed pouches for quick consumption.
 - **Seared Fish Strips** – Thinly sliced, heavily spiced fish dried in hot air and eaten like jerky.
-

Tiefling Rations – *Exotic & Fiery*

Tiefling cuisine is bold, spiced, and often features foods resistant to spoilage through alchemical preservation.

- **Infernal Jerky** – Meat cured with exotic spices that tingle the tongue.
 - **Spiced Flatbread** – Thin, durable bread infused with cinnamon and clove.
 - **Darkfruit Preserves** – Tart, almost bitter fruit preserves that complement savory meals.
 - **Charred Bean Cakes** – Savory, smoky cakes of beans and spices, packed for travel.
-

Lizardfolk Rations – *Raw & Foraged*

Lizardfolk value fresh, natural foods that require minimal preparation.

- **Sun-Dried Fish** – Entire fish dried in the sun and eaten whole, bones and all.

- **Insect Clusters** – Dried, crunchy insects mixed with honey for long-term storage.
 - **Swampfruit Pouches** – Thick-skinned fruit with a gelatinous, energy-rich interior.
 - **Blood-Filled Gourds** – Stored animal blood used as a nutrient-dense drink.
-

Tavern & Inn Fare Across the Lands

Using the racial ration styles as a foundation, here's a list of meals typically served in taverns, inns, and roadside eateries across your world. Each establishment caters to its region's dominant culture while offering specialty dishes to travelers.

Dwarven Taverns – Hearty, Heavy & Ale-Soaked

Dwarven inns serve filling, robust meals that sustain miners, warriors, and craftsmen after long shifts underground.

- **Stonebread & Ale Stew** – Chunks of rock-hard stonebread softened in a thick, meaty stew.
 - **Forge-Grilled Sausages** – Heavy spiced sausages seared on a forge plate and served with melted cheese.
 - **Deepdelve Roast** – Slow-roasted goat or boar basted with mushroom butter and dark ale glaze.
 - **Molten Cheese Dip** – A bubbling pot of thick cheese mixed with stout and served with dense bread.
 - **Blackiron Pies** – Meat and root vegetable pies with a charcoal-crusted shell, seasoned with deep-dwelling herbs.
-

Elven Wayhouses – Fresh, Herbal & Light

Elven eateries favor fresh, aesthetically pleasing meals, often enhanced with natural spices and elixirs.

- **Sylvan Salad** – A delicate mix of crisp greens, edible flowers, and sliced nuts, dressed with honey nectar.
- **Moonbloom Tarts** – Delicate pastries filled with spiced fruits and drizzled with flower syrup.
- **Everleaf Soup** – A light broth infused with forest herbs and mushrooms, served with thin, crisp wafers.
- **Mistfruit & Nut Platters** – Sliced exotic fruits and roasted nuts arranged in intricate patterns.

- **Waybread & Wildberry Jam** – Thin, crisp elven wafers paired with sweet and tart berry preserves.
-

Human Inns – Practical, Filling & Preserved

Human taverns offer warm, simple dishes that cater to weary travelers and farmers alike.

- **Stew of the Day** – A hearty broth with seasonal vegetables, salted meats, and thick-cut potatoes.
 - **Meat & Bread Platter** – A wooden board of sliced smoked meats, fresh bread, and sharp cheeses.
 - **Pickled Plowman's Lunch** – A plate of pickled onions, eggs, hard cheese, and dark rye bread.
 - **Seafarer's Pie** – A flaky crust filled with salted fish, creamy sauce, and herbs.
 - **Rustic Roast** – A slow-cooked joint of meat basted in its own juices, served with root vegetables.
-

Gnomish Eateries – Compact, Clever & Savory-Sweet

Gnomes love inventive, bite-sized meals, often with quirky combinations of flavors.

- **Tinkerer's Tartlets** – Miniature cheese-filled pastries with a surprise mix of spiced nuts and dried fruit.
 - **Cogs & Gravy** – Tiny meat-filled dumplings arranged like gears, served with a thick mushroom sauce.
 - **Spiced Nut Bites** – Sweet and savory roasted nuts pressed into crunchy squares.
 - **Mushroom & Herb Hand Pies** – Flaky, buttery pastries filled with sautéed mushrooms, garlic, and cream.
 - **Clockwork Cakes** – Small, honey-drizzled oat cakes infused with cinnamon and clove.
-

Orcish Mead Halls – Heavy, Meat-Centered & Intense

Orc feasting halls provide protein-rich, sustaining meals that encourage strength and endurance.

- **Battle Boar Platter** – Thick slabs of spiced, fire-roasted boar, served with charred root vegetables.
- **Bloodmeat Stew** – A dense stew of marrow-rich broth, root starch, and spicy dried meats.

- **Savage Skewers** – Chunks of grilled meat, tubers, and peppers on thick bone skewers.
 - **Bone Broth Tankard** – A hot, spiced broth served in a carved bone cup, fortified with fermented root.
 - **Warrior's Flatbread** – Thick, chewy bread topped with spicy sausage and fermented vegetables.
-

Halfling Inns – Comforting, Warm & Generous Portions

Halflings treasure home-cooked flavors, filling their inns with warmth and enticing smells.

- **Grandmother's Hotpot** – A slow-cooked stew of tender meats, garden vegetables, and savory herbs.
 - **Hearth-Baked Meat Pies** – Buttery-crusts pies filled with spiced meats, mushrooms, and gravy.
 - **Sweetberry Crumble** – Baked fruit with a honey-oat crumble topping, served with thick cream.
 - **Honeyed Apple Slices** – Caramelized apple rings dusted with cinnamon sugar.
 - **Tea & Biscuit Platter** – A warm pot of tea served with shortbread, oat cakes, and jam.
-

Dragonborn Fire-Pits – Spicy, Charred & Protein-Rich

Dragonborn cuisine focuses on intense spices, fire-grilled meats, and meals that fuel their powerful frames.

- **Flame-Seared Steak** – Thick slabs of spiced meat grilled over an open flame, basted with dragonpeppers.
 - **Smoked Ember Nuts** – Fiery-spiced nuts roasted over coals for a crunchy, smoky snack.
 - **Inferno Fish Skewers** – Spiced fish grilled to crisp perfection and served with fire-roasted vegetables.
 - **Volcanic Stew** – A thick, spicy stew featuring charred root vegetables, game meat, and ember spices.
 - **Crisp Pepper Bread** – A flaky, layered bread infused with crushed fire salts and molten butter.
-

Tiefling Dens – Exotic, Spiced & Mysterious

Tiefling fare embraces bold flavors, smoky undertones, and a mix of sweet and savory.

- **Infernal Spice Roast** – A slow-roasted joint of meat covered in exotic spices and served with dark fruit sauce.
 - **Ashen Flatbread** – Smoky, slightly charred bread infused with clove and star anise.
 - **Darkfruit & Goat Cheese Platter** – Tart, bitter fruits paired with soft, spiced goat cheese.
 - **Smoked Bean & Pepper Stew** – A thick, smoky bean stew with roasted peppers and sharp herbs.
 - **Honeyed Spice Nuts** – A mix of roasted nuts glazed with chili honey and citrus zest.
-

Lizardfolk Marsh Taverns – Raw, Foraged & Nutrient-Dense

Lizardfolk prefer natural, high-energy meals, often favoring raw or sun-dried ingredients.

- **Bogfish Tartare** – Finely chopped raw fish mixed with swamp herbs and citrus.
 - **Crunchy Insect Cakes** – Dense cakes of mashed tubers and roasted insects, lightly seasoned.
 - **Sun-Dried Reptile Strips** – Thin slices of preserved lizard or snake meat, air-dried for a chewy texture.
 - **Gelatinous Swampfruit Bowl** – Thick-skinned fruit cracked open to reveal its nutrient-rich, jelly-like flesh.
 - **Bone-Broth Gourd** – A nutrient-rich, concentrated broth stored in hollowed gourds, served warm or cold.
-

Dwarven Agriculture & Husbandry – *Subterranean Cultivation & Resilient Livestock*

Dwarves rely on underground farming and hardy animals suited to deep mountain life.

Farming & Crops:

- **Deep Mushrooms & Fungi Farms** – Cultivated in vast underground cavern farms, enriched with compost and mineral dust.
- **Rockroot Tubers** – Starchy underground tubers that thrive in rocky soil with little light.
- **Fermenting Hops & Dark Barley** – Hardy grains for brewing stout ales and thick breads.

Animal Husbandry:

- **Mountain Goats & Cave Boars** – Raised in deep caverns, producing rich meat, cheese, and durable leather.
- **Burrowing Poultry (Rockhens)** – Hardy birds adapted to underground living, providing eggs and meat.
- **Magma-Fish Tanks** – Geothermal-warmed pools breed heat-resistant fish, a rare delicacy.

Food Storage & Preservation:

- **Salt Caves** – Natural salt deposits for meat preservation.
 - **Cheese Aging Vaults** – Underground halls dedicated to aging and waxing cheese wheels.
-

Elven Agriculture & Husbandry – *Sustainable, Wild-Grown & Herbal Cultivation*

Elves prioritize harmony with nature, using careful land management and low-impact techniques.

Farming & Crops:

- **Perennial Tree Orchards** – Fruit-bearing trees such as mistfruit, figs, and elderberries.
- **Herbal Terraces** – Tiered gardens growing mint, thyme, moonbloom, and healing herbs.
- **Sylvan Grain Fields** – Wild-growing grains like golden sylvan wheat, harvested without plowing.

Animal Husbandry:

- **Forest Deer & Stags** – Free-range venison herds, occasionally culled for meat and leather.
- **Songbirds & Doves** – Raised for eggs, their feathers used in art and enchantments.
- **Butterfly Apiaries** – Harvesting nectar-rich honey and edible pollen from rare insects.

Food Storage & Preservation:

- **Leaf-Wrapping Techniques** – Fresh foods wrapped in broad leaves to prevent spoilage.
 - **Solar Drying Racks** – Sun-drying fruits and nuts for long-term storage.
-

Human Agriculture & Husbandry – *Mixed-Crop Farming & Livestock Rearing*

Humans rely on crop rotation and varied livestock to maintain food security.

Farming & Crops:

- **Wheat, Rye & Barley Fields** – Rotational grain farming for bread, ale, and animal feed.
- **Root Vegetables & Hardy Greens** – Carrots, cabbage, and potatoes stored through winter.
- **Vineyards & Orchards** – Grapes, apples, and pears grown for wine, cider, and preserves.

Animal Husbandry:

- **Cattle & Sheep Herding** – Producing milk, meat, and wool.
- **Pigs & Chickens** – Efficient meat producers raised in small farms and villages.
- **Fishing & Saltwater Farms** – Harvesting salted fish and shellfish for coastal settlements.

Food Storage & Preservation:

- **Smokehouses & Salt Preservation** – Common methods for meats and fish.
 - **Pickling & Fermentation** – Long-term storage of vegetables in brine.
-

Gnomish Agriculture & Husbandry – *Compact, Efficient & Innovative*

Gnomes focus on high-yield, space-efficient farming and preservation methods.

Farming & Crops:

- **Underground Mushroom Greenhouses** – Climate-controlled domes for cultivating edible fungi.
- **Terrace Farming** – Multi-tiered gardens growing root vegetables and herbs.
- **Experimental Hybrid Crops** – Crossbreeding plants for unique flavors and higher yield.

Animal Husbandry:

- **Miniature Livestock** – Small breeds of goats, pigs, and birds optimized for small spaces.
- **Insect Farms** – Raising crickets and beetles for high-protein flour.
- **Tinned Fish Production** – Small fish farms providing canned mushroom-seafood stews.

Food Storage & Preservation:

- **Steam-Powered Canning Factories** – Early industrial food preservation.
 - **Vacuum-Sealed Cheese Storage** – Wax-coating and pressurization for long shelf life.
-

Orcish Agriculture & Husbandry – *Nomadic Herding & Hardy Crops*

Orcs emphasize high-protein, long-lasting foods for survival in harsh conditions.

Farming & Crops:

- **Wild Root Farming** – Tubers and yams grown in scattered fields.
- **Spice Bushes & Fermented Grains** – Hardy, fiery plants used for flavor and preservation.
- **Bloodgrain Fields** – A rare, high-protein grain cultivated in volcanic soil.

Animal Husbandry:

- **Bison & Warboars** – Raised for meat, leather, and bone tools.
- **Giant Insects** – Used for meat, oils, and durable chitin armor.
- **Carrion Birds** – Scavengers trained to clean bones for broth.

Food Storage & Preservation:

- **Clay-Sealed Meat Barrels** – Long-term preservation through clay-smoking.
 - **Bone-Broth Fermentation** – Concentrated protein drinks.
-

Halfling Agriculture & Husbandry – *Homey, Pastoral & Small-Scale Farming*

Halflings farm for abundance and comfort, ensuring flavorful, sustainable foods.

Farming & Crops:

- **Rolling Wheat & Oat Fields** – Growing grains for bread, biscuits, and ale.
- **Fruit Orchards & Berry Patches** – Apples, pears, blackberries, and plums.
- **Honeybee Farms** – Large-scale honey production for sweets and preserves.

Animal Husbandry:

- **Pasture-Raised Livestock** – Small-scale cattle, sheep, and fowl for fresh dairy and meat.
- **Hearth-Hens** – Plump, slow-growing chickens prized for their rich flavor.
- **Rabbit Warrens** – Domesticated rabbit farms providing meat and fur.

Food Storage & Preservation:

- **Root Cellars & Butter Churns** – Keeping dairy and produce fresh.
 - **Jam & Pie Preserves** – Bottling fruits for winter feasts.
-

Dragonborn Agriculture & Husbandry – *Fiery, Tough & Spiced Crops*

Dragonborn lands cultivate heat-resistant foods that match their intense diet.

Farming & Crops:

- **Fire Peppers & Spice Herbs** – Extremely hot peppers grown in volcanic soil.
- **Charred Nuts & Tough Grains** – Protein-rich plants adapted to dry heat.
- **Scorch-Resistant Root Vegetables** – Tubers that thrive in ash-laden lands.

Animal Husbandry:

- **Lavafish Farms** – High-temperature aquatic creatures bred in volcanic lakes.
- **Drake Poultry** – Large, reptilian birds that provide rich meat.
- **Flame-Sheep** – Hardy sheep with thick wool, raised in warm climates.

Food Storage & Preservation:

- **Fire-Cured Meat Processing** – Heavy spice curing for long-term storage.
- **Stone-Oven Smoking Racks** – Slow-roasting meats over volcanic stones.

Water in the Skies of Kaysender

In the world of Kaysender, obtaining water is a constant and critical challenge, especially for those who traverse its vast skies. The world's aerial landscape is dotted with floating islands, skyships, and open airspaces where access to reliable fresh water is scarce. The difficulty of securing water, essential for survival, heavily influences the lives of air sailors, traders, adventurers, and even entire fleets.

Aerial Geography and Lack of Natural Water Sources

While the lands below may have rivers, lakes, and oceans, the sky itself is largely devoid of these crucial natural resources. Floating islands, though abundant, are often arid or sparsely vegetated, lacking the necessary conditions to support large bodies of water. Waterfalls or streams that might exist on some of these islands are rare and often hard to find, especially as they may be located deep within the jungle canopies or the interior of craggy mountain ranges.

For those flying in the open skies between islands, the vast expanse of clouds offers little help, and any rain that does fall is often unpredictable and brief. Thus, water is not something that can be easily gathered from nature while soaring high above the ground.

Challenges of Harvesting Water

While some skyships are equipped with rain-catching apparatus, these mechanisms are prone to inefficiency. A skyship may sail through a passing rainstorm and collect water, but this depends on being in the right place at the right time. The water collected is often insufficient to last long, especially considering the size of the crew and their need for hydration over extended journeys. Furthermore, storms in the skies are dangerous, and they may not always provide the pure, clean water that travelers require—leading to the risk of contamination or spoilage.

Another method involves gathering water from the clouds themselves. Some cultures have developed techniques for gathering "cloud dew," which is formed when moisture condenses on from cloud layers. However, this process is time-consuming and requires specialized tools or magic, making it unreliable for consistent water acquisition Unless already prepared.

Water Storage and Transportation

Given the scarcity and difficulty of acquiring water in the sky, air sailors and travelers rely heavily on magical and mundane methods to store and transport water. Traditional containers like casks, kegs, and barrels are used, but the sheer size and weight of these containers make them difficult to carry on long journeys. This leads many to develop magical storage options, such as enchanted flasks and waterskins, which hold large amounts of water in a compact, lightweight form. These magical items are highly prized but not always affordable for every traveler or crew.

The demand for such enchanted water storage has given rise to trade routes dedicated specifically to water supply. Merchant fleets, like *The Whisper Web* or *The Skyweaver Consortium*, often specialize in transporting and trading precious water supplies, charging exorbitant fees due to the scarcity of the resource.

Cultural and Economic Implications

In regions where water is particularly scarce, certain islands or floating cities have built their economies around water collection and distribution. Water may be traded as a luxury commodity, where certain islands that have access to freshwater sources sell it to those who cannot access it. The importance of water as both a necessity and a resource drives much of the political landscape in Kaysender, with rival factions often vying for control of key freshwater sources.

For adventurers and travelers, the constant need to plan for water acquisition adds an extra layer of complexity to any journey. Whether relying on a magical water supply, carefully rationing mundane water containers, or hoping for a stroke of luck with a rare rainfall, the challenge of obtaining water is one that shapes both daily life and larger geopolitical dynamics in the skies above Kaysender.

Mundane

Cask of Water (10 gp)

A small, sturdy cask that holds enough water to sustain a single person for approximately 3 days. Made of oak and tightly sealed to prevent leaks, this cask is ideal for individuals or small groups in need of portable hydration.

Mechanics:

Holds 3 gallons of water.

Sufficient for one person for 3 days.

Easily carried by one person but not ideal for extended use.

Keg of Water (30 gp)

A medium-sized keg, larger than a cask but still portable for small groups. The keg holds enough water for a few travelers, ensuring hydration for up to 1 week. Made from durable wood and tightly bound with metal bands, it's perfect for a short journey or a small crew.

Mechanics:

Holds 10 gallons of water.

Sufficient for a group of up to 4 people for 7 days.

Can be carried by two people or loaded onto a cart or wagon for easy transport.

Barrel of Water (50 gp)

A large, heavy barrel designed to hold a significant amount of water. This barrel is made for long trips or larger groups, providing enough water for a crew of four for two weeks. With reinforced metal hoops and a strong wooden body, it's designed for the rigors of extended travel or sea voyages.

Mechanics:

Holds 40 gallons of water.

Sufficient for a crew of 4 for 14 days.

Requires 2-3 people to carry or must be transported via wagon or ship.

The barrel can be tapped for easy access to water.

Magical

Arcane Flask of Water (150 gp)

Wondrous Item

This sleek, compact flask appears as a simple leather-bound container, but it holds an enchantment of remarkable power. It has the capacity of a barrel but can easily fit into a backpack. The flask needs refilling and always provides fresh, clean water with a simple twist of its cap.

Mechanics:

- **Capacity:** Holds 40 gallons of water, the same as a standard barrel.
 - **Magical Properties:** The flask provides enough water to sustain up to 4 people for 14 days.
 - **Activation:** You can draw 1 gallon of water per action. The flask will refill automatically after 24 hours.
 - **Weight:** Only weighs 5 pounds, despite holding the same amount of water as a barrel.
-

Feyborne Waterskin (100 gp)

Wondrous Item

Crafted by fey artisans, this radiant waterskin appears to be no larger than an ordinary canteen, yet it magically expands to contain vast amounts of water. Its delicate, shimmering fabric and embroidered design glow faintly with natural energy.

Mechanics:

- **Capacity:** Holds 10 gallons of water, the same as a keg.
 - **Magical Properties:** The waterskin provides enough water to sustain 4 people for 7 days.
 - **Activation:** You can draw 1 gallon of water per action.
 - **Weight:** Only weighs 2 pounds, despite holding the same amount of water as a keg
-

Adventuring gear

Warm Weather Gear (25 gp)

Common adventuring gear

This lightweight outfit is designed for air sailors navigating scorching skies and sun-drenched routes. It includes breathable fabrics, a wide-brimmed hat or shaded goggles, and enchanted cooling wraps.

Mechanics: While wearing this gear, you have advantage on Constitution saving throws to resist exhaustion caused by extreme heat (DMG, p. 110). Additionally, you reduce water consumption by half when traveling in hot climates.

Cold Weather Gear (25 gp)

Common adventuring gear

This insulated outfit is designed for air sailors braving icy altitudes and frigid winds. It includes a thick coat, fur-lined gloves, thermal boots, and an enchanted warming layer.

Mechanics: While wearing this gear, you have advantage on Constitution saving throws to resist exhaustion caused by extreme cold (DMG, p. 110). Additionally, you reduce the effects of wind chill and can endure temperatures as low as -50°F without additional protection.

Stormproof Gear (30 gp)

Common adventuring gear

Designed for air sailors navigating violent tempests and torrential downpours, this outfit includes a reinforced waterproof cloak, non-slip boots, insulated gloves, and a hooded mask to shield against wind and rain. Some sets feature minor enchantments to repel moisture and static buildup.

Mechanics: While wearing this gear, you have advantage on Strength (Athletics) and Dexterity (Acrobatics) checks to maintain footing in strong winds and slippery conditions. Additionally, you have advantage on Constitution saving throws to resist exhaustion from prolonged exposure to stormy weather.

Armored Air Sailor Gear (75 gp)

Common adventuring gear (light armor)

This reinforced outfit is designed for air sailors who expect combat in the skies. It consists of a padded flight jacket with embedded metal plates, lightweight bracers, reinforced gloves, and a reinforced harness for mobility in aerial skirmishes.

Mechanics:

- Counts as **studded leather armor** (AC 12 + Dex mod).
- Grants advantage on Strength (Athletics) checks to brace against strong winds or impact from sudden movements.
- Reduces falling damage by 5 (as long as the wearer is conscious).

Skyguard Battle Gear (150 gp)

Common adventuring gear (medium armor)

Heavier than standard air sailor gear, this set includes a reinforced coat lined with chain mesh, wind-resistant plating, a sturdy helmet with retractable eye protection, and reinforced boots with climbing grips.

Mechanics:

- Counts as **half plate armor** (AC 15 + Dex mod, max 2).
- Grants resistance to non-magical bludgeoning damage from falling or being thrown into surfaces due to high winds.
- Grants advantage on saving throws against being knocked prone by storm winds or sudden turbulence.

Raider's Skirmish Gear (60 gp)

Common adventuring gear (light armor)

Designed for hit-and-run attacks, this lightweight outfit is made of flexible leather with reinforced stitching, a face-concealing scarf, climbing gloves, and strapped-on throwing dagger holsters.

Mechanics:

- Counts as **leather armor** (AC 11 + Dex mod).
- Grants advantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks in dim light or foggy conditions.
- When rolling initiative, the wearer can move 10 feet as a reaction.

Storm Raider Assault Gear (120 gp)

Common adventuring gear (medium armor)

A brutal outfit for high-speed boarding actions, this set includes a reinforced chest guard, clawed gauntlets, a spiked belt for grappling, and a hooked grappling anchor for quick ship-to-ship movement.

Mechanics:

- Counts as **breastplate armor** (AC 14 + Dex mod, max 2).
 - Grants advantage on Strength (Athletics) checks to grapple or climb.
 - Once per short rest, when leaping onto an enemy ship, you can take the Dash action as a bonus action.
-

Kaysender classes

1. Airship Engineer Class

The **Airship Engineer** is a master of mechanical innovation and craftsmanship, focusing on enhancing, repairing, and creating advanced devices and technologies. **Airship Engineer** can specialize in crafting gadgets, improving airships, or deploying combat-effective tools like turrets

and traps. They are vital to any crew, keeping airships in optimal condition and providing support with tactical devices and repairs. Engineers excel at turning the tide of battle through innovation, whether it's by reinforcing ships, enhancing weapons, or setting traps to outwit opponents.

- **Core Focus:** Crafting, enhancing, and repairing devices, airships, and weapons.
 - **Playstyle:** Tactical support, combat innovation, ship enhancement, and trapmaking.
 - **Archetypes:** **Ship Engineer** (ship repair and enhancement), **Sky Machine Engineer** (combat gadgets and mechanical defenses), **Tinker Engineer** (crafting and setting traps).
-

2. Captain Class

The **Captain** is a natural leader, commanding airships and their crews with authority and tactical brilliance. Captains are charismatic leaders who excel in guiding their crews through dangerous skies, utilizing strategic maneuvers, and inspiring their allies. Whether they are seasoned battle commanders or skilled explorers, Captains play an essential role in navigating the skies and ensuring the success of their missions. Their leadership can boost morale, enhance combat effectiveness, and even dictate the outcome of critical decisions in both combat and exploration.

- **Core Focus:** Leadership, tactical combat, exploration, and ship management.
 - **Playstyle:** Leadership, boosting crew and allies, tactical combat decisions, and airship navigation.
 - **Archetypes:** **Sky Warlord** (battlefield command and strategy), **Explorer Captain** (navigation and exploration), **Shipwright Captain** (crafting and ship enhancements).
-

3. Skywarden Class

The **Skywarden** is a divine protector, focusing on safeguarding their allies from the dangers of the skies, particularly from falling into the abyss. With a strong connection to the divine, they use their healing and protective abilities to ensure the safety of their crew while in the perilous skies. Skywardens are not just healers but also guardians, able to provide defensive support, bolster morale, and shield their allies from harm. Their unique ability to prevent falls and protect against aerial threats makes them invaluable in the dangerous world above the clouds.

- **Core Focus:** Healing, protection, and defensive abilities against falling and other aerial dangers.
- **Playstyle:** Healing, defensive support, and fall prevention.
- **Archetypes:** **Sky Warden** (fall protection and divine healing).

Summary of Synergy

- **Engineer:** Innovators and crafters, enhancing combat capabilities and ensuring airship survival.
- **Captain:** Leaders and tacticians, guiding their crews and making pivotal decisions in combat and exploration.
- **Skywarden:** Protectors and healers, ensuring the safety of their allies, especially from falls and aerial dangers.

Each class brings something crucial to the table, whether it's through innovation, leadership, or divine protection, and they work together to overcome the challenges of navigating the dangerous skies.

Airship engineer

Airship Engineer Class Progression (Levels 1–5)

Hit Points

- **Hit Dice:** 1d8 per Airship Engineer level.
- **Hit Points at 1st Level:** 8 + your Constitution modifier.
- **Hit Points at Higher Levels:** 1d8 (or 5) + your Constitution modifier per Airship Engineer level.

Proficiencies

- **Armor:** Light armor.
- **Weapons:** Simple weapons, one martial weapon of your choice (typically a tool-like weapon, e.g., wrench, spanner).
- **Tools:** Tinker's tools, smith's tools, and navigator's tools.
- **Saving Throws:** Intelligence, Dexterity.
- **Skills:** Choose three from Arcana, History, Insight, Investigation, Perception, and Sleight of Hand.

Class Features

Level 1: Tinker's Expertise

- **Airship Specialist:** You can identify the function and current condition of airship components with a successful Intelligence (Investigation) check.
- **Tool Savant:** You gain expertise in one type of artisan's tools of your choice (doubles your proficiency bonus).
- **Improvised Engineer:** When using tools to create, repair, or modify a mechanical device, you can do so in half the time it would normally take.

Level 2: Engineer's Ingenuity

- **Gadgeteer:** You can construct a number of simple gadgets equal to your Intelligence modifier. Gadgets require 1 hour to assemble and last 24 hours or until used. Examples include:
 - **Emergency Grappling Hook:** Grants a climbing speed of 15 feet for 5 rounds.
 - **Repair Drone:** Restores 1d6 hit points to an object or construct.
 - **Smoke Bomb:** Creates a 10-foot-radius sphere of smoke that heavily obscures the area for 5 rounds.

Level 3: Engineering Archetype

Choose an archetype that reflects your specialty:

- **Skywright:** Focuses on enhancing airships and flying constructs.
- **Gadgeteer Savant:** Masters advanced, personal-use gadgets.
- **Artillerist:** Specializes in mounted weaponry and ship defenses.

Base Archetype Feature (Skywright):

Efficient Design: You can increase an airship's speed by 10 feet or reduce fuel consumption by 20%. Can only be applied once per airship.

Level 4: Ability Score Improvement

Increase one ability score by 2, or two ability scores by 1 each. Alternatively, take a feat.

Level 5: Master Engineer

- **Revolutionary Design:** You can create a **Prototype Device**, a powerful invention that has limited uses before requiring repairs. Example prototypes include:
 - **Magnetic Repulsion Field:** Grants a +2 AC bonus to all allies within 10 feet for 5 rounds.
 - **Burst Booster:** Temporarily increases an airship's speed by 60 feet for 5 rounds.
 - **Static Discharge Array:** Releases a shockwave dealing 3d8 lightning damage in a 15-foot radius (Dex save halves).

Class Table: Airship Engineer (Levels 1–5)

Level	Proficiency Bonus	Features	Gadgets	Prototype Slots
1	+2	Tinker's Expertise	—	—
2	+2	Engineer's Ingenuity	2	—
3	+2	Engineering Archetype	3	—
4	+2	Ability Score Improvement	3	—
5	+3	Master Engineer	4	1

Engineer Archetypes: Level 1–5 Abilities

1. Ship Engineer (Ship Repair and Enhancement Focus)

Level 1: Hull Fortification

- **Ship Enhancement:** As an action, you can strengthen a part of an airship's hull, increasing its AC by +2 for 1 hour. This ability can be used once per long rest.
- **Quick Repairs:** You can spend 10 minutes repairing a ship or vehicle, restoring hit points equal to your Engineer level (maximum of 5 hit points). This can be used once per short or long rest.

Level 2: Machine Mastery

- **Arcane Tools:** You gain proficiency with artisan tools related to airship or mechanical systems, such as tinker's tools, smith's tools, or carpenter's tools.
- **Engine Overdrive:** Once per long rest, you can activate an airship's engines to increase its speed by 30 feet for 5 rounds. The ship gains advantage on any saving throws related to speed or maneuvering during this time.

Level 3: Structural Reinforcement

- **Hull Integrity:** As a bonus action, you can reinforce a damaged section of a ship's hull. The reinforced area gains resistance to damage for 5 rounds. This can be used a number of times per long rest equal to your proficiency bonus.
- **Repair Crew:** When you use your *Quick Repairs* ability, you can extend the effect to up to three allies, each restoring an additional 1d6 hit points to a ship or vehicle within 30 feet.

Level 4: Ability Score Improvement

- Increase one ability score by 2, or two ability scores by 1 each. Alternatively, take a feat.

Level 5: Master of Engines

- **Advanced Overdrive:** You can use your *Engine Overdrive* ability to grant the ship an additional benefit: the ship gains advantage on all ability checks and saving throws related to maneuvers and evasions during the overdrive.
- **Shipwright's Touch:** As a bonus action, you can repair the ship's vital systems with your tools, healing an additional 1d8 hit points to a ship or vehicle. This can be used once per long rest.

2. Sky Machine Engineer (Mechanical Combat and Gadgetry Focus)

Level 1: Gadgeteer's Craft

- **Mechanical Tools:** You gain proficiency with tinker's tools and one additional type of artisan tools related to mechanical devices (e.g., smith's tools, carpentry tools).
- **Deployable Turret:** As an action, you can create a small mechanical turret or automated defense mechanism. This turret lasts for 5 rounds and provides cover for allies, granting +2 AC to any ally within 5 feet of it.

Level 2: Enhanced Weaponry

- **Gadget Enhancement:** You can modify a weapon, airship system, or tool to add an elemental effect (such as fire, lightning, or cold). This modification lasts for 1 hour and applies to one attack per round, adding an additional 1d6 elemental damage to the attack.
- **Quick Rebuild:** As an action, you can repair or rebuild a damaged weapon or piece of equipment within 60 feet, restoring it to full functionality and preventing it from breaking for the next 24 hours.

Level 3: Constructed Defenses

- **Automated Defenders:** You can deploy a set of mechanical defenses (e.g., a turret, clockwork sentries) that provide protection to allies. Once per long rest, you can create a set of 3 mechanical defenders that last for 1 hour. Each defender can make an attack against enemies within range (melee or ranged, depending on the type of defender).
- **Mechanical Shielding:** As an action, you can activate mechanical shielding on an ally within 30 feet. The ally gains temporary hit points equal to your Engineer level (minimum of 5), which lasts for 5 rounds.

Level 4: Ability Score Improvement

- Increase one ability score by 2, or two ability scores by 1 each. Alternatively, take a feat.

Level 5: Overclocking

- **Mechanical Overdrive:** You can enhance one of your created devices, weapons, or gadgets, increasing its effect. For the next 5 rounds, any device or gadget you've created has its damage output or effect range doubled.
 - **Clever Modifications:** You can use your *Gadget Enhancement* ability to add an additional effect to your weapon or airship device, such as granting an additional effect (stunning, knocking prone, or blinding) on a successful attack.
-

3. Tinker Engineer (Innovative Crafting and Traps Focus)

Level 1: Crafting Expertise

- **Innovative Tools:** You gain proficiency with tinker's tools and one other type of artisan tools (e.g., blacksmith's tools, alchemist's supplies).
- **Trapmaking:** As an action, you can create and set a simple mechanical trap within 5 minutes. The trap can deal 1d8 damage (depending on the type of trap—poison, fire, or bludgeoning) to any creature that triggers it. The trap lasts for 1 hour.

Level 2: Quick Construction

- **Rapid Repair:** Once per short rest, you can use your tools to repair or modify a piece of equipment or a damaged airship component, restoring it to full functionality or granting it a temporary bonus (+1 AC, advantage on ability checks) for 1 hour.
- **Utility Gadgets:** You can create small gadgets such as smoke bombs, grappling hooks, or repair kits. These gadgets are useful for enhancing combat tactics or exploration.

Level 3: Advanced Traps

- **Explosive Traps:** You can create and set an explosive trap, dealing 3d6 damage (based on the trap's type) to any creature within 5 feet of it when triggered. The trap lasts for 1 hour or until triggered.
- **Trap Mastery:** You can now craft and set traps with added effects such as blinding or ensnaring. Traps deal 2d8 damage and have an additional effect (e.g., blindness, speed reduction, or entanglement) for 5 rounds.

Level 4: Ability Score Improvement

- Increase one ability score by 2, or two ability scores by 1 each. Alternatively, take a feat.

Level 5: Master Tinker

- **Masterful Creations:** You can create an advanced gadget or piece of equipment that grants an additional benefit to you or your allies (e.g., a mechanical companion, enhanced traps, or a floating device for easy traversal). These creations can last up to 1 hour, and you can only have one active at a time.

Archetype Summary Table

Level	Ship Engineer	Sky Machine Engineer	Tinker Engineer
1			
1	Hull Fortification, Quick Repairs	Gadgeteer's Craft, Deployable Turret	Crafting Expertise, Trapmaking
2	Machine Mastery, Engine Overdrive	Enhanced Weaponry, Quick Rebuild	Quick Construction, Utility Gadgets
3	Structural Reinforcement, Repair Crew	Constructed Defenses, Mechanical Shielding	Advanced Traps, Trap Mastery
4	Ability Score Improvement	Ability Score Improvement	Ability Score Improvement

Class Synergy

These archetypes emphasize different aspects of engineering, from ship enhancement and repair to creating mechanical devices and traps. Whether you're focused on fixing and improving airships with the **Ship Engineer**, enhancing weapons and gadgets with the **Sky Machine Engineer**, or crafting tactical tools and traps with the **Tinker Engineer**, each archetype offers unique abilities for strategic combat, exploration, and ship management.

Would you like to refine any abilities, adjust any features, or expand on how these archetypes work in synergy with other classes?

GADGETS

Below is the chart of gadgets that can serve as versatile tools for the Airship Engineer class. These gadgets are modular and can be used to:

- 1. **Enhance airships** (ship systems).
- 2. **Create weapons** for personal combat.
- 3. **Improve armor** for defensive purposes.

Airship Engineer Gadget Chart

Gadget Name	Description	Ship System	Weapon Enhancement	Armor Enhancement
Static Discharge Array	Converts energy into a powerful electric shock.	Lightning cannon: Deals 3d6 lightning damage (DC 13 Dex save	Shock weapon: Adds 1d6 lightning damage to weapon attacks.	Shock field: Attackers take 1 lightning damage per hit.

		for half) in a 60 ft. line.		
Reinforced Hull Plating	Strengthens physical defenses with durable materials.	+2 to ship's AC.	N/A	+1 to wearer's AC.
Grappling Winch	A deployable, retractable cable with a grappling hook.	Can grapple objects or terrain within 120 ft., aiding navigation or towing.	Launchable hook: Grapples enemies or objects within 60 ft. (Strength DC 15 to resist).	Can anchor wearer to avoid forced movement.
Smoke Dispersal System	Releases a cloud of obscuring smoke for concealment.	Creates a 30-ft. sphere of smoke around the ship, heavily obscuring the area for 5 rounds.	Smoke bomb: Creates a 10-ft. radius obscured area for 5 rounds.	Smoke veil: Disadvantage on ranged attacks against the wearer.
Burst Booster	Temporarily increases speed using an energy surge.	+60 ft. speed for 1 round (limited uses).	N/A	Dash action costs no movement.
Kinetic Stabilizer	Absorbs kinetic energy to reduce impacts or falls.	Reduces damage to the ship from collisions by 50%.	Impact resistance: Grants resistance to bludgeoning damage for 5 rounds.	Reduces fall damage by half.
Flame Vents	A defensive countermeasure that releases a burst of fire.	Flamethrower: 15 ft. cone, 3d6 fire damage (DC 13 Dex save for half).	Fire burst: Adds 1d6 fire damage to melee attacks.	Flame aura: Adjacent creatures take 2 fire damage.
Thermal Shielding	Provides protection against extreme heat or cold.	Halves damage from fire or cold effects targeting the ship.	N/A	Resistance to fire and cold damage.

Arcane Dampener	A device that absorbs magical energy.	Grants advantage on saving throws against spells targeting the ship.	Spell dampener: Enemies within 5 ft. have disadvantage on spell attack rolls.	Advantage on saving throws against spells.
Sonic Pulse Generator	Emits a powerful sound wave to disrupt enemies or objects.	Emits a pulse that pushes enemies within 30 ft. back 10 ft. (Strength DC 15).	Adds a sonic blast effect: Pushes enemies back 10 ft. on a hit.	Immune to thunder damage.
Auto-Repair Module	Repairs damage to mechanisms over time.	Repairs 10 hit points to the ship per minute.	N/A	Regains 1 hit point per round up to half max HP.

Usage Notes

- **Crafting Time:** Each gadget takes 1 hour to construct and requires access to tools and materials worth 10–50 gp (depending on gadget complexity).
- **Deployment:** Gadgets can be installed on ships, worn, or wielded as weapons with a bonus action during downtime.
- **Durability:** Gadgets last for 24 hours or until destroyed, whichever comes first.

Would you like to expand this chart with additional gadgets or provide specific crafting mechanics?

AIR CAPTAIN

Air Captain Class Progression (Levels 1–5)

Hit Points

- **Hit Dice:** 1d10 per Air Captain level.
- **Hit Points at 1st Level:** 10 + your Constitution modifier.

- **Hit Points at Higher Levels:** 1d10 (or 6) + your Constitution modifier per Air Captain level.

Proficiencies

- **Armor:** Light armor, medium armor.
 - **Weapons:** Simple weapons, martial weapons.
 - **Tools:** Navigator's tools, cartographer's tools.
 - **Saving Throws:** Charisma, Dexterity.
 - **Skills:** Choose three from Athletics, Insight, Intimidation, Perception, Persuasion, and Survival.
-

Class Features

Level 1: Commanding Presence

- **Tactical Orders:** You can use a bonus action to grant one ally within 60 feet who can hear you the ability to take the Help action as a reaction.
- **Airship Commander:** You gain proficiency with airships and can calculate optimal routes, reducing travel time by 25% (DM's discretion).

Level 2: Leadership

- **Inspiring Command:** As an action, you can inspire up to 6 creatures within 30 feet. Each gains temporary hit points equal to your Charisma modifier + your level.
- **Quick Maneuver:** You can take the Dash action as a bonus action.

Level 3: Command Archetype

Choose a specialization reflecting your command style:

- **Sky Warlord:** Focuses on combat tactics and boosting allies in battle.
- **Explorer Captain:** Excels at navigation and resource acquisition.
- **Shipwright Captain:** Combines tactical acumen with shipbuilding and repairs.

Archetype Feature Example (Sky Warlord):

Battlefield Commander: When an ally within 30 feet hits with an attack, you can use your reaction to grant them an additional 1d8 damage to the attack.

Level 4: Ability Score Improvement

Increase one ability score by 2, or two ability scores by 1 each. Alternatively, take a feat.

Level 5: Master Tactician

- **Legendary Orders:** You can issue powerful tactical commands to your allies. Choose one of the following effects (recharges on a long rest):
 - **All-Out Attack:** All allies within 30 feet gain advantage on their next attack roll.
 - **Evasive Maneuvers:** All allies within 30 feet gain +2 to AC until the start of your next turn.
 - **Push Forward:** All allies can move up to 15 feet as a reaction.

Class Table: Air Captain (Levels 1–5)

Level	Proficiency Bonus	Features	Legendary Orders
1	+2	Commanding Presence	—
2	+2	Leadership	—
3	+2	Command Archetype	—
4	+2	Ability Score Improvement	—
5	+3	Master Tactician	1

Air Captain Gadget Chart

Gadget Name	Description	Ship System	Weapon Enhancement	Armor Enhancement
Signal Booster	Amplifies communication systems for long-range command.	Doubles the range of ship communications.	Signal flare: Marks a target, granting advantage to all ranged attacks.	Grants advantage on Perception checks.
Reinforced Rudder	Enhances the ship’s steering capabilities.	Grants advantage on Dexterity saving throws for the ship.	N/A	N/A

Magnetic Compass	Automatically aligns the ship to its course.	Reduces navigation errors or penalties by 50%.	N/A	Advantage on Survival checks.
Tactical Scope	A precision lens for better targeting.	Increases weapon accuracy: +2 to attack rolls for ship weapons.	Adds +1 to ranged weapon attack rolls.	N/A
Emergency Lifeboat System	Deploys small escape pods for emergencies.	Allows up to 6 creatures to escape a crashing ship safely.	N/A	N/A
Battle Horn	Projects a powerful sound to inspire allies or intimidate enemies.	Allies within 60 feet gain +2 to attack rolls for 5 rounds.	Horn blast: Forces enemies within 15 feet to make a DC 14 Wisdom save or be frightened.	N/A
Plating Reinforcement	Enhances the durability of ship armor.	+2 AC to the ship.	N/A	+1 to wearer's AC.
Targeting Array	A device that calculates optimal firing solutions.	Grants advantage on one ship weapon attack per round.	Adds +1 to ranged weapon attack rolls.	N/A
Maneuver Thrusters	Enhances mobility for sudden movements.	Grants the ship +10 ft. movement speed.	N/A	Advantage on Dexterity saving throws.
Emergency Ballast	A deployable weight system for balancing or stabilizing a ship.	Stabilizes a falling ship, reducing crash damage by 50%.	N/A	Reduces fall damage by half.

Class Synergy

The Air Captain excels in teamwork and tactical advantages, making them invaluable during combat and exploration. They complement the Airship Engineer by maximizing ship performance and leading crews effectively.

Here's a breakdown of the **level 1 through 5 abilities** for the **Sky Captain** archetypes: **Sky Warlord**, **Explorer Captain**, and **Shipwright Captain**. Each archetype offers unique features based on the Captain's style of leadership and the role they play in both tactical combat and managing their airship or crew.

Sky Captain Archetypes: Level 1–5 Abilities

1. Sky Warlord (Battlefield Commander Focus)

Level 1: Battlefield Leadership

- **Tactical Orders:** As a bonus action, you can grant one ally within 60 feet who can hear you the ability to take the **Help** action as a reaction.
- **Combat Focus:** You can choose one combat tactic per long rest, granting you and your allies advantage on attack rolls against creatures of your chosen type (e.g., humanoid, beast, undead) for 5 rounds.

Level 2: Commander's Inspiration

- **Inspiring Presence:** When an ally within 30 feet takes damage, you can use your reaction to grant them temporary hit points equal to your Charisma modifier + your Sky Captain level (minimum 1).
- **Tactical Retreat:** As a bonus action, you can grant one ally within 30 feet a 15-foot movement speed boost or allow them to disengage or hide as a free action.

Level 3: Warborn Strategy

- **Battlefield Commander:** When an ally within 30 feet hits with an attack, you can use your reaction to grant them an additional 1d8 damage to the attack (damage type chosen by you). This can be used once per short or long rest.
- **Strategic Retreat:** As an action, you can allow up to 5 allies within 30 feet to take an immediate disengage or dash action, without provoking opportunity attacks.

Level 4: Ability Score Improvement

- Increase one ability score by 2, or two ability scores by 1 each. Alternatively, take a feat.

Level 5: Commander's Resolve

- **Inspiring Leadership:** You can use an action to inspire a group of allies within 30 feet. Each ally gains temporary hit points equal to your Charisma modifier + your Sky Captain level. These temporary hit points last for 1 hour.
-

2. Explorer Captain (Exploration and Navigation Focus)

Level 1: Skilled Navigator

- **Expert Route Planning:** When navigating your airship, you reduce travel time by 25%, and your ship gains advantage on checks related to navigation, weather forecasting, and finding hidden paths or landmarks.
- **Scout's Insight:** You gain proficiency in Survival checks, and you can grant one ally within 30 feet advantage on Survival checks once per long rest.

Level 2: Uncharted Territory

- **Explorer's Courage:** You can grant yourself or an ally within 30 feet advantage on saving throws against exhaustion or fear effects. This can be used once per long rest.
- **Quick Mapping:** As an action, you can create a detailed map of your surroundings, revealing hidden objects, secret passages, or terrain features, providing you and your allies advantage on Investigation or Perception checks for 1 hour.

Level 3: Adventurer's Lore

- **Cartographer's Eye:** You can recall details of any region you've previously visited, granting you insight into potential hazards or important resources. You gain advantage on checks related to exploration in known territories.
- **Find the Path:** Once per long rest, you can cast **Find the Path** as a 1st-level spell without expending a spell slot.

Level 4: Ability Score Improvement

- Increase one ability score by 2, or two ability scores by 1 each. Alternatively, take a feat.

Level 5: Treasure Seeker

- **Resourceful Search:** As an action, you can search for hidden treasures or resources in your current location. You and up to five allies can each find one useful item, whether it's

a consumable (such as food, rations, or medicine) or valuable material. The DM can determine the rarity based on the environment.

3. Shipwright Captain (Ship Construction and Repair Focus)

Level 1: Master Builder

- **Shipwright's Tools:** You are proficient with artisan tools related to ship construction and repair. You can repair damaged airships, machinery, and vehicles, restoring a portion of their durability each long rest.
- **Mechanical Insight:** As an action, you can inspect the mechanics of a ship or device to find weaknesses. You can use your Wisdom modifier to find a vulnerable spot, granting your allies advantage on attack rolls against that target.

Level 2: Reinforced Hull

- **Ship Reinforcement:** You can use your action to grant an airship or vehicle within 30 feet +2 AC for 5 rounds. This effect can be used a number of times equal to your Wisdom modifier per long rest.
- **Shipwright's Repair:** As an action, you can begin repairing a damaged ship or vehicle, restoring 1d8 hit points per use. You can perform this repair during combat or in downtime.

Level 3: Precision Construction

- **Engineering Expertise:** You can craft one small mechanical device (such as a trap, a lock mechanism, or a device for your airship) in 1 hour, which functions as long as it is treated with care. These devices can grant advantages, disable enemies, or provide temporary utility during exploration.
- **Quick Fix:** You can perform emergency repairs on your airship or ship-related systems, restoring up to 1d10 hit points with a short rest. This can be used once per long rest.

Level 4: Ability Score Improvement

- Increase one ability score by 2, or two ability scores by 1 each. Alternatively, take a feat.

Level 5: Master Craftsman

- **Legendary Build:** Once per long rest, you can craft or improve one piece of equipment, enhancing its capabilities. This can include a weapon, armor, or mechanical device (e.g.,

an upgrade for a ship's engines or weaponry). The upgrade should add +1 to attack rolls, AC, or other mechanics based on the item crafted.

Archetype Summary Table

Level	Sky Warlord	Explorer Captain	Shipwright Captain
1			
1	Tactical Orders, Combat Focus	Skilled Navigator, Scout's Insight	Master Builder, Mechanical Insight
2	Commander's Inspiration, Tactical Retreat	Uncharted Territory, Quick Mapping	Reinforced Hull, Shipwright's Repair
3	Battlefield Commander, Strategic Retreat	Adventurer's Lore, Find the Path	Engineering Expertise, Quick Fix
4	Ability Score Improvement	Ability Score Improvement	Ability Score Improvement
5	Commander's Resolve	Treasure Seeker	Master Craftsman

Class Synergy

These archetypes provide **Sky Captains** with abilities that enhance their leadership, tactical prowess, and versatility in combat and exploration. Each archetype has a different flavor, from direct combat leadership with the **Sky Warlord**, to enhancing exploration and navigation with the **Explorer Captain**, to crafting and repairing with the **Shipwright Captain**.

Would you like to modify any abilities, expand on the archetypes, or refine the synergy with other character types?

Sky Warden Class Progression (Levels 1–5)

Hit Points

- **Hit Dice:** 1d8 per Sky Warden level.
- **Hit Points at 1st Level:** 8 + your Constitution modifier.
- **Hit Points at Higher Levels:** 1d8 (or 5) + your Constitution modifier per Sky Warden level.

Proficiencies

- **Armor:** Light armor, medium armor, shields.
 - **Weapons:** Simple weapons.
 - **Tools:** None.
 - **Saving Throws:** Wisdom, Constitution.
 - **Skills:** Choose two from Arcana, Insight, Medicine, Perception, Religion, and Survival.
-

Class Features

Level 1: Ward of the Sky

- **Abyssal Anchor:** When a creature within 30 feet of you falls or is pushed off a surface, you can use your reaction to cast **feather fall** without expending a spell slot. You can do this a number of times equal to your Wisdom modifier (minimum 1), regaining all uses after a long rest.
- **Sky's Blessing:** You and your allies within 10 feet reduce fall damage by half.

Level 2: Divine Channeling

- **Channel Skyward Energy:** You gain the ability to channel divine energy to protect or heal:
 - **Healing Updraft:** As an action, restore 10 hit points divided among creatures within 30 feet, Or moves the friendly targeted creature 15 feet up and holding them there in the air for one round.
 - **Repelling Gust:** Force enemies within 15 feet to make a Strength saving throw (DC = 8 + your proficiency bonus + your Wisdom modifier) or be pushed 10 feet away from you.

Level 3: Celestial Domain

Choose a domain that reflects your connection to the skies:

- **Zephyr Domain:** Focuses on speed, wind-based abilities, and reducing fall damage.
- **Aether Domain:** Grants magical protections against abyssal threats and enhances healing.
- **Stormcall Domain:** Combines protective abilities with thunder and lightning damage.

Domain Feature Example (Zephyr Domain):

Fleet Footed: Gain a flying speed of 15 feet for 5 rounds as a bonus action (limited uses equal to Wisdom modifier per long rest).

Level 4: Ability Score Improvement

Increase one ability score by 2, or two ability scores by 1 each. Alternatively, take a feat.

Level 5: Skywarden's Grace

- **Aegis of the Sky:** As an action, create a **Protective Dome** in a 10-foot radius around you for 5 rounds. Creatures inside the dome gain the following benefits:
 - Resistance to nonmagical damage.
 - Advantage on saving throws against being pushed or knocked prone.
- **Warden's Flight:** You gain the ability to fly (30 feet) for 5 rounds, once per long rest.

Class Table: Sky Warden (Levels 1–5)

Level	Proficiency Bonus	Features	Channel Divinity Uses	Spell Slots (Cleric Progression)
1	+2	Ward of the Sky	—	2

2	+2	Divine Channeling	1	3
3	+2	Celestial Domain	1	4
4	+2	Ability Score Improvement	2	4
5	+3	Skywarden's Grace	2	6

Sky Warden Gadget Chart

Gadget Name	Description	Ship System	Weapon Enhancement	Armor Enhancement
Feather Glide Harness	A harness that cushions falls with magical energy.	N/A	N/A	Grants resistance to fall damage.
Abyssal Beacon	A magical flare that lights up the darkness of the abyss.	Reveals hidden dangers within a 120-ft radius around the ship.	N/A	Grants darkvision up to 60 feet.
Windcaller's Rod	A staff imbued with wind magic for defense or offense.	N/A	Adds 1d6 thunder damage to weapon attacks.	Disarms enemies on a successful hit (DC 13).
Healing Turbine	A device that generates soothing winds for healing.	Heals 2d6 hit points to the ship's crew in a 20-ft radius.	N/A	Regains 1d4 HP at the start of each turn for 5 rounds.
Repulsion Field Generator	Creates a barrier that pushes objects and creatures away.	Repels enemies within 15 feet of the ship.	Pushes enemies back 10 feet on a successful hit.	Grants immunity to being grappled.
Aetheric Shielding	Protects against abyssal energies.	Reduces damage from abyssal creatures by half.	N/A	Resistance to necrotic damage.

Stormcall Totem	A portable device that summons a thunderstorm.	Creates a storm that deals 3d6 lightning damage to enemies within 20 feet of the ship.	Adds 1d8 lightning damage to melee attacks.	Enemies within 5 feet take 1 lightning damage per turn.
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Class Synergy

The Sky Warden is perfect for safeguarding the party and airship from environmental hazards and combat threats, especially in a high-risk sky-based campaign. Their abilities ensure the crew survives both combat and the dangers of falling into the abyss.

Zephyr Domain (Wind and Speed Focus)

- **Level 1: Windborn Blessing**
 - **Bonus Action:** You and one ally within 30 feet gain a flying speed of 15 feet for 5 rounds. This ability can be used a number of times per long rest equal to your Wisdom modifier (minimum 1).
- **Level 2: Gale Strikes**
 - **Channel Divinity:** You can use your Channel Divinity to empower your strikes with the power of the wind. For 5 rounds, you and your allies within 30 feet of you gain the ability to deal an additional 1d6 thunder damage on melee weapon attacks.
- **Level 3: Zephyr's Embrace**
 - You can use your action to create a wave of wind that grants a 30-foot radius of difficult terrain around you for 5 rounds, reducing movement speed of all creatures (except allies) by half within the area.
- **Level 4: Windwalk**
 - **Bonus Action:** You can cast **Fly** on yourself or an ally within 30 feet without expending a spell slot. This ability recharges after a short or long rest.
- **Level 5: Typhoon's Fury**
 - You can summon a devastating gale that causes the area within 20 feet of you to be covered in violent winds. Each creature in that area must make a Strength saving throw (DC = 8 + your proficiency bonus + your Wisdom modifier) or be knocked prone and pushed 10 feet away. Creatures that succeed on their saving throw only take half the damage.

Aether Domain (Magical Protection and Healing Focus)

- **Level 1: Aetheric Blessing**
 - **Bonus Action:** You can imbue yourself or an ally within 30 feet with the energy of the aether, granting them temporary hit points equal to your Wisdom modifier (minimum 1). These temporary hit points last for 5 rounds.
 - **Level 2: Aether Shield**
 - **Channel Divinity:** You can use your Channel Divinity to create a protective aether shield around you or an ally within 30 feet. The shield grants resistance to all damage for 5 rounds.
 - **Level 3: Celestial Ward**
 - As a reaction, when an ally within 30 feet of you is hit by an attack, you can reduce the damage by an amount equal to your cleric level.
 - **Level 4: Protective Aether**
 - **Bonus Action:** You can use your action to create an invisible barrier around yourself or one willing creature within 30 feet, granting them advantage on saving throws against spells for 5 rounds.
 - **Level 5: Celestial Ascension**
 - As a final defensive measure, once per long rest, you can use your action to become enveloped in celestial aether, gaining immunity to all damage for 5 rounds. While this ability is active, all creatures within 30 feet of you gain resistance to all damage.
-

Stormcall Domain (Thunder and Lightning Focus)

- **Level 1: Thunderous Blessing**
 - **Bonus Action:** You can imbue an ally within 30 feet with storm energy, granting their next attack to deal an additional 1d6 thunder damage.
- **Level 2: Call of the Storm**
 - **Channel Divinity:** You can use your Channel Divinity to call down a bolt of lightning from the storm. Choose one target within 60 feet of you, which must make a Dexterity saving throw (DC = 8 + your proficiency bonus + your Wisdom modifier). On a failed save, the target takes 3d6 lightning damage; half as much on a successful save.
- **Level 3: Thunderclap Aura**

- You emit an aura of thundering energy. Any creature that starts its turn within 10 feet of you takes 1d6 thunder damage. You can activate or deactivate this aura as a bonus action.
- **Level 4: Lightning Stride**
 - **Bonus Action:** You can move up to 30 feet, and during that movement, you deal 2d6 lightning damage to any creature you pass within 5 feet. This movement doesn't provoke opportunity attacks.
- **Level 5: Stormlord's Wrath**
 - Once per long rest, you can call down a mighty storm. For 5 rounds, you and all allies within 30 feet of you gain the ability to deal an additional 1d6 thunder or lightning damage (your choice) with weapon attacks. In addition, any creature that hits you with a melee attack during this time takes 1d8 thunder damage.

Domain Summary Table

Domain	Focus	Primary Abilities
Zephyr Domain	Speed, Wind	Windborn Blessing, Gale Strikes, Zephyr's Embrace, Windwalk, Typhoon's Fury
Aether Domain	Magical Protection	Aetheric Blessing, Aether Shield, Celestial Ward, Protective Aether, Celestial Ascension
Stormcall Domain	Thunder, Lightning	Thunderous Blessing, Call of the Storm, Thunderclap Aura, Lightning Stride, Stormlord's Wrath

Choosing Domain Abilities

These abilities offer a wide range of utility, healing, and protection, and can be chosen based on the campaign's needs or playstyle preferences. Each domain provides both support (healing, protection) and offensive capabilities (thunder/lightning damage, speed), ensuring the **Sky Warden** can protect allies while aiding in combat.

Backgrounds in the World of Kaysender

The unique world of Kaysender offers rich opportunities for characters to develop diverse and vibrant backstories. Each background ties directly into the floating islands, airborne societies, and the eternal struggle for survival. Below are detailed backgrounds tailored to 5th Edition gameplay, offering compelling traits, features, and flavor specific to Kaysender.

Skyfarer

You were born and raised aboard an airship or among a community of skyfarers. You know the skies better than most and are at home in the turbulent winds and unpredictable dangers of Kaysender's floating islands.

- **Skill Proficiencies:** Acrobatics, Perception
- **Tool Proficiencies:** Navigator's tools, Vehicles (airships)
- **Equipment:** A tattered map of your favorite trade route, a weathered sky compass, a sturdy rope harness, and a pouch containing 10 gold pieces.
- **Feature: Eye of the Storm:** You have an uncanny ability to read weather patterns and air currents. You can predict storms, magical anomalies, and other aerial hazards one day in advance when traveling in the skies.

Personality Traits:

- "I have a story for every star and wind current."
- "I never get vertigo, but I distrust anything that keeps my feet planted too long."

Ideal:

- *Freedom.* The open skies are the only true home. (Chaotic)

Bond:

- "The crew of my first ship is like family to me, even if we've gone our separate ways."

Flaw:

- "I get anxious when I'm too far from the skies or a vessel to take me there."

Abyss Watcher

You have spent much of your life near the edges of the Eternal Abyss, guarding settlements from the encroaching dangers that rise from its depths.

- **Skill Proficiencies:** Athletics, Survival
- **Tool Proficiencies:** Artisan's tools (pick one related to fortifications or traps)
- **Equipment:** A sturdy pair of boots, a shard of skystone etched with runes, a hunting trap, and a pouch containing 8 gold pieces.
- **Feature: Abyssal Warning:** Your time near the abyss has honed your instincts. You have advantage on checks to detect creatures, traps, or magical phenomena associated with the abyss.

Personality Traits:

- "I'm always on edge, scanning for dangers that others overlook."
- "I take pride in holding the line, no matter the cost."

Ideal:

- *Duty.* Protecting others from the abyss is my sacred responsibility. (Lawful)

Bond:

- "I lost someone I cared about to the abyss. I'll never let that happen again."

Flaw:

- "I struggle to trust those who've never faced the abyss; they just don't understand."
-

Driftlander

You grew up on a small, drifting island far removed from the crowded mainland or bustling skyports. Isolation has shaped your perspective, and you've learned to survive in self-sufficient ways.

- **Skill Proficiencies:** Nature, Insight
- **Tool Proficiencies:** Herbalism kit, one artisan's tool of your choice
- **Equipment:** A small bag of dried herbs, a carved wooden charm, a sky fishing net, and a pouch containing 5 gold pieces.

- **Feature: Island Resilience:** You are adept at foraging and making do with limited resources. You can always find enough food and water for yourself and up to three others on floating islands, provided the land isn't barren.

Personality Traits:

- "I value simplicity and despise waste."
- "I'm curious about the wider world, though it often overwhelms me."

Ideal:

- *Self-Reliance.* Everyone should be able to fend for themselves. (Neutral)

Bond:

- "My island is my home, and I'll always return to protect it."

Flaw:

- "I struggle to trust technology and magic I didn't grow up with."
-

Guild Artisan (Sky Trade)

You were trained in one of the many guilds that operate in Kaysender, crafting goods or providing services essential to life in the skies.

- **Skill Proficiencies:** Persuasion, Investigation
- **Tool Proficiencies:** One type of artisan's tools, Vehicles (airships or seafaring ships)
- **Equipment:** A set of artisan's tools, a certificate of guild membership, a business ledger, and a pouch containing 15 gold pieces.
- **Feature: Guild Connections:** Your guild affiliation grants you access to guild resources, allies, and safe havens. Other guild members are generally inclined to assist you, provided you don't tarnish the guild's reputation.

Personality Traits:

- "I judge people by the quality of their work."
- "I value efficiency and precision above all else."

Ideal:

- *Ambition.* Hard work and skill will take me to the top. (Neutral)

Bond:

- "My guild is like a second family, and I'd do anything to uphold its honor."

Flaw:

- "I can be ruthless when it comes to competition."
-

Sky Reclaimer

You are a scavenger who explores abandoned ruins, fallen ships, and forgotten islands in search of lost treasures and resources.

- **Skill Proficiencies:** Sleight of Hand, History
- **Tool Proficiencies:** Thieves' tools, Tinker's tools
- **Equipment:** A set of thieves' tools, a small crowbar, a battered journal filled with maps and notes, and a pouch containing 7 gold pieces.
- **Feature: Treasure Hunter's Instinct:** You have an eye for spotting valuable artifacts and components. When exploring ruins or wreckage, you can identify the most valuable items at a glance.

Personality Traits:

- "I'm always looking for the next big find."
- "I have a knack for seeing value in what others discard."

Ideal:

- *Adventure.* There's always something worth risking it all for. (Chaotic)

Bond:

- "I once found something priceless that changed my life, and I'm always searching for its equal."

Flaw:

- "I can't resist taking a risk, even when I know better."

Skybound Noble

You hail from a wealthy family that rules over a prominent island, controls a major trade fleet, or serves as vassals to the Dragon Lords.

- **Skill Proficiencies:** History, Intimidation
- **Tool Proficiencies:** Calligrapher's supplies, Vehicles (airships)
- **Equipment:** A fine cloak bearing your family's crest, a signet ring, a set of calligrapher's tools, and a pouch containing 25 gold pieces.
- **Feature: Noble Influence:** Your noble status grants you access to high society. You can secure an audience with minor Dragon Lords, guild leaders, or other influential figures.

Personality Traits:

- "I act as if I'm destined for greatness, because I am."
- "I strive to lead by example, even when it's difficult."

Ideal:

- *Responsibility.* Noblesse oblige; it's my duty to protect those under my care. (Lawful)

Bond:

- "My family's honor is everything to me, and I'll do whatever it takes to uphold it."

Flaw:

- "I struggle to connect with those of lower status."
-

Guild Apprentice (Current or Past Member)

You were trained as a member of one of Kaysender's many guilds, learning a trade, craft, or skill that shaped your early life. Whether you remain loyal to the guild or have left its ranks, its influence still lingers in your life.

- **Skill Proficiencies:** Arcana, Insight

- **Tool Proficiencies:** One type of artisan's tools or a trade-related kit (e.g., alchemist's supplies or navigator's tools)
- **Equipment:** A set of artisan's tools (matching your proficiency), a guild insignia or token, a ledger or notebook detailing your work, and a pouch containing 10 gold pieces.
- **Feature: Guild Affiliation:** You have access to guild halls or workshops associated with your trade. Other guild members are inclined to assist you in matters related to your craft, provided your actions haven't tarnished the guild's reputation.

Suggested Characteristics:

- **Personality Trait:**
 - "I take immense pride in the quality of my work and expect the same of others."
 - "I always compare myself to my mentors, striving to exceed their expectations."
- **Ideal:**
 - *Mastery.* Perfection is the ultimate goal of any craft. (Neutral)
- **Bond:**
 - "My guild is a second family, and I will always come to their aid if needed."
- **Flaw:**
 - "I can't resist showing off my skills, even when it's not appropriate."

Pirate (Black Fleet or Independent)

The skies are wild, and so were you. As a member of a pirate crew, you plundered airships and evaded authorities. Perhaps you served the Black Fleet, or maybe you were an independent sky raider. Either way, the pirate's life has left its mark.

- **Skill Proficiencies:** Athletics, Deception
- **Tool Proficiencies:** Vehicles (airships), Navigator's tools
- **Equipment:** A weathered tricorne hat or bandana, a trophy from a successful raid (a piece of jewelry, a ship emblem, etc.), a length of sturdy rope, and a pouch containing 8 gold pieces.
- **Feature: Raider's Reputation:** Your name carries weight in certain circles. Among pirates, smugglers, and other unsavory types, you are recognized and may be treated with respect or fear depending on your deeds. You can also find safe harbor among pirate-friendly settlements.

Suggested Characteristics:

- **Personality Trait:**
 - "I love the thrill of danger and the open skies."
 - "I can't resist a good tale of adventure or treasure."

- **Ideal:**
 - *Freedom.* Rules are chains meant to be broken. (Chaotic)
 - **Bond:**
 - "My old crew is still out there, and I'll find my way back to them one day."
 - **Flaw:**
 - "I'm a sucker for treasure, even when it's clearly a trap."
-

Homesteader

You grew up or lived on a remote floating island, surviving through hard work, resourcefulness, and perseverance. Isolation shaped your worldview, and you know the value of self-reliance.

- **Skill Proficiencies:** Survival, Animal Handling
- **Tool Proficiencies:** Herbalism kit, Carpenter's tools or Brewer's tools
- **Equipment:** A sturdy axe or hoe(club), a handmade charm for good fortune, a pouch of seeds or dried herbs, and a pouch containing 5 gold pieces.
- **Feature: Island Survivalist:** You are adept at living off the land, even in harsh or magical environments. You can locate fresh water, forage for food, and identify dangerous flora and fauna on floating islands with ease.

Suggested Characteristics:

- **Personality Trait:**
 - "I take pride in doing things with my own two hands."
 - "I'm slow to trust, but fiercely loyal to those I consider family."
 - **Ideal:**
 - *Independence.* I don't need anyone else to thrive. (Neutral)
 - **Bond:**
 - "I'll do anything to protect the homestead I worked so hard to build."
 - **Flaw:**
 - "I'm stubborn to a fault and hate asking for help."
-

Identification Practices Among Nations and Trade Guilds

In a world where multiple nations and merchant guilds coexist and interact, identification has become an essential practice for ensuring smooth trade, travel, and social interaction. Certain nations and regions require official identification as a matter of routine, particularly when entering port cities, conducting business, or passing through borders. Additionally, various merchant guilds, trades unions, and organizations have also adopted their own systems of personal identification, often functioning as a form of certification that can open doors to business opportunities, legal protections, and other privileges.

Merchant Guilds and Identification Cards

One of the most widespread forms of identification is the Merchant's ID Card, issued by established Merchant Guilds. These guilds have recognized the need to facilitate easier trade and protect their members from exploitation in foreign lands. The process of acquiring such a card typically involves:

Guild Membership: A merchant must first be a member of an established guild, which typically requires an entrance fee or sponsorship. Guilds vary in size, influence, and regional coverage, with some being recognized across multiple countries while others operate locally.

ID Application Process: Once a merchant has gained membership, they can apply for an ID card, which certifies their association with the guild. This card typically includes personal information such as the merchant's name, their business affiliation, and a physical description, as well as a symbol or seal that denotes the guild's signature.

Validity and Acceptance: These Merchant ID Cards are generally accepted by most nations as valid identification. They are especially useful for merchants traveling between regions with different legal systems, as they provide a universally recognized symbol of the merchant's right to trade. The card typically guarantees the merchant safe passage, fair pricing, and the right to conduct business without undue interference from local authorities.

Tracking and Monitoring: Some merchant guilds have sophisticated tracking systems to monitor their members' movements and trade activities. These guilds may require their members

to report major transactions, which helps maintain their credibility and standing within the broader trade network.

Tradesman and Craftsman Identification

While Merchant ID Cards are primarily used by traders, Tradesmen's Identification serves a similar function for those in skilled labor. Trade Guilds or Craftsman Unions have their own systems of identification, which allow their members to be recognized for their skills and training. The types of IDs and certificates issued by these organizations may include:

Craftsman's Certificate: This document affirms that a tradesman has met the required standards set by the guild. It may include details such as the tradesman's specialty (blacksmith, carpenter, alchemist, etc.), years of experience, and the level of expertise achieved.

Tradesman ID Card: Similar to a merchant's card, this is an official document certifying a craftsman's membership in a guild. It may provide access to particular workshops, resources, or specialized markets that are restricted to certified professionals. This card may also guarantee a certain standard of craftsmanship, which can help buyers ensure they are purchasing quality goods or services.

Professional Recognition: Some nations may require proof of craftsmanship for certain types of work. For example, in regions where advanced machinery or delicate magical items are crafted, a tradesman may need to demonstrate that they are certified and have been trained to handle such tasks, providing them with professional recognition and rights in certain communities.

Skills Documentation: Some guilds issue special Skills Certificates, indicating a level of mastery in specific areas. This type of certification is useful when applying for apprenticeships or seeking work in competitive trades where highly skilled labor is in demand.

Citizenry Documentation

In addition to merchant and tradesman ID cards, many nations require citizens or residents to carry official documents proving their status as a lawful member of the nation. These can include:

Citizen's Identification (ID) Cards: These are government-issued documents that prove a person's identity and citizenship status. They often feature a person's name, age, physical description, occupation, and a government-issued seal. In some places, citizens may be required to carry these ID cards at all times.

Certificate of Personhood: Some cultures or legal systems issue a Certificate of Personhood to individuals born within the jurisdiction. This document officially recognizes a person's legal rights and status, allowing them to own property, marry, and engage in certain legal contracts. These certificates are generally required for anyone seeking to engage in formal employment, own land, or acquire financial services.

Residency or Work Permits: In certain cities or regions, especially in nations with strict immigration laws or heavily urbanized trade hubs, travelers or temporary residents may be required to carry Residency Permits or Work Visas. These documents may only be valid for a limited time and must be renewed periodically.

Travel Passports: For citizens wishing to travel beyond their native land, a Travel Passport issued by the government may be required. This document typically includes detailed information on a citizen's national origin and travel history, allowing the holder to cross borders legally.

Special Considerations for Foreign Identification

Recognition of Foreign IDs: Some nations may not honor foreign IDs or require additional authentication from an official embassy or consulate to verify the validity of the ID card. This is especially true when it comes to merchant or tradesman IDs, as some nations have strict laws that favor their own guilds and may not accept guild certifications from foreign territories.

Counterfeit Risk: Due to the importance of identification documents, many governments and guilds have implemented anti-counterfeit measures. These can include watermarks, seals, enchanted markings, or even magical wards to ensure the authenticity of the documents. Some governments even employ magic-using officials who can use spells to detect counterfeit IDs.

Impact of Identification Systems

Ease of Trade: For merchants and tradespeople, having an official ID streamlines their ability to interact with foreign markets, proving their legitimacy and gaining the trust of other traders, guilds, or even governments. This helps reduce the risks of trade disruption or legal complications.

Lawful Entry and Exit: Citizenship documentation often determines the entry and exit privileges of individuals traveling from one nation to another. It helps governments monitor and control immigration and emigration, preventing unwanted individuals from entering their cities or countries.

Regulation of Goods and Services: Many nations use these certifications and identifications to regulate certain industries, such as crafting, magic, and trade. For example, a certified alchemist may be the only person legally allowed to sell certain types of potions in some cities, ensuring that all goods are produced to the correct standards.

Cultural Implications: The types of identification systems adopted by nations and guilds can also reflect cultural values, such as a society's emphasis on personal freedom (where IDs are less required) or a focus on collective responsibility (where IDs are central to accessing resources and services).

ITEMS

Skycompass

Wondrous item, common

This small, hand-sized device is made of a smooth, polished crystal set into a circular brass frame. Within the crystal, faintly glowing flecks of light swirl and align to reflect the celestial movements above. The skycompass always points to the exact position of the sun, moon, or stars, even when hidden by clouds, underground, or during magical obfuscations.

While holding the skycompass, you can determine the current time of day or night and find your approximate cardinal direction. However, it cannot distinguish between planes of existence, so its guidance is only accurate in the Material Plane.

Adventurers and travelers value this tool for its reliability, especially when traditional navigation methods fail. Despite its practical uses, the skycompass is a common sight among sailors, merchants, and explorers who swear by its accuracy.

Tattered Trade Route Map

Wondrous item, uncommon

This weathered parchment shows a once-thriving trade route with faded but legible details. Smudges and notes mark favorite inns and shortcuts.

- **Whispers of the Past:** Spend 10 minutes studying the map to learn the name and brief vision of a major landmark along the route.
- **Traveler's Guidance:** Gain a +2 bonus to Survival checks for navigating the depicted region. The map subtly adjusts to show your location and suggest paths.
- **Hidden Secrets:** Once per long rest, uncover a hidden feature within 1 mile, such as a campsite or treasure cache.

The map carries the scent of old journeys and memories of distant roads.

Etched Skystone

Wondrous item, common

This small, smooth chunk of skystone is a dull gray, faintly shimmering with an otherworldly light. Simple patterns are etched across its surface, depicting constellations, swirling winds, or abstract designs. It feels cool to the touch and hums faintly when held.

Properties:

While carrying the etched skystone, you always know the direction of the nearest open sky.

When tapped against a hard surface, it emits a brief, soft glow, useful for signaling or lighting a small area (10-foot radius) for up to 5 rounds.

Invention system

Below is a system that uses tables for various stages of invention, from conceptualization to trial and error, failure, and eventual success. This system also allows for the development of spells, gadgets, ship parts, and magical items.

1. Conceptualizing the Invention

Before any crafting or enchanting begins, the players need to decide what they are trying to invent. This involves choosing the category and brainstorming the specific goal of the invention.

Invention Type	Category Options	Applicable Skill/Stat/Tools
Magical Items	Armor, Weapon, Trinket, Accessory	Arcana (for identifying magic or crafting)
Gadgets/Devices	Mechanical, Clockwork, Elemental, Arcane	Tinkering (Intelligence), Arcana (Arcane Devices)

Ship Parts	Engine, Hull, Weapons, Navigation	Engineering (Intelligence), Survival (Navigation), Smith's Tools (for weapons)
Spells	Combat, Utility, Enhancement, Curse	Arcana (for spell crafting and identification)
Enchantments	Armor, Weapon, Tool, Vessel	Arcana, Smith's Tools, Carpenter's Tools (for vessel enchantment)

2. Research and Development Phase

Once the invention type is chosen, the next step is research. This phase can involve gathering materials, consulting with

experts, and experimenting with different ideas. Players can roll for this phase to determine whether they have found a viable path.

Research Phase Success Roll

Roll Result

DC 15 or below

Success: You have a clear idea on how to proceed. (+1 to next crafting check)

DC 16-20

Partial Success: You have a vague understanding, but more testing is required. (No modifier)

DC 21+

Failure: No breakthrough. You must try again, possibly with different materials or methods. (-1 to next crafting check)

3. Materials Gathering & Preparation

The materials required for crafting will vary depending on the type of invention, but they should always be tied to the goal. The players may have to make checks to gather the correct resources.

Gathering Material Check

Roll Result

DC 10 or below	Success: Materials are gathered without issue.
DC 11-15	Partial Success: Some materials are harder to obtain, causing delays. (+1 to next crafting check)
DC 16+	Failure: Materials are not found or are of poor quality. (-1 to next crafting check)

4. Crafting or Enchanting Phase

Once materials are obtained, crafting or enchanting begins. This is the most critical stage and involves the most potential for failure. The invention can fail, partially succeed, or be completely successful.

Crafting/Enchanting Check	Roll Result
DC 15	Minor Success: The invention works, but it's flawed in some way (e.g., armor gives less protection, weapon is slightly less effective). (-2 to next check)
DC 16-18	Success: The invention works as intended, achieving your goal. (-1 to next check)
DC 19-20	Great Success: The invention surpasses expectations, giving added benefits. (+1 bonus to next check)
DC 21+	Exceptional Success: The invention is revolutionary, providing a major advantage or unique properties. (+2 bonus to next check)

DC 14 or below Failure: The invention doesn't work at all, possibly causing waste of materials or creating a defective item. (-2 penalty to next two checks)

DC 10 or below Critical Failure: The invention explodes or is catastrophically destroyed. The materials are ruined, and additional damage may occur (fire, injury). (Failure, no progress made)

5. Testing the Invention

Once the invention is crafted or enchanted, testing is necessary to ensure it functions properly. Testing can involve using the item, casting the spell, or installing the ship part into an airship. The testing phase also allows for adjustments and modifications.

Testing Phase Roll

Roll Result

DC 16 or below Minor Issue: There are small problems, but nothing critical. (-1 modifier to next improvement)

DC 17-18 Success: The invention works as expected without any issues.

DC 19-20 Excellent: The invention works perfectly, and you discover a hidden benefit. (+1 modifier to next improvement)

DC 21+ Exceptional: The invention is flawless and exceeds expectations. (+3 modifier to next improvement)

DC 14 or below Failure: The invention doesn't work, revealing significant flaws that need to be addressed. (-2 modifier to next improvement)

DC 10 or below	Major Failure: The invention malfunctions and may cause harm. Materials are ruined, and the invention needs to be scrapped. (-3 modifier to next improvement)
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6. Improving the Invention

After the first invention is complete, players may choose to improve it, either through further research, testing, or modifications. Improvement attempts can be rolled based on the original invention's success level.

Improvement Phase Roll	Roll Result
DC 16 or below	Minor Improvement: The invention gains a Negligible bonus
DC 17-18	Success: The invention is now much better. (+1 to functionality)
DC 19-20	Great Success: The invention has achieved the desired improvements. (+2 to functionality)
DC 21+	Exceptional Success: The invention reaches near-perfect levels. (+3 to functionality)
DC 15 or below	Failure: The improvement does not work, and the item may suffer damage or lose effectiveness. (-2 to functionality)
DC 5 or below	Critical Failure: The invention becomes completely useless or hazardous to use. (-4 to functionality)

7. Potential Modifiers

Several factors can affect the chance of success for invention. These modifiers can be applied during any of the phases, including conceptualizing, crafting, testing, and improving.

Modifier	Effect
Materials Quality	Rare or high-quality materials (+1 to checks)
Research Assistance	Having access to a knowledgeable NPC (+1 to checks)
Magical Assistance	Using magic or arcane tools (+1 to checks)
Special Expertise	Specialized knowledge (e.g., blacksmith, mage) (+1)
Funding	Extra money can buy better materials and time (+1 to checks)
Preparation Time	Adequate time spent increases success (+1 to checks)
Magical Boost	Infusing items with temporary enchantments (+1 to checks)

Failure Consequences and Cost

Failure is an expected part of the invention process and is a crucial part of balancing the system. Meeting a check is considered failure, and failing by more the 2 can have fallout. For example:

- **Minor Failure:** Wastes materials, and the invention is slightly flawed. The next attempt has a slight penalty.

- **Major Failure:** Significant materials are wasted, and the invention is no longer functional. Players must rebuild or start fresh.
 - **Critical Failure:** Catastrophic failure that causes loss of resources and possibly injuries. Inventions may explode or become dangerous.
 - **Repeated Failure:** After multiple failures (2 or more), additional penalties may apply to future rolls unless the player changes their approach or obtains assistance.
-

Mass Combat systems

Mass combat is a grand, sprawling affair that can either involve thousands of soldiers or a smaller, more intimate skirmish with a handful of troops. In a tabletop setting, players can influence the outcome of such a conflict through direct involvement, tactical orders, logistical support, and magical assistance. Below is a comprehensive system for how players can influence mass combat situations.

1. Influence via Direct Involvement

Players can directly engage in combat by participating as individual soldiers, commanders, or specialized agents (e.g., spies, duelists, or magical specialists). Their contributions can either bolster the forces in their army or lead to dramatic shifts in the battle's momentum.

Direct Combat Involvement Rules

When players engage in direct combat, they can perform actions that directly impact enemy units or defend allied forces. This includes melee combat, ranged attacks, spellcasting, sabotage, and other heroic actions.

Action	Effect	DC	Outcome on Mass Combat
Engage in Melee Combat	Deal damage to enemy units (e.g., infantry, cavalry).	Melee Attack Roll + modifiers	Reduces enemy forces by number based on success (e.g., 5 per successful hit).
Engage in Ranged Combat	Attack enemy from a distance (e.g., archery, firearms).	Ranged Attack Roll + modifiers	Reduces enemy forces based on successful hits (e.g., 3 per successful shot).

Spellcasting (Offensive)	Cast destructive spells (e.g., fireball, lightning).	Spellcasting Check + modifiers	Targeted enemy unit suffers damage, reducing their numbers (e.g., 10 per successful spell).
Spellcasting (Defensive)	Buff friendly units (e.g., haste, shield, healing).	Spellcasting Check + modifiers	Increases effectiveness of friendly forces (e.g., +1 morale or +5 HP for an allied unit).
Sabotage	Damage enemy supplies or equipment (e.g., sabotage siege weapons).	Stealth + Dexterity Roll	Reduces enemy's offensive capabilities (e.g., reduces siege weapons' effectiveness).
Dual/Leader Duel	Challenge an enemy leader to a duel.	Special Roll based on class (e.g., Strength/Charisma)	If successful, eliminate key leadership or morale boost for the enemy.
Inspire Troops	Rally friendly forces with a speech or leadership skill.	Charisma + Persuasion Roll	Boosts morale of friendly units, providing bonuses to attacks or defense.

2. Command and Orders

Players may be able to command armies, leading to large-scale tactical changes. Depending on their leadership ability, players can issue orders that have a significant impact on their own side's performance.

Commanding Units

Players can issue general orders to large units or entire regiments. These orders influence the tactics, morale, and strategy of the battle.

Order Type	Effect	DC	Outcome on Mass Combat
Charge	Send units to aggressively attack enemy positions.	Commanding Roll + modifiers	Increases attack power for one round, but makes units vulnerable to counterattacks.

Hold Position	Command units to defend a specific position.	Commanding Roll + modifiers	Reduces enemy effectiveness against defending units (e.g., +2 to AC for a round).
Flank	Order units to move around the enemy and strike from the side.	Commanding Roll + modifiers	Gains advantage on enemy's next defense roll (e.g., forces the enemy to make defense rolls at disadvantage).
Retreat	Command retreat to reorganize.	Commanding Roll + modifiers	Reduces casualties, but may cause loss of territory or positioning.
Fortify	Reinforce defenses, constructing barriers or fortifications.	Commanding Roll + modifiers	Increases defensive stats of a position (e.g., +10 HP, +2 to AC).
Disperse	Spread units thin to increase area coverage.	Commanding Roll + modifiers	Increases the range of coverage but reduces overall strength.
Ambush	Send select units into an ambush position.	Stealth + Commanding Roll	When executed successfully, enemy units suffer surprise attacks with high damage potential.

3. Logistical Support

In addition to direct combat or tactical orders, players can support their army through logistics, ensuring their troops are well-supplied, healthy, and prepared for battle. This includes managing food supplies, reinforcement, medical assistance, and troop organization.

Logistical Support Action	Effect	DC	Outcome on Mass Combat
Provide Supplies	Ensure soldiers have food, water, and other supplies.	Logistics Roll + modifiers	Prevents morale drops and fatigue, +1 to morale or +5 HP per day of supplies provided.
Reinforce Troops	Bring in additional units to the battlefield.	Logistics Roll + modifiers	Increases force strength by a set number of units (e.g., 10 reinforcements).

Medicine/Healing	Aid injured troops and keep casualties low.	Medicine Check + modifiers	Reduces casualties, increases unit longevity. (e.g., 5-10 soldiers saved per day of healing).
Repairs and Maintenance	Fix equipment, weapons, and vehicles.	Mechanics Check + modifiers	Reduces damage to siege weapons, airships, or armor, improving effectiveness.
Rest and Recovery	Rest units to restore energy and morale.	Commanding Roll + modifiers	Restores full stamina, increasing morale (+1 morale, +1 to damage).
Morale Boost (Logistical)	Provide entertainment or inspirational acts for troops.	Performance/Charisma Check	Boosts morale (+1 to rolls for next 24 hours).

4. Magical Assistance

Magical powers, when used strategically, can be a force multiplier on the battlefield. Wizards, clerics, and other spellcasters can influence combat through damage-dealing spells, healing, buffs, debuffs, or battlefield manipulation.

Magical Assistance Action	Effect	DC	Outcome on Mass Combat
Area Damage Spells	Cast spells that target multiple enemies (e.g., Fireball, Lightning Storm).	Spellcasting Roll + modifiers	Reduces enemy forces by a large amount (e.g., 10-20 per successful spell, depending on spell).
Healing Spells	Heal wounded allies or entire units (e.g., Mass Heal, Healing Word).	Spellcasting Roll + modifiers	Restores HP to allied units, possibly saving them from defeat.
Buffing Spells	Cast spells that enhance allies (e.g., Haste, Protection from Evil).	Spellcasting Roll + modifiers	Increases combat effectiveness (+1 to attack rolls, +1 AC, etc.).

Debuffing Spells	Cast spells that hinder enemies (e.g., Bane, Slow, Fear).	Spellcasting Roll + modifiers	Reduces enemy combat effectiveness (e.g., -1 to attack rolls, -5 HP).
Control Spells	Cast spells to control elements (e.g., Control Weather, Earthquake).	Spellcasting Roll + modifiers	Causes massive environmental changes that affect the battle (e.g., cover fire, fog for concealment, earthquakes).
Summoning	Summon creatures or allies to aid in battle (e.g., Conjure Animals, Summon Elemental).	Spellcasting Roll + modifiers	Summoned creatures fight alongside the army, dealing damage and causing disruption.

5. Resolution and Outcome

After each round of mass combat, the effects of player actions should be factored in to determine the overall outcome. The mass combat can be tracked by measuring the health of each side, their resources, and overall morale.

Combat Tracking

- **Force Strength:** Track the number of active troops on each side, factoring in losses from combat, spells, and sabotage.
- **Morale:** Measure the morale of both sides, adjusting based on victories, defeats, magical assistance, and leadership bonuses.
- **Resources:** Track food, water, and ammunition, which can impact a side's ability to maintain a prolonged fight. Running out of resources can lead to surrender, retreat, or chaos.
- **Weather and Terrain:** Alter the battlefield based on environmental factors or magical influences (e.g., a storm might reduce visibility, or a mountain pass could block reinforcements).

Victory Conditions

Victory in mass combat is determined by the following:

- **Elimination of Enemy Forces:** If one side's units are reduced to zero, they are considered defeated.
- **Capture or Sabotage of Key Targets:** If a side has important targets (e.g., commanders, siege engines, airships), capturing or destroying them can lead to victory.

- **Morale Collapse:** If one side's morale is reduced to zero, they will retreat or surrender.
- **Victory by Objectives:** Some mass combats may have specific objectives (e.g., control of a key location) that can determine the winner.

Airships

Airship Classes: Types and Base Information

1. Jetty (Light Transport and Scout)

Purpose: Small, fast, and agile. Used primarily for reconnaissance, fast transport, or scouting missions, The aerial equivalent of a rowboat with a shack strapped on top.

- **Armor Class (AC):** 12 + Dex modifier (light armor)
 - **Speed:** 120 ft.
 - **Cargo Hold:** 10 cubic feet (light cargo)
 - **Weapons:** None (typically unarmed, though can be modified)
 - **Crew Capacity:** 2–4 (small crew, often solo piloted by one)
 - **Weapons/Defenses:**
 - **Stealth Maneuver:** Advantage on Stealth checks while moving in open skies.
 - **Speed Burst:** Once per long rest, gain a 60 ft. speed boost for 5 rounds.
 - **Customizable Features:** Can be outfitted with small guns or scout equipment like telescopes, advanced navigation tools, or espionage devices.
-

2. Scutter (Small Utility and Combat)

Purpose: Designed for small skirmishes or utility purposes, this ship is highly maneuverable and versatile. Would probably be a small fishing vessel if it wasn't armed.

- **Armor Class (AC):** 13 + Dex modifier (light armor)
- **Speed:** 100 ft.
- **Cargo Hold:** 20 cubic feet (light cargo)
- **Weapons:** Light Cannons (2)
- **Crew Capacity:** 4–6
- **Weapons/Defenses:**

- **Rapid Maneuvers:** Advantage on Dex-based saving throws.
 - **Shielding Nets:** Can deploy nets to hinder enemy movement or protect allies.
 - **Customizable Features:** Can be upgraded with additional cargo space, light turrets, or trap systems.
-

3. Corvette (Small Combat and Defense)

Purpose: A compact, agile warship designed for offensive and defensive roles in fleet engagements.

- **Armor Class (AC):** 15
 - **Speed:** 90 ft.
 - **Cargo Hold:** 30 cubic feet
 - **Weapons:** Light Cannons (4), 2 Anti-Air Ballistas
 - **Crew Capacity:** 6–8
 - **Weapons/Defenses:**
 - **Rapid Fire:** Can use an action to fire all light cannons in a single, rapid salvo, dealing 1d6 per cannon.
 - **Countermeasures:** Can deploy flares or smoke to grant disadvantage to enemy ranged attacks targeting it.
 - **Customizable Features:** Can have extra armor plating or additional combat weaponry like grappling hooks or boarding devices.
-

4. Frigate (Medium Combat and Patrol)

Purpose: A balanced warship designed for fleet patrols and light skirmishes, capable of defending larger ships or attacking smaller vessels.

- **Armor Class (AC):** 16
- **Speed:** 80 ft.
- **Cargo Hold:** 50 cubic feet
- **Weapons:** Medium Cannons (6), Anti-Air Guns (2)
- **Crew Capacity:** 8–12
- **Weapons/Defenses:**
 - **Commanding Presence:** Allies within 30 feet gain +1 AC while on the same ship.
 - **Focused Fire:** Once per short rest, you can focus your cannon fire on a single target, dealing an additional 2d6 damage.

- **Customizable Features:** Enhanced communication systems, extra engines for speed, or additional weapon slots for bombardment.
-

5. Cruiser (Heavy Combat and Support)

Purpose: A versatile ship used for both offense and strategic support, the cruiser can provide firepower and defensive capabilities.

- **Armor Class (AC):** 17
 - **Speed:** 70 ft.
 - **Cargo Hold:** 90 cubic feet
 - **Weapons:** Heavy Cannons (4), Ballista (2), Siege Weapons (1)
 - **Crew Capacity:** 15–25
 - **Weapons/Defenses:**
 - **Fire Support:** When an ally within 30 feet of the cruiser makes a ranged attack, the cruiser can fire a supplementary light cannon, dealing 1d6 damage.
 - **Hull Reinforcement:** Can temporarily boost the ship's AC by +2 for 5 rounds.
 - **Customizable Features:** Options for cargo expansion, magical shields, or long-range artillery.
-

6. Liner (Luxury and Large Cargo)

Purpose: A large, luxurious airship built for passenger travel, merchant convoys, or exploration missions.

- **Armor Class (AC):** 14
- **Speed:** 60 ft.
- **Cargo Hold:** 150 cubic feet
- **Weapons:** None (typically unarmed, though can be modified)
- **Crew Capacity:** 30–50
- **Weapons/Defenses:**
 - **Passenger Comfort:** Passengers aboard gain advantage on saving throws against fear effects due to the luxury.
 - **Large Cargo Hold:** Ability to carry a substantial amount of cargo, increasing its value for trade missions or as a moving base of operations.
- **Customizable Features:** Can be equipped with large-scale transport mechanisms, defensive measures like light cannons, or magical aura-enhancements for better comfort.

7. Destroyer (Heavy Combat and Escort)

Purpose: A heavily armed vessel meant to escort larger ships or deal with threats in high-intensity combat situations.

- **Armor Class (AC):** 18
 - **Speed:** 60 ft.
 - **Cargo Hold:** 300 cubic feet
 - **Weapons:** Heavy Cannons (8), Anti-Air Weapons (4), Torpedoes (2)
 - **Crew Capacity:** 30–40
 - **Weapons/Defenses:**
 - **All Out Barrage:** Once per long rest, the ship can fire all weapons in a single attack, causing 6d6 damage.
 - **Counterstrikes:** Automatically deal 1d6 damage to any ship that successfully hits the Destroyer.
 - **Customizable Features:** High armor options, additional weapons slots, or faster engines for pursuit.
-

8. Galleon (Massive Combat and Heavy Cargo)

Purpose: A colossal vessel that combines firepower, defensive capacity, and massive cargo capabilities, used for flagship roles or as a battleship.

- **Armor Class (AC):** 20
 - **Speed:** 50 ft.
 - **Cargo Hold:** 600 cubic feet
 - **Weapons:** Heavy Cannons (12), Ballistas (4), Harpoons (2)
 - **Crew Capacity:** 50–100
 - **Weapons/Defenses:**
 - **Supreme Barrage:** When the Galleon takes an attack action, all cannons can fire in sequence, dealing an additional 3d6 damage.
 - **Imperial Command:** Allies within 100 feet of the Galleon have their attacks deal an additional 1d6 damage when they're within range of the Galleon's command aura.
 - **Customizable Features:** Can be outfitted with massive siege weapons, extra armor, or a command bridge to issue orders.
-

9. Battleship (Flagship, Heavy Combat)

Purpose: An iconic and powerful vessel, designed to dominate the battlefield and lead entire fleets in combat.

- **Armor Class (AC):** 22
 - **Speed:** 40 ft.
 - **Cargo Hold:** 900 cubic feet
 - **Weapons:** Siege Cannons (8), Heavy Ballistae (6), Torpedoes (4), Area Defense Cannons (2)
 - **Crew Capacity:** 100–200
 - **Weapons/Defenses:**
 - **Tactical Supremacy:** The Battleship can issue a command that gives one allied ship advantage on its next attack roll or saving throw.
 - **Massive Firepower:** Once per long rest, fire all weapons in a single devastating salvo, dealing 8d10 damage.
 - **Customizable Features:** Can be upgraded with advanced shields, powerful arcane engines, or enchanted cannons.
-

10. Dreadnought (Ultimate Warship)

Purpose: The largest and most powerful airships, designed to lead battles and crush opposition with overwhelming force and resilience.

- **Armor Class (AC):** 24
- **Speed:** 30 ft.
- **Cargo Hold:** 1000 cubic feet
- **Weapons:** Super Siege Cannons (6), Orbital Cannons (2), Heavy Torpedoes (6), Heavy Ballistae (8)
- **Crew Capacity:** 200–500
- **Weapons/Defenses:**
 - **Final Assault:** Once per day, the Dreadnought can unleash a final, all-encompassing attack from all weapons, dealing massive destruction (10d10 damage).
 - **Titanic Durability:** Resistance to all damage types while the Dreadnought is below half its hit points.
- **Customizable Features:** Includes powerful arcane systems, advanced defensive capabilities, and unlimited modification options for crew accommodations, engines, and weapons.

Customization and Modifications

Each airship type can be modified by the **construction yard**, influencing the following aspects:

- **Armor:** Adjust the AC or damage resistance of the ship.
- **Weapons:** Change weaponry types (e.g., swap cannons for magical weaponry).
- **Speed:** Modify the airship's speed for different purposes (faster for reconnaissance or slower for heavy combat).
- **Purpose:** Tailor the ship's features based on race or faction needs (e.g., a merchant fleet might have larger cargo holds, while a military fleet prioritizes heavy weapons).

This structure provides a versatile way to create a wide variety of airships that can fit any role within your world, whether they're designed for combat, exploration, or cargo transport. Each airship can be adjusted based on the race, culture, and purpose of its builders, giving each one a unique flair and function.

Racial differences to Flight

1. Humans: Aetheric and Steam-Powered Flight

Flight Method:

Humans primarily rely on aetheric engines and steam power to achieve flight. Aetheric engines use a mixture of magic and technology, drawing from the raw power of the aether (the ethereal energy that permeates the world) to propel the airship. This energy is harnessed through large, carefully constructed engines, which use a combination of magical runes and mechanical gears. The steam aspect of the propulsion involves coal or fuel-driven boilers that power turbines, giving ships speed and stability.

Effects on Ship Construction:

- **Speed and Maneuverability:** Moderate (Base Speed: +0 ft; Maneuverability: +0).
- **Maintenance Complexity:** High (Failure Rate: 15% per extended flight without repairs).

Racial Modifiers:

- **Engineering Ingenuity:** +2 bonus to checks related to repairing or modifying airship components.
- **Balanced Design:** Human airships have +1 to all performance attributes (armor, speed, maneuverability), making them versatile but not overly specialized.

- **Racial weakness:** Weakness to lightning damage x2
- **Stout construction:** Ships at zero hit points are floating wrecks. And are destroyed at -10

Ship Features:

- **Steam Turbines:** Increase base speed by +10 ft.
- **Aetheric Runes:** Store excess energy, providing a one-time speed burst (+30 ft for 5 rounds; recharges after 24 hours).
- **Smog cloud:** -2 to hide and move silently, +10 miles detection range.

Description:

Human airships are built with practicality in mind, often mixing advanced steam engineering with magical devices that power the ship. They are relatively easy to maintain, making them popular among trade fleets and mercenary groups. However, the heavy reliance on machinery means they require a skilled crew to operate effectively.

2. Elves: Arcane Levitation and Lightwinds

Flight Method:

Elves use arcane levitation to achieve flight, powered by their deep connection to the natural world and the magic that flows through it. Rather than relying on mechanical engines, elven ships are often enchanted with powerful spells of levitation and wind control. These ships are lightweight, often constructed from the finest wood or metals that naturally have magical properties, such as silverleaf wood or moonstone. The ship's propulsion comes from wind elementals or lightwind sails, which can be summoned or controlled by skilled elven navigators.

Effects on Ship Construction:

- **Speed and Maneuverability:** High (Base Speed: +30 ft; Maneuverability: +3).
- **Durability:** Weak (AC -2 compared to other ships).
- **Resistance:** Force and lightning damage Resistance

Racial Modifiers:

- **Natural Magic:** Elves gain a +2 bonus to Arcana checks for creating or enhancing levitation spells and propulsion systems.
- **Windship Mastery:** Elven ships have advantage on checks for navigation or maneuvering in difficult air conditions.
- **Racial weakness:** Weakness to fire damage x2
- **Fragile construction:** At zero hit points ships are considered completely destroyed

Ship Features:

- **Elemental Wind Sails:** Increase maneuverability by +1 and allow speed bursts (+20 ft for 1d4 minutes).
- **Arcane Levitation Stones:** Reduce weight by 30%, improving flight efficiency.
- **Aetheric Wings:** Grant +1 to AC and maneuverability in combat per 10ft moved.
- **Smokeless:** +2 to hide checks

Description:

Elven airships are elegant, sleek, and graceful. They glide effortlessly through the skies, often guided by a blend of arcane knowledge and an intimate connection to nature. They are the perfect vessels for exploration, ceremonial journeys, and fast strikes. Their reliance on magic, however, makes them less durable under fire.

3. Dwarves: Rune-Enchanted Stonecraft and Steam

Flight Method:

Dwarven airships combine ancient runic magic with steam power. Rather than relying on lightness or wind magic, dwarves craft ships from incredibly dense and sturdy materials, often utilizing stone, mithril, and adamantium. Rune-enchanted engines, powered by a combination of runic symbols and steam-driven mechanisms, allow these ships to remain aloft. The use of stone or other heavy materials means that dwarven ships are slower but incredibly resilient.

Effects on Ship Construction:

- **Speed and Maneuverability:** Low (Base Speed: -20 ft; Maneuverability: -1).
- **Durability:** Very High (+4 AC; resistance to fire and force damage).

Racial Modifiers:

- **Heavy Armor:** Dwarven airships gain +2 AC due to their rune-enchanted hulls.
- **Durability:** Stonecraft built, reducing all damage taken by 50%.
- **Redundant levitation:** Dwarven levitation engineering, Almost impossible to destroy fully. Ship must go into negative (-10) hit points to begin sinking. And are considered destroyed at their negative hit point value.

Ship Features:

- **Rune-Powered Engines:** Grant +1 AC and reduce engine damage rates by 20%.

- **Gravitational Anomalies:** Reduce effective weight by 50%, enabling limited propulsion.
- **Defensive Shields:** Provide an additional +2 to saving throws against magical attacks, Crew cannot be targeted by attacks.
- **Smokeless:** +2 to hide checks

Description:

Dwarven airships are designed for combat and heavy-duty purposes, such as transporting large goods or military endeavors. They are tough, slow-moving, and virtually indestructible in combat, making them ideal for dangerous missions or protecting vital cargo. Their reliance on runic magic and steam engines gives them excellent resilience but limits their speed and agility.

4. Gnomes: Mechanized and Arcane Hybrid Flight

Flight Method:

Gnomes blend mechanical ingenuity and arcane tinkering to create highly advanced, hybrid-powered airships. These ships use intricate mechanical systems such as gear-driven engines, clockwork wings, and magical propulsion (often powered by rare crystals or arcane fuel sources). The ships are compact, highly maneuverable, and rely heavily on innovation and gadgets for their flight mechanisms.

Effects on Ship Construction:

- **Speed and Maneuverability:** High (Base Speed: +0 ft; Maneuverability: +3).
- **Durability:** Low (-3 AC compared to other ships).

Racial Modifiers:

- **Tinkerer's Advantage:** Gnomes gain a +2 bonus to tool proficiency checks for airship construction or modification.
- **Inventive Design:** Ships can incorporate up to 2 additional features or gadgets without performance penalties.

Ship Features:

- **Clockwork Propulsion:** Improves maneuverability by +1.
- **Arcane Fuel:** Provides temporary speed boosts (+40 ft for 5 rounds; recharges after 24 hours).
- **Gadget Systems:** Include customizable features like smoke screens or automated turrets (+1 to combat rolls).
- **Smog cloud:** -2 to hide and move silently, +10 miles detection range.
- **Fragile construction:** Ships at zero hit points are considered completely destroyed.

Description:

Gnome airships are a blend of intricate machinery and arcane technology, often resulting in highly customizable, fast, and adaptable vessels. Gnomes are known for their inventiveness and love of tinkering, so their ships are often full of experimental technologies that give them the edge in unique situations, though they may not be as reliable in the long term as other races' ships.

5. Dragonborn: Draconic Elemental Flight**Flight Method:**

Dragonborn airships are powered by draconic magic and elemental breath. The ships are constructed with an intense focus on the elements, often involving a dragon's heartstone or elemental cores—large magical crystals that draw power from dragonkind's connection to the elemental forces. These ships are extremely strong and can incorporate draconic influence to propel themselves through the skies with the assistance of fire, lightning, wind, or earth elements.

Effects on Ship Construction:

- **Speed and Maneuverability:** Moderate (Base Speed: 70 ft; Maneuverability: +0).
- **Durability:** High (+1 AC; resistance to damage based on elemental core).

Racial Modifiers:

- **Elemental Infusion:** Ships gain resistance to an elemental type (e.g., fire, lightning) based on the elemental core.
- **Dragonborn Majesty:** Ships captained by Dragonborn gain +2 Charisma in interactions with other dragonkind or races that respect dragons.

Ship Features:

- **Elemental Breath Engine:** Provides bursts of speed (+30 ft for 5 rounds) or elemental attacks (4d6 damage in a cone or line; once per day).
- **Fire Wings or Lightning Sails:** Increase base speed by +10 ft and grant resistance to corresponding elemental damage.
- **Draconic Roar:** Once per day, unleashes an elemental roar that deals 3d8 damage in a 60 ft cone.
- **Smog cloud:** -2 to hide and move silently, +10 miles detection range.
- **Stout construction:** Ships at zero hit points are floating wrecks. And are destroyed at -10

Description:

Dragonborn airships are majestic and fierce, with designs inspired by dragons themselves. They are powerful, combining elemental might with magical technology. Their unique ability to use elemental forces makes them a force to be reckoned with, but the ships require specialized knowledge to operate effectively.

Summary of Racial Flight Methods

- **Humans** use a combination of **steam engines** and **aetheric magic**, emphasizing **versatility** and **practicality**.
- **Elves** rely on **arcane levitation** and **wind magic**, creating **graceful**, **agile** ships capable of speed and maneuverability.
- **Dwarves** employ **runic stonecraft** and **steam power**, constructing **heavily fortified**, **durable** airships that are **slow** but **unyielding** in combat.
- **Gnomes** combine **mechanical innovation** and **arcane tinkering**, producing **nimble**, **customizable** ships with advanced gadgets and high maneuverability.
- **Dragonborn** infuse their ships with **elemental breath magic**, creating **powerful**, **majestic** vessels that harness the strength of dragons for flight and combat.

Putting all the pieces together

In this system, players and Dungeon Masters collaboratively create the base statistics for vessels, whether for encounters or player use, by following a structured framework:

1. Base Vessel Statistics:

Start with the core attributes of the ship. These represent the foundational characteristics shared by all vessels of its class, such as size, durability, speed, maneuverability, and cargo capacity. Base statistics can be derived from templates representing common ship types (e.g., schooners, galleons, airships, etc.).

2. Racial Modifications:

Apply racial influences based on the origin of the vessel's construction. Each race has unique shipbuilding traditions that enhance or limit certain aspects of the vessel.

3. Cultural and Technological Priorities:

These racial traits reflect the cultural and technological priorities of the builders and are applied directly to the base statistics.

4. Purpose Modifications:

Finally, adjust the vessel's statistics based on its intended purpose. These modifications

reflect specialized outfitting or enhancements designed for specific roles. Examples include:

- **Combat Vessels:** Increased firepower and reinforced hulls, possibly at the cost of cargo capacity.
 - **Cargo Ships:** Maximized cargo space and efficiency, sacrificing speed and armament.
 - **Exploration Ships:** Enhanced navigation systems, increased range, and adaptability to harsh conditions.
 - **Passenger Ships:** Improved comfort and safety systems, but lower durability and reduced defenses.
5. Purpose modifications allow for further personalization and ensure the vessel fulfills its intended role within the campaign.
-

Purpose-Based Ship Modifications

Below is a list of purpose-based modifications that can be installed on a ship to specialize it for a particular role. Each modification represents a significant overhaul of the vessel, reshaping its capabilities and functions to excel in one specific area. Ships can only support **one modification at a time**, as the modifications conflict with one another due to their unique structural and operational demands.

1. Passenger Liner Modification

- **Purpose:** Optimized for carrying passengers in comfort and safety.
- **Features:**
 - **Expanded Quarters:** Additional and luxurious cabins for passengers.
 - **Stabilizers:** Enhanced stabilization systems to ensure smooth journeys, reducing turbulence.
 - **Entertainment Facilities:** Equipped with common areas like observation decks, dining halls, and entertainment lounges.
 - **Safety Measures:** Lifeboat pods or emergency gliders for passenger evacuation.
- **Drawbacks:** Reduced cargo and weapon capacity; requires more maintenance.
- **Effects:**
 - +10 to capacity for non-combatants (passengers).

- Advantage on saving throws against environmental hazards (comfort-focused design).
 - Disadvantage on combat maneuvers due to reduced maneuverability.
-

2. Cargo Hauler Modification

- **Purpose:** Built for carrying large amounts of goods and supplies.
 - **Features:**
 - **Expanded Holds:** Reinforced storage areas for maximum cargo capacity.
 - **Loading Rigs:** Mechanical arms and cranes for quick loading and unloading.
 - **Durable Frames:** Strengthened hulls to handle heavier loads.
 - **Drawbacks:** Reduced speed and maneuverability; minimal weaponry.
 - **Effects:**
 - +50% cargo capacity.
 - -10 feet to flying speed.
 - Disadvantage on initiative rolls in combat scenarios.
-

3. Scout Vessel Modification

- **Purpose:** Designed for speed, agility, and reconnaissance missions.
 - **Features:**
 - **Lightweight Hull:** Reduced weight for increased speed and agility.
 - **Enhanced Optics:** Magical or mechanical telescopes and scanning devices.
 - **Stealth Systems:** Noise-dampening materials and smoke dispensers.
 - **Drawbacks:** Minimal armor and cargo capacity; limited passenger space.
 - **Effects:**
 - +20 feet flying speed.
 - +5 to Perception checks while airborne.
 - Disadvantage on checks to resist damage (weaker armor).
-

4. Combat Line Vessel Modification

- **Purpose:** Geared toward front-line combat and sustained engagements.
- **Features:**
 - **Reinforced Hull:** Enhanced armor plating for better durability.
 - **Weapon Platforms:** Additional mounts for ballistae, cannons, or other weaponry.

- **Ammunition Storage:** Increased capacity for combat supplies.
 - **Drawbacks:** Reduced speed and maneuverability; high maintenance requirements.
 - **Effects:**
 - +2 AC for the ship.
 - +2 to attack rolls with mounted weapons.
 - -10 feet flying speed.
-

5. Support Vessel Modification

- **Purpose:** Provides repairs, healing, or logistical support to other ships.
 - **Features:**
 - **Repair Bays:** Equipped with tools and magical devices for field repairs.
 - **Medical Facilities:** Healing stations for injured crew members.
 - **Supply Stores:** Reserves of food, water, and magical energy.
 - **Drawbacks:** Lightly armed; relies on other ships for protection.
 - **Effects:**
 - Can repair 1d8+Intelligence mod hit points to allied ships as an action (once per short rest).
 - Can stabilize wounded crew automatically during battle.
 - -5 to maximum hull hit points.
-

6. Explorer Vessel Modification

- **Purpose:** Optimized for long journeys into uncharted territories.
 - **Features:**
 - **Improved Navigation:** Advanced charts, maps, and magical compasses.
 - **Self-Sustaining Systems:** Algae farms, water purification systems, and energy-efficient engines.
 - **Survey Equipment:** Tools for analyzing terrain and magical anomalies.
 - **Drawbacks:** Moderate in all capacities; not specialized for combat or cargo.
 - **Effects:**
 - Gain advantage on Navigation checks.
 - +20% fuel efficiency or energy reserves.
 - +5 to checks to detect environmental hazards.
-

7. Dreadnought Modification

- **Purpose:** A heavily armed and armored vessel for maximum destruction.
 - **Features:**
 - **Fortified Hull:** Immensely strong armor for enduring damage.
 - **Heavy Weaponry:** Massive cannons or arcane artillery.
 - **Siege Systems:** Designed for prolonged assaults against large targets.
 - **Drawbacks:** Extremely slow and cumbersome; requires significant resources to operate.
 - **Effects:**
 - +4 AC for the ship.
 - +5 to damage rolls with ship-mounted weapons.
 - -20 feet flying speed.
-

8. Research Vessel Modification

- **Purpose:** Built for magical and scientific study.
 - **Features:**
 - **Arcane Labs:** Magical and alchemical facilities for experimentation.
 - **Specimen Containers:** Secure chambers for capturing and studying creatures or anomalies.
 - **Advanced Sensors:** Magical or mechanical tools for detecting magical auras or elemental phenomena.
 - **Drawbacks:** Minimal combat capabilities; fragile structure.
 - **Effects:**
 - +5 to Arcana and Nature checks while aboard the ship.
 - Can store magical anomalies safely without backlash.
 - -2 AC for the ship.
-

9. Smuggler's Vessel Modification

- **Purpose:** Designed for stealth and secrecy, ideal for illicit activities.
- **Features:**
 - **Hidden Compartments:** Concealed spaces for storing contraband.
 - **Speed Boosters:** Enhanced propulsion for quick escapes.
 - **Camouflage Systems:** Mimicry to blend with the surrounding sky.
- **Drawbacks:** Limited storage for legitimate cargo; lightly armed.
- **Effects:**
 - +5 to Deception checks to avoid detection.
 - +10 feet flying speed.
 - Disadvantage on checks to resist damage.

10. Luxury Vessel Modification

- **Purpose:** A floating palace for the wealthy elite.
 - **Features:**
 - **Ornate Design:** Lavish interiors with high-end materials and decor.
 - **Entertainment Halls:** Banquet rooms, theaters, and magical performance spaces.
 - **Elite Crew:** Staff trained in serving high-status passengers.
 - **Drawbacks:** Minimal combat and cargo capabilities.
 - **Effects:**
 - Gain +2 to Charisma-based checks when entertaining dignitaries.
 - Advantage on persuasion checks with wealthy individuals.
 - -10 feet flying speed.
-

Vessel Size and Modifications

The **size of the vessel** determines the base cost and capabilities of a ship, with **purpose-based modifications** typically selected during construction to enhance its role. These modifications can later be changed at a suitably sized shipyard, but the cost of doing so increases with each size category.

Below are the **ship size categories**, their typical functions, and the costs associated with modifying a ship:

Vessel Size Categories and Costs for Modifications:

Vessel Size	Category Description	Modification Fee
Jetty	The smallest type of airship, typically used for personal transport or light cargo. Compact, fast, but not designed for combat.	100 Gold

Scutter	Slightly larger than a jetty, often used for reconnaissance or short-range missions. It's nimble and efficient.	200 Gold
Corvette	A small, fast ship often used for combat or scouting in more hostile areas. Combat-ready but still highly maneuverable.	400 Gold
Frigate	Larger than corvettes, typically used for patrols or protecting smaller ships. Versatile in both combat and cargo.	800 Gold
Cruiser	A versatile ship capable of medium cargo or combat missions. Often used as a general-purpose vessel.	1,600 Gold
Liner	A large ship focused on passenger transport, luxury, or mass cargo. Often slower and more comfortable.	3,200 Gold
Destroyer	A combat-heavy vessel designed for offense and defense. Features powerful weaponry and tough hulls.	6,400 Gold
Galleon	A massive vessel used for carrying vast amounts of cargo or troops. Slow-moving but powerful and heavily armed.	12,800 Gold
Battleship	Heavily armored and armed, built for long-term battles or defense missions. Often the main vessel in a fleet.	25,600 Gold
Dreadnought	The largest and most imposing airship design. Made for complete dominance in combat, exploration, or defense.	51,200 Gold

Key Points About Modifications:

- **Modification Process:** Modifications to a ship's purpose (such as converting a passenger liner into a combat vessel) can only be made at a suitably large shipyard. The ship must be docked for the modifications to take place, and the time required depends on the size of the ship.
 - **Cost of Modifications:** The base modification fee starts at **100 gold** for the smallest ships (Jetty). Each larger ship category increases the modification cost by doubling the fee as you move up the size ladder.
 - **Race-Influenced Design:** The race of origin influences the materials used in the ship's construction, affecting how the ship can be modified. A **Dwarven-built** ship may have additional armor layers, making it more resistant to combat modifications, while an **Elven ship** might allow for easier application of stealth and speed modifications.
 - **Shipyard Availability:** Larger shipyards are typically located in major air cities, where resources and skilled labor are plentiful. Smaller settlements may have shipyards that only cater to the smallest vessels.
-

Modifications Conflict:

- **Purpose-Specific Modifications:** Only one modification can be selected at any given time, as each modification reshapes the vessel for a specific purpose. For example, a **Cargo Hauler Modification** might add more cargo space but reduce the ship's speed and combat effectiveness, which would conflict with modifications like a **Combat Line Vessel Modification** that focuses on weaponry and armor.
- **Changing Modifications:** If a shipowner wants to change the purpose of the vessel after it has already been constructed, it is possible to do so, but the modification cost will depend on the ship's size. For instance, converting a **Cruiser** into a **Liner** will be a more expensive process than modifying a **Jetty** into a **Scutter**.

These system changes add an extra layer of customization and strategy to ship ownership, ensuring that players or NPCs must carefully consider how to shape their ships for the missions or roles they require. The choice of race and purpose-based modifications can also significantly influence the overall strategy and experience.

Ship Upgrade Resource Costs and Shipyard Requirements

Upgrading a vessel from one size category to the next is a significant undertaking that requires not only monetary resources but also access to a shipyard that can accommodate such a large project. Shipyards are rated for their ability to handle various vessel sizes, and it's important to

ensure that the shipyard can handle the scale of the upgrade you're planning. Below is a detailed breakdown of the gold cost to upgrade your ship and the necessary shipyard specifications.

Upgrade Costs by Vessel Size Category

From Size Category	To Size Category	Gold Cost for Upgrade	Shipyard Requirements	Additional Notes
Jetty	Scutter	100 Gold	Tiny Shipyard (minimum)	Requires basic tools and materials. A small, local facility will suffice.
Scutter	Corvette	200 Gold	Small Shipyard (minimum)	Needs basic hull expansion and additional propulsion capacity.
Corvette	Frigate	400 Gold	Small to Medium Shipyard	Expansion of weapon systems, additional hull armor, and internal space.
Frigate	Cruiser	800 Gold	Medium Shipyard (minimum)	Requires more advanced weaponry, larger hull, and structural reinforcement.
Cruiser	Liner	1,600 Gold	Medium Shipyard (minimum)	Needs expansion of passenger or cargo space, plus amenities for comfort.

Liner	Destroyer	3,200 Gold	Large Shipyard (minimum)	Requires significant combat upgrades, including more advanced weapons and armor.
Destroyer	Galleon	6,400 Gold	Large Shipyard (minimum)	Major increase in cargo capacity, armor, and crew facilities.
Galleon	Battleship	12,800 Gold	Very Large Shipyard (minimum)	Focus on heavy weaponry, armor, and advanced engines.
Battleship	Dreadnought	25,600 Gold	Grand Shipyard (minimum)	Full combat specialization, the most advanced armor, weapons, and propulsion.

Ship based weapons

Below is a comprehensive table of **ship-mounted weapons** designed for a wide range of vessels, from small ships like Jetties to massive ships like Dreadnoughts. Each weapon type has two to three options tailored to each vessel size category, ranging from smaller, lighter weapons for small ships to heavy, destructive weapons for the largest vessels.

These by far are not the only weapons in the world but they are broad examples and categories that weapons fall into.

It is important to remember that only ship based weaponry is able to damage other vessels the player wielded weaponry is incapable of doing the scale of damage necessary to inflict damage on another ship, Conversely a ship mounted weapon is so devastating and damaging that if targeted and used against anything less than a vessel or creature of significant size(say a dragon) is considered as dealing 4X damage.

Keep in mind that general reference rules the weapons require as many crew to operate as it does die of damage. And that for every crew short add an additional round of reload time, and a -1 to

attack and damage. Be it from the size of maneuvering the gun to struggles to aim the weapon and adjust the weapons while aiming, simple muscle strength required to reload the weapon And various other parameters.

Ship Class	Weapon Type	Weapon Name	Description	Damage	Range	Reload Time
Jetty	Light Weapon	Rail-mounted Crossbow	A simple crossbow mounted on the vessel, ideal for light defense against small creatures or boarding parties.	1d6 piercing	30 ft	1 round
	Light Weapon	Pneumatic Dart Shooter	Fires poisoned darts that can stun or weaken targets on impact. Commonly used for disabling enemy crew or creatures.	1d4 poison damage	20 ft	1 round
	Light Weapon	Small Ballista	A small, one-shot siege weapon ideal for light defense or attacking creatures within range.	1d8 piercing	60 ft	2 rounds
Scutter	Light Weapon	Rail-mounted Crossbow	A small, effective crossbow for defending against small airborne threats or crew combat.	1d6 piercing	40 ft	1 round
	Light Weapon	Mini-Turret Cannons	Small, rotating cannons that fire low-damage shots rapidly, effective against small ships and boarding parties.	2d6 piercing	60 ft	1 round

Corvette	Medium Weapon	Deck-mounted Ballista	A larger version of the ballista, capable of firing heavy bolts with greater damage to enemy ships or large creatures.	2d10 piercing	100 ft	2 rounds
	Medium Weapon	Light Cannons	Small cannons that provide rapid-fire support, effective against enemy crews, light armor, or small ships.	3d6 fire damage	80 ft	1 round
	Medium Weapon	Heavy Crossbow	A large crossbow capable of firing massive bolts, often used for sinking smaller ships or causing heavy damage to aerial creatures.	3d8 piercing	150 ft	2 rounds
Frigate	Heavy Weapon	Deck Ballista	A larger, more powerful version of the ballista designed to pierce armor and disable enemy vessels or creatures at greater ranges.	3d12 piercing	200 ft	2 rounds
	Medium Weapon	Light Cannons	Fire small explosive rounds, great for disabling enemy ship systems or striking personnel.	4d6 fire damage	120 ft	1 round
	Medium Weapon	Deck-mounted Crossbow	A sturdy crossbow capable of firing large bolts at enemy	4d10 piercing	150 ft	2 rounds

			vessels or airborne threats.			
	Heavy Weapon	Heavy Broadside Cannons	Large cannons mounted along the sides of the ship, ideal for close-range combat and massive damage to enemy ships.	6d10 bludgeoning	200 ft	3 rounds
Cruiser	Heavy Weapon	Light Deck Cannons	Light cannons designed for flexible use against airborne or naval threats, offering moderate damage at medium range.	5d8 explosive damage	150 ft	2 rounds
	Heavy Weapon	Heavy Broadside Cannons	Powerful cannons mounted on either side, used for devastating enemy vessels or creating massive shockwaves in close combat.	7d12 bludgeoning	250 ft	3 rounds
	Massive Weapon	Deck Ballista	A massive ballista, capable of sinking smaller ships and dealing enormous damage to enemies or structures.	5d12 piercing	300 ft	2 rounds
Liner	Heavy Weapon	Broadside Cannons	Designed for maximum damage output, these cannons can deal huge damage to enemy vessels or aerial threats.	8d10 bludgeoning	200 ft	3 rounds

Destroyer	Massive Weapon	Heavy Ballista	Massive siege weapon mounted on the deck for devastating damage and range.	7d12 piercing	350 ft	2 rounds
	Massive Weapon	Deck-mounted Gatling Cannons	Rapid-fire cannons mounted for defense, capable of delivering rapid small explosive shots, perfect for taking down smaller ships or waves of creatures.	4d6 explosive damage	120 ft	1 round
	Heavy Weapon	Heavy Broadside Cannons	Powerful and destructive cannons mounted along the broadside, capable of sinking most ships in just a few shots.	10d10 bludgeoning	250 ft	3 rounds
	Massive Weapon	Spinal-mounted Behemoth Cannon	A cannon mounted on the spine of the ship, capable of delivering massive amounts of damage to enemies in a single shot.	12d10 bludgeoning	400 ft	5 rounds
	Massive Weapon	Heavy Ballista	A large and precise ballista for long-range precision fire, designed for sinking ships or large creatures with pinpoint accuracy.	8d12 piercing	400 ft	2 rounds

Galleon	Massive Weapon	Heavy Broadside Cannons	Galleons are known for their heavy cannons mounted on each side, capable of destroying enemy ships in broadside engagements.	10d12 bludgeoning	300 ft	3 rounds
	Massive Weapon	Spinal-mounted Behemoth Cannon	An enormous cannon capable of launching devastating, concentrated barrages of energy or projectiles at enemy ships or cities.	15d10 bludgeoning	500 ft	6 rounds
	Massive Weapon	Mega Deck Ballista	The largest ballista, capable of firing massive bolts that can cripple entire fleets or break through the toughest of armors.	10d12 piercing	400 ft	3 rounds
Battleship	Massive Weapon	Deck-mounted Broadside Cannons	Mounted on the ship's broadside, these powerful cannons fire devastating blasts that can tear apart any ship or fortress in their path.	15d12 bludgeoning	350 ft	3 rounds
	Massive Weapon	Spinal Behemoth Cannons	The largest and most powerful cannon in existence, it's capable of wiping out entire fleets with its devastating power and blast radius.	20d12 bludgeoning	600 ft	7 rounds

Dreadnought	Massive Weapon	Skybreaker Ballista	A colossal ballista capable of piercing nearly any defense and targeting enemy ships or giant creatures from immense distances.	12d12 piercing	500 ft	3 rounds
	Massive Weapon	Behemoth Spinal Cannon	A terrifying weapon mounted on the spine of the ship, capable of decimating entire fleets or cities with a single shot of its enormous projectiles.	25d12 bludgeoning	700 ft	8 rounds
	Massive Weapon	Skybreaker Deck Ballista	Designed for devastating range and accuracy, this weapon can destroy entire fleets or multiple enemies with a single shot, hitting targets with pinpoint precision.	20d12 piercing	600 ft	4 rounds
	Ultimate Weapon	Cataclysmic Broadside Cannons	The most powerful broadside cannons ever created, capable of obliterating anything in their path, from enemies to entire islands.	30d12 bludgeoning	500 ft	5 rounds

Weapon Descriptions by Category:

1. **Light Weapons:** These are smaller, easier-to-use weapons ideal for small vessels or quick skirmishes. They provide moderate damage but limited range and firepower.
 - **Rail-mounted Crossbows:** A crossbow mounted on a rail system that fires powerful bolts at small targets.

- **Pneumatic Dart Shooter:** A non-lethal weapon that fires darts often laced with poison or sleeping agents.
- **Mini-Turret Cannons:** Small cannons capable of rapid-fire, useful for defending against lighter threats.
- 2. **Medium Weapons:** These provide better offensive capabilities with higher damage and range, suitable for medium-sized ships or vessels in defense and skirmishes.
 - **Light Cannons:** Small cannons used for defense, good against lighter ships or creatures.
 - **Heavy Crossbow:** A larger, more powerful crossbow used to sink enemy ships or down large creatures.
 - **Deck Ballista:** A larger, heavier version of the ballista for piercing through armor or dealing damage at greater range.
- 3. **Heavy Weapons:** These are powerful, often mounted on larger ships, offering the capability to deal severe damage and destroy significant targets.
 - **Heavy Broadside Cannons:** Mounted along the sides of ships, these cannons fire high-impact blasts to damage enemy vessels.

The installation and operation of ship-mounted weapons in a sky world are not just about the weapon itself but also about the entire system required to mount, reload, and maintain these weapons. Each weapon system is part of a larger complex that includes the weapon itself, the mounts, ammunition stores, crew training, and operational costs. Below is a breakdown of the costs for installing and maintaining each type of weapon system, as well as ammunition and reload expenses.

Weapon Systems Description and Installation Costs:

1. **Rail-mounted Crossbows (Light Weapon)**
 - **Description:** A rail-mounted crossbow system that fires powerful bolts. Typically mounted on small ships such as Jetties or Scutters. These crossbows are manned by a single crew member who can reload and fire the weapon with minimal effort.
 - **Installation Cost:** 12 gold each
 - **Weapon System Setup:** Includes the crossbow, a rail system for stable aiming, basic mounting hardware, and crew training for aiming and firing.
 - **Ammo Stores:** Requires a small storage area for bolts (1 gold per 10 bolts).
 - **Reload Cost:** 1 gold per bolt (for materials and labor).
2. **Pneumatic Dart Shooter (Light Weapon)**
 - **Description:** A simple yet effective system for launching poisoned darts or sleep darts. Typically used for non-lethal encounters or to disable targets such as creatures or enemy crew.
 - **Installation Cost:** 15 gold each

- **Weapon System Setup:** Includes the dart-shooter, pneumatic mechanisms, and air compressors. Specialized storage for dart types (poison, sleep, etc.) is included.
 - **Ammo Stores:** Requires 1 gold per 5 darts (poison or sleep).
 - **Reload Cost:** 1 gold per dart (materials and air compressor refill).
3. **Mini-Turret Cannons** (Light Weapon)
- **Description:** A rotating cannon system capable of rapid fire, typically used against small threats such as flying creatures or light vessels. They provide fast-paced combat effectiveness.
 - **Installation Cost:** 25 gold each
 - **Weapon System Setup:** Includes the turret mount, rotating mechanism, power source, ammunition feed, and crew training for operating the turret.
 - **Ammo Stores:** 1 gold per 10 rounds of light cannonballs (usually low explosive or solid shot).
 - **Reload Cost:** 1 gold per round (for cannonballs and firing powder).
4. **Light Cannons** (Medium Weapon)
- **Description:** Small-caliber cannons mounted on ships for moderate range and damage. Ideal for defending against smaller threats or engaging in skirmishes with enemy ships.
 - **Installation Cost:** 50 gold each
 - **Weapon System Setup:** Includes the cannon, mount, firing mechanism, crew positions (usually 1-2 gunners), and powder stores.
 - **Ammo Stores:** 5 gold per 10 rounds of light cannonballs (explosive or solid shot).
 - **Reload Cost:** 3 gold per round (cannonball and powder).
5. **Heavy Crossbow** (Medium Weapon)
- **Description:** A large crossbow capable of firing massive bolts to pierce the hulls of enemy ships or down large flying creatures. These crossbows are manually operated, requiring 1-2 crew members to load and fire.
 - **Installation Cost:** 75 gold each
 - **Weapon System Setup:** Includes the large crossbow, a sturdy mount, mechanical assist systems, and ammunition stores for bolts.
 - **Ammo Stores:** 8 gold per 5 large bolts (typically metal-tipped and designed for armor-piercing).
 - **Reload Cost:** 3 gold per bolt (materials and labor).
6. **Deck Ballista** (Medium Weapon)
- **Description:** A larger, more powerful version of the ballista, often used for taking down enemy ships or huge creatures from a distance. These are large siege weapons requiring significant space on the deck.
 - **Installation Cost:** 100 gold each

- **Weapon System Setup:** Includes the ballista, mounting hardware, aiming mechanisms, and specialized crew training. It often requires 2-3 crew members to operate and maintain.
 - **Ammo Stores:** 12 gold per 3 heavy bolts (designed to puncture thick ship hulls or large beasts).
 - **Reload Cost:** 5 gold per bolt (materials and labor).
7. **Heavy Broadside Cannons** (Heavy Weapon)
- **Description:** Large cannons mounted along the ship's sides, designed for powerful broadsides that can decimate enemy ships in close combat. These cannons require larger crews to load and fire.
 - **Installation Cost:** 200 gold each
 - **Weapon System Setup:** Includes the cannon, rotating mounts, crew training, powder storage, and extensive aiming mechanisms for accuracy.
 - **Ammo Stores:** 25 gold per 10 rounds of cannonballs (usually explosive or high-impact shot).
 - **Reload Cost:** 8 gold per round (cannonball and powder).
8. **Spinal-mounted Behemoth Cannon** (Massive Weapon)
- **Description:** A massive cannon mounted along the spine of the ship, capable of delivering devastating damage to enemy ships or creatures. These cannons can only be mounted on large ships, such as Destroyers or Galleons.
 - **Installation Cost:** 500 gold each
 - **Weapon System Setup:** Includes the enormous cannon, specialized mounting along the ship's spine, support systems, and crew training (usually requiring 4-6 people to operate).
 - **Ammo Stores:** 100 gold per 3 large rounds (designed for massive impact, often explosive).
 - **Reload Cost:** 25 gold per round (materials and labor).
9. **Skybreaker Deck Ballista** (Massive Weapon)
- **Description:** An enormous ballista designed for long-range, high-damage precision shots. Often used to disable enemy ships or cause destruction to large aerial creatures.
 - **Installation Cost:** 600 gold each
 - **Weapon System Setup:** Includes the gigantic ballista, reinforced mounting, aiming systems, and crew positions (typically 3-4 people required for operation).
 - **Ammo Stores:** 150 gold per 5 giant bolts (made of heavy materials designed to penetrate large targets).
 - **Reload Cost:** 50 gold per bolt (materials, labor, and effort).
10. **Cataclysmic Broadside Cannons** (Ultimate Weapon)

- **Description:** The largest and most destructive broadside cannons capable of obliterating anything in their path. These are mounted on the largest ships, typically Dreadnoughts, and require extensive training to fire.
 - **Installation Cost:** 1000 gold each
 - **Weapon System Setup:** Includes the titanic cannons, reinforced mounts, aiming systems, powder stores, and 6-8 crew members to manage the weapon.
 - **Ammo Stores:** 200 gold per 3 rounds of ultra-heavy cannonballs (massive projectiles designed for catastrophic destruction).
 - **Reload Cost:** 75 gold per round (ammo, powder, and labor).
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Ammo Stores and Reload Costs Overview:

- **Light Weapons:** Ammo is relatively cheap and easy to manufacture, usually requiring only basic materials (wood, iron, or light explosives) to produce.
- **Medium Weapons:** Ammo costs start to increase due to the size and complexity of the projectiles used, often requiring better materials (iron, steel, or magical elements) to craft more effective shots.
- **Heavy and Massive Weapons:** The cost of ammunition dramatically increases as the size of the weapon increases, requiring larger amounts of material to construct each round. These weapons typically use specialized projectiles, sometimes even including magical or highly volatile substances for explosive shots.
- **Reloading Costs:** Reloading larger weapons is both time-consuming and expensive, often involving multiple crew members and expensive materials such as specialized powder, iron, or even rare materials for specialized ammo types. Each shot must be carefully loaded, with some weapons requiring custom-crafted ammunition that can take significant time to produce.

Shipyard Rating System and Requirements

Tiny Shipyard

- **Vessel Capacity:** Can accommodate ships up to **Scutter** size.
- **Tools Available:** Basic tools for hull repairs, small expansion work, and minor modifications.
- **Upgrade Capacity:** Can only support upgrades between **Jetty** to **Scutter** or **Scutter** to **Corvette**. Any larger ship upgrades require a larger facility.

Small Shipyard

- **Vessel Capacity:** Can handle ships up to **Corvette** size.
- **Tools Available:** Enhanced hull-building equipment, limited weaponry upgrade tools, basic material refineries for expansion.
- **Upgrade Capacity:** Can support upgrades between **Corvette** to **Frigate** and **Scutter** to **Corvette**. Larger upgrades require medium facilities.

Medium Shipyard

- **Vessel Capacity:** Can accommodate ships up to **Frigate** and **Cruiser** size.
- **Tools Available:** Advanced hull reinforcement tools, basic arcane and mechanical upgrade equipment, structural expansion equipment.
- **Upgrade Capacity:** Can support upgrades between **Frigate** to **Cruiser** and **Liner** to **Destroyer**. Larger upgrades require a large facility.

Large Shipyard

- **Vessel Capacity:** Can handle ships up to **Destroyer** and **Galleon** size.
- **Tools Available:** Full-scale arcane and mechanical upgrade systems, heavy armor refineries, large weapon systems installations.
- **Upgrade Capacity:** Can support upgrades between **Destroyer** to **Galleon**, **Cruiser** to **Liner**, and minor upgrades on larger ships. Larger upgrades require very large facilities.

Very Large Shipyard

- **Vessel Capacity:** Can accommodate ships up to **Battleship** size.
- **Tools Available:** Heavy industrial systems for mass armor installation, advanced propulsion system installations, military-grade weaponry construction.
- **Upgrade Capacity:** Can support upgrades between **Galleon** to **Battleship** and any other smaller upgrades. Dreadnought upgrades require the most advanced systems.

Grand Shipyard

- **Vessel Capacity:** Can handle **Dreadnought** size ships.
- **Tools Available:** High-end systems for cutting-edge weapons, shields, and armor. Capable of integrating rare magical or arcane elements into ships.
- **Upgrade Capacity:** Can support upgrades to **Dreadnought** and the most specialized and powerful ship modifications. Requires vast resources and extremely skilled workers.

Upgrade Process Overview

1. **Preparation:** Before the upgrade begins, the ship will need to be docked at a shipyard that can handle its new size. Smaller ships cannot be upgraded at larger shipyards unless there is room and a corresponding payment for the work.
2. **Engineering Consultation:** Ship owners will need to consult with master engineers to determine the best upgrades for the vessel. This can include adjusting the purpose of the ship (e.g., from a **Passenger Liner** to a **Combat Destroyer**) or focusing on improving its core functionalities, such as speed, combat effectiveness, or cargo space.
3. **Resource Gathering:** Depending on the upgrade size, the shipyard will need raw materials such as metal alloys, wood, arcane crystals, and other resources. These resources are gathered by the ship owner or provided by the shipyard at an additional cost.
4. **Construction and Modifications:** The ship will be worked on over a period of time, with the amount of time required varying by the ship's size and the complexity of the upgrade. Larger upgrades (e.g., from **Battleship** to **Dreadnought**) can take months, while smaller upgrades can be done in a few weeks.
5. **Testing and Final Adjustments:** After the ship's upgrade is completed, it will undergo testing, including combat simulations, cargo load checks, and speed assessments. Once this phase is complete, the vessel will be cleared for use by the owner.

Additional Notes

- **Shipyard Location Matters:** Larger shipyards are generally located in major port cities, often near the core capitals of the most powerful empires or alliances. Small shipyards are more commonly found in rural or less-developed regions, where ships are often used for trade or personal use rather than military purposes.
- **Fleet Upgrades:** In some cases, fleets or organizations will pool resources to upgrade a fleet's ships, often prioritizing larger vessels. Group upgrades may be cheaper per ship, but the time required to complete them can extend significantly.
- **Upgrades and Purpose Conflict:** Some modifications are so specialized that they conflict with other upgrades. For example, a ship designed for luxury (such as a **Liner**) cannot easily be converted into a **Dreadnought** without considerable redesign and rebuilding, as their structural needs are entirely different.

uilding a shipyard capable of maintaining and upgrading ships is an ambitious but rewarding undertaking. The following table details the costs, materials, supplies, and personnel required to create each level of shipyard, from a small, private work area capable of crafting basic vessels to a grand, industrial-scale facility capable of building and maintaining the largest and most advanced ships in the sky.

Shipyards Construction and Requirements

Shipyards Level	Cost (in Gold)	Size (in square feet)	Materials Required	Supplies Required	Personnel Required	Functionality
Level 1: Tiny Workbench	50 gold	100 sq ft	10 units of wood, 5 iron ingots	Basic tools, carpentry supplies	1 worker (Craftsman/Engineer)	Basic repairs, small craft creation (Jetty or Scutter), rudimentary maintenance
Level 2: Small Dock	200 gold	200 sq ft	50 units of wood, 20 iron ingots, 10 cloth	Basic tools, carpentry tools, small supplies for ship repairs	2 workers (Craftsman/Engineer, Assistant)	Small repairs, crafting of small to medium ships (up to Frigate), rudimentary upgrades
Level 3: Private Shipyards	500 gold	400 sq ft	100 units of wood, 50 iron ingots, 20 cloth, 10 copper	Tools for basic repairs, a small forge, crafting supplies	4 workers (Craftsman, 2 Assistants, Junior Engineer)	Medium ships (Corvette to Frigate), basic ship upgrades, hull repairs
Level 4: Regional Shipyards	1,500 gold	800 sq ft	250 units of wood, 100 iron ingots, 50 cloth, 20 copper, 10 glass	Full set of shipbuilding tools, forge, carpentry shop,	6 workers (Engineer, 3 Craftsmen, 2 Assistants)	Construction of large ships (Frigate to Cruiser), upgrades, hull repairs

				inventory system		
Level 5: Advanced Shipyard	4,000 gold	1,500 sq ft	500 units of wood, 200 iron ingots, 100 cloth, 50 copper, 30 glass, 15 enchanted gems	Full set of shipbuilding tools, specialized tools for large vessels, foundry, smelting area, material storage	10 workers (Engineers, Craftsmen, Assistants, Smelter)	Large ship creation (Cruiser to Liner), advanced upgrades, custom crafting
Level 6: Industrial Shipyard	10,000 gold	2,500 sq ft	1,000 units of wood, 400 iron ingots, 200 cloth, 100 copper, 50 glass, 30 enchanted gems, rare materials	Heavy equipment for ship construction, high-tech forges, advanced smithing tools	20 workers (Engineers, Craftsmen, Foremen, Material Handlers)	Construction of very large ships (Liner to Destroyer), advanced enhancements, military-grade vessels
Level 7: National Shipyard	25,000 gold	5,000 sq ft	2,000 units of wood, 800 iron ingots, 400 cloth, 200 copper, 100 glass, 50 enchanted gems, 30	Automated systems, mechanized cranes, extensive docks, multiple foundries, fuel systems	40 workers (Engineers, Craftsmen, Specialists, Laborers, Foremen)	Creation of Destroyer to Galleon, military vessels, specialized crafts

				rare materials		
Level 8: Grand Shipyard	50,000 gold	10,000 sq ft	4,000 units of wood, 1,500 iron ingots, 800 cloth, 400 copper, 200 glass, 100 enchanted gems, 50 rare materials, magic-enhanced materials	Fully mechanized equipment, arcane workshops, magic-infused tools	75 workers (Engineers, Master Craftsmen, Architects, Foremen, Laborers)	Ship production for Galleon to Battleship, major upgrades, arcane vessels
Level 9: Super Shipyard	100,000 gold	15,000 sq ft	8,000 units of wood, 3,000 iron ingots, 1,500 cloth, 800 copper, 400 glass, 200 enchanted gems, 100 rare materials, arcane metals	Massive cranes, multiple shipbuilding docks, specialized labor force, arcane workshops, material refinement stations	100 workers (Master Engineers, Foremen, Arcane Craftsmen, Specialists, Laborers)	Custom ship construction for Battleship to Dreadnought, shipyard defense, arcane or advanced tech vessels

Level 10: Imperial Shipyard	200,000 gold	25,000 sq ft	16,000 units of wood, 6,000 iron ingots, 3,000 cloth, 1,500 copper, 1,000 glass, 500 enchanted gems, 200 rare materials, 100 mythical materials	Cutting-edge technology for production, mechanized arcane workstations, magic-infused infrastructure, elite specialists	200 workers (Master Engineers, Arcane Masters, Craftsmen, Laborers, Shipyard Architects)	Construction of Dreadnoughts, creation of legendary ships, superweapons, and shipyard defense
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Explanation of Requirements:

- Gold Cost:** The initial cost reflects the establishment of the shipyard. Each level represents a significant upgrade in both size and complexity, requiring large sums of gold to construct the necessary infrastructure and facilities.
- Size:** The space required grows as the shipyard progresses, with larger shipyards housing more advanced equipment, more material storage, and larger teams of workers.
- Materials:** The materials required scale according to the complexity of the shipyard. Higher-level shipyards need larger quantities of wood, iron, copper, glass, and specialty materials, often incorporating magic or rare elements for advanced ship designs.
- Supplies:** As the shipyard grows, so does the need for specialized supplies. This includes tools for specialized crafting, forging, arcane equipment for higher-level materials, and systems for material transportation.
- Personnel:** The number of workers increases as the shipyard level rises. It starts with a few basic engineers and craftsmen and eventually escalates to highly trained specialists, arcane crafters, and a larger labor force capable of building massive ships.
- Functionality:** As the shipyard level increases, its capacity to build and upgrade larger and more complex ships grows exponentially. Lower-level shipyards can handle basic

small crafts and repairs, while higher levels are capable of constructing massive warships, passenger liners, or specialized vessels.

Additional Considerations for Shipyard Operation:

- **Construction Time:** Higher-level shipyards reduce the amount of time required to build or upgrade ships. For example, a small dock might take months to construct a single Corvette, while a Mega Shipyard could finish it in a matter of weeks.
- **Personnel Specialization:** With higher levels of shipyard development, workers will need specific skills for advanced production. This could include arcane knowledge for magic-infused ships, technical expertise for advanced engine systems, or military tactics for warship design.
- **Security:** As the shipyard's value and output grow, so does the necessity for security. Higher-tier shipyards often attract thieves, pirates, or rival factions, leading to the need for guards, fortifications, and possibly even personal defense systems or hired mercenaries.

This detailed breakdown allows players to fully comprehend the scope and complexity of building their own shipyard and navigating the costs and requirements for maintaining and expanding their fleet.

Ship Inspections and Ownership Validation in Major Ports

In many of the world's major ports and cities, particularly those of significant size and wealth, there are strict regulations regarding the entry and docking of ships, especially those of substantial size such as **Corvettes** and larger vessels. These regulations are enforced through a thorough **inspection process** that serves a dual purpose: ensuring the safety of the ship, its cargo, and its passengers, as well as verifying the **legitimacy of the vessel's ownership** and the **intentions** of the ship's crew. Depending on the **government in power**, the rules surrounding inspections can vary significantly.

General Inspection Process:

Upon arrival at a port or docking facility, ships will typically be required to undergo an **official inspection**. This inspection often includes the following steps:

1. **Physical Inspection:** Port authorities or customs officials will inspect the ship's exterior and interior, ensuring it meets the local safety and construction standards. This includes verifying the vessel's hull integrity, fire-fighting equipment, and life-saving devices.
2. **Cargo Check:** If the ship is carrying cargo, the contents will be examined to ensure there are no illegal goods or contraband on board. This process can involve a full inventory check and, depending on the cargo, a physical examination.

3. **Passenger Check:** For ships with passengers, a manifest listing all individuals on board will be requested. Any discrepancies between the manifest and the actual number of passengers can lead to delays, fines, or further scrutiny.
4. **Ownership Validation:** For ships of significant size (often **Corvettes** and larger), **proof of ownership** is required. The captain or ship's representative must present an official **deed of ownership** to ensure the vessel is legally registered.

Deed of Ownership and Potential Issues:

While most governments accept deeds of ownership that are valid within their own borders, things become more complicated when a ship is from a rival nation or a foreign power. Different nations or cities may refuse to honor deeds of ownership from other governments, particularly if there is an ongoing **political conflict** or tension between them.

For instance, if a ship arrives at a **neutral port** but the deed of ownership is from a **rival nation**, the following scenarios could unfold:

- **Seizure of the Vessel:** In extreme cases, especially if there is known political animosity, the port authorities may outright seize the ship under suspicion that it may be used for espionage, smuggling, or even military action. This is especially common if the ship's home nation is considered a threat or has broken diplomatic ties with the port's governing body.
- **Flagging of the Vessel:** Some ports may opt to temporarily flag the vessel, meaning it will be quarantined or isolated for further inspection. This may include detainment for days or even weeks as the vessel's intentions are investigated, and it could lead to significant delays and potential fines.
- **Ownership Dispute:** If the deed of ownership is from a nation that is known to be at war or in conflict with the port's nation, the ship may be subjected to further scrutiny regarding its **legitimacy**. Authorities may challenge the deed, claim the ship's cargo, or place the vessel under temporary ownership until a proper investigation is conducted.
- **Bribery or Political Influence:** In some cases, powerful political figures or merchants may leverage connections to ensure that their ships' deeds are accepted or even bypass inspection entirely. However, this is generally a rare and risky practice, as bribery is often illegal and can lead to heavy penalties for both the ship's crew and the officials involved.

Differing Government Practices:

The exact nature of inspections and ownership validation can vary dramatically between different governments and regions. For example:

- **Theocratic or Monarchic Nations:** These governments often place a high value on loyalty and allegiance. As such, ships arriving from nations with conflicting political or

religious beliefs may be met with harsher scrutiny or outright refusal to honor the ownership deed, sometimes under the pretext of safeguarding the realm's security or upholding divine will.

- **Democratic or Free Cities:** In cities governed by democratic principles, there may be a more formalized, transparent process for recognizing foreign ownership deeds. However, the city may still impose a strict vetting process, especially if the ship is carrying sensitive materials or comes from a nation with a checkered diplomatic history.
- **Merchant Nations:** In highly commercialized or trade-centric cities, ownership deeds from foreign nations may be more easily accepted, particularly if the ship is seen as a valuable resource for trade. These cities may prioritize the economic value of the vessel over national loyalty, though political tension may still influence inspection procedures.
- **Pirate Haven Ports:** In regions where piracy is prevalent or the port is controlled by criminal elements, official documentation such as deeds of ownership may be ignored entirely. Ships may be forcibly "claimed" by these groups, and ownership becomes a matter of power rather than law. Ships entering these areas risk having their ownership contested or entirely nullified, especially if the ship's crew cannot prove loyalty or negotiate with the port's leaders.

Consequences of Failed Inspections:

If a ship fails an inspection, several consequences can occur depending on the severity of the infraction and the political climate:

- **Delays:** A failed inspection may result in significant delays as the ship is temporarily held for further investigation or repair. This is especially problematic for ships on tight schedules or those with perishable goods.
- **Fines:** Ships with discrepancies in their cargo or ownership documentation may be fined heavily. In some cases, the fines can be so severe that the captain or crew may be forced to sell their goods, and potentially their vessel, to cover the costs.
- **Confiscation:** In the most extreme cases, the ship may be confiscated, and its cargo seized. This typically occurs if the authorities suspect that the vessel is either stolen or has been involved in illicit activities.
- **Imprisonment or Detainment:** If ownership documents are forged or found to be fraudulent, the ship's captain and crew may be detained or imprisoned until the issue is resolved. In extreme cases, particularly when crossing into hostile territories, imprisonment could result in political hostage situations.

In summary, the **validation of ownership** and **inspection of ships** is an important and often complex part of traveling the skies. Ships larger than **Corvettes** will require detailed documentation, and failure to present proper ownership deeds can lead to confiscation, fines, or

even imprisonment. Governments may choose to honor or contest these deeds based on political relations, and the consequences of failing an inspection can be severe, especially if the ship hails from a rival or enemy nation. Travelers and sailors must always ensure their paperwork is in order and understand the nuances of international relations when embarking on journeys to distant ports.

Final Thoughts

Upgrading a vessel is a major decision that can significantly impact a ship's capabilities, its role in the world, and the resources required to keep it operational. While the cost of upgrading increases with size, the potential for more powerful, versatile, and customized ships is a tempting proposition for ship captains looking to make their mark in the dangerous and ever-competitive skies. However, the shipyard's size and available resources must always be considered before undertaking such a grand project.

Crew Requirements and Supply Usage for Airship Classes (Jetty to Dreadnought)

The crew size and supply usage for airships increase dramatically with the size of the ship. Each class requires specific crew members to maintain and operate the ship efficiently, depending on the type of propulsion system, the purpose of the vessel, and the duties needed to manage everything from engines and sails to security and morale. Below is a detailed breakdown of crew requirements, supply usage, and travel costs for each level of vessel, starting from the **Jetty** (the smallest class) and scaling up to the **Dreadnought**.

1. Jetty (Small Boat with Cabin)

- **Crew Requirements:**
 - **1 Captain/Engineer:** Responsible for steering, engine management (typically a small steam or basic wind engine), and general ship maintenance. Can also handle cooking and minor maintenance tasks.
 - **1 Extra Crew Member (Optional):** If the ship is carrying cargo, an extra hand may be needed for loading/unloading or securing small goods.
- **Engine/Systems:**
 - **Engine Type:** Simple Wind or Steam Engine.
 - **Fuel Type:** Wind for sail-powered vessels or a small amount of coal or enchanted crystal for steam engines.
- **Supplies:**
 - **Food/Water:** 2 rations per person per day (1 week of supplies).

- **Fuel:** If steam-powered, 1 barrel of coal or 1 enchanted crystal can last for a week of travel.
 - **Travel Cost:**
 - Travel Range: 50 miles per day (assuming calm winds or minimal engine use).
 - **Daily Supply Cost:** 2 Gold per day (for food, water, and fuel).
-

2. Scutter (Small Light Vessel)

- **Crew Requirements:**
 - **1 Captain/Engineer:** Manages the steering, engine, and general maintenance.
 - **1-2 Additional Crew:** One for cargo handling and general maintenance; one for security and keeping the crew in line.
 - **1 Cook:** If extended travel is expected, a cook is necessary for feeding the crew.
 - **Engine/Systems:**
 - **Engine Type:** Steam or Etheric Engine.
 - **Fuel Type:** Coal (or Etheric Crystal for etheric engines); 1-2 barrels of coal or etheric crystals needed per week.
 - **Supplies:**
 - **Food/Water:** 3 rations per person per day (1 week of supplies for a crew of 3).
 - **Fuel:** 2 barrels of coal or etheric crystals.
 - **Travel Cost:**
 - Travel Range: 60 miles per day.
 - **Daily Supply Cost:** 5 Gold per day (food, water, fuel, and crew wages).
-

3. Corvette (Small Combat Vessel)

- **Crew Requirements:**
 - **1 Captain:** Responsible for navigation and combat.
 - **1 Engineer:** Manages engines, repairs, and fuel use.
 - **2 Gunners:** Operate basic cannons or ballistae.
 - **2-3 Crew Members:** Handle maintenance, loading, and unloading supplies.
 - **1 Cook:** Prepares food for the crew.
 - **1 Quartermaster:** Organizes supplies and rations, keeps track of equipment.
- **Engine/Systems:**
 - **Engine Type:** Etheric Engine or Steam Engine.
 - **Fuel Type:** 3-4 barrels of coal or etheric crystals per week.
- **Supplies:**
 - **Food/Water:** 4 rations per person per day (2 weeks of supplies for a crew of 7).

- **Fuel:** 4 barrels of coal or etheric crystals.
 - **Travel Cost:**
 - Travel Range: 80 miles per day.
 - **Daily Supply Cost:** 10 Gold per day (food, water, fuel, and crew wages).
-

4. Frigate (Medium Combat Vessel)

- **Crew Requirements:**
 - **1 Captain:** Oversees overall operations.
 - **1 Engineer:** Manages engine systems.
 - **3 Gunners:** Operate larger cannons or ballistae.
 - **3-4 Crew Members:** Handle maintenance, loading/unloading, or securing cargo.
 - **1 Cook:** Provides meals for the crew.
 - **1 Quartermaster:** Manages the stock of supplies.
 - **2 Lookouts:** Guard the ship's perimeter and watch for dangers.
 - **Engine/Systems:**
 - **Engine Type:** Etheric Engine, Steam Engine, or a combination.
 - **Fuel Type:** 4-6 barrels of coal or etheric crystals per week.
 - **Supplies:**
 - **Food/Water:** 6 rations per person per day (3 weeks of supplies for a crew of 12).
 - **Fuel:** 6 barrels of coal or etheric crystals.
 - **Travel Cost:**
 - Travel Range: 100 miles per day.
 - **Daily Supply Cost:** 20 Gold per day (food, water, fuel, and crew wages).
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5. Cruiser (Large Combat/Passenger Vessel)

- **Crew Requirements:**
 - **1 Captain:** Oversees all ship operations.
 - **2 Engineers:** Maintain engine systems, ensuring continuous propulsion.
 - **4 Gunners:** Operate advanced weaponry and cannons.
 - **4-5 Crew Members:** General maintenance, cargo loading, security.
 - **2 Cooks:** Provide meals for the entire crew.
 - **2 Quartermasters:** Manage supplies, equipment, and rations.
 - **2 Lookouts:** Watch for threats, both aerial and below.
- **Engine/Systems:**
 - **Engine Type:** Advanced Etheric or Hybrid Engines.
 - **Fuel Type:** 6-8 barrels of coal or etheric crystals per week.

- **Supplies:**
 - **Food/Water:** 8 rations per person per day (4 weeks of supplies for a crew of 20).
 - **Fuel:** 8 barrels of coal or etheric crystals.
 - **Travel Cost:**
 - Travel Range: 120 miles per day.
 - **Daily Supply Cost:** 35 Gold per day (food, water, fuel, and crew wages).
-

6. Liner (Luxury Passenger or Freight Vessel)

- **Crew Requirements:**
 - **1 Captain:** Oversees all operations.
 - **2 Engineers:** Maintain the ship's engines, ensure smooth travel.
 - **4 Gunners:** Provide security for passengers or cargo.
 - **6-7 Crew Members:** For maintenance, cargo handling, and passenger services.
 - **2 Cooks:** Meals for passengers and crew.
 - **3 Quartermasters:** Manage supplies, food, and cargo.
 - **3 Lookouts:** Watch for threats and navigate.
 - **2 Steward/Host:** Ensure passenger comfort.
 - **Engine/Systems:**
 - **Engine Type:** Hybrid Etheric Engines or Advanced Steam Engines.
 - **Fuel Type:** 8-10 barrels of coal or etheric crystals per week.
 - **Supplies:**
 - **Food/Water:** 10 rations per person per day (5 weeks of supplies for a crew of 30).
 - **Fuel:** 10 barrels of coal or etheric crystals.
 - **Travel Cost:**
 - Travel Range: 150 miles per day.
 - **Daily Supply Cost:** 50 Gold per day (food, water, fuel, and crew wages).
-

7. Destroyer (Heavy Combat Vessel)

- **Crew Requirements:**
 - **1 Captain:** In charge of overall strategy and ship operations.
 - **3 Engineers:** Maintain and upgrade multiple engine systems.
 - **6 Gunners:** Operate advanced combat weaponry.
 - **8-10 Crew Members:** Handle maintenance, combat prep, and cargo.
 - **4 Cooks:** Provide sufficient food for the entire crew.
 - **4 Quartermasters:** Manage provisions and ammunition.
 - **4 Lookouts:** Ensure security and clear navigation.

- **4 Marines:** Protect cargo, repel boarders.
 - **Engine/Systems:**
 - **Engine Type:** Advanced Etheric Engines or Steam-Etheric Hybrid Engines.
 - **Fuel Type:** 12-14 barrels of coal or etheric crystals per week.
 - **Supplies:**
 - **Food/Water:** 12 rations per person per day (6 weeks of supplies for a crew of 40).
 - **Fuel:** 12 barrels of coal or etheric crystals.
 - **Travel Cost:**
 - Travel Range: 180 miles per day.
 - **Daily Supply Cost:** 70 Gold per day (food, water, fuel, and crew wages).
-

8. Galleon (Massive Merchant or Combat Vessel)

- **Crew Requirements:**
 - **1 Captain:** Oversees all operations, including diplomacy and combat.
 - **3 Engineers:** Manage multiple engine systems and repairs.
 - **8 Gunners:** Operate heavy weaponry.
 - **12-15 Crew Members:** Handle cargo, maintenance, and repairs.
 - **6 Cooks:** Provide meals for the large crew.
 - **6 Quartermasters:** Manage the vast stores of food, fuel, and supplies.
 - **6 Lookouts:** Guard and assist in navigation.
 - **6 Marines:** Protect cargo and defend against attacks.
 - **Engine/Systems:**
 - **Engine Type:** Advanced Etheric Engines or Steam-Etheric Hybrid Engines.
 - **Fuel Type:** 16-18 barrels of coal or etheric crystals per week.
 - **Supplies:**
 - **Food/Water:** 15 rations per person per day (8 weeks of supplies for a crew of 60).
 - **Fuel:** 16 barrels of coal or etheric crystals.
 - **Travel Cost:**
 - Travel Range: 200 miles per day.
 - **Daily Supply Cost:** 100 Gold per day (food, water, fuel, and crew wages).
-

9. Battleship (Massive War Vessel)

- **Crew Requirements:**
 - **1 Captain:** Oversees operations and makes strategic decisions.
 - **4 Engineers:** Responsible for maintaining all power and engine systems.
 - **10 Gunners:** Operate heavy artillery and magical weapons.

- **20-30 Crew Members:** Handle repairs, maintenance, and general labor.
 - **8 Cooks:** Maintain a well-fed crew.
 - **8 Quartermasters:** Manage supplies, munitions, and repairs.
 - **10 Lookouts:** Guard the vessel from both air and land-based threats.
 - **10 Marines:** Specialize in defense, boarding actions, and cargo protection.
 - **Engine/Systems:**
 - **Engine Type:** Hybrid Etheric or Steam Engines.
 - **Fuel Type:** 20-22 barrels of coal or etheric crystals per week.
 - **Supplies:**
 - **Food/Water:** 20 rations per person per day (10 weeks of supplies for a crew of 80).
 - **Fuel:** 20 barrels of coal or etheric crystals.
 - **Travel Cost:**
 - **Travel Range:** 250 miles per day.
 - **Daily Supply Cost:** 150 Gold per day (food, water, fuel, and crew wages).
-

10. Dreadnought (Colossal Warship)

- **Crew Requirements:**
 - **1 Captain:** In charge of the entire operation, strategic and tactical command.
 - **5 Engineers:** Handle maintenance of multiple propulsion systems, shields, and engines.
 - **15 Gunners:** Operate the most powerful weapon systems known.
 - **40-50 Crew Members:** Perform general duties, maintenance, cargo handling, and repairs.
 - **12 Cooks:** Serve food for the massive crew.
 - **12 Quartermasters:** Organize and track all supplies.
 - **15 Lookouts:** Ensure the safety and navigation of the ship.
 - **15 Marines:** Defend the vessel from all threats.
- **Engine/Systems:**
 - **Engine Type:** Cutting-edge Etheric or Arcane-Infused Steam Engines.
 - **Fuel Type:** 30-40 barrels of coal or etheric crystals per week.
- **Supplies:**
 - **Food/Water:** 30 rations per person per day (12 weeks of supplies for a crew of 120).
 - **Fuel:** 30 barrels of coal or etheric crystals.
- **Travel Cost:**
 - **Travel Range:** 300 miles per day.
 - **Daily Supply Cost:** 250 Gold per day (food, water, fuel, and crew wages).

Conclusion

As a ship grows in size and complexity, so too do the crew requirements, supplies, and costs. Larger ships require a wider range of specialists to handle everything from engine systems and combat readiness to basic cargo loading and morale management. Understanding these needs is critical when managing a fleet or embarking on long journeys across the dangerous sky world.

Challenge Roles for Weekly Travel on a Ship

Managing a ship, especially during extended travel through the sky, requires the party to balance crew duties, navigation, maintenance, and morale. Below is a table outlining different **Challenge Roles** that the party must manage each week, along with **disadvantages** for failure in each role.

It should be noted that these roles are only required if the ship is more than 50% NPC crew

Role	Description	Skill Check	D C	Disadvantages of Failure
Captain's Command	The Captain ensures proper navigation, orders, and general leadership. Oversees overall operations and crew morale.	Persuasion (Charisma)	15	If failed: Disorganization, morale loss (-1 to all crew-based rolls for the week), and potentially hostile interactions with crew.
Engineer Maintenance	The Engineer maintains the ship's engines (steam, etheric, or sails). Ensures propulsion and fuel usage are optimized.	Arcana/Mechanics (Intelligence)	15	If failed: Minor engine malfunction or inefficiency, leading to reduced speed (-10% speed for the week) and potential fuel waste.

Navigator's Course	The Navigator ensures proper heading and charts the course, avoiding hazards or off-course deviations.	Survival/Navigation (Wisdom)	12	If failed: Ship goes off-course, risking a detour or collision with environmental hazards, adding +2 days to the journey time.
Quartermaster's Supplies	The Quartermaster manages food, water, and cargo storage, keeping the crew supplied for the journey.	Investigation (Intelligence)	14	If failed: Shortage of or mismanaged provisions (1 ration less per person per day), leading to possible starvation, malnutrition, or low morale.
Cook's Nutrition	The Cook ensures that meals are prepared and provide proper nutrition for the crew's health and energy.	Cook's Tools (Dexterity/Intelligence)	13	If failed: Poor quality food, leading to upset stomachs and possible disease outbreaks, reducing morale (-1 to morale and crew rolls).
Morale Management	The party must keep spirits high and ensure that the crew remains disciplined and motivated.	Performance/Charisma	12	If failed: Crew morale declines, resulting in mutiny risk, or at best, reduced efficiency (-1 to all checks for the week).
Repair and Maintenance	The crew must maintain ship structure, fixing minor damage and ensuring the ship	Smith's Tools/Carpentry (Dexterity)	14	If failed: Minor damage becomes severe, reducing ship durability-1 Php and increasing vulnerability in case of combat or hazards.

remains in good condition.

Cargo & Freight (Optional)	The Crew handles loading/unloading cargo, ensuring proper storage, and avoiding loss or damage.	Athletics/Strength (Strength)	12	If failed: Cargo mismanagement, loss, or damage (e.g., 10% cargo loss or unbalanced loading leading to reduced maneuverability).
Ship's Security Watch management or Harbor security	The crew must be vigilant for potential hazards or attempts at sabotage or boarding. Ensuring the ship's integrity.	Perception (Wisdom)	15	If failed: Possible Sabotage attempts or boarding by hostile creatures, leading to possible combat or theft, increasing danger or damage.
Crew Discipline	Ensuring the crew remains in line, and minor conflicts do not escalate into bigger problems.	Intimidation/Insight (Charisma)	15	If failed: Crew members start fighting, stealing, or breaking the ship's code of conduct, leading to chaotic behavior (-1 to morale and all checks).

Disadvantages of Failure:

- **Morale Impact:** A recurring issue in several roles is morale. Failure in any critical role may lead to decreased morale, causing crew inefficiency or unrest. This can lead to penalties on all checks, from navigation to combat, and even cause outright mutiny if ignored.
- **Delays:** Failure in navigation or cargo management can result in time wasted. An off-course route or disorganization can increase travel time by days or force the ship into dangerous areas, leading to further encounters.

- **Supplies:** Failure to monitor food, water, and other supplies can lead to shortages, malnutrition, or even disease outbreaks. Crew members suffering from hunger or illness may not perform as expected, and certain conditions could lower their effectiveness.
- **Ship Integrity:** Failing in maintenance or engine checks can result in system malfunctions or damage. This reduces the ship's ability to travel effectively and may leave it vulnerable to further damage or environmental hazards.
- **Combat Readiness:** Security failures or poor weather tracking can expose the ship to hostile creatures or pirates, which can cause significant damage or casualties. This could also result in delays or losses in resources.

Crew Morale Effects on Ship Performance

Crew morale plays a critical role in ensuring the smooth operation of a vessel, especially on long journeys in a harsh and competitive sky world. The following table outlines the effects of **low crew morale**, as well as **positive bonuses** at higher morale levels. As morale decreases, the crew becomes less efficient and more difficult to manage. At extreme low morale, rebellion or mutiny may occur.

Morale Level	Bonus/Effect	Ship Performance Impact
+10	Highly Positive Morale	- Crew works at peak efficiency. - +2 to all crew-related rolls (navigation, repairs, cooking, etc.).
+5	Good Morale	- Crew is cooperative and motivated. - +1 to crew-related rolls. - Slightly higher efficiency in tasks.
0	Neutral Morale	- Standard performance, no bonuses or penalties. - No impact on ship's travel or performance.

-1 to -4	Slightly Negative Morale	- Minor discontent with a few crew members. - -1 to all crew-related rolls. - Slight delays or mistakes.
-5 to -9	Low Morale	- Growing discontent, crew feels overworked. - -2 to all crew-related rolls. - Minor sabotages may occur.
-10 to -14	Very Low Morale	- Discontent spreads to most of the crew. - -3 to all crew-related rolls. - Increased chance of mutiny.
-15 to -19	Severely Low Morale	- Crew feels neglected and oppressed. - -4 to all crew-related rolls. - Increased chances of open rebellion.
-20	Mutinous Morale	- Total collapse in morale. - -5 to all crew-related rolls. - Mutiny occurs unless immediate action is taken.

Detailed Effects of Low Morale

- **+10 Morale (Highly Positive)**

Ship Performance: At this level, the crew is deeply committed to their work. Tasks are completed quickly and efficiently, and there's a strong sense of camaraderie. The captain's orders are followed eagerly, and any special requests for repairs, navigation, or morale boosting are handled with enthusiasm.

Bonuses:

- +2 to all crew-related skill checks (repairs, navigation, cooking, etc.).
- Increased speed in reaching destinations (up to +10% travel speed).
- Crew shows initiative in looking after the ship and improving efficiency.

- **+5 Morale (Good)**

Ship Performance: The crew is in good spirits. While they are still motivated and cooperative, they aren't as proactive as at +10 morale. They are working well together but will need some direction.

Bonuses:

- +1 to all crew-related rolls.
- Efficient work, with minimal delays in daily operations.
- No noticeable problems with ship efficiency or maintenance.

- **0 Morale (Neutral)**

Ship Performance: No noticeable improvement or decline. The crew simply does the bare minimum required. They're not unhappy, but they aren't particularly motivated either.

Penalties:

- No bonuses or penalties.
- Standard efficiency.

- **-1 to -4 Morale (Slightly Negative)**

Ship Performance: There are a few disgruntled crew members, though the issues are minor. The crew may grumble about workload or conditions but still complete their tasks. The captain may need to reassure them occasionally.

Penalties:

- -1 to all crew-related rolls (navigation, repairs, cooking, etc.).
- Small mistakes and delays in operations, though they don't heavily affect the overall journey.
- Increased fatigue or minor complaints among crew members.

- **-5 to -9 Morale (Low)**

Ship Performance: Crew morale is noticeably low. Tensions are high, and efficiency suffers. There is frequent grumbling, and tasks may take longer to complete. Some crew members might sabotage or neglect minor tasks.

Penalties:

- -2 to all crew-related rolls.

- Minor sabotage may occur, like leaving repairs incomplete, not following instructions properly, or wasting resources.
- Increased likelihood of food or water shortages.
- Decreased speed and efficiency, leading to longer travel times.
- **-10 to -14 Morale (Very Low)**

Ship Performance: Morale has deteriorated significantly. The crew is actively dissatisfied with their work and begins to question the captain's leadership. There is a strong chance that mutiny or rebellion could occur, especially if not addressed.

Penalties:

 - -3 to all crew-related rolls.
 - Increased chances of sabotage and even open rebellion from a portion of the crew.
 - Crew may refuse orders, leading to significant delays or mistakes.
 - Some crew members might openly refuse to participate in duties (e.g., refuse to cook, man the engines, or repair damage).
 - Discipline becomes difficult to maintain.
- **-15 to -19 Morale (Severely Low)**

Ship Performance: At this point, the ship is in disarray. The majority of the crew is either openly rebelling or near rebellion. The captain's authority is severely undermined, and there's a real risk of mutiny or outright insubordination.

Penalties:

 - -4 to all crew-related rolls.
 - Increased chances of open rebellion, sabotage, or theft of supplies.
 - Multiple crew members may openly defy the captain, potentially leading to factions forming within the crew.
 - Discipline and morale have broken down entirely, making it very difficult to keep the ship running smoothly.
 - Food and water may be hoarded, leading to scarcity.
 - There is a serious risk of the crew leaving or abandoning ship.
- **-20 Morale (Mutinous)**

Ship Performance: Crew morale has fallen to rock bottom. At this level, mutiny is imminent if not immediately addressed. The crew refuses to follow orders and may take hostile actions against the captain and senior officers.

Penalties:

 - -5 to all crew-related rolls.
 - **Mutiny:** Crew members attempt to take over the ship. The captain must either fight back or negotiate with the mutineers, or they risk losing control of the ship entirely.
 - **Total breakdown** of ship discipline and control. Critical systems like engines or sails may be sabotaged.

- The captain is at great risk of being overthrown, imprisoned, or even killed by the mutineers.
-

Managing Morale

- **Positive Morale Solutions:**
 - Regular positive interactions with the crew (charisma-based checks).
 - Providing better pay, rewards, or luxury items for crew members.
 - Recognizing crew achievements and promoting a sense of community.
 - Offering rest periods or breaks during longer voyages.
- **Negative Morale Solutions:**
 - Increase interaction with crew members to listen to their grievances.
 - Address issues quickly (e.g., improve food or water supply, reduce workload).
 - Use intimidation or disciplinary actions to keep order in extreme cases.
 - Take steps to address specific causes of dissatisfaction, such as overcrowding, lack of supplies, or poor leadership.

Morale management is crucial for maintaining the success of any ship on a journey. If left unchecked, low morale can derail the mission, waste resources, and even lead to the complete failure of the voyage.

AIRSHIP CORES

1. Dwarven Airship Core

General Description:

Dwarven airship cores are compact, robust, and built for reliability. These cores are typically constructed from sturdy metals, enchanted crystals, and intricate mechanical systems. A Dwarven core uses a combination of geothermal or elemental magic and advanced craftsmanship to generate lift and thrust.

Shape and Size:

The core takes the form of a thick, cylindrical chamber with mechanical appendages protruding from the sides, designed for structural reinforcement. Dwarven cores are often large, heavy, and solid, ranging from a size that can float a small airship to massive structures that can lift a towering fortress.

Methods of Manufacture:

Dwarven airship cores are forged in massive foundries using a combination of arcane and smithing techniques. They require skilled blacksmiths, artificers, and enchanter to imbue the

core with elemental magic. The crafting process is intensive, requiring both natural and synthetic resources, such as magical ores, fire-infused crystals, and enchanted molten metals.

Cost:

Dwarven cores are expensive due to the high cost of the materials involved and the extensive labor required. They are often crafted in dwarven strongholds or guild halls, with prices ranging from a few thousand gold for a smaller, personal ship core to tens of thousands for larger, industrial-sized cores.

Core Functionality:

The core operates by generating powerful bursts of heat and elemental force through controlled combustion and fire magic, creating lift and thrust through heated air or fire-driven propellers. This makes the core reliable, durable, and long-lasting, but it is less nimble than others.

How it Varies in Size:

For smaller ships, Dwarven cores are compact, powerful, and ideal for stability. For larger airships or dreadnoughts, multiple cores are often combined to create a larger, interconnected system capable of carrying vast amounts of cargo or even entire castles. These cores produce consistent, constant power and are designed for long-term, heavy-duty use.

Elven Airship Core

General Description:

Elven airship cores are a marvel of elegance and magical purity, designed to be more than mere mechanical constructs—they are living, breathing entities that require an Elven operator to fully harness their potential. Unlike Dwarven, Dragonborn, and Gnomish cores, which can be operated by anyone with the proper understanding of mechanics or arcane practices, Elven cores are intrinsically attuned to the Elven race, and their magic can only be properly harnessed by an Elven operator who shares a deep, almost symbiotic connection with the core. This bond is not simply technical; it is spiritual and magical, and it requires the operator to be attuned to the Weave, the magical force that powers the core.

Shape and Size:

The Elven core itself is typically shaped like a crystal or gemstone, radiating an ethereal glow. It is smaller and more compact than the cores of other races, often spherical or faceted, resembling a precious gem embedded within the heart of the airship. The core is often encased in a delicate but intricately carved latticework of fine metals or enchanted wood, symbolizing the deep connection between nature and magic that the Elves cherish. These cores are often found within sleek, graceful airships that echo Elven architecture—lightweight, elegant, and designed for beauty as much as function.

Methods of Manufacture:

The creation of an Elven airship core is an art form as much as a technical achievement. It is crafted in a process that combines ancient Elven rites with the highest levels of arcane mastery. Skilled Elven enchanters and artisans gather rare materials from nature—crystal, wood, and metals imbued with elemental magic—then weave those components together through rituals that attune the core to the Weave itself. The process involves deeply attuning the core to the magic of the Elven operator, ensuring that only someone with the right connection to the core's magic can unlock its full potential. As such, the core is often seen as a sacred object, and only those of Elven descent or with the approval of the Elven people can operate it.

Cost:

Elven airship cores are incredibly expensive and difficult to obtain due to the rare materials used in their construction and the specialized enchantments required. Only the wealthiest individuals or organizations, or those with close ties to Elven enclaves, can afford to commission or purchase these cores. Prices for a basic Elven core start in the tens of thousands of gold, and can skyrocket depending on the size, intricacy, and intended use of the airship. However, their value is not just monetary—Elven cores are considered works of art and are highly revered for their beauty and craftsmanship.

Core Functionality:

Elven airship cores function through a unique blend of arcane magic and natural energy, drawing power from the Weave and channeling it through the core to create lift and propulsion. The core is not simply a source of energy; it is a conduit that requires the operator to actively channel their own magical essence through it. This means that only an Elven operator (or someone with deep magical training and attunement to the Weave) can properly control the ship. The operator must be in constant physical contact with the core to regulate the flow of magic and ensure the ship moves smoothly through the air. Without this connection, the core cannot function, making it impossible for anyone else to use the ship effectively.

How it Varies in Size:

Small Elven cores are used for personal airships or light vessels, where the bond between the operator and the core can be easily maintained. Larger cores, meant for grand airships or fleets, require the presence of multiple Elven operators to function, each attuned to the core in different ways to coordinate the ship's movement, defense, and energy use. These larger ships may require a fleet of Elven airships working in concert, their cores acting in harmony to power vast, floating cities or arcane fortresses. The more powerful the core, the more complex and intricate the required connection between the operator and the core, making it a highly specialized skill to command such ships.

Summary of Elven Airship Core Technology:

The Elven airship core is a unique and mystical creation that demands both magical expertise and a deep, personal connection between the operator and the ship. Unlike any other race's core, it cannot function without an Elven operator or someone who shares a profound bond with the core's magic. These cores are not only a technological marvel but a symbol of the Elven people's connection to the Weave, nature, and their ancient traditions. Although they offer unparalleled grace and maneuverability, they come with the requirement of specialized knowledge and are considered sacred objects, often only trusted to those of Elven descent.

Adversity for Non-Elven Operators of Elven Airship Cores

Elven airship cores are intrinsically attuned to the Elven race, relying on a deep connection with the Weave that is difficult—if not impossible—for non-Elves to replicate. While the core can function in a basic passive mode, without an Elven operator, controlling the full potential of the core requires immense effort, skill, and magical endurance. Here's a detailed breakdown of the challenges anyone not of Elven origin would face when attempting to operate and maintain an Elven airship core.

Challenges of Energy Flow and Management

The Elven core draws power from the Weave, and requires a constant and intricate balancing act of magical energy to function. For non-Elven operators, this balance is far more difficult to maintain, often leading to instability. The key aspects of this challenge include:

- 1. Magical Affinity to the Weave:**

The core is attuned to the Elven operator's natural affinity with the Weave, making it incredibly hard for non-Elves to establish the same level of control. This lack of attunement means the flow of magic within the core becomes difficult to regulate. Without an innate understanding of the subtle currents of the Weave, the core can easily go into flux, leading to inefficiencies, surges of power, or even total magical feedback.

- 2. Constant Magical Interaction:**

The core requires the operator to remain in direct magical contact with the system, managing the flow of energy, adjusting the magical currents, and preventing surges that could overload the core or cause it to go dormant. For non-Elves, this process requires constant focus and is incredibly draining. The operator must channel their own magical energy into the core to simulate the effect an Elven operator would naturally exert. Failure to maintain this flow can result in sudden loss of control, dangerous magical surges, or a complete shutdown of the core.

- 3. Energy Regulation and Synchronization:**

Non-Elves attempting to operate the core often find that the magical energy within the core fluctuates unexpectedly. In Elven hands, the energy flow is smooth, synchronized,

and nearly seamless. For outsiders, the flow might feel uneven or erratic, requiring them to constantly adjust their focus to prevent power surges or drops in energy. This can be mentally exhausting, particularly during extended flight.

Game Mechanics: Continued Core Operation for Non-Elven Operators

Operating an Elven airship core is challenging for non-Elves, and this difficulty can be represented through a series of **DC checks** (Difficulty Class checks) and **penalties for failure**.

Basic Passive Mode Operation (Floating Effect):

In a basic, passive state, the Elven core allows the ship to float gently in place without any propulsion. This requires minimal magical intervention, but the core is still prone to decay and requires periodic maintenance. This mode is only possible if the core is attended to every six hours to maintain the magical balance.

- **Passive Mode Maintenance Check:**

To maintain the floating effect, the operator must make a **DC 15 Arcana** check every six hours. This represents their ability to maintain the necessary magical connection to prevent a slow descent.

Failure: If the check fails, the core begins to lose its magical charge, and the ship starts to descend slowly. The descent is not immediate but can lead to a significant loss of altitude over time. This could result in crashes or dangerous landings if not addressed.

Continued Core Operation (Full Functionality):

When trying to actively control the core for flight, propulsion, or directional control, non-Elven operators face much greater adversity. These tasks require far more concentrated magical effort, and the complexity of the operation increases the difficulty of managing the core.

1. **Magical Coordination Check (Operational Energy Flow):**

The operator must regularly make an **Arcana check** to manage the core's energy flow and maintain propulsion. The DC for this check depends on the complexity of the operation:

- **Basic Operation (flight with no combat or heavy movement):** DC 18
- **Advanced Operation (maneuvering, combat flight, sudden changes in direction or altitude):** DC 22
- **Emergency Operation (stabilizing a failing core, averting magical feedback):** DC 25

2. *Failure:*

- **Failure by 5 or more:** The core destabilizes, causing a temporary loss of flight or sudden erratic movements in the ship, such as sudden drops or sharp rises, leading to possible damage to the ship or crew.
 - **Failure by 10 or more:** The core suffers a magical feedback surge, forcing the ship into an uncontrollable nosedive or causing the ship to momentarily shut down, making it incapable of moving for a brief period (1d4 rounds).
3. **Magical Fatigue Check (Exerting Magical Energy):**
As the operator must expend their own magical energy to keep the core operational, they must regularly make a **Constitution saving throw (DC 15)** to avoid magical fatigue.
Failure: If the saving throw fails, the operator suffers one level of exhaustion. Exhaustion can accumulate with prolonged failure to maintain the core, leading to debilitating effects on the operator's ability to continue operating the airship.
-

Negative Consequences for Failures

1. **Magical Overload:**

If the operator fails to regulate the magical flow properly, the core may experience a **magical overload**. This could lead to the following consequences:

- **Arcane Backlash:** A violent magical surge causes the ship to temporarily lose control. This results in **1d6 force damage to the ship** and a **DC 20 Dexterity saving throw** for the operator to avoid being injured by the backlash. Failure results in **2d10 force damage** and immediate loss of control.
- **Magical Burnout:** The operator suffers from **magical burnout**, a temporary or permanent loss of access to spellcasting abilities (if they are a spellcaster), or an inability to perform further checks with the core until a **long rest** is taken.

2. **Slow Descent:**

If the core is left in its passive floating mode but the operator fails to maintain it every six hours, the ship begins to slowly descend, losing 10 feet of altitude per hour. If the descent reaches abyss level, the ship may be severely damaged, resulting in a crash dive.

Critical Failure:

A series of failed checks or inability to maintain the core can result in a **critical failure**, where the core completely deactivates, and the ship plummets to the ground. This would require **immediate repairs** or a rescue operation to avoid catastrophic failure.

Conclusion

The Elven airship core is a complex and delicate system, one that requires the magical affinity of an Elven operator to function optimally. While the core can be coaxed into a passive floating

mode by non-Elven operators, this still requires regular checks and maintenance. The core's full functionality—flight, propulsion, and maneuvering—demands constant magical management, and the inability to maintain the core properly can result in instability, descent, or even catastrophic failure. Non-Elves who attempt to operate the core face significant challenges, from magical instability to the risk of exhaustion or burnout, making it an incredibly difficult undertaking without Elven involvement.

3. Dragonborn Airship Core

General Description:

Dragonborn airship cores are designed to be powerful, forceful, and majestic, mirroring their draconic heritage. These cores often incorporate dragon's breath elements—primarily fire or lightning—along with deep elemental magic. The Dragonborn's innate connection to elemental forces gives their cores immense potency.

Shape and Size:

Typically designed as large, hexagonal or octagonal-shaped cores, these are adorned with dragon motifs or scales. Dragonborn cores are larger than Elven or Dwarven cores, often encased in draconic metal, making them durable and highly resistant to damage.

Methods of Manufacture:

The manufacturing process for Dragonborn airship cores involves forging special draconic metals and using the essence of dragons themselves—often in the form of breath gems or enchanted scales. Rituals are performed to bind elemental forces, and the process often involves ancient dragon runes to ensure the proper functioning of the core.

Cost:

Dragonborn cores are extremely costly due to the rare materials involved and the dangerous rituals required for their construction. A small core might cost as much as an Elven core, but larger cores—capable of lifting heavy-duty ships—can easily cost tens of thousands of gold due to the rarified nature of dragonblood magic.

Core Functionality:

Dragonborn cores use intense elemental breath magic to power their vessels, with either fire or lightning magic providing lift and thrust. They function through a controlled release of raw, destructive power, creating propulsive forces or lift through explosive force channels. The core is a powerful engine that makes the ship a formidable force in battle or transportation.

How it Varies in Size:

Small Dragonborn airship cores are capable of lifting lighter, more agile ships, while larger cores can create massive vessels capable of flying through harsh conditions, including air dreadnoughts or warships. Larger cores tap into the raw essence of the dragons themselves, enabling the lifting of vast amounts of weight, including entire mountains of material or massive structures like fortresses.

4. Gnomish Airship Core**General Description:**

Gnomish airship cores are a mix of technological ingenuity and magical experimentation. These cores often combine clockwork mechanisms with arcane runes, creating systems that are highly customizable and versatile. Gnomes approach airship propulsion with a focus on precision and innovation.

Shape and Size:

The core is often spherical or boxy, small enough to be carried by a single individual. These cores contain a network of gears, levers, and crystals that allow for fine-tuned control of the ship's movement. Gnomish cores are often compact and intricately designed to be efficient yet adaptable.

Methods of Manufacture:

Gnomish airship cores are created through a mix of mechanical engineering and magical circuitry. Rare metals, crystals, and clockwork components are used to form the internal machinery, which is then enchanted to regulate the arcane flow. The process often involves trial and error, with each core slightly different from the next, due to the constant innovation and refinement by gnomish engineers.

Cost:

While more affordable than the other races' cores due to their mechanical nature, Gnomish cores still carry a hefty price tag because of the complex design and constant adjustments needed. A personal core might cost a few thousand gold, but larger models capable of propelling heavier ships can run much higher.

Core Functionality:

Gnomish cores combine mechanical precision with arcane enhancement, generating lift and thrust through intricate mechanical systems powered by magic. These systems allow for very fine control over the ship, giving the crew the ability to make quick adjustments in movement and direction, often utilizing steam and compressed air for propulsion alongside magical energy.

How it Varies in Size:

Smaller Gnomish cores are ideal for nimble, lightweight ships, such as private airships or scouting vessels. Larger cores, integrated into more complex ships, are capable of lifting entire gnomish factories, clockwork cities, or massive experimental airships. Their versatility allows for varying amounts of cargo and weight, adjusting through mechanical design to suit different needs.

Human Airship Core**General Description:**

Human airship cores represent a crude but effective synthesis of Dwarven and Gnomish technologies. While they lack the elegance of Elven or the raw power of Dragonborn designs, and certainly don't exhibit the same ancient tradition or harmony as Dwarven or Elven cores, they make up for it in pragmatism and adaptability. Humans, ever resourceful and ambitious, have taken the hard-won techniques of the Dwarves and Gnomes and combined them with their own innovations, often resulting in cores that are reliable but less refined. These cores represent a "bastardization" of the more traditional designs, borrowing key concepts but often improvising with whatever materials and techniques are readily available.

Shape and Size:

The human-designed core tends to be bulky and patchwork, often taking on an industrial look with exposed gears, vents, and arcane conduits. Unlike the sleek, carefully crafted cores of the Dwarves or the intricate, harmonious designs of the Gnomes, the human cores often appear more utilitarian and hastily assembled, though still functional. They are typically cylindrical or rectangular in shape, though the designs are often varied based on the ingenuity of individual creators or the specific needs of the airship. Human cores can range from small enough to power personal vessels to larger versions capable of running sizable airships, though they are often considered less efficient than their Dwarven or Gnomish counterparts.

Methods of Manufacture:

Human cores are typically constructed in large, bustling workshops or makeshift factories, combining the engineering knowledge of the Gnomes with the heavy-duty craftsmanship of the Dwarves. The core is usually built from a combination of metal plates, gears, mechanical pistons, and magical crystals. The core's magical components, often gathered from existing enchanted items or scavenged materials, are then bound together with rudimentary enchantments that allow them to function as one. The process is faster and more haphazard than those of the more refined races, sometimes leading to inconsistencies in the power output and reliability. Still, they remain a feasible alternative for those without access to more intricate methods.

Cost:

Human cores are relatively affordable compared to those of the Dwarves or Gnomes, primarily due to the mass-production methods humans employ. The cost varies widely depending on the quality of the materials used and the skill of the artisan, but they are often the go-to choice for merchants, adventurers, and explorers looking for a functional yet cost-effective solution. A small human airship core might only cost a few hundred gold, with larger models costing a few thousand, depending on the ship size and the number of modifications made to the design.

Core Functionality:

Human airship cores combine the Dwarven reliance on physical force and mechanical systems with the Gnomish use of arcane power. These cores typically function through a combination of steam-powered pistons, arcane-infused gears, and the infusion of elemental magic. While they can generate enough power to propel a ship through the air, they are less efficient and more prone to mechanical failure than either Dwarven or Gnomish designs. Their versatility, however, allows them to be used in a wide range of airships, from simple merchant vessels to military ships. The core works by channeling magical energy into a series of mechanical pistons that generate lift and thrust. The result is a noisy, somewhat cumbersome system that is less graceful but often highly effective when it comes to sheer power.

How it Varies in Size:

Small human airship cores, powered by simple steam mechanisms and a small reservoir of elemental magic, are often used in personal ships or cargo vessels, offering a reliable but limited power source. For larger ships, human technology can combine multiple cores to create an interlocking system capable of supporting airships with a range of functions. These multi-core designs are often rudimentary but surprisingly effective, able to support everything from merchant fleets to warships. Human cores are capable of lifting entire battlecruisers or even small fortresses when combined with additional mechanisms or steam-powered boosters, though their efficiency is a constant concern. They also tend to consume more fuel and magical energy than other designs, requiring frequent refueling or maintenance to avoid failures.

Summary of Human Airship Core Technology:

While Human airship cores are certainly more "improvised" compared to the works of the Dwarves and Gnomes, they remain a testament to humanity's creativity and adaptability. Blending Dwarven mechanical strength with Gnomish ingenuity, humans have created a hybrid design that, while rough around the edges, is entirely functional and can compete with more advanced technologies in certain areas. The trade-off is typically reliability and efficiency, with humans often relying on sheer resourcefulness and innovation to keep their ships afloat—literally and figuratively.

Tracking a Ship: Core Rules

1. Determine the Tracking Method:

Select the primary method(s) for tracking. Each method has a specific **range**, **detection difficulty**, and **situational modifiers** as per the table above. Tracking may involve:

- Visual tracking (smoke cloud, glint/reflection, or cloud disruption)
- Magical tracking (ether trails, magical beacons, or elemental disturbances)
- Mechanical tracking (radar, sonar, or temperature differentials)

2. Set the Initial Detection Roll:

To begin tracking, roll the appropriate skill check for the chosen method:

- **Perception** (Visual, Sound, or Cloud Disruption)
- **Arcana** (Magical tracking like ether trails or elemental disturbances)
- **Investigation** (Using radar, sonar, or thermal sensors)

The DC is set by the detection method and adjusted by the modifiers in the table.

3. Roll for Distance and Conditions:

After detecting the ship, determine the following factors to maintain the track:

- **Distance:** Establish the initial distance to the target. Roll 1d10 to determine how far within the method's range the ship is detected (e.g., 1 = near maximum range, 10 = minimum range).
- **Visibility:** Apply weather, time of day, or other environmental modifiers to the tracking rolls.

4. Tracking Rolls (Every 10 Minutes of Pursuit):

Once detection begins, tracking rolls are made every 10 minutes of in-game time.

Tracking involves:

- Maintaining line of sight or detection through sensors or magic.
- Rolling against a **tracking DC**, which increases by **+2 for every mile the ship moves out of range** or **+3 if the ship uses evasive maneuvers or enters a stealth condition**.

5. Evasion by the Target Ship:

If the target ship takes deliberate actions to escape, the tracking DC increases. Target ship actions may include:

- **Evasive Maneuvers:** Add +2 to the tracking DC for each successful pilot roll (DC 12).
- **Using Cover (Clouds/Weather):** Add +5 to the tracking DC if the target ship enters dense clouds, fog, or a storm.
- **Magical Concealment:** If the ship uses magic such as invisibility or illusion, the tracker must make an **Arcana check (DC 15)** to maintain pursuit.

6. Roll Modifiers by Tracker Ship:

Ships equipped with specialized tracking tools or advanced magic receive bonuses:

- **+2 Bonus** for advanced radar, sonar, or magical sensors.
- **+3 Bonus** if the tracking ship has a trained mage or sensor operator.

- **Advantage** if multiple tracking methods are employed simultaneously (e.g., radar + ether trail detection).
-

Tracking Scenarios

Scenario 1: Smoke Cloud

- **Initial Detection:** Perception check (DC 10). Modifiers include weather, time of day, and wind conditions.
- **Tracking Rolls:** Every 10 minutes, roll Perception against DC 10, +1 for every mile the target moves or -2 if the wind disperses the smoke.

Scenario 2: Ether Trail

- **Initial Detection:** Arcana check (DC 12). Modifiers include the strength of the ship's ether output or interference from magic-dampened regions.
- **Tracking Rolls:** Roll Arcana every 10 minutes against DC 12, +2 for every mile the target moves out of range or -3 if it uses stealth runes.

Scenario 3: Radar/Sonar

- **Initial Detection:** Investigation check (DC 10). Modifiers include radar range (+5 for high-quality systems, -5 for magical interference).
 - **Tracking Rolls:** Roll Investigation every 10 minutes against DC 10, +1 for every mile the target moves or -3 if it enters dense clouds.
-

Advanced Tracking Rules

1. **Critical Success:**
A natural 20 on a tracking roll provides additional information about the target ship, such as heading, speed, and approximate size/type.
2. **Critical Failure:**
A natural 1 results in losing the trail entirely. The tracker must spend 1 hour to reacquire the trail and may only retry if using a different detection method.
3. **Prolonged Pursuit:**
For every hour of pursuit, add **+1 cumulative DC** due to fatigue, equipment strain, or environmental interference.

4. **Simultaneous Detection (Teamwork):**

If multiple allied ships or trackers are involved, each tracker can roll independently. Successes allow **one reroll per failure** if a tracker loses the trail.

5. **Ship Stealth Bonuses:**

Stealth-equipped ships (e.g., those using anti-detection wards or cloaking magic) impose disadvantage on tracking rolls unless the tracker uses a countermeasure (e.g., arcane counter-sensors).

Tracking Outcomes

1. **Maintaining Track:**

If tracking rolls succeed consistently, the tracker gains periodic updates on the target's location and heading.

2. **Losing the Trail:**

If two consecutive tracking rolls fail, the trail is lost unless the tracker uses advanced magic or equipment to reacquire it.

3. **Interception:**

If the tracking party successfully maintains pursuit and closes within 1 mile of the target, they can attempt interception rolls (Pilot check vs. Target Pilot check) to engage or board the ship.

The Chase Over the Culverin and Skysea

An Elven Military Officer's Story

Captain Elion of the *Dawnrider* stood at the prow, eyes fixed on the horizon where the storm clouds of the Culverin and Skysea met. He hadn't said much since they left Tilverid Island two hours ago, but I could feel the weight of his thoughts, like the looming thunderheads. His gaze was distant, focused, as always, on the mission. And the mission was simple: capture or destroy the human vessel, the *Chameleon*, before it reached Morrison Lookout.

I, Lieutenant Taelis, an officer of the Elven Skyguard, had been tasked with leading our tracking efforts. And I had tracked ships before. But this was different. The humans we pursued were unlike any adversary we had faced. They were cunning, and their methods—unpredictable.

The *Chameleon* was no ordinary human vessel. Its crew was skilled in the art of evasion. The humans, though outmatched in speed, had a craftiness born of necessity. Their ship moved like a

shadow in the clouds, using the very weather itself as a shield. In our position, high above the sea and clouds, we should have had the upper hand. But that advantage felt more and more like a lie the further we chased.

My crew and I had been studying their movements since the moment we spotted their thin smoke trail across the sea. I couldn't help but admire their ingenuity. They were masters of hiding, slipping between the layers of mist and fog banks, sometimes invisible for hours.

I turned to Captain lion, who was silently watching the shifting fog ahead of us.

"Captain," I began, "they're clever. They're using the currents, the clouds...everything they have. They know how to hide."

lion didn't answer at first, his focus on the dense cloud cover swirling beneath us. Then, his voice came, low and sure, like the calm before a storm.

"We know they're out here, Taelis. They have nowhere to hide for long. They can only choose to either outrun us... or outgun us. But in the end, they know the sky belongs to us."

I nodded, understanding his words. The Elven vessels were faster, more agile in the sky. But the humans had learned to use the elements to their advantage in ways we hadn't anticipated. Even so, their options were running out.

We had pushed the *Chameleon* into a corner.

The thick fogs between us had begun to shift. The currents were changing, the winds picking up, creating an unsettling tension in the air. I had to make a choice for my team—whether to close the distance or continue to track them slowly, watching for their next move. But the humans had already made their choice.

"Captain!" I called to lion, "They've split. They're going deeper into the clouds—into the fog banks."

lion's eyes narrowed as he surveyed the ship's instruments.

"They'll slow down in there, but they're going to try and use the shifting currents to get ahead of us. That's the only way they can escape us... or they'll try to outrun us."

I looked over at the captain. He had made up his mind.

"Then we let them," he said with an eerie calmness. "We're going to give them the illusion of escape."

The *Dawnrider* veered slightly, skimming the edge of the cloud cover. We knew that if we pressed too hard, the humans would likely break from the fog and outmaneuver us, gaining distance. But if we stayed behind just enough, forcing them to push their ship through the dense cloud banks, they would slow down. It was a gamble, but it was the only choice we had left.

We waited. The fog wrapped itself around us, thickening with every passing minute. My crew worked in silence, scanning the skies for any sign of the human ship. We knew it was close, but we had no visual. No trail of smoke, no etheric disturbance. Just the quiet howl of wind through the mist.

Our sensors couldn't penetrate this. The clouds had become magically dense, far denser than we had expected, preventing even the most refined arcane tracking spells from reaching through. This was where the humans had the advantage.

I stood at the edge of the ship, my eyes searching the white nothingness. A sense of unease crept into me. Had they gotten away? Were they already miles ahead?

But then, as if the clouds themselves had parted just for me, I saw it—a faint shimmer in the distance. The *Chameleon*, using its arcane cloaking and weather manipulation, had revealed itself for just a moment. And in that instant, I knew.

"They're trying to outrun us," I said softly. "They're not staying low. They're pushing ahead."

lion's expression didn't change. "Then we'll force them into a choice. They can't go back now."

We had them now. The *Chameleon* was fast, but their desperation was clear. The fog was both a shield and a prison. They could either stay low and risk being slowed down, or they could break free and run—into our waiting guns.

The clouds began to dissipate slightly, and in the break, we saw them—a flash of dark metal, glistening against the sunlight. The *Chameleon* had pushed to full speed, but they couldn't break through the fog quick enough. The distance between us had closed to half a mile.

"Now, Taelis," lion commanded.

I gave the signal, and our engines roared to life. The *Dawnrider* surged forward, cutting through the fog like a blade. We had them cornered.

The *Chameleon* broke free from the clouds, trying to surge ahead, but it was too late. We were already in range.

“Fire when ready,” lion said.

The first volley of energy bolts shot forward, tearing through the mist and slamming into the *Chameleon's* sails, The humans fought back valiantly, but their speed was no longer an advantage. The gamble had failed.

lion’s voice rang out, cold and unyielding: “It’s over. You’ve nowhere to go.” Matched by the continuous ringing of our ships bell.

The human ship, caught between the choice of fighting or fleeing, had lost. They had pushed themselves too far into the clouds. They've never had a way to outrun our ships and they had been caught in the clear. Not wanting to risk further open conflict they surrendered.

The *Chameleon* was brought low, its sails torn. The crew had surrendered, knowing full well that they had no hope left. We had forced them into a decision, and in the end, the power of the Elven Skyguard had proven too much. A more ruthless captain might have tried the battle to fight his way out... Luckily they hadn't pushed their luck.

As we moved in to board, I glanced back at the captain, whose gaze remained fixed on the human ship. He said nothing, but I knew what he was thinking. They had made their choice, and it had led to this. For the *Dawnrider*, it was just another day’s work. But for the humans, it was the end of their game, One more batch of smugglers captured. Their ship easily had double our crew when we boarded them, it could have been a hard fight. But their captain had wisely decided to surrender after the first volley rather than risk another diplomatic incident or being sent into the abyss below.

And in the swirling mists of the Culverin and Skysea, we left another legend for the skies.

Abyss information

Challenges as Airship Cores Descend into the Abyss

The Abyss is a treacherous and shifting region of the sky that lies below the regular cloud layers, a chaotic expanse of magical instability, thick fogs, unpredictable winds, and oppressive darkness. As airships descend into the Abyss, the challenges they face grow more intense, particularly for their airship cores, which must deal with increasing magical interference, lack of natural energy flow, and mechanical stress. The deeper the ship descends, the more difficult it

becomes to maintain core operation and keep the ship afloat. Below, we'll explore the layers of the Abyss and the types of failures that arise at each stage.

Layer -1: Upper Abyss (Light Disturbance)

At this layer, the airship begins to feel the first signs of interference from the Abyss. The magical currents become somewhat erratic, but not yet overwhelmingly dangerous. There are pockets of instability in the air that could cause subtle turbulence, affecting the ship's movement. The airship core must adapt to these disturbances in energy flow to continue operating.

Challenges for Core Operation:

- **Magical Turbulence:** Small, localized magical surges disrupt the smooth flow of energy, requiring constant fine-tuning to keep the ship flying steadily.
- **Energy Fluctuations:** The magical flow within the core becomes erratic, causing inefficiency and power dips.

Required Checks:

1. **Magical Control (Arcana Check, DC 15):** Maintain a stable flow of energy through the core.
 - **Failure:** The core's energy surges or falters. The ship may lose 10 feet of altitude per hour.
 2. **Turbulence Adjustment (Dexterity or Acrobatics Check, DC 14):** Adjust course or stabilize movement through minor turbulence.
 - **Failure:** Loss of control for 1d4 rounds, causing a temporary drop or sharp rise.
-

Layer -2: Middle Abyss (Moderate Disturbance)

At this layer, the magical interference becomes stronger. The ship experiences heavy turbulence, violent winds, and an increasing inability to rely on natural elemental magic to maintain altitude. The magical energy flowing through the airship core becomes increasingly volatile, with occasional feedback and surges. Core operation demands constant, concentrated magical focus.

Challenges for Core Operation:

- **Magical Flux:** Unstable flows of magical energy within the core. The energy begins to vary greatly, and the core starts to pull from external sources to stabilize itself.

- **Increasing Air Resistance:** The air is denser with strange magical forces, requiring more energy to maintain lift.
- **Sudden Feedback:** The magical instability causes sudden bursts of magical power to surge through the system, requiring the operator to act quickly.

Required Checks:

1. **Magical Control (Arcana Check, DC 18):** Maintain steady energy flow, prevent magical feedback.
 - **Failure by 5 or more:** A sudden magical feedback causes the ship to drop 20 feet in a moment of instability.
 2. **Energy Synchronization (Constitution Saving Throw, DC 16):** Avoid magical fatigue due to increased strain from the core.
 - **Failure:** The operator suffers 1 level of exhaustion, impacting their ability to maintain focus and core operation.
 3. **Course Adjustment (Dexterity or Acrobatics Check, DC 17):** The turbulence requires constant steering adjustments.
 - **Failure:** Ship may roll or tilt wildly, causing a 1d6 damage to the hull from intense stress.
-

Layer -3: Lower Abyss (Strong Disturbance)

Descending further into the Abyss, the ship enters a region of extreme magical distortion. The core experiences significant power fluctuations, and maintaining flight becomes increasingly difficult. The environment is filled with thick fogs and dangerous magical lightning, making it challenging for non-Elven operators to control the ship.

Challenges for Core Operation:

- **Elemental Anomaly Fields:** Areas where elemental energy randomly shifts, disrupting the ship's magical propulsion and causing erratic movement.
- **Depletion of Magic:** The surrounding magical energy becomes sparse, and the core has to draw more heavily on the operator's energy reserves, leading to fatigue.
- **Magical Lightning Strikes:** Sudden bursts of magical lightning might strike the core, short-circuiting or damaging it.

Required Checks:

1. **Magical Power Management (Arcana Check, DC 20):** Ensure the core maintains a balanced magical flow despite interference.

- **Failure by 5 or more:** The ship begins to lose altitude at a rate of 30 feet per hour.
 - 2. **Magical Fatigue (Constitution Saving Throw, DC 18):** The operator must resist draining their magical energy due to the core's high power demands.
 - **Failure:** The operator suffers 1 level of exhaustion, plus an additional level every hour spent operating the core in this layer.
 - 3. **Damage Control (Investigation or Medicine Check, DC 18):** Repair any minor damage caused by magical lightning strikes or elemental anomalies.
 - **Failure:** Core suffers 2d6 damage, reducing its maximum power output by 10%.
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Layer -4: Deep Abyss (Extreme Disturbance)

The Deep Abyss is where the most severe magical disturbances occur. The air is thick with magical fog that interferes with perception, and the core experiences almost constant flux, requiring intense magical focus. The ship struggles to stay aloft, and energy control becomes a monumental task.

Challenges for Core Operation:

- **Total Magical Disruption:** The surrounding environment twists and corrupts magical energy. The airship core must continuously battle to stabilize itself, but the energy flow is dangerously unstable.
- **Magical Drain:** The core draws so much energy that it begins draining directly from the operator, causing severe physical and mental fatigue.
- **Persistent Lightning Storms:** The environment is constantly filled with magical lightning that targets the core. At times, it may strike the ship multiple times in a single round.

Required Checks:

1. **Magical Control (Arcana Check, DC 22):** Constantly stabilize the core and maintain an acceptable energy flow.
 - **Failure by 5 or more:** The ship begins a rapid descent, losing 40 feet per hour, and the operator suffers 1d10 psychic damage as the core struggles.
2. **Magical Drain (Constitution Saving Throw, DC 20):** Avoid magical burnout from the constant strain on the operator's own energy.
 - **Failure:** The operator suffers 2 levels of exhaustion, with their spellcasting abilities being significantly impaired.
3. **Core Shielding (Arcana or Engineering Check, DC 20):** Reinforce the magical barriers to protect the core from continuous lightning strikes.

- **Failure:** The core takes 4d6 damage, and its energy output is reduced by 20%. This requires repairs to resume normal operation.
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Layer -5: Deepest Abyss (Total Chaos)

At the deepest layer of the Abyss, the airship faces complete magical chaos. The very fabric of reality is unstable, and core operation becomes nearly impossible. The ship will likely be spiraling out of control, and maintaining any semblance of flight is a desperate task requiring unparalleled magical skill and endurance.

Challenges for Core Operation:

- **Total Magic Failure:** The core struggles to function at all, with energy surges, backfires, and total shutdowns being a regular occurrence. The operator must fight to prevent the core from failing entirely.
- **Extreme Physical and Mental Exhaustion:** The operator is pushed to their absolute limit. The overwhelming magical interference also makes it harder to repair the core when it breaks down.
- **Total Loss of Control:** The ship may be tossed around by uncontrollable magical currents, falling further into the Abyss.

Required Checks:

1. **Magical Maintenance (Arcana Check, DC 25):** Keep the core running despite total magical chaos, ensuring it doesn't shut down completely.
 - **Failure by 5 or more:** The core suffers total failure and powers down. The ship plummets into the Abyss.
2. **Magical and Physical Endurance (Constitution Saving Throw, DC 23):** Resist total exhaustion, both physically and magically.
 - **Failure:** The operator suffers 3 levels of exhaustion, and they are incapable of further action for 1d4 hours.
3. **Repairing the Core (Arcana or Engineering Check, DC 22):** Attempt to repair critical damage to the core.
 - **Failure:** The core suffers 6d6 damage, leaving it inoperable without a full overhaul, and the ship continues to fall.

Effects of the Abyss on Living Creatures

The Abyss is a perilous and hostile environment, with each descending layer becoming increasingly dangerous not only for airships but also for the living who venture into its depths.

The layers of the Abyss are defined by unique environmental hazards, magical disturbances, and physical ailments that affect all living creatures, including those aboard airships. These effects are caused by various miasmas, choking fogs, and strange magical phenomena that warp the natural world, disrupting both life forces and magical energies. Below is a breakdown of the effects each layer has on living creatures.

Layer -1: Light Abyss (Mild Magical Disturbance)

The Light Abyss is the first layer of descent into the Abyss. While not overwhelmingly dangerous, it marks the transition into a more unstable environment. The effects on living creatures here are subtle, but over time, they accumulate, and the threat is real.

Effects on Living Creatures:

- **Faint Magical Disturbance:**

The ambient magical energy in the Light Abyss is slightly erratic, creating a mild dissonance in spellcasting and magical abilities. All creatures with innate or external magical abilities (such as spellcasters, magical items, or creatures with magical powers) experience a slight **-1 penalty to all spellcasting rolls** and magical abilities. Spells may fizzle or manifest at reduced power, particularly if the caster is not attuned to the environment.

- **Choking Fog (Low Oxygen):**

The air is thick with a **choking, metallic fog**, which reduces oxygen levels and increases fatigue. This causes **1 level of exhaustion** for all creatures after **4 hours of exposure**. The fog doesn't immediately cause life-threatening harm, but it wears down endurance, making physical exertion more difficult over time.

- **Disorienting Illusions:**

The Light Abyss creates low-level visual and auditory distortions, causing confusion. Creatures must make a **DC 13 Wisdom saving throw** every 3 hours of exposure to avoid **mild hallucinations**. Failure results in **disadvantage on perception checks** for 1 hour.

Layer -1: Light Abyss (100 feet deep)

- **Depth:** The Light Abyss is the first and shallowest layer of the Abyss, spanning roughly **100 feet** beneath the normal cloud layers.
- **Environment:** The air is still breathable, but there is a **slight magical disturbance** in the environment. It's here that the first signs of the Abyss begin to appear: the fog is **thin**, metallic, and slightly oppressive. The layer is not immediately dangerous, but it begins to affect magical flows and endurance.

Layer -2: Middle Abyss (Moderate Magical Flux)

The Middle Abyss introduces more severe magical disturbances and a heavier atmosphere. The natural laws of magic become increasingly distorted, and the environment itself becomes more hostile. Creatures here suffer more noticeable symptoms of strain as the deeper layers approach.

Effects on Living Creatures:

- **Magical Flux (Erratic Magical Effects):**

The flux of magic in the Middle Abyss is stronger, and creatures feel a sense of the Weave shifting unpredictably. All creatures with magical abilities suffer a **-2 penalty to spellcasting rolls**, and spells cast have a **50% chance of misfiring** (casting unintended effects).

This can cause **wild surges of magic**, leading to random magical effects affecting the environment or creatures, such as suddenly manifesting elemental effects (fire, ice, etc.).

- **Dense, Acrid Fog (Reduced Visibility and Breathing):**

The fog here is not only metallic but also **acrid**—a mixture of magical toxins and corrosive air. All creatures exposed to this environment must make a **DC 14 Constitution saving throw** every 4 hours or gain **1 level of exhaustion**.

Those who fail the saving throw experience **disadvantage on Constitution-based checks**, and if they fail by 5 or more, they gain an additional level of exhaustion.

- **Magical Drain (Life Force Erosion):**

Prolonged exposure to the Middle Abyss begins to drain the life force of creatures, as the environment leeches magical energy. Non-magical creatures are not immune to the effects.

All creatures must make a **DC 15 Constitution saving throw** every 4 hours of exposure to prevent the **magical drain** from sapping their vitality.

- **Failure:** Creatures lose **1d4 hit points** and suffer **disadvantage on all attack rolls** until they take a long rest.

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Layer -2: Middle Abyss (200 feet deep)

- **Depth:** The Middle Abyss extends down **200 feet**, doubling the depth of the Light Abyss. The atmosphere is significantly thicker, and the fog becomes **more acrid and dense**, further decreasing visibility. The environment begins to feel more oppressive, as magical disturbances grow stronger.

Layer -3: Lower Abyss (Magical Decay and Toxic Air)

At this point, the magical disturbances become incredibly strong. The air is toxic, the environment is actively hostile, and living creatures are at risk of severe physical and magical deterioration. The Lower Abyss is a place where only the strongest can survive for extended periods without succumbing to its effects.

Effects on Living Creatures:

- **Magical Decay (Severe Disruption of Magic):**

The deeper you descend, the more erratic and decayed the Weave becomes. All magical abilities, spells, and magical effects suffer a **-3 penalty** to casting rolls. The chance of misfiring magic increases to **75%**.

Wild Magic Surges become a frequent occurrence, with each spellcasting attempting to break the rules of magic, sometimes catastrophically.

Additionally, creatures with innate magic suffer from **disruptive feedback** that may cause **psychic damage** or temporary magical disabilities.

- **Toxic Fog (Severe Oxygen Deprivation):**

The fog is now thick with **poisonous miasmas** that cause **severe respiratory distress**.

All creatures exposed to the fog must make a **DC 16 Constitution saving throw** every 2 hours or gain **1 level of exhaustion**.

Failure also causes **poisoned status** for 1 hour, where creatures suffer from **disadvantage on all ability checks and attack rolls**.

Creatures with a low Constitution modifier (or none) are at a much higher risk, suffering an additional level of exhaustion or direct **poison damage** over time.

- **Corrupted Magic Fields (Aetheric Distortion):**

The fabric of magic is beginning to **warp**. Creatures casting spells must make a **DC 15 Wisdom saving throw** to avoid being affected by **corruption of their magic**, causing the spells to backfire or cause unintended effects such as delayed casting, draining life energy, or damaging the caster themselves. This manifests as **psychic damage** equal to half the spell's level.

Layer -3: Lower Abyss (400 feet deep)

- **Depth:** The Lower Abyss plunges to a **depth of 400 feet**. At this level, the Abyss starts to feel more like a **vast, cavernous void**. The magical interference is very strong here, and the environment is filled with dense, **acidic fog** that is **poisonous**, creating dangerous and suffocating conditions. The atmosphere also feels crushing, with **increased atmospheric pressure**.

Layer -4: Deep Abyss (Magical Void and Crushing Atmospheric Pressure)

The Deep Abyss represents the true dangers of descending too far. The air is practically unbreathable, and the magical disturbances are extreme, causing instability that warps both life forces and the fabric of magic. All creatures here face existential threats from the environment itself.

Effects on Living Creatures:

- **Magical Void (Void-like Energy Depletion):**
Magic no longer flows naturally in this layer. Magic becomes increasingly **ineffective**, with a **-4 penalty to all magical abilities**, and spells have a **90% chance to fail** or manifest in dangerous, unintended ways (such as explosions, reversing spell effects, or draining life force from the caster).
Wild Magic Surges are constant and unpredictable, with a high chance of **catastrophic results**.
- **Crushing Atmospheric Pressure (Extreme Exhaustion):**
The atmospheric pressure in the Deep Abyss is so intense that it feels as though the very air is trying to crush those who breathe it. All creatures exposed to this environment must make a **DC 18 Constitution saving throw** every hour or suffer **1d6 bludgeoning damage** as their bodies are pushed to their limits.
 - **Failure:** Creatures gain **2 levels of exhaustion** per failed save, which significantly impacts their physical abilities and may cause death if accumulated over time.
- **Magical Rot (Gradual Decay of the Body):**
Magical and physical decay begins to set in. Creatures that fail a **DC 16 Constitution saving throw** every 4 hours suffer **1d4 necrotic damage** and their bodies slowly degrade. **Healing magic becomes ineffective** here, as it cannot overcome the natural decay caused by the environment.

Layer -4: Deep Abyss (800 feet deep)

- **Depth:** The Deep Abyss is now a **vast expanse of 800 feet deep**, and the very nature of the environment feels alien. The magical forces here are wild, chaotic, and increasingly uncontrollable. The air is no longer breathable for long periods, as the **atmosphere is thick with poisonous miasmas** that drain both life energy and magical essence.

Layer -5: Deepest Abyss (Absolute Chaos and Despair)

At the Deepest Abyss, all magic fails and the very laws of nature break down. This layer is the most inhospitable, where the air itself becomes a **suffocating, ethereal miasma** that tears apart the minds and bodies of all who enter. There is no survival here without extreme intervention or magical protection.

Effects on Living Creatures:

- **Magical Collapse (Void of Magic):**
Magic is entirely neutralized, as if the very Weave has torn. Creatures without magical protection suffer from **complete magical impotence**; spellcasters lose all abilities, and magic items stop working.
Aetheric Energy Drain: All creatures lose **1d6 hit points per hour** as the environment siphons their life force. **Regeneration and healing spells fail** in this layer.
- **Suffocating Miasma (Deathly Air):**
The air is saturated with **foul, suffocating miasma**. Creatures must make a **DC 20 Constitution saving throw** every hour or begin to suffocate. Those who fail gain **1 level of exhaustion** and take **2d6 poison damage**. Prolonged exposure leads to **suffocation**, causing the creature to drop to 0 hit points after 6 hours without fresh air.
- **Psychic Despair (Mind-Shattering Effects):**
The constant distortion of reality causes **hallucinations, nightmarish visions**, and **psychic damage** to all creatures. Anyone exposed to the Deepest Abyss must make a **DC 18 Wisdom saving throw** every hour or suffer **2d6 psychic damage** and gain **1 level of madness** (or temporary insanity), making it incredibly difficult to maintain any sense of reality.

Layer -5: Deepest Abyss (1,200 feet deep)

- **Depth:** The **Deepest Abyss** is the deepest and most dangerous layer, reaching a staggering **1,200 feet deep**. At this level, the Abyss is more than just a physical place—it's an **otherworldly realm** of total chaos. Time, space, and magic seem to break down entirely, and the environment is hostile in every conceivable way. The fog here is thick with the remnants of dead magic and the essence of despair.

Conclusion

The deeper one ventures into the Abyss, the more severe the physical and magical challenges become. From subtle exhaustion and minor hallucinations in the Light Abyss to complete magical nullification and psychic decay in the Deepest Abyss, the environment demands careful management, resilience, and, most importantly, constant vigilance. Each layer poses significant risks, requiring unique tactics and preparation to avoid death, madness, or complete failure.

The Infernal Core: The Abyss's Final Layer

If a ship or brave soul manages to survive the unimaginable perils of the Abyss and descends through the **Deep Abyss** (Layer -5), they will reach the **Infernal Core**—a realm of eternal chaos and destruction. The Infernal Core is not just the bottom of the Abyss; it is a world of its own, an unyielding cauldron of molten rock, churning magical energy, and suffocating despair. The rules for survival here are nearly impossible to abide by, as the environment itself is designed to repel all living beings and structures.

Description of the Infernal Core

Size and Scope

- The **Infernal Core** spans approximately **a mile in diameter**, surrounded by towering black walls of unbroken, swirling darkness from the Abyss above. The airspace is cluttered with volcanic plumes, embers, and cascading waves of fiery energy.
- At its center lies an endless, **molten lava sea**, dotted with constantly forming and collapsing volcanic islands that erupt without warning. The sea itself is infused with unholy magic, radiating heat and corrosive energy that makes prolonged exposure deadly.

Atmosphere

- The **air is eternally toxic**, filled with choking **ash, sulfur, and dense fumes** that can kill most creatures in seconds without extraordinary protection.
- The atmosphere is a swirling mass of shimmering heat waves, which distort vision and create **phantasmal mirages** that disorient the mind.
- A **pitch-black dome** of the Abyss above plunges the space into a lightless void, pierced only by the fiery red glow of the molten core below and the flashes of volcanic eruptions.

Terrain

- The molten sea churns with **endless waves of lava**, capable of melting most materials, even those enchanted for protection.
- Temporary volcanic islands rise and sink at random, each lasting anywhere from seconds to minutes before collapsing back into the molten depths in catastrophic explosions.

- Volcanic plumes constantly erupt, shooting **ash clouds**, **pyroclastic flows**, and **molten debris** high into the air, adding further chaos to navigation.
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Rules and Mechanics for the Infernal Core

Surviving or operating in the Infernal Core requires strict adherence to a complex set of rules. These rules govern the ship's functionality, magical interaction, and the crew's survival.

Survival Rules

1. Breathable Air

- **Check Frequency:** Every **minute**.
- **DC:** Constitution saving throw **DC 20** or take **3d10 poison damage** from the toxic air. Failure by 5 or more also inflicts **1 level of exhaustion**.
- **Mitigation:** Magical air purification (e.g., *Control Air and Water* spell or similar effects) reduces the DC to **15**.

2. Heat and Ash Damage

- **Check Frequency:** Every **5 minutes**.
- **DC:** Constitution saving throw **DC 25** to resist heat exhaustion and ash-laden air. Failure results in **4d10 fire damage** and **2d6 bludgeoning damage** from flying debris.
- **Mitigation:** Fire resistance halves fire damage; fire immunity negates it.

3. Lava Proximity

- Any creature or object within **30 feet** of the lava sea takes **6d10 fire damage** per round. Direct contact with the lava inflicts **10d10 fire damage** per round.
- Even enchanted materials risk **structural failure** from prolonged exposure; an **Arcana check DC 20** must be made every **10 minutes** to sustain magical protections.

4. Volcanic Eruptions

- Volcanic islands erupt randomly, creating **area-wide hazards**:
 - **Eruption Radius:** $1d6 \times 50$ feet.
 - **Effect:** Affected creatures or objects must succeed on a **Dexterity saving throw DC 22** or take **8d10 fire damage** and be knocked prone.
-

Magical and Ship Challenges

1. Magical Suppression

- The molten sea radiates an aura of **anti-magic** that disrupts all but the most potent spells.
 - Spells of 5th level or lower automatically fail.
 - Spells of 6th level or higher require a **DC 24 Arcana check** to succeed.
 - Passive magical enchantments on airships degrade quickly, requiring a **DC 18 Engineering check** every 8-hours to maintain functionality.

2. Power Drain

- The oppressive heat and magical disturbance drain power from cores:
 - **Dwarven Core:** Begins to overheat, requiring an **Arcana DC 25** check every **10 minutes** to regulate energy output.
 - **Elven Core:** Suffers from extreme feedback loops due to the chaotic environment, requiring **two separate Arcana DC 22 checks** every **5 minutes** to maintain basic functionality.
 - **Gnomish Core:** Risk of system meltdown increases; roll **1d20** every **10 minutes**. On a **1-5**, the core malfunctions, inflicting **10d10 force damage** to the ship.
 - **Dragonborn Core:** Fire-based enhancements function normally, but the chaotic magic risks backfiring. Roll **1d20** every **10 minutes**; on a **1-3**, the core unleashes a surge, dealing **5d10 fire damage** to the crew.

3. Navigation Hazards

- Navigating the Infernal Core requires constant skill and focus:
 - Piloting checks every **minute** at **DC 20** to avoid lava flows and debris.
 - Failure by 5 or more results in the ship colliding with lava or debris, taking **10d10 bludgeoning and fire damage**.

The Deep Abyss's Unique Magical Influence

The Infernal Core is not just a physical space but also an environment steeped in **unholy magic**:

- **Maddening Aura:** All creatures must succeed on a **Wisdom saving throw DC 18** every 8-hours or suffer **short-term madness**. Failure by 5 or more results in **long-term madness**.
- **Cursed Lava:** Lava from the Infernal Core can inflict **curses** on anyone who survives contact, making their very presence destabilize magic when they return to other realms.

Short-Term Madness Effects (Exposure to the Infernal Core)

Roll (1d10)	Madness Effect	Description
1	Paranoia	The character believes everyone around them is an enemy or trying to deceive them. They may lash out defensively at even friendly NPCs.
2	Compulsive Behavior	The character develops a compulsion, such as repeating certain actions or phrases. They are unable to stop or break the cycle.
3	Hallucinations (Auditory)	The character hears disturbing sounds, whispers, or voices. These auditory hallucinations may give them misinformation or be utterly nonsensical.
4	Nightmares	The character experiences vivid and disturbing dreams, waking in a cold sweat. The dreams feature their worst fears or unsettling visions.
5	Nausea and Dizziness	A sudden wave of nausea and dizziness overcomes the character. They may suffer penalties to perception or concentration for a short period.
6	Inexplicable Anger	The character suddenly becomes enraged at a specific target, friend or foe alike. This rage is uncontrolled and irrational.
7	Paralysis of Will	The character is struck by an overwhelming paralysis of action and thought. For a short time, they may be unable to move or take significant actions.

8	Intense Fear	The character experiences a deep and overwhelming fear of something minor or nonthreatening, such as a creature, object, or location. They may attempt to flee or hide.
9	Exhaustion	The character becomes intensely fatigued, suffering from extreme tiredness or dizziness. This impedes their movement speed and may cause disadvantage on checks.
10	Lucid Dreaming (Involuntary)	The character enters a semi-conscious state, and for a brief time, they can't distinguish between waking and dreaming. The boundaries of reality blur, and they may lose valuable time.

Long-Term Madness Effects (Exposure to the Infernal Core)

Roll (1d10)	Madness Effect	Description
1	Apathy	The character loses the drive to take action or care about anything. They may remain indifferent to danger, people, or their own well-being.
2	Delusional Beliefs	The character adopts a delusion or false belief about themselves, others, or the world. They might believe they are invincible, destined for greatness, or believe they are someone else entirely.
3	Phantom Pain	The character experiences constant, intense pain in a part of their body that is either uninjured or no longer there (phantom

limbs). This debilitating pain affects their ability to concentrate and function.

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|---|---|--|
| 4 | Insomnia | The character is unable to sleep for long periods, leading to chronic exhaustion. This results in disadvantage on skill checks, combat abilities, and decreased effectiveness. |
| 5 | Psychosis | The character begins to lose touch with reality entirely, frequently switching between delusions and moments of clarity. They might speak in riddles, talk to imaginary entities, or behave unpredictably. |
| 6 | Obsessive Compulsion | The character develops an intense obsession with something insignificant. They feel an uncontrollable urge to collect, touch, or focus on it, hindering their progress or social relationships. |
| 7 | Hallucinations (Visual and Auditory) | The character begins to see and hear things that do not exist, often linked to their greatest fears or deepest desires. These hallucinations may guide them towards dangerous choices or make them hesitant in combat. |
| 8 | Memory Loss | The character begins to forget parts of their past, including key events, relationships, and basic skills. This could lead to confusion or disorientation as they struggle to retain vital information. |
| 9 | Paranoia (Extreme) | The character becomes deeply paranoid, suspecting betrayal and conspiracy from everyone they encounter. They may isolate themselves, act aggressively toward allies, or betray their own team in a misguided attempt at self-preservation. |

10	Soul Corruption	The character's essence becomes tainted by the corrupting influence of the Infernal Core. They may slowly lose their humanity, turning into something darker or unrecognizable. This could lead to a descent into madness, becoming a servant of evil, or even a transformation into a demonic creature.
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Notes on Long-Term Madness:

- **Severity:** The effects of long-term madness are often irreversible, or at the very least, difficult to cure. They may require rare magic or specialized treatment to reverse or mitigate.
 - **Effects on Roleplay:** Characters suffering from long-term madness often experience significant roleplaying challenges, such as losing friends, failing missions, or succumbing to irrational fears. This could create compelling character arcs or potentially lead to tragedy.
 - **Cure:** A cure for long-term madness may involve complex rituals, healing magic, or time away from the infernal influence of the Infernal Core. However, in most cases, the damage done is permanent, especially if the character has been exposed for an extended period.
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The Infernal Core's Eternal Mystery

The Infernal Core is thought to be the **origin point** of the Abyss, a place where the natural and magical worlds converge in a chaotic, destructive nexus. Some believe it holds the remains of an ancient battle between gods, while others speculate it is a **primordial scar** left over from the creation of the world. Whatever its origins.

The Insanity of the Infernal Core: A Descent into Death

The **Infernal Core** is a destination no sane or living soul would willingly seek. It is not merely the bottom of the Abyss but a crucible of **inevitable destruction**, where only the truly desperate, the irreparably broken, or the terminally doomed dare to tread. The stories of those who have reached the Infernal Core are not tales of triumph or heroism—they are whispered warnings, grim recountings of despair and madness.

Who Reaches the Infernal Core?

1. The Insane

- Only the **insane**—those driven mad by the torment of the Abyss—find themselves plunging to the Infernal Core. These are the cursed captains and crews who have **lost their grip on reality**, unable to distinguish life from death, driven forward by **delusions of glory**, **visions of power**, or a perverse urge to escape the nightmares that haunt them.
- Their madness shields them from the fear of what lies below, but it also blinds them to the impossibility of survival.

2. The Doomed

- Those who reach the Infernal Core are often already **marked for death**. Whether they've lost control of their vessel, been cast adrift by a failed escape from the Abyss, or are resigned to their fates, they hurtle downward in a final act of defiance—or surrender.
- Crews who have exhausted their ship's resources or suffered irreparable damage in the **Deep Abyss** are left with no choice but to descend, hoping for a miracle that will never come.

3. The Sacrificial

- Rare accounts speak of those who deliberately descended into the Infernal Core as an **act of sacrifice**, hoping to rid the world of some unspeakable evil or deliver a weapon of mass destruction into the heart of the Abyss. These individuals are remembered not for their success but for the certainty of their fiery demise.

The Final Plunge

The Journey Through Madness

- By the time a ship reaches the **Infernal Core**, its crew has faced the unrelenting horrors of the Abyss:
 - **Layer -4** stripped them of hope as the chaotic magic tore apart their vessel and their minds.
 - **Layer -5** reduced them to hollow shells, unable to comprehend the **psychic damage** and **existential despair** that engulfed them.
- When the molten glow of the Infernal Core appears below, it is often too late for them to reverse their course. **Navigation systems fail**, magical cores overload, and the sheer gravitational pull of the Abyss drags them inexorably downward.

The Chaos Before the End

- Ships that plunge into the Infernal Core typically experience catastrophic **malfunctions** in the final moments:
 - **Cores Explode:** The magical cores powering the vessel succumb to the chaotic energy and **implode** or **explode**, taking the ship with them in a fiery blaze.
 - **Hull Disintegration:** The oppressive heat and corrosive air weaken the ship's structure, causing it to **crack, collapse, or outright dissolve** before it even reaches the lava below.
 - **Crew Madness:** Survivors aboard the ship may turn on each other in their final moments, consumed by the madness of the Abyss.
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Fiery Death in the Lava Sea

If a ship miraculously avoids destruction during the descent and reaches the **molten sea**, its fate is no less certain:

1. **Molten Destruction**
 - The ship's impact with the **lava sea** triggers an explosive eruption of **magma, ash, and fire**. The intense heat (far beyond any natural lava) melts even the strongest enchanted hulls within seconds.
 - Any living creature on board is instantly **incinerated**, reduced to ash or vaporized entirely.
 2. **Volcanic Eruption**
 - The ship's crash often destabilizes the molten sea, triggering violent **volcanic eruptions**. These eruptions create **plumes of pyroclastic flows** and torrents of magma that consume the remnants of the vessel.
 3. **The Abyss Claims Its Own**
 - Even the **ashes** of those who perish in the Infernal Core do not escape. The turbulent winds and magical void of the Abyss scatter them into oblivion, erasing any trace of their existence.
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Why No One Survives

1. **No Safe Ground**
 - The constantly shifting volcanic islands are unstable and last only moments before erupting or sinking back into the molten sea. There is no refuge, no sanctuary, only chaos.

2. No Breathable Air

- The toxic, sulfurous fumes are so potent that even the most powerful magical protections struggle to withstand them. Any protective enchantments are quickly overwhelmed, and living creatures suffocate within moments.

3. Magical Collapse

- The unholy magic of the Infernal Core negates nearly all forms of magical escape or survival. Teleportation and planar travel fail entirely due to the **anti-magic aura** emanating from the core.
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Legacy of the Infernal Core

Those who descend into the **Infernal Core** leave behind no legacy but the cautionary tales of their demise. Ships that fall into the molten sea are consumed entirely, leaving no wreckage to recover and no survivors to tell their tale. The Infernal Core is a place of absolute **finality**, a destination from which **nothing returns**.

The rare few who claim to have seen the Infernal Core and lived (always from afar, at the brink of the Abyss) speak of it in hushed tones, describing it as the **mouth of hell**, a place where the rules of the world end and eternal destruction begins. Only the mad, the dying, or the truly cursed ever reach it—and none escape its fiery embrace.

The Tale of the Emperor of Dragons and the Infernal Core

The **Emperor of Dragons**, His Regal Imperial Majesty, the ageless and peerless sovereign of dragonkind, is known for his stoic demeanor and commanding presence. Yet, in the rare moments when he allows himself to indulge in a dozen kegs of the **finest dwarven ales**, his scales glisten with a nostalgic shimmer, and his regal mask gives way to the tales of his youth—wild stories of arrogance, bravery, and tragedy. Among these stories, one stands apart: the **Conquest of the Infernal Core**.

The Insane Bid for Bravado

In his youth, long before ascending to the throne, the Emperor was known for his **reckless daring** and **unyielding pride**. Drunk on the hubris of youth and the adulation of his draconic peers, he gathered **twelve of the mightiest dragons** of his age—stalwart warriors of immense strength, cunning, and magical prowess. They were dragons who bore titles that shook mountains and seared skies, beings whose names were spoken in reverence across continents.

With no higher goal than to prove their unmatched bravery, the thirteen dragons set their sights on the **Infernal Core**, a place whispered about even among dragons as the **domain of ultimate death**. The Emperor described their mission not as one of conquest in the traditional sense, but as an **act of defiance against nature itself**, a challenge to prove that not even the Abyss could extinguish the fires of their might.

The Descent into Madness

The Emperor recounted the descent with vivid, terrifying clarity.

1. Layers of the Abyss

As they plunged through the **Light Abyss (Layer -1)**, their spirits remained high, mocking the oppressive atmosphere. They were dragons, after all—creatures born of flame and strength.

- By **Layer -2**, the skies grew heavier, the magic in the air turning hostile, biting at their scales and gnawing at their minds. The Emperor recalled how the first cracks of doubt began to form in the hearts of his companions.
- At **Layer -3**, the choking miasma became unbearable even for dragons. The group began to lose formation, and the corrosive air seeped into their lungs, weakening their once-mighty roars.

2. Layers of Despair

- By **Layer -4**, the Emperor admitted, even he began to feel the pull of despair. His once-proud companions faltered, their scales blackened and singed, their wings struggling to beat against the crushing forces. The dark whispers of the Abyss clawed at their minds, trying to sow dissent and madness.
 - At **Layer -5**, the Deep Abyss, the Emperor watched as two of his most trusted warriors fell—one consumed by a sudden volcanic explosion, another by the writhing tendrils of dark, molten magic that dragged him into the abyssal void.
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The Arrival at the Infernal Core

The Emperor described the **Infernal Core** as the **mouth of oblivion**, a realm unlike anything they had encountered in their long lives. The air shimmered with unrelenting heat, and the molten sea raged below like a living, malevolent force.

- Their once-mighty roars were reduced to rasps as the toxic atmosphere clawed at their very essence.

- The volcanic islands rose and fell like fleeting phantoms, belching ash and fire that coated their wings and dimmed their fiery breath.

It was here that the **creature of the molten sea** emerged.

The Lava-Born Horror

As the Emperor's voice grew somber, he recounted the moment that brought their doomed journey to its final, tragic conclusion. From the depths of the **molten sea**, a **colossal creature of living lava** rose—a beast of unimaginable size, its molten form radiating both heat and malice.

The Emperor described it as a **titan of fire and destruction**, with eyes like black pits that radiated pure hatred and claws that could rend even the sturdiest dragon scale. Its form shifted and churned like the molten sea itself, its body glowing with the fury of the Infernal Core.

One by one, the remaining dragons fell to the creature:

- **Two were consumed** by plumes of molten rock it spat into the air.
 - **Another was swatted from the sky** by its massive, lava-coated claws.
 - **The final companion**, a dragon known only as **Iragan the Stalwart**, engaged the creature in a desperate battle. Iragan's flames blazed brighter than the sun, and his roars shook the very foundation of the Infernal Core. Yet, in the end, the lava-born beast **seized Iragan in its fiery maw**, swallowing him whole as the Emperor watched helplessly.
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The Emperor's Escape

With his companions gone and his body scorched and battered, the Emperor realized the futility of their mission. Though his heart burned with grief and fury, he knew that to remain would mean certain death. Using the last of his strength, he flew upward, **out of the Infernal Core and through the Abyss**, his path marked by the smoldering remains of his fallen brethren.

He emerged from the Abyss alone, a shadow of the proud dragon he once was. The experience left him forever changed—his scales dulled, his heart heavy, and his mind haunted by the screams of his companions and the eternal roar of the Infernal Core.

The Emperor's Warning

When asked why he tells this tale only in moments of drunken vulnerability, the Emperor simply responds:

“To remind myself of the cost of pride. To remember the faces of those I led to their deaths. And to warn the foolish who think they can conquer what was never meant to be conquered.”

His tale is both a cautionary lesson and a chilling reminder of the **ultimate power of the Infernal Core**. It is a place where even the mightiest beings of the world meet their end—a realm not to be challenged, but to be avoided at all costs.

Fleet Control

Fleet Organization Challenges and Checks

When managing a fleet of ships, the leader (captain, admiral, or fleet commander) must oversee a variety of logistical and strategic concerns. Organizing the fleet is an ongoing process, and poor management can result in delays, confusion, and even conflict within the fleet. The following table details the challenges a fleet commander may face when organizing and managing a fleet, along with the necessary skill checks and potential consequences of failure.

Challenge	Skill Check	Difficulty (DC)	Effect of Success	Effect of Failure
Fleet Coordination	Charisma (Persuasion)	15	Ships stay in formation, move together as planned, and communicate well.	Ships stray from formation, communication breakdown occurs, causing delays.
Navigational Routing	Intelligence (Navigation)	15	Routes are optimized, avoiding obstacles and hazardous zones.	Fleet becomes lost or delayed, running into hazards, reducing travel time or resources.

Supply Chain Management	Wisdom (Insight)	12	Supplies are organized efficiently, ensuring each ship has enough food, water, and ammunition.	Some ships suffer shortages, leading to mutinous behavior or slower movement.
Ship Condition Maintenance	Intelligence (Arcana or Tinker's Tools)	13	Ships are kept in optimal condition, with no critical failures in essential systems (engines, sails, etc.).	Critical systems may break down, leading to individual ships being left behind or disabled.
Fleet Discipline	Charisma (Intimidation)	14	Fleet remains disciplined; no pirate-like behavior, no theft, and minimal distractions.	Decreased morale, fights break out among the crew, potential loss of authority.
Crew Management	Charisma (Leadership)	16	Crew remains motivated, reduces fatigue, and stays focused on the mission.	Crew morale drops, causing unrest, disobedience, or refusal to carry out orders.
Combat Readiness	Wisdom (Perception)	18	Ships are ready for combat, crew is organized, and the fleet is properly prepared for battle.	Lack of preparation, crew confusion, delay in combat readiness, and tactical disadvantage.
Ship-to-Ship Communication	Intelligence (Investigation)	13	Clear communication between ships, reducing the risk of accidents or miscommunication.	Miscommunication or lack of coordination, leading to uncoordinated maneuvers, confusion.

Fleet Resource Management	Intelligence (Investigation)	15	Resources such as food, water, and ammunition are distributed evenly among the fleet.	Scarcity of resources causes tension, arguments, and hunger, leading to rebellion or mutiny.
Reinforcements	Charisma (Persuasion)	16	Successfully coordinate the arrival of reinforcements, bolster morale.	Reinforcements are delayed, leaving the fleet vulnerable, lowering morale.
Scouting and Reconnaissance	Wisdom (Survival)	14	Identifies potential threats ahead of time, allowing the fleet to avoid dangerous encounters.	Failing to spot threats, allowing dangerous creatures or enemy ships to ambush the fleet.
Defensive Formation	Dexterity (Athletics)	16	Fleet forms defensive formations quickly, protecting each other from enemy attacks.	Formation breaks down, leading to vulnerable ships being damaged or destroyed.
Fleet Morale Boosting	Charisma (Performance)	14	Crew morale is boosted through speeches, rewards, or entertainment, improving efficiency.	Morale remains low, resulting in inefficient operations and potential for mutiny.
Evacuation and Abandonment	Wisdom (Medicine)	17	Evacuating crew members efficiently in case of ship destruction or emergency.	Panic and chaos, leading to injured crew or loss of life during evacuation.
Reallocation of Crews	Charisma (Persuasion)	14	Crews are reassigned to ships with greater need for personnel, maintaining optimal staffing.	Ship staffing is uneven, leading to overworked crew, poor ship performance, or under-manned vessels.

Tactical Maneuvering	Intelligence (Tactics)	18	Fleet successfully executes complex maneuvers under pressure, evading threats or countering enemies.	Disjointed tactics lead to vulnerable ships, resulting in ship damage or loss.
Fleet Maintenance (Docking & Repairs)	Dexterity (Tinker's Tools)	15	Ships undergo scheduled maintenance, repairs are done efficiently, and vessels remain operational.	Delays in repairs, worsening ship conditions or leaving damaged ships vulnerable.
Cargo Management	Intelligence (Investigation)	12	Efficiently manage cargo, ensuring important supplies are prioritized and secured.	Cargo mismanagement leads to critical supplies being lost or damaged, impacting the fleet's mission.
Weather Monitoring	Wisdom (Nature)	15	Fleet avoids dangerous weather, adjusting sails and speeds to avoid storms or rough clouds.	Fleet runs into severe weather, slowing progress or damaging ships.

Additional Notes:

- **Managing Fleet Challenges:** Fleet leadership requires a balance of tactical, logistical, and interpersonal skills. Success or failure in these checks directly impacts the outcome of the journey or mission. Having a fleet of ships means that multiple factors must be coordinated simultaneously, making the leader's role complex.
- **Consequences of Failure:** Failing certain checks can result in a cascading series of problems for the fleet, from ship delays and casualties to crew insubordination or even the complete collapse of the mission. Poorly managed fleets risk losing resources, morale, and even entire vessels.

Ship-to-Ship Combat System:

In the world of aerial and naval combat, ship-to-ship encounters can vary greatly depending on ship types, combat tactics, and player abilities. Below is a detailed system for how ship-to-ship combat can be managed, with specific actions and rules for movement, firing weapons, and performing special maneuvers.

1. Ship-to-Ship Combat Overview

Ship-to-ship combat involves three main phases of action:

1. **Movement Phase:** Where each ship moves based on its speed and tactical positioning.
2. **Action Phase:** Where each ship can fire its weapons, perform special actions, or engage in other ship-related tasks.
3. **Reaction Phase:** Where ships can respond to attacks, dodge, or make other defensive maneuvers.

The game turns in combat are broken into rounds. Each ship gets one *movement*, one *action*, and a potential *reaction* based on the conditions. It may seem counterintuitive at first but ship to ship combat takes place on the same grid scale as players using the same range and movement increments, This is for ease of scale reference and proportional range and navigation As well as to allow companions with range abilities on board a ship to contribute to intership combat, naturally player weaponry cannot target Ships but they can target individuals on opposing ships If they were within range, It is assumed that only ship based weaponry has the punch It's necessary to afflict damage to other vessels. No amount of player fired normal arrows are going to damage a dreadnought, Nor do you need to worry about the troop carrier full of pirates filling your tiny ship with so many arrows that it simply sinks out of weight. The same is to be said for player spells The magic enchantments protecting ships is strong enough to deflect all but the strongest magics.

2. Ship Movement

Movement Rules

Movement is determined by the ship's speed and the pilot's/commander's decision. Most ships have a fixed movement speed in squares.

Movement Modifiers:

- **Wind:** Ships with sails will gain or lose speed depending on the wind direction (can vary by 1-2 hexes).
 - **Turbulence:** In stormy or turbulent skies, movement may be halved or reduced (DC check for precise maneuvering).
 - **Magical Influence:** Ships powered by magic or special engines (Ethereic Engines, etc.) may ignore wind and turbulence, and their movement can be more consistent.
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3. Ship Actions

Each ship gets one action per round. This action can be used to fire weapons, perform special maneuvers, or take another action, such as repairing damage or setting traps. Some ships might have specialized actions based on their size and purpose.

Weapon Firing

Ships can fire their weapons during the action phase. The number and type of weapons a ship has will determine the firing options. Ships with more than one weapon may choose which one to use, or they may decide to spread fire across multiple targets. Here's how firing works:

Weapon Firing Process:

1. **Declare Target:** Select an enemy ship or object within range.
 2. **Attack Roll:** Roll to hit the target using the weapon's attack modifier.
 3. **Damage Roll:** If successful, roll the weapon's damage dice.
 4. **Critical Hit:** If the attack roll exceeds the target's AC by 10 or more, deal double damage.
-

4. Special Ship Actions

Some ships have unique abilities or actions they can perform, such as repairing damage, buffing crew morale, or dealing area-of-effect damage. Below are some examples of special actions that can be taken during combat:

Special Action	Effect	DC	Outcome
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Repair Damage	Fix damage to the ship or specific systems.	Crafting/Repair Check	Restores 5-15 HP of the ship or specific systems.
Rally Troops	Boost morale of the crew, improving their performance.	Charisma + Command Roll	+1 morale and +1 to all crew actions for 1 round.
Deploy Barricades	Create temporary defenses (e.g., spikes or sails)	Strength + Command Roll	Provides +2 AC or similar defensive benefit for 1 round.
Teleportation (Magic Ships)	Teleport the ship or crew to a different location.	Spellcasting Check	Ship or crew transported to a different hex or area.
Cloak Ship (Magic Ships)	Temporarily hide the ship from enemy detection.	Spellcasting Check	The ship becomes invisible to enemy detection for 1 round.
Deploy Smoke Screen	Use magical or physical means to obscure visibility.	Dexterity + Command Roll	Reduces enemy visibility by 50% for 1 round.
Boarding Action	Launch a boarding party or attempt a raid on an enemy ship.	Strength/Charisma Check	Allows a boarding party to board or defend against boarding.

5. Ship Reactions

The reaction phase allows ships to perform defensive maneuvers in response to enemy actions. Ships can only react once per round.

Reaction Type	Effect	DC	Outcome
Evasive Maneuver	Attempt to dodge incoming attacks or projectiles.	Dexterity + Piloting Check	Gain +2 to AC against the next attack.
Brace for Impact	Prepare the ship for a hard hit.	Constitution + Piloting Check	Reduce damage by half on a successful check.
Deploy Countermeasures	Use defensive systems (e.g., magical shields, counter-projectiles).	Dexterity + Engineering Check	Reduces incoming damage by 10-20%.
Evacuate	Order the crew to abandon ship	Charisma + Command Roll	Evacuate up to 50% of the crew (with penalties if failed).

Tracking ships in the open

Tracking a Ship: Core Rules

1. Determine the Tracking Method:

Select the primary method(s) for tracking. Each method has a specific **range**, **detection difficulty**, and **situational modifiers** as per the table above. Tracking may involve:

- Visual tracking (smoke cloud, glint/reflection, or cloud disruption)
- Magical tracking (ether trails, magical beacons, or elemental disturbances)
- Mechanical tracking (radar, sonar, or temperature differentials)

2. Set the Initial Detection Roll:

To begin tracking, roll the appropriate skill check for the chosen method:

- **Perception** (Visual, Sound, or Cloud Disruption)
- **Arcana** (Magical tracking like ether trails or elemental disturbances)

- **Investigation** (Using radar, sonar, or thermal sensors)

The DC is set by the detection method and adjusted by the modifiers in the table.

3. Roll for Distance and Conditions:

After detecting the ship, determine the following factors to maintain the track:

- **Distance:** Establish the initial distance to the target. Roll 1d10 to determine how far within the method's range the ship is detected (e.g., 1 = near maximum range, 10 = minimum range).
- **Visibility:** Apply weather, time of day, or other environmental modifiers to the tracking rolls.

4. Tracking Rolls (Every 10 Minutes of Pursuit):

Once detection begins, tracking rolls are made every 10 minutes of in-game time.

Tracking involves:

- Maintaining line of sight or detection through sensors or magic.
- Rolling against a **tracking DC**, which increases by **+2 for every mile the ship moves out of range** or **+3 if the ship uses evasive maneuvers or enters a stealth condition**.

5. Evasion by the Target Ship:

If the target ship takes deliberate actions to escape, the tracking DC increases. Target ship actions may include:

- **Evasive Maneuvers:** Add +2 to the tracking DC for each successful pilot roll (DC 12).
- **Using Cover (Clouds/Weather):** Add +5 to the tracking DC if the target ship enters dense clouds, fog, or a storm.
- **Magical Concealment:** If the ship uses magic such as invisibility or illusion, the tracker must make an **Arcana check (DC 15)** to maintain pursuit.

6. Roll Modifiers by Tracker Ship:

Ships equipped with specialized tracking tools or advanced magic receive bonuses:

- **+2 Bonus** for advanced radar, sonar, or magical sensors.
- **+3 Bonus** if the tracking ship has a trained mage or sensor operator.
- **Advantage** if multiple tracking methods are employed simultaneously (e.g., radar + ether trail detection).

Tracking Scenarios

Scenario 1: Smoke Cloud

- **Initial Detection:** Perception check (DC 10). Modifiers include weather, time of day, and wind conditions.

- **Tracking Rolls:** Every 10 minutes, roll Perception against DC 10, +1 for every mile the target moves or -2 if the wind disperses the smoke.

Scenario 2: Ether Trail

- **Initial Detection:** Arcana check (DC 12). Modifiers include the strength of the ship's ether output or interference from magic-dampened regions.
- **Tracking Rolls:** Roll Arcana every 10 minutes against DC 12, +2 for every mile the target moves out of range or -3 if it uses stealth runes.

Scenario 3: Radar/Sonar

- **Initial Detection:** Investigation check (DC 10). Modifiers include radar range (+5 for high-quality systems, -5 for magical interference).
 - **Tracking Rolls:** Roll Investigation every 10 minutes against DC 10, +1 for every mile the target moves or -3 if it enters dense clouds.
-

Advanced Tracking Rules

1. **Critical Success:**
A natural 20 on a tracking roll provides additional information about the target ship, such as heading, speed, and approximate size/type.
 2. **Critical Failure:**
A natural 1 results in losing the trail entirely. The tracker must spend 1 hour to reacquire the trail and may only retry if using a different detection method.
 3. **Prolonged Pursuit:**
For every hour of pursuit, add **+1 cumulative DC** due to fatigue, equipment strain, or environmental interference.
 4. **Simultaneous Detection (Teamwork):**
If multiple allied ships or trackers are involved, each tracker can roll independently. Successes allow **one reroll per failure** if a tracker loses the trail.
 5. **Ship Stealth Bonuses:**
Stealth-equipped ships (e.g., those using anti-detection wards or cloaking magic) impose disadvantage on tracking rolls unless the tracker uses a countermeasure (e.g., arcane counter-sensors).
-

Tracking Outcomes

1. **Maintaining Track:**

If tracking rolls succeed consistently, the tracker gains periodic updates on the target's location and heading.

2. **Losing the Trail:**

If two consecutive tracking rolls fail, the trail is lost unless the tracker uses advanced magic or equipment to reacquire it.

3. **Interception:**

If the tracking party successfully maintains pursuit and closes within 1 mile of the target, they can attempt interception rolls (Pilot check vs. Target Pilot check) to engage or board the ship.

Ship Detection Table

Detection Method	Base Detection Range	Modifiers (Positive/Negative)	Detection Difficulty (Roll)	Notes
Smoke Cloud	5 miles (clear skies)	+2 miles: Clear weather +1 mile: High altitude -3 miles: Rain or fog -2 miles: Nighttime -1 mile: Strong wind dispersing smoke	DC 10 Perception (Visual)	Smoke clouds are easiest to spot visually but are affected heavily by weather and wind conditions.
Ether Trail	8 miles (arcane sensor)	+4 miles: High arcane sensitivity +2 miles: Experienced Arcana user -3 miles: Magic-dampened region -2 miles: Ship using stealth runes	DC 12 Arcana (Magical Sensing)	Ether trails are residual magical energy left by aether-powered ships; they are detectable by trained mages or sensors.
Cloud Disruption	10 miles (high altitude)	+3 miles: Clear sky contrast +2 miles: Clear weather -4 miles: Storm clouds -2 miles: Ship has camouflaged or gray hull	DC 15 Perception (Visual/Airship Spotter Tools)	Ships moving through clouds may displace or disrupt them, creating visible patterns or gaps detectable from a distance.

Sound (Engines)	3 miles (open skies)	+2 miles: Quiet environment +1 mile: Loud engines -2 miles: Storm noise -1 mile: Distance between elevations	DC 14 Perception (Hearing)	Certain engines, such as steam turbines, produce audible noise detectable over relatively short ranges.
Elemental Disturbances	6 miles (arcane sensor)	+3 miles: Strong elemental magic presence +2 miles: Calm weather -3 miles: Interfering magical storms -1 mile: Cloaked by opposing element	DC 12 Arcana (Magical Disturbance Detection)	Ships powered by elemental engines can leave disruptions in the surrounding elemental balance, noticeable to arcane users.
Glint/Reflection	4 miles (sunlight)	+2 miles: Direct sunlight +1 mile: Reflective surfaces (e.g., polished metal) -3 miles: Overcast skies -2 miles: Nighttime	DC 11 Perception (Visual)	A ship's hull or windows can reflect sunlight, creating visible glints that reveal its presence from afar.
Temperature Differentials	2 miles (thermal sensor)	+2 miles: Advanced thermal sensors +1 mile: Large thermal engines -2 miles: Cold weather -1 mile: Small ship with insulated engines	DC 13 Investigation (Using Equipment)	Some ships produce noticeable heat signatures, especially when powered by large steam or arcane engines.
Air Pressure Shifts	6 miles (special tools)	+3 miles: Advanced pressure sensors +1 mile: Fast-moving ship -3 miles: Turbulent weather -2 miles: High altitude	DC 14 Insight (Using Specialized Equipment)	Large ships displace air, creating shifts in local pressure that can be detected with the right equipment or spells.

Magical Beacons	15 miles (beacon active)	+5 miles: Strong magic beacon +3 miles: Trained sensor operator -7 miles: Anti-detection wards -2 miles: Low beacon power	DC 10 Arcana (Magical Beacon Detection)	Ships emitting active magical signals (e.g., distress calls) can be detected at extreme ranges with magical sensors.
Visual Sight (Crew)	2 miles (naked eye)	+1 mile: High vantage point +2 miles: Telescope or spyglass -3 miles: Rain or fog -1 mile: Hazy conditions	DC 12 Perception (Visual)	Simple visual detection, often augmented with tools like spyglasses or telescopes.
Radar or Sonar (Advanced)	20 miles (radar-equipped ship)	+5 miles: High-quality radar/sonar +3 miles: Calm weather -5 miles: Jamming field or magical interference -3 miles: Dense clouds	DC 10 Investigation (Using Radar/Sonar Equipment)	Advanced ships equipped with radar or sonar can detect even cloaked or camouflaged vessels in most conditions.
Smoke Signals (Intentional)	10 miles (clear day)	+5 miles: High altitude +2 miles: Large smoke plume -4 miles: Strong winds -2 miles: Heavy rain or storms	DC 8 Perception (Visual)	Ships using intentional smoke signals for communication are easily spotted if weather permits.

6. Ship Combat Resolution

At the end of each combat round, the effectiveness of each ship's actions is calculated. This involves:

1. **Damage Calculation:** The damage inflicted to enemy ships is tallied, and critical hits, weapon overloads, and other effects are factored in.

2. **Morale Check:** A morale check (based on crew strength, leadership, and situation) may be required for both ships. A failure could cause a ship to flee, surrender, or take significant penalties.
3. **Ship Status:** Ship status is updated (e.g., HP, damage to specific systems, crew morale, and available supplies).

Outcome	Effect
Critical Damage	Ship suffers significant damage, possibly causing systems to fail.
Ship Disabled	Ship loses mobility, cannot move or take actions for 1 round.
Surrender	Ship offers to surrender if they are outmatched or heavily damaged.
Total Loss	Ship is destroyed, requiring repair or full replacement.

This system allows for a mix of tactical planning, personal player involvement, and grand-scale ship combat. The success or failure of actions will depend on the players' decisions, their ship's specifications, and the environment in which they fight. By offering a variety of actions, ship types, and unique abilities, this system promotes deep engagement in aerial and naval battle

Running a large company group or Guild

Creating a Player-Run Group or Organization

Establishing a player-run group or organization in a campaign is a significant and rewarding undertaking. It allows players to shape the world around them, build resources, gain influence,

and leave a lasting impact on the story. Whether it's a guild, military faction, corporation, township, or other large-scale entity, creating and managing such an organization requires a mix of strategic thinking, roleplay, and decision-making. Below are the key steps, checks, and requirements for establishing and running a player-run organization.

Step 1: Conceptualizing the Organization

Before any logistics or formalities, the players should define the **purpose**, **identity**, and **goal** of the organization. This step is fundamental in laying the foundation for the group.

- **Purpose:** Why does this organization exist? What need does it fulfill in the world?
Common examples include:
 - A **Guild** for a specific trade or craft (e.g., Mercenary Guild, Thieves Guild, Crafting Guild).
 - A **Corporation** designed for profit, usually dealing with resources, magic, or trade.
 - A **Military Faction** serving a kingdom, city, or ideological purpose.
 - A **Township** that represents a settlement with its own governance, laws, and resources.
- **Identity:** What are the core values, culture, or ideologies that shape this organization?
Consider:
 - **How is the organization structured?** (e.g., hierarchy, democratic, collective leadership).
 - **What makes them unique?** Are they benevolent, ruthless, highly-skilled, or secretive?
- **Goal:** What are the long-term and short-term goals of this organization? These could include:
 - **Expansion:** Gaining more territory, influence, or resources.
 - **Reputation:** Building a name in the world.
 - **Power:** Political, economic, or military dominance.

Skill Check: Intelligence (Investigation) or Charisma (Persuasion) - DC 15 to outline a coherent vision and gather the necessary information.

Step 2: Resources and Funding

Any successful organization needs funding to get started and remain operational. Resources are required for:

- **Building Infrastructure:** Establishing buildings, ships, headquarters, or forts.
- **Staffing:** Hiring or recruiting skilled workers, soldiers, or magic users.
- **Supplies:** Gathering materials for weapons, goods, food, and utilities.
- **Legal Protection:** Securing permits, property, or affiliations with noble houses or governments.

Checks and Requirements:

- **Funding:** The organization will need gold or other valuable resources to kick-start operations. The cost may vary depending on the type and scope of the organization.
 - Example: A small guild may cost 100-500 gold to set up, while a township or military faction could require thousands of gold or political alliances.
 - Resources are gathered from existing wealth, loans, or alliances.
- **Recruitment:** The organization will need people to support its goals. This may include specialized individuals like craftsmen, soldiers, or bureaucrats.

Skill Check: Charisma (Persuasion) or Intelligence (Investigation) - DC 18 to secure resources, land, or funding from external sources or influential figures.

Step 3: Establishing the Infrastructure

With resources in hand, the next task is to establish the physical and administrative structure. This step includes:

- **Location:** Deciding on the place where the organization will reside or operate.
 - A **Guild** might set up in a bustling city center.
 - A **Corporation** could build industrial facilities.
 - A **Military** faction might construct a fortress or barracks.
 - A **Township** needs buildings, roads, and housing for residents.
- **Leadership Structure:** Who will run the organization? This can be a single person (CEO, Guild Master, Governor) or a council of individuals. The leadership style may be:
 - **Autocratic** (single leader with total control).
 - **Democratic** (elected leaders or shared decision-making).
 - **Oligarchic** (a ruling class of powerful individuals).
- **Internal Operations:** The day-to-day activities of the organization must be organized. Consider:
 - **Roles:** Assigning roles like treasurers, quartermasters, captains, or diplomatic envoys.
 - **Logistics:** Managing inventory, missions, services, or trade routes.
 - **Security:** Ensuring the safety of property, staff, and information.

Skill Check: Intelligence (Engineering) or Wisdom (Insight) - DC 20 to plan and oversee the creation of buildings and structures.

Step 4: Gaining Influence and Expanding Reach

Now that the organization is operational, it must gain influence and expand its power. This step focuses on growth, alliances, and establishing its presence in the world.

- **Public Relations:** The organization must get the word out, build a reputation, and form alliances with other factions or influential figures.
 - Establishing a **Trade Network** (Corporation).
 - Gaining **Military Contracts** (Military Faction).
 - Building **Community Ties** (Guild or Township).
- **Expansion:** The organization will need to grow through expansion.
 - This could involve taking control of more land or territory.
 - Building new branches or outposts.
- **Funding Expansion:** More wealth is needed for expanding operations. This could come from taxes (Township), profits (Corporation), or external patrons (Military or Guild).

Skill Check: Charisma (Persuasion), Intelligence (Investigation) - DC 18 to forge alliances or recruit new members.

Step 5: Maintaining Stability and Avoiding Collapse

Sustaining the organization is the final step. This involves handling internal conflicts, managing resources efficiently, maintaining morale, and keeping the group's goals aligned.

- **Managing Internal Conflict:** Conflicts may arise between factions, leadership, or employees. It's important to handle disputes with tact and resolve issues before they destabilize the organization.
 - Failure here could lead to **Mutiny, Betrayals, or Loss of Reputation.**
- **Resource Management:** Ensuring that resources are not wasted and that all departments or divisions are functioning smoothly.
- **Maintaining Leadership:** Keeping a balance of power and ensuring the leadership doesn't grow corrupt or disconnected from the organization's original mission.
- **Security:** Ensuring the safety of assets, including valuable trade routes, locations, or key personnel.

Skill Check: Charisma (Intimidation or Persuasion), Wisdom (Insight) - DC 20 to keep everyone in line, resolve disputes, and prevent sabotage.

Step 6: Consequences and Challenges

Creating and maintaining a large organization involves numerous risks, and failure can have significant consequences:

- **Financial Collapse:** If the organization runs out of funds or resources, it may lose its influence and support.
 - **Rebellion or Mutiny:** Low morale, corruption, or poor leadership may lead to the organization's downfall from within.
 - **Enemies and Rivals:** Other factions may target or sabotage the organization, leading to military or economic conflicts.
 - **Public Backlash:** If the organization's actions become too controversial, it could lose support from its followers or allies.
-

Ongoing Checks for the Organization's Survival

As the organization progresses, regular checks will be needed to maintain its power:

- **Quarterly Financial Reviews:** To ensure that it is financially viable and continuing to meet its goals.
 - **Intelligence (Accounting)** - DC 18 to identify any budgetary concerns.
 - **Morale Checks:** Ensuring that the leadership maintains the support of the staff, guild members, or townspeople.
 - **Charisma (Performance)** - DC 15 to maintain morale.
 - **Diplomatic Efforts:** Regular negotiations and alliances with other factions or organizations to further the organization's goals.
 - **Charisma (Persuasion)** or **Intelligence (Politics)** - DC 16 to maintain beneficial relationships.
-

By following these steps, players can create a complex and lasting organization that shapes the world around them. With the right decisions and effective management, the organization will grow, thrive, and become a force to be reckoned with. However, failure to carefully plan and adapt could lead to disastrous consequences.

Organization Management Challenges and Checks

Managing a large organization, especially one involved in complex activities such as running a fleet, airship manufacturing, or overseeing a kingdom, requires balancing resources, personnel, and logistical operations. Below is a table of various Mounthly organizational challenges, the corresponding skill checks, difficulty ratings, and the consequences of success or failure.

Challenge	Skill Check	Difficulty (DC)	Effect of Success	Effect of Failure
Leadership and Authority	Charisma (Leadership)	16	The leader maintains control, gains loyalty, and the staff remains motivated and focused on organizational goals.	Authority is challenged, lower morale, increased disobedience, and loss of respect for leadership.
Resource Allocation	Intelligence (Investigation)	14	Resources (money, materials, time) are efficiently distributed across departments and needs are met.	Resources are poorly allocated, causing shortages or wasted materials, affecting productivity.
Personnel Recruitment	Charisma (Persuasion)	15	Successful recruitment of skilled personnel, ensuring the right people are in the right roles.	Difficulties in attracting qualified personnel, leading to staff shortages or unqualified hires.
Project Management	Wisdom (Insight)	18	Projects are completed on time, under budget, and meet organizational objectives.	Delays, increased costs, and poor project outcomes due to disorganization or lack of oversight.
Conflict Resolution	Charisma (Intimidation)	15	Conflicts between departments or personnel are swiftly resolved, restoring harmony and focus.	Conflict escalates, creating factions within the organization, lowering morale, and reducing effectiveness.

Financial Stability	Intelligence (Accounting)	17	Financial health of the organization is stable, accounts balanced, and resources properly managed.	Budget overruns, mismanaged funds, or unaccounted debts jeopardize financial health and cause organizational strain.
Teamwork and Collaboration	Charisma (Performance)	14	Departments and individuals work together effectively, boosting productivity and innovation.	Lack of coordination leads to inefficiency, wasted efforts, and interdepartmental tension.
Morale and Well-being	Charisma (Performance)	16	Team morale is high, employees are motivated, and productivity increases.	Low morale, burnout, and resentment towards leadership, leading to high turnover or decreased efficiency.
Crisis Management	Wisdom (Medicine or Survival)	18	The organization effectively handles crises (natural disasters, accidents, etc.), minimizing damage and loss.	Poor crisis response leads to significant losses, damage to reputation, and diminished staff confidence.
Regulatory Compliance	Intelligence (Investigation)	14	All operations comply with regulations, avoiding fines or legal trouble.	Legal or regulatory violations lead to fines, reputation damage, and potential shutdown of certain operations.
Innovation and Growth	Intelligence (Arcana or Tinker's Tools)	16	New ideas, inventions, or strategies are implemented successfully, increasing efficiency or profit.	Lack of innovation stagnates the organization, falling behind competitors, and missing opportunities for growth.

Supply Chain Management	Wisdom (Insight)	15	Supply chains remain steady, with no disruptions or shortages, allowing for continuous operations.	Supply chain breakdowns cause production delays, missing deadlines or failing to meet customer demands.
Public Relations	Charisma (Deception or Persuasion)	14	Public relations efforts maintain a positive image for the organization, ensuring good press and community relations.	Poor PR or a bad reputation leads to a loss of clients, diminished trust, or potential public backlash.
Logistics and Inventory	Intelligence (Investigation)	14	Inventory is correctly managed and organized, preventing shortages or overstocking.	Mismanaged inventory leads to excess stock, missed sales, or inability to fulfill client orders.
Legal Affairs	Intelligence (Law)	16	Legal issues are managed effectively, preventing lawsuits, fines, or penalties.	Legal mismanagement results in lawsuits, fines, or the loss of valuable assets and business relationships.
Security and Risk Management	Wisdom (Perception)	15	Risks are properly assessed and mitigated, and security measures are in place to protect the organization's assets.	Security lapses lead to theft, sabotage, or attacks that damage the organization and its resources.
Employee Training	Wisdom (Medicine or Insight)	14	Employee training programs are effective, improving skills, safety, and productivity.	Untrained employees, or poorly implemented training, lead to accidents, inefficiency, and higher turnover.

Strategic Planning	Intelligence (Tactics)	18	Long-term strategic goals are successfully identified and pursued, with the organization positioned for future success.	Failure to plan strategically leads to missed opportunities, lack of growth, and an inability to adapt to market changes.
Productivity and Output	Dexterity (Sleight of Hand)	15	Productivity and output increase, meeting organizational targets and exceeding expectations.	Decreased output and missed targets harm profits and may lead to job cuts or organizational restructuring.
Customer Satisfaction	Charisma (Persuasion)	16	Customer satisfaction is high, leading to positive reviews, repeat business, and customer loyalty.	Poor customer service or unsatisfactory products/services result in customer complaints and loss of business.

Additional Notes:

- **Organizational Health:** Managing an organization involves a balance of leadership, strategic planning, and management skills. A failed check may not just affect the immediate area but could lead to long-term consequences for the organization's reputation, productivity, and financial stability.
- **Organizational Success:** The success of the organization is often defined by its ability to function efficiently, adapt to challenges, and maintain employee and public satisfaction. Leadership is critical to maintaining control, morale, and resources.

Table: Losing Control of an Organization

This table outlines various ways that a player-run organization can lose control, whether through internal mismanagement, external pressures, or the actions of its own members. Each scenario can drastically change the course of the organization, leading to potential chaos, rebellion, or even collapse.

Event	Description	Required Action or Check	Consequence
Leadership Election	Members of the organization (or key influential figures) elect a new leader, either through votes or due to shifting allegiances.	Charisma (Persuasion) or Wisdom (Insight) - DC 18 to maintain support.	The player characters lose control of the organization as a new leader with differing goals is chosen. The transition can be peaceful or cause internal strife.
Internal Coup	A faction or group within the organization, often led by someone with substantial power, forcibly takes control of leadership.	Strength (Athletics) or Charisma (Intimidation) - DC 20 to prevent or quell the coup.	The organization falls into the hands of the coup leaders, who may alter its goals, structure, or allies. Previous leaders are often imprisoned or killed.
Military Rebellion	The organization's military or hired mercenaries rebel against the leadership, either due to mistreatment, poor conditions, or ideological differences.	Charisma (Intimidation) or Wisdom (Insight) - DC 22 to restore order or calm tensions.	If failed, the rebellion causes a loss of military support and disrupts operations. The organization may need to negotiate with the rebels or fight them off.
Economic Collapse	Poor financial management or misallocation of resources leads to bankruptcy or inability to pay employees, causing rebellion from within the ranks.	Intelligence (Investigation) or Charisma (Persuasion) - DC 18 to resolve economic issues.	Workers, mercenaries, or other employees demand higher pay or better conditions. If not addressed, the organization could dissolve or face a strike.
External Sabotage	A rival organization or external force infiltrates or sabotages the organization, causing a	Intelligence (Investigation) or Dexterity (Stealth) - DC 20 to uncover the sabotage.	Loss of valuable assets, trust in leadership, or trade routes. The external force might take advantage of

	loss of control or valuable resources.		the organization's vulnerability.
Corruption Scandal	A scandal involving corruption or illegal activities by leadership comes to light, causing public outcry and loss of support.	Charisma (Deception) or Wisdom (Insight) - DC 22 to avoid exposure or damage control.	The organization loses favor, and a significant portion of its members may leave. This could lead to investigations, protests, or even the overthrow of leadership.
Morale Collapse	Morale plummets due to continuous failure, unfair practices, or leadership neglect. Workers and members rebel against leadership.	Charisma (Performance) or Wisdom (Insight) - DC 18 to maintain morale or reestablish faith.	The organization's operations are hindered as key members defect, the workforce becomes unproductive, and a new leader must rise.
Revolt by Constituents	The people, guild members, or residents of a township rise up against their leadership, citing oppression or abuse of power.	Charisma (Persuasion) or Charisma (Intimidation) - DC 20 to resolve the situation peacefully.	Violent uprisings or mass desertion from the organization cause chaos, with townspeople or guild members demanding the overthrow of leadership.
Exile of Leadership	The leadership is forced into exile by a coalition of rivals, political opponents, or military factions, leaving the organization leaderless.	Charisma (Persuasion) or Strength (Athletics) - DC 22 to fight back or escape.	The organization is thrown into disarray, unable to function without its former leadership. Power struggles ensue as factions attempt to take control.
Ideological Schism	A major ideological difference between factions or leaders divides the organization, leading to separate factions and the collapse of unity.	Wisdom (Insight) or Charisma (Deception) - DC 18 to restore unity.	The group fractures into multiple factions with different goals, weakening the organization's influence and resources. Reconciliation becomes a difficult path forward.

Potential Consequences of Loss of Control:

- **Loss of Resources:** The organization may lose control over valuable assets such as gold, magic items, ships, buildings, or land.
- **Reputation Damage:** Public trust in the organization’s ability to lead may diminish, which could affect alliances, trades, or recruits.
- **Internal Division:** The organization splits into multiple factions, each with its own agenda, leading to a lack of cohesive action.
- **Political Consequences:** Rival organizations or factions may take advantage of the chaos to expand their power or influence.
- **Possible Collapse:** In extreme cases, the organization may collapse entirely, with members scattering and assets being lost or seized.

By carefully managing leadership, resources, and public relations, players can ensure the longevity of their organization. However, failure to address internal conflict, external threats, or mismanagement could lead to the dissolution of their hard-built empire or guild.

Seizing the means of production

Table: Industrial Product Creation System

This table provides a system for crafting products at three levels of output. Players can increase their efficiency and scale by using different setups—from working alone to overseeing a full industrial workshop. The system uses skill checks based on the player’s proficiency and expertise, and the output increases with each tier, offering more materials, faster production, and greater variety.

Level	Description	Required Skills / Checks	Output (Materials)	Time to Complete	Failure Consequences
Level 1: Solo Workshop	The player works alone with a basic workbench and limited materials. This setup is useful for creating small amounts of specialized items or repairing things.	Skill Check (Proficiency-Based): <i>Crafting, Smithing, Carpentry, Alchemy, Tailoring, etc.</i> DC 15-18 (based on complexity)	Small quantities of goods (up to 5 items per week)	1-3 days per item (depends on complexity)	Minor imperfections, increased likelihood of wasting materials, or slower progress if failed.

Level 2: Small Team	The player leads a small team of NPC assistants. There are a few helpers, and the work can be divided to speed up production. Each assistant brings a specific skill set that complements the player's craft.	Skill Check (Team Leadership + Crafting): <i>Crafting, Smithing, Carpentry, Alchemy, Tailoring, etc.</i> DC 14-17 (based on complexity). Charisma (Leadership) or Wisdom (Insight) DC 16-18 for effective coordination.	Medium quantities of goods (up to 15 items per week)	3-4 days per item (depends on complexity and available assistants)	Failed leadership checks may cause delays, errors in craftsmanship, or loss of product efficiency.
Level 3: Industrial Workshop	The player oversees a full industrial workshop with dozens of skilled craftsmen, assistants, and equipment. The facility is capable of mass production, and the player manages the overall workflow.	Skill Check (Management + Crafting): <i>Crafting, Smithing, Carpentry, Alchemy, Tailoring, etc.</i> DC 12-16 (based on complexity). Charisma (Leadership) or Intelligence (Investigation) DC 14-16 for coordination.	Large quantities of goods (up to 50 items per week)	1-2 days per batch of up to 10 items (depends on complexity and material availability)	Major flaws in product quality, catastrophic mismanagement, or the loss of valuable materials can occur if production isn't managed effectively.

Detailed Breakdown for Each Level:

Level 1: Solo Workshop

Required Tools / Materials: A basic workbench, raw materials (metal, wood, cloth, etc.), tools specific to the type of product being crafted (e.g., hammer, anvil, sewing kit, etc.)

Skill Requirements: Players must be proficient in a crafting skill (Smithing, Alchemy, Carpentry, etc.) to succeed. They can use their proficiency bonus to add to the check.

Crafting Check: The complexity of the item being created will affect the DC. Simple items have a lower DC, while more complex items (enchanted or intricate designs) have higher DCs.

Time to Complete: Crafting is slow but highly personalized. Each item requires 1-2 days, depending on complexity.

Failure Consequences: Minor imperfections in the crafted items (weakened durability, aesthetic flaws), reduced material efficiency, or potential time loss due to mistakes.

Level 2: Small Team

Required Tools / Materials: A larger workbench or crafting area, raw materials, and a variety of tools for different types of work. The player also needs to hire or manage a small group of assistants (usually 2-5).

Skill Requirements: The player must have proficiency in the relevant crafting skill, plus a Charisma (Leadership) or Wisdom (Insight) check to manage assistants effectively. This ensures that tasks are allocated efficiently and production speed is maximized.

Crafting Check: The player makes a crafting check, and each assistant contributes a bonus based on their skill. For example, a skilled smith might add a +2 to a metalworking project.

Time to Complete: With multiple hands at work, production is faster, but not as fast as in an industrial workshop. Each item will take around 3-4 days, and larger batches can be crafted faster as work is divided.

Failure Consequences: Mismanagement of the team could lead to delays, mistakes in the crafted items, or inefficient use of resources. If the Leadership or Crafting checks fail, it might lead to a reduction in output or quality.

Level 3: Industrial Workshop

Required Tools / Materials: A fully-equipped workshop with industrial-grade tools, such as steam-powered hammers, metal presses, looms, or enchanted crystal machinery. This facility requires large quantities of raw materials to maintain production.

Skill Requirements: In addition to proficiency in the relevant crafting skill, the player must manage a large team of workers (10+ assistants). This requires Charisma (Leadership) to maintain morale and Intelligence (Investigation) to troubleshoot issues in the workflow or machinery.

Crafting Check: The player oversees production, and a set of secondary skill checks can be made for specialized workers (e.g., Smithing, Carpentry, Engineering). The more skilled the

team is, the faster and more efficient the process. Group work will add bonuses to the final outcome.

Time to Complete: With proper management, large batches of goods can be produced in 1-2 days. A typical industrial workshop can produce 50 items per week, though this depends on the complexity and type of item being crafted.

Failure Consequences: Major flaws in products (e.g., structural weaknesses, poor enchantment), disruption in the supply chain (lost materials), or even machinery breakdowns can slow or stop production entirely. Poor leadership can lead to reduced morale among workers, which affects quality and speed.

Bonus Outcomes for High Skill/Management Success:

Level 1 Success: Crafting an item with a flawless finish, gaining a reputation for high-quality craftsmanship, or crafting a rare item with bonuses.

Level 2 Success: Increased efficiency in production, better use of materials, and a potential bonus to quality (e.g., better durability or enchantment strength).

Level 3 Success: Mass production of goods with additional bonuses like higher item quality, enchanted items becoming more stable, or an overall increase in profit. The player can produce complex or magical items with higher success rates.

Training skills

System for Attending Classes or Receiving Instruction to Become Trained in a Skill

This system outlines how players can receive formal training or attend classes to acquire proficiency in a skill, whether it's a crafting skill, combat ability, social skill, or magic. It includes a cost structure, a series of checks, and consequences for failure.

Overview:

- **Skill Training:** Players can pay for instruction in specific skills, gaining proficiency or expertise over time. The training can range from short-term lessons to long-term apprenticeships, depending on the complexity of the skill.
- **Monetary Costs:** The cost of training depends on the skill being learned and the duration of instruction. Typically, costs will range from 5 to 50 gold per day, scaling higher for specialized skills or rarer instructors.
- **Time Commitment:** The time it takes to become proficient varies from a few weeks for simple skills to several months or more for complex training.

- **Outcome of Training:** Upon successful completion, the player either gains proficiency in the skill or improves their expertise (e.g., gaining a new skill proficiency, learning a new toolset, or improving a crafting or combat ability).

Step-by-Step System

Step	Description	Skill Check Required	Cost	Time to Complete	Failure Consequences
Step 1: Select Skill to Train	The player selects a skill (Crafting, Combat, Magic, Social, etc.) to train. Some skills may require specialized teachers, like advanced magical skills, while others are more widely available.	None	5–50 Gold per day, depending on skill and instructor	Varies (days to months depending on the skill)	N/A
Step 2: Find Instructor	The player must locate a teacher or class, which can be found in cities, guilds, or special academies. Certain rare skills might require a unique instructor, which may be difficult to find.	Investigation Check (DC 12-18) or Charisma Check if networking	5-50 Gold per day depending on instructor quality	1 week – 1 month depending on skill level	Failure means difficulty finding the right instructor or a poor-quality teacher.

Step 3: Begin Training	The player attends classes or apprentices under the instructor. The player must actively participate in lessons and practice skills during the training period.	Skill Check (DC 12-18): Crafting, Combat, or Knowledge Check (based on the skill)	Varies by skill	1 week to 1 month, based on skill complexity	Failure results in slower progress or a setback in training (e.g., need for additional sessions).
Step 4: Progression Check	At the end of each week/month, the player makes a check to see how much they've learned. This determines whether they gain proficiency or improve their expertise in the skill.	Intelligence (Learning) or Wisdom (Insight) Check (DC 12-15)	5-10 Gold per week of instruction	1–4 weeks for basic skills, 3+ months for complex skills	Failure results in no improvement, the player may need to pay for additional weeks of instruction or restart training.
Step 5: Final Assessment	After the necessary time of study, the player undergoes a final assessment or practical test. Success means the player has learned the skill or improved it.	Skill Check (Relevant Skill Proficiency)	Training cost for the final assessment	1 day or session for the assessment	Failure results in no skill acquisition, or the player must start again.

Types of Training and Associated Costs

Skill Type	Typical Cost per Day of Training	Time to Complete	Final Result
Basic Skills (e.g., Athletics, Stealth, Insight)	5–10 Gold	1–2 weeks	Gain proficiency in skill (if not already)
Crafting (e.g., Smithing, Alchemy, Tailoring)	10–15 Gold	1 month	Proficiency in craft or tool set
Weapon Training (e.g., SwordsmanSHIP, Archery, Polearms)	10–20 Gold	1–3 months	Proficiency or combat feat related to the weapon
Magic (e.g., Spellcasting, Arcana, Rituals)	20–50 Gold	1–3 months	Learning a new spell or spellcasting ability
Social (e.g., Persuasion, Deception, Insight)	5–15 Gold	1–2 weeks	Expertise in skill or gaining a social feat
Rare Skills (e.g., Dragonology, Magical Item Crafting)	30–50 Gold	3–6 months	Mastery of a rare skill or knowledge

Detailed Outcomes and Consequences of Failure

Step 1: Finding an Instructor

- **Failure Consequences:**
 - **Investigation Fail (DC 12-18):** Difficulty locating the right instructor. The player may need to try several times or pay a higher price to hire a private instructor. In extreme cases, the player may end up with a less qualified teacher, which will affect the quality of instruction.
 - **Charisma Failure (DC 10-15):** If the player fails a Charisma check to network or gain access to a particular instructor, they might be barred from attending a particular class, or they might get a lower-quality instructor.

Step 2: Progressing in Training

- **Failure Consequences:**
 - If the player fails a skill check to learn during a particular session, they gain less understanding of the skill or fall behind in their training.
 - Time or money may be wasted, and the player might need to pay for additional lessons or extend their training.

Step 3: Final Assessment Failure

- **Failure Consequences:**
 - Failure in the final assessment results in no skill gain. In this case, the player either has to restart their training or spend more time/money paying for remedial lessons to ensure they meet the required level of proficiency.
 - The player may be disheartened or feel they've wasted time and money, potentially leading to morale damage (depending on how the DM portrays failure).
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Optional Alternative System: Mentorships or Guild Training

Instead of formal schooling or paying instructors, players can seek out mentors or join guilds. These alternatives work in similar ways but might have different costs, time frames, and benefits.

- **Mentorships:** A mentor may provide hands-on training or direct guidance. Costs are lower (or the mentor may be willing to offer training in exchange for favors, quests, or items), but progress is slower and less structured.
 - **Guilds:** Guilds may offer classes or specialized training programs in exchange for a membership fee, and often have an established curriculum. However, they may require contributions in the form of labor, services, or guild-specific quests.
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This training system allows the player to gain proficiency or expertise in new skills over time. It provides both monetary costs and roleplay-driven elements like finding the right teacher, managing time efficiently, and taking responsibility for successful or failed training sessions. Depending on the DM's style, players may need to balance their time between adventuring and improving their skills through formal instruction.

So now I'm a criminal

In **Kaysender**, managing one's criminal status and dealings with law enforcement is an intricate and nuanced aspect of life in this world. Whether you're a seasoned rogue, an accidental lawbreaker, or someone trying to maintain a clean record, navigating Kaysender's criminal justice system requires strategy, knowledge, and often a healthy dose of cunning.

Law Enforcement Structure in Kaysender:

1. **City Guard (Citywide):** The primary enforcement body in urban areas, dealing with petty crimes, thefts, and maintaining order in marketplaces, streets, and taverns. They

have limited authority but are known for being quick to respond to incidents and capable of capturing criminals.

2. **Watchers (Elite Units):** A more specialized branch of law enforcement dedicated to investigating major crimes, high-profile cases, and more politically motivated offenses. Watchers are highly trained and often involved in espionage or sabotage against groups considered a threat to the realm.
 3. **Enforcers (Specialized Forces):** This division focuses on physical enforcement, such as bounty hunters, interrogators, and law-bringers who track down criminals and ensure the punishment is served.
 4. **The Court of Law:** The formal judicial system, which includes judges, barristers, and legal proceedings. It is responsible for setting sentences, presiding over major crimes, and handling appeals or disputes within the justice system.
 5. **Guild Law:** Criminal offenses within guilds or merchant groups are judged and punished by guild leaders or appointed members. The penalties may vary from fines to excommunication or even assassination orders for extreme cases.
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Key Criminal Statuses and How They Affect Interaction with Law Enforcement:

1. Outlaw:

- **Description:** An individual who is considered a criminal by law and whose capture is a priority for authorities. They are not entitled to trial and may be executed on sight or brought in for immediate punishment. Their name may be on a public wanted list.
- **Managing Status:** To mitigate being caught, outlaws can hide their identity, assume false names, or seek sanctuary with criminal organizations that can protect them. In some cases, bribing or intimidating law enforcement officers may help delay or evade capture.
- **Possible Solutions:** Pay off bounties, escape to a foreign city, seek refuge with a criminal organization, or attempt to have your record expunged through a political favor or a major act of service to the kingdom.

2. Wanted (with Bounty):

- **Description:** The individual is a criminal with an established bounty. While not yet considered an outlaw, the individual is wanted by law enforcement for specific crimes, and rewards may be offered for information leading to their capture.
- **Managing Status:** Bounty hunters may be hired to track down the individual, and the city guard will actively search for them. The criminal can attempt to lay low, frequently change locations, or bribe informants to remove their bounty.

- **Possible Solutions:** Paying off the bounty (directly or through negotiation), entering into a deal with a bounty hunter to escape or perform tasks in exchange for freedom, or using disguise and subterfuge to avoid detection.
3. **Accused/Arrested:**
- **Description:** A person who has been apprehended by law enforcement but is still awaiting trial. They are often detained in a local jail or holding area.
 - **Managing Status:** The accused can attempt to bribe the guards, escape during transport, or gain favor with influential individuals (e.g., lawyers, guild members, or nobles) who can influence the trial. Depending on the nature of the crime, the accused may be allowed to plead for a lesser sentence or negotiate a deal.
 - **Possible Solutions:** Escape from custody, hire a powerful lawyer or noble to sway the court's opinion, bribe or intimidate witnesses, or flee the city and lay low in a different jurisdiction.
4. **Convicted Criminal:**
- **Description:** The individual has been found guilty of a crime and sentenced to punishment, which may range from a fine, imprisonment, forced labor, or even execution, depending on the crime's severity.
 - **Managing Status:** The criminal must either serve their punishment or attempt to escape. However, once convicted, fleeing the jurisdiction without proper arrangements can worsen their criminal status.
 - **Possible Solutions:** If imprisoned, there is the possibility of organizing a jailbreak with the help of other prisoners or outside allies. Alternatively, one can serve the punishment and seek rehabilitation through acts of service or community involvement to earn a reduced sentence.

How to Manage Relations with Law Enforcement:

Bribery and Corruption:

Bribing local law enforcement or influential individuals within the government can often smooth over a criminal status. Depending on the crime, bribery can ensure lenient treatment, avoidance of punishment, or even the erasure of criminal records. However, continual bribery may build resentment, and more officials may become involved, increasing the chances of exposure.

- **Bribe Amounts:** These can vary based on the gravity of the offense, from a modest sum to significant wealth. A small fine or fine-based offense may cost between 10-50 gold pieces, while major offenses (e.g., assault, theft) could demand more substantial sums. Escaping more serious crimes may require hundreds or thousands of gold.

Influencing the Legal System:

Some cities have corruption or leverage points where influential figures (noble houses, guilds, or powerful individuals) hold sway over the legal system. If a criminal has a friend or ally in one of these groups, they may be able to have their case thrown out, reduced, or hidden.

- **Methods of Influence:** Offering services in exchange for legal favors, cultivating political relationships, or performing dangerous tasks to win favor.
- **Risk:** There is always the risk that the wrong person gets involved, leading to more suspicion and a more intense investigation.

Escape and Evade:

In some situations, it may be safer to simply leave the jurisdiction and lay low. However, as a criminal's notoriety grows, escaping to a neighboring town or city may make them more famous, increasing the difficulty of hiding.

- **Escape Routes:** Hidden passages, secret transport options (smuggler routes, secret tunnels), or bribing officials to get documents that allow the criminal to travel without being flagged.
- **Consequence:** Escaping doesn't erase the crime, and new locations may have different laws, higher bounty prices, or new threats that complicate the life of a criminal.

Gaining Redemption or Forgiveness:

Redemption is a long and difficult road, but there are often opportunities for criminals to seek forgiveness for their transgressions. This may involve performing acts of public service, working with the law enforcement system, or even providing valuable information in exchange for amnesty.

- **Redemption Paths:** Quest-based redemption (e.g., retrieving stolen items, helping solve a crime, or saving someone important), proving loyalty through service, or working with high-ranking authorities in a meaningful way.
- **Risks of Redemption:** Redemption can sometimes be used as a trap to gain information or a false sense of security before a heavier punishment is meted out.

Help something big is trying to eat me!

Here is a detailed **table** of rules and roles designed for **fleeing a situation**—whether on foot or aboard a ship. This table outlines the core mechanics and checks necessary to facilitate a dramatic escape. Each role represents a key part of the process, from physical challenges to tactical decisions, allowing the players to fully immerse themselves in the chaos of evading capture, pursuit, or danger.

Fleeing a Situation – Rules and Roles

Role/Action	Description	Mechanic/Check	Failure Consequences	Success Consequences
1. Initiative (General)	Who acts first in fleeing. The quicker you flee, the harder it is for pursuers to catch up.	Roll Initiative for all participants.	Failure to act quickly leads to enemies closing the gap, disadvantage in later checks.	Gaining a head start, reducing pursuer advantage.
2. Navigating Terrain	Selecting the best route to escape. Whether in a forest, through a city, or across open fields, the terrain will impact your speed and survival chances.	Survival or Athletics (DC 12) to find safe routes.	Poor navigation could lead to obstacles, traps, or dead-ends.	Finding hidden or quicker escape routes, avoiding obstacles.
3. Stealth (Foot Only)	Evading being seen by pursuing enemies, hiding in shadows, or blending with crowds.	Stealth (DC 15-20) for hiding or blending in.	Being spotted; pursuers gain a +2 bonus on future chase rolls.	Remaining undetected, avoiding pursuit and gaining distance.
4. Speed (On Foot)	The physical speed and stamina to outpace pursuers. Whether running or riding, this role is key in gaining distance.	Athletics (DC 13) or Dexterity (Acrobatics, DC 14) to sprint.	Slow pace gives enemies a chance to close in.	Faster pace, gaining 1d6 rounds of distance.
5. Speed (Ship)	On water or in the air, navigating a ship or vehicle to escape.	Piloting (Dexterity or Wisdom, DC	Running aground, misjudging winds or	Increased speed, gaining distance from pursuers.

		15-18) to control speed.	currents, losing control.	
6. Evasion (Foot or Ship)	Dodging obstacles or incoming attacks, like arrows or magic.	Dexterity Saving Throw (DC 12-18) to dodge attacks.	Taking damage, slowing down, or losing ground.	Successfully avoiding harm and maintaining speed.
7. Distraction (Foot or Ship)	Creating a diversion to mislead pursuers or to give the group a chance to flee.	Performance or Sleight of Hand (DC 14-18) to create a distraction.	Distraction fails, no time gained, enemy awareness increases.	Distracting enemies, causing them to lose track or delay pursuit.
8. Obstruction (Foot or Ship)	Using the environment or creating barriers to block pursuers.	Strength or Dexterity (DC 15) to push obstacles, set traps.	Obstacle fails to slow down pursuers, or backfires.	Obstructing or slowing down pursuers, gaining time.
9. Perseverance (Foot)	Managing exhaustion, continuing the run even when stamina is low.	Constitution Saving Throw (DC 14) to avoid fatigue.	Slow pace due to exhaustion, disadvantage on further checks.	Maintaining stamina, continuing at full speed.
10. Coordination (Ship)	Working with the crew to maintain ship speed and avoid distractions during escape.	Wisdom (Insight) or Charisma (Persuasion, DC 16) to coordinate actions.	Disorganized crew, ship falters, losing speed or direction.	Teamwork improves efficiency, maintaining high escape velocity.
11. Disengagement (Ship)	Breaking off combat or navigating away from an enemy ship or airship.	Charisma (Intimidation) or Dexterity (Stealth, DC 14-17) to escape a ship battle.	Enemy ship gives chase, closing distance.	Successfully breaking away, gaining distance from threat.

12. Final Stand (Optional)	In some situations, players may decide to make a last stand before fleeing.	Varies by player action. Examples include Attack Rolls, Spells.	Risk of failure could lead to serious injury or capture.	Holding enemies off long enough for escape, buying time.
13. Environmental Hazards (Ship)	Navigating through hazardous weather, sea creatures, or dangerous terrain.	Survival or Perception (DC 16-20) to avoid natural hazards.	Damage, slowing down, or misdirection.	Navigating safely around environmental dangers.

Expanded Explanation:

1. Initiative (General):

- **Purpose:** Initiative decides who has the first chance to flee or take action. A high initiative means your character can act quickly to create distance, gain an advantage, or take actions to improve the chance of escape.
- **Failure Consequence:** If your initiative roll is low, pursuers get to act first, and you may find yourself trapped or in a worse position.

2. Navigating Terrain:

- **Purpose:** Choosing the right path to take can affect the success of an escape. A natural environment like forests, caves, or city streets all offer advantages and challenges for those trying to flee.
- **Failure Consequence:** The terrain may slow you down, introduce hazards, or create dead-ends, potentially leading to being caught or injured.

3. Stealth:

- **Purpose:** Evading detection by hiding in shadows or blending in with a crowd is vital for an escape, especially when pursuing forces are strong.
- **Failure Consequence:** Being spotted gives your pursuers a direct advantage, and they'll be able to catch up more quickly.

4. Speed (On Foot):

- **Purpose:** Raw physicality and quick thinking—running, sprinting, or navigating obstacles—are crucial to gaining distance and avoiding capture.

- **Failure Consequence:** Slow or delayed movements will allow pursuers to get much closer, increasing the danger.

5. Speed (Ship):

- **Purpose:** Navigating a ship is more complicated, but escaping via a vessel requires skilled piloting to adjust for wind, current, and potential threats.
- **Failure Consequence:** A miscalculation could cause the ship to lose speed or get caught in dangerous waters.

6. Evasion:

- **Purpose:** Dodging environmental dangers, arrows, spells, or attacks is essential to avoid taking damage or slowing down.
- **Failure Consequence:** Failing to evade could result in injury, which might force the group to slow down.

7. Distraction:

- **Purpose:** Distraction techniques are often used to confuse or mislead pursuers. This could involve throwing objects, setting off alarms, or otherwise drawing attention away from the group.
- **Failure Consequence:** A failed distraction could make the group more obvious, increasing the difficulty of escaping.

8. Obstruction:

- **Purpose:** Blocking pursuers with debris, setting traps, or otherwise disrupting their path gives the escapees time to gain distance.
- **Failure Consequence:** An obstacle that doesn't work or backfires may delay the escape and make it easier for pursuers to catch up.

9. Perseverance:

- **Purpose:** If escape takes a long time, players must resist exhaustion. Otherwise, they risk slowing down and getting caught.
- **Failure Consequence:** Fatigue causes slower movement and potential disadvantages on future checks.

10. Coordination:

- **Purpose:** If you're on a ship or in a group, coordinating actions and ensuring everyone is on the same page will help the escape succeed.

- **Failure Consequence:** Disorganized groups lose speed, communication breaks down, and key escape actions may be missed.

11. Disengagement (Ship):

- **Purpose:** When faced with a threat, disengaging properly will allow you to flee safely without getting involved in unnecessary combat.
- **Failure Consequence:** If the ship's crew fails to disengage, they could end up in a prolonged fight, which will slow their escape.

12. Final Stand:

- **Purpose:** Sometimes players may decide to make a last stand or delay pursuers by using combat or spells.
- **Failure Consequence:** If the fight goes poorly, the group could be captured, injured, or killed.

13. Environmental Hazards:

- **Purpose:** Dangers like storms, wild animals, or unstable terrain are common in the world, and avoiding them while fleeing is crucial for survival.
- **Failure Consequence:** Natural hazards can cause damage, slow your movement, or lead you off course, increasing the danger.

This table ensures that every element of escape, from foot races to ship maneuvers, is handled with detail, and encourages creative solutions and teamwork. The higher the stakes, the more exciting and complex the escape becomes.

Help! Ive been Marooned!

Being stuck on a tiny floating island in the sky can be a challenging survival scenario for a player. Below is a detailed list of **survival roles** and **methods** to help them attract attention, signal passing ships, and even attempt to create a crude transportation device to return to civilization. These actions will require creativity, resourcefulness, and determination.

Survival Roles and Methods for Escaping a Tiny Floating Island

Role/Action	Description	Mechanic/Check	Failure Consequences	Success Consequences
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1. Scouting the Island	Evaluate the island's resources and strategic locations for signaling or crafting escape tools.	Perception (DC 12) to identify landmarks or potential signaling spots (e.g., higher ground, areas with natural visibility).	Missing the best location for signaling, wasting time on less effective spots.	Discovering the best place for visibility, making future signaling attempts more effective.
2. Creating Smoke Signals	Building a signal fire to attract attention, or create large smoke plumes.	Survival (DC 10) to gather dry materials, Strength (DC 10) to build a fire.	Fire is poorly constructed, weak signals, or out of control.	Creating a strong, visible signal that may attract attention from ships or aerial creatures.
3. Crafting a Signal Flag	Using available materials (cloth, leaves, or other scrap) to create a visible flag.	Sleight of Hand or Survival (DC 13) to craft the flag, Athletics (DC 10) to hoist it.	The flag is too small or unnoticeable. It may be damaged by the wind or storms.	A large, visible flag that can be seen from a distance.
4. Using Mirrors or Reflective Objects	Using reflective materials like shards of glass, water surfaces, or metal scraps to signal ships.	Sleight of Hand (DC 12) to craft reflective surfaces, Dexterity (DC 13) to angle the reflection correctly.	Inaccurate angles, weak light, or too much cloud cover prevents effective signaling.	Sending a noticeable reflection toward passing ships or flying creatures.
5. Rigging a Crude Raft or Transportation Device	Crafting a basic raft, glider, or other form of transportation to attempt a journey off the island.	Survival (DC 14) to gather materials, Strength or Dexterity (DC 13) to assemble the raft/glider.	The raft or glider fails upon use, leading to capsizing or falling apart.	Successfully building a raft or glider that can carry you to the nearest floating island or ship.

6. Crafting a Signal Sound (Drums, Horns)	Using available materials to create a loud, attention-grabbing sound to signal ships.	Performance or Survival (DC 12) to craft drums, horns, or noise-making devices.	The sound is too faint or incorrect, not traveling far enough to be heard.	Creating a sound loud enough to catch the attention of nearby ships.
7. Constructing a Beacon	Using large rocks, wood, or metal to construct a noticeable beacon to attract attention.	Survival or Strength (DC 14) to gather materials, Intelligence (DC 12) to plan the beacon.	Beacon is poorly constructed or too small to be seen from afar.	Building a towering beacon that can be seen from a great distance, increasing visibility.
8. Trapping or Attracting Wildlife	Using traps or lures to attract flying creatures or wildlife, hoping to signal ships or direct attention to the island.	Survival (DC 14) to construct traps or bait, Animal Handling (DC 13) to coax wildlife.	Traps fail, or creatures ignore the signals.	Attracting a flying creature that might lead a ship to your location or help with your escape.
9. Creating a Signal Rocket (If Resources Allow)	Crafting a basic rocket or firework from the island's resources to signal at night.	Alchemy or Crafting (DC 16) to create the signal rocket, Dexterity (DC 14) to launch it correctly.	The rocket misfires, causing an explosion or failing to fly.	Successfully launching a bright, visible signal that may attract attention.
10. Crafting Floating Debris to Sail Off	Using scrap materials or floating debris to construct a makeshift vessel.	Survival or Crafting (DC 15) to select debris, Strength (DC 12) to assemble.	The vessel is too unstable, breaking apart or becoming too difficult to control.	Creating a crude but usable vessel to drift away from the island toward larger land masses.

11. Signal Lights (Glowstones, Torches)	Setting up a light at night using available glowing resources to attract attention.	Survival (DC 11) to gather materials for light, Intelligence (DC 10) to position it correctly.	The light is too dim, or the position is ineffective.	Creating a bright signal that can be seen for miles during the night.
12. Communicating with Passing Creatures	Using gestures or magic to communicate with flying creatures or other animals to guide them toward the island.	Animal Handling (DC 13) to call and guide creatures, Charisma (DC 12) for magical communication.	Creatures are not responsive or aggressive, leading to failure.	Successfully communicating with creatures, gaining a potential guide to the nearest civilization.
13. Weather Prediction (Navigating Storms)	Understanding weather patterns to predict when the skies may clear, making signals or travel more effective.	Nature (DC 14) or Survival (DC 13) to interpret signs.	Misreading the weather, worsening the chances of safe escape.	Correctly predicting favorable weather, improving future attempts.
14. Finding Water Sources	Ensuring the player has enough fresh water while stranded to remain alive and focused on escape.	Survival (DC 12) to locate water sources, Intelligence (DC 11) for purification methods.	Dehydration leads to exhaustion, reducing effectiveness in other checks.	Successfully finding and purifying water, preventing exhaustion.
15. Crafting a Signal Fire at Night	Building a large fire or bonfire that sends a clear signal.	Survival (DC 12) to gather dry fuel and set fire, Strength (DC 13) to maintain it.	Fire is weak, or quickly extinguished, failing to send a clear signal.	A blazing fire that could be seen from far away, especially at night.

These actions, checks, and consequences form a comprehensive survival system for a player stranded on a tiny floating island, allowing them multiple avenues to escape or signal for help while also managing the threats of isolation and limited resources.

Here is a detailed table of **things players might encounter paper week starnded** while trapped on a floating skyland, including wild fauna, creatures, predators, passing bandits, traders, caravaneers, and mercenaries. Each entry provides a brief description and the potential outcome or challenge associated with the encounter. A minor sky island is described as an area of sky island that is less than 150 foot square, Which normally drift quite readily with the wind.

Table of Encounters on a minor Floating Sky island

Encounter Type	Description	Challenge/Mechanic	Outcome/Consequences
Wild Fauna (Small)	Small creatures like rabbits, birds, and rodents, often scavenging.	Survival (DC 10) to track and catch.	Food and materials for crafting; low risk, but some creatures may escape.
Wild Fauna (Large)	Larger creatures, such as predators or herbivores. Could include boar-like creatures or aggressive birds of prey.	Survival or Animal Handling (DC 12) to approach or subdue.	Potential food, materials, or danger if creatures are hostile.
Flying Predator (Small)	Small aerial predators, such as giant hawks or falcons that may swoop down to hunt.	Perception (DC 12) to spot the predator early, Dexterity (DC 13) to evade.	Injury, possible loss of supplies, or food; may cause harm to the player.
Flying Predator (Large)	Larger aerial predators, like wyverns or giant	Perception (DC 14) to spot; Combat (DC 15) to defend or escape.	Combat, damage, or possible capture if unsuccessful. Players

	eagles, often territorial and aggressive.		may also gain rare items from these creatures.
Pack of Wild Beasts	A small pack of feral creatures, such as wild dogs, boar, or beast kin.	Survival or Animal Handling (DC 15) to fend off or tame.	Battle or evasion required, potentially leading to injury or loss of resources.
Bandits (Low-Level)	Small groups of bandits, scavengers, or opportunistic criminals, often looking to steal supplies.	Insight (DC 14) to assess threat, Charisma (DC 13) to negotiate.	Possible robbery, injury, or allies; could lead to alliances or combat.
Bandits (Experienced)	A more experienced bandit group, possibly with heavy weapons or magical abilities.	Combat (DC 16) to fend off or outwit; Charisma (DC 14) to negotiate.	Significant risk of harm, loss of goods, or valuable allies. Possible capture for ransom.
Merchant Caravan	Traveling merchants or traders offering goods, supplies, or services.	Charisma (DC 13) to haggle, Insight (DC 12) to judge trustworthiness.	Potential to trade for resources, gear, or information; possibly misled or cheated.
Traveler or Caravaner	A lone traveler or small caravan with knowledge of the surrounding regions or trade routes.	Survival or History (DC 12) to glean useful info, Charisma (DC 14) to persuade.	Trade for information, goods, or alliances. They may offer advice or assist in finding escape routes.

Mercenaries	Professional mercenaries hired to escort, protect, or enforce order.	Insight (DC 14) to assess intentions, Combat (DC 16) if hostile.	Possible allies, but may require payment or risk of hostile encounters depending on alignment.
Aerial Trader or Caravan	A floating sky caravan or trade ship offering goods and services from the sky.	Charisma (DC 15) to negotiate, Perception (DC 14) to spot flying ships.	Potential trade for needed supplies or escape; could be a one-time chance.
Fleeing Refugees	Individuals or families fleeing danger, possibly looking for aid or shelter.	Charisma (DC 13) to offer assistance, Survival (DC 14) to comfort.	Aid them, gain allies or supplies, or learn more about threats nearby. They may also have vital information.
Storm Elementals	Creatures made of wind, lightning, and air, often appearing near storms or turbulence.	Nature (DC 14) to identify; Combat (DC 16) to avoid or defeat.	Combat with dangerous elemental forces; successful evasion could lead to safety.
Fallen Sky Tree	A giant, ancient tree that has fallen from a higher island, carrying dangerous wildlife or treasure.	Investigation (DC 15) to explore safely; Strength (DC 14) to avoid danger.	Valuable resources or dangerous creatures within the tree; hidden items may be found.

Strange Magical Phenomena	An area of intense magical activity, unstable weather, or shifting gravity that can confuse or mislead travelers.	Arcana (DC 16) to understand and resist; Wisdom Saving Throw (DC 14) to avoid disorientation.	Temporal disorientation, magical damage, or finding rare, unknown magical artifacts.
Skyborne Marauders	Groups of flying, dangerous raiders attacking from ships or sky creatures, bent on looting.	Perception (DC 16) to spot early, Combat (DC 18) to defend.	Heavy battle, potential for damage or loss of ship/shipmates, or valuable gear from raiders.
Lost Wanderer	A lone individual who is stranded or has lost their way, possibly needing assistance.	Charisma (DC 12) to offer help, Insight (DC 14) to judge the wanderer's motives.	Can offer valuable information, possibly rewarding the party with assistance or supplies.
Cloud Serpent	A giant serpent that flies through the sky, often mistaken for a storm cloud.	Nature (DC 17) to identify; Combat (DC 18) if hostile.	High-risk combat, with possible treasure if defeated; dangerous and elusive.
Skybander Thieves	A group of skilled thieves operating in the air, stealing from anyone they can find.	Perception (DC 16) to spot their approach, Dexterity (DC 15) to evade.	Loss of goods or potential capture; may lead to hostile combat with thieves.
Floating Ruins	Ancient ruins or temples with powerful artifacts or dangerous traps and guardians.	Investigation (DC 15) to avoid traps; History (DC 14) to uncover secrets.	Discovering ancient magic or treasure; risk of triggering dangerous

traps or hostile guardians.

Floating Beast (Exotic)	An unusual and rare floating beast (giant jellyfish, floating whale, etc.), which may be passive or territorial.	Nature (DC 16) to understand behavior; Survival (DC 15) to avoid attack.	Possible peaceful encounter or dangerous fight; could provide resources if studied.
Wandering Sky Druid	A druid or nature-based caster traveling the skylands, offering assistance or a challenge.	Nature (DC 14) to negotiate or receive wisdom.	Potential ally or opponent, depending on how the encounter unfolds. Can offer healing, magic, or guidance.

Randomly generated minor islands

Here's a **table for determining the contents of a randomly encountered minor sky island** (typically less than 150 feet square). This table provides a variety of possible elements that can be encountered, such as flora, fauna, water, debris, treasure, and more. Roll a d10 for each category to create a unique environment for the island.

Table: Minor Sky Island Contents

d10 Roll	Flora	Fauna	Water	Sand/Soil	Ship Debris	Treasure/ Valuables	Remains/ Other
1	Scraggly grass and small, wind-twisted bushes.	A small group of fluttering sky butterflies.	A tiny spring trickles from a rock.	Damp, mossy ground.	Fragments of old wooden crates and barrels.	A small chest with rusted coins and broken	The remains of a small animal, partially

						jewelry.	eaten.
2	Fern-like plants, some glowing faintly at night.	A few harmless small birds (brightly colored).	A shallow pond surrounded by reeds.	Fine, loose dirt.	A broken, half-sunken rowboat with ropes.	A single, unmarked scroll with a faded map.	A pile of old, weathered clothes.
3	Large mushrooms growing in patches along the edges.	A lone, timid rabbit-like creature.	A pool of stagnant water with algae.	Sandy soil with some sparse vegetation.	Wreckage from an old skyship mast.	A pair of gold-plated spectacles, slightly tarnished.	The remains of a previous traveler, bones scattered.
4	Tall, spiky grass that sways with the wind.	A small group of wild, chirping lizards.	A tiny stream runs through the island.	Soft sand, with patches of bare stone.	Fragments of an old telescope and charts.	A bag with some minor gemstones and trinkets.	Empty crates with odd symbols carved into them.
5	A single, massive tree with fruit (though hard to reach).	A large bird-like creature roosting in the tree.	A shallow creek with clear water.	Thin, rocky soil.	Half-buried planks, possibly from a damaged ship.	A silver ring encrusted with a single large gem.	Old cooking utensils, likely left behind in haste.
6	Lush, thick vines tangled around rocks.	A territorial snake-like creature with iridescent scales.	A large freshwater lake occupies a crater.	Wet, spongy ground with moss patches.	A broken mast and several torn sails.	A small sack of copper coins hidden under a rock.	A pair of skeletal hands clutching a cracked dagger.
7	Bright, colorful flowers scattered across the	A playful group of small, hopping creatures.	A small but deep spring at the island's center.	Fertile, rich soil with patches of flowers.	A tattered, empty barrel half-sunk in a patch	A small carved idol made from bone or wood.	An old journal with strange, cryptic

	island.				of sand.		writing.
8	Tiny, delicate ferns and mosses growing in sheltered spots.	A lone, injured winged creature (like a hawk or falcon).	A natural, clear spring with an almost magical glow.	Very fine sand with some large stone debris.	Fragments of a metal object, possibly from a ship's engine.	A worn map leading to a distant, unknown island.	A rotting corpse with a broken sword and shield.
9	Cacti-like plants that store water in their stems.	A predatory, insectoid creature scuttling across the ground.	A stagnant puddle of rainwater in a depression.	A mixture of soil and compacted sand.	Pieces of an old ship's rudder, with strange carvings.	A rusty but still functional mechanical tool or gadget.	A lone skeleton, missing its helmet, clutching a broken compass.
10	Dense, thorny bushes and creeping ivy.	A pack of small, fur-covered creatures (like squirrels).	A tiny, bubbling spring on the edge of the island.	Damp earth with scattered rocks.	A disassembled, crushed airship hull.	A small stash of magical trinkets or talismans.	A set of shackles and chains, possibly of unknown origin.

Explanations of Categories:

- **Flora:** The types of plants that grow on the island, which may provide food, materials, or medicinal properties. They can vary in terms of rarity or usefulness.
- **Fauna:** The animals or creatures found on the island, which may pose a threat, offer food, or provide resources (such as fur or scales). They could also be potential allies or interesting to interact with.
- **Water:** The availability of water on the island, which is essential for survival. It may be clean and drinkable, stagnant, or even magical in nature.
- **Sand/Soil:** The type of terrain found on the island. It can affect movement and survival, depending on the composition (sandy, rocky, mossy, etc.).
- **Ship Debris:** Fragments of ships that may provide clues, equipment, or hazards. This may also indicate the island's history or serve as the site of a previous wreck.
- **Treasure/Valuables:** Items of worth that could be found on the island. This could include coins, jewels, magical items, or tools that can help the players.

- **Remains/Other:** The bones, corpses, or objects left behind by previous inhabitants. This can serve as a clue to the island's history or as a warning to the players about potential dangers. Some remains may hold important items or offer a chilling reminder of the island's perilous nature.
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Usage:

To generate a random island encounter, roll a d10 for each category. This will create a unique island encounter with a combination of flora, fauna, and other elements. The players can then explore these elements to gather resources, face challenges, or uncover hidden treasures or dangers.

World Lore

The Shattering of the World: A Legend Told by Many

Long ago, the world was a single, unified landmass—a vast, fertile expanse of earth and sea, where all races lived together in harmony. The **Elves** walked in peaceful groves, the **Dwarves** mined deep in the mountains, the **Humans** built kingdoms by the shores, and the **Gnomes** filled the air with their clever inventions. The **Dragons** and **Dragonborn**, with their ancient wisdom, ruled the skies, and even the **Halflings** could be found in every corner, cultivating the earth and building small, tight-knit communities. All races lived side by side, thriving in what was considered a perfect world.

But that peace did not last. The event that shattered the world—the divine calamity known as **The Shattering**—is now a mystery, and each race tells its own story of how the land was torn asunder. Some of their accounts are wildly different, while others share a disturbing commonality, pointing toward something much darker and greater than any one race could understand.

The Elven Tale: The Betrayal of the Starborn

The Elves, wise and long-lived, speak of the **Starborn**, ancient beings of light who once walked among them, bringing gifts of celestial knowledge. It was said that these beings were not of this world, but descended from the heavens, their arrival heralded by a great cosmic alignment. The Elves believe that the Starborn warned them of an impending catastrophe, and that their world

would be shattered by the greed and ambition of mortals who sought to seize the powers of the stars.

The Elven story tells of an act of treachery—the **Starborn** were betrayed by a faction of humans, who in their arrogance, sought to harness the celestial power for themselves. The resulting cosmic explosion tore the land asunder, and the earth splintered, sending continents into the air, never to be reunited. The Elves claim that the **Starborn** ascended back to the heavens, leaving behind only the memory of their divine power and a warning to all races: that the stars should never be disturbed again.

The Dwarven Tale: The Great Forge of the World

The Dwarves, keepers of the earth, tell a different story—a tale of the **Great Forge** beneath the earth. In their version, the world was once a unified mass, a living forge with mountains deep enough to hold the heart of the world itself. The Dwarves say that the calamity began when a powerful **artifact**, known only as the **Heart of the Forge**, was discovered by a greedy and reckless king. This artifact was said to possess the power to forge reality itself, and the king sought to use it to reshape the world, creating a paradise for his people.

But the artifact was far too powerful to control, and when the king attempted to use it, the Heart exploded in a cataclysmic event, breaking the world into pieces. The **Great Forge** was shattered, and the land rose into the sky in fragments. The Dwarves believe the power of the Heart still pulses beneath the shattered pieces of the world, hidden away in the deep places, waiting for someone strong enough to control it once more.

The Human Tale: The Wrath of the Gods

Humans, always prone to both ambition and superstition, tell of a wrathful act by the **gods themselves**. According to their legends, the world was once whole and beautiful, a gift from the gods to their mortal creations. However, mankind became arrogant, believing they could match the power of the divine. They built massive cities in the heavens, encroaching on the domain of the gods. The humans dared to steal divine secrets, believing they could live forever.

In response, the gods unleashed their fury. The sky cracked, and the heavens fell to earth in an endless rain of divine fire and fury. The **Abyss**, a void of darkness, swallowed entire kingdoms, and the world shattered into floating islands that drifted forever apart. To this day, many humans believe the **Shattering** was a divine punishment for their ancestors' hubris, a warning that the gods must never again be defied.

The Gnome Tale: The Accidental Collision

The Gnomes, ever the inventors and curious minds, have a more **practical** theory. Their story speaks of an ancient and vast **machinery** that once powered the entire world. This machinery was hidden deep beneath the surface and powered by an unknown, forgotten source. According to the Gnomes, it was not greed or malice that caused the Shattering, but the **inadvertent actions** of an ambitious engineer—a Gnome by the name of **Veldrin Sparkwhistle**.

Veldrin, seeking to increase the efficiency of the world's machinery, made a miscalculation in his calculations. His experiment, designed to harness the energy of the earth, went horribly wrong. The machines reacted in ways no one could have predicted, causing an energy explosion of catastrophic proportions. The earth splintered, and the world was cast into the air in floating fragments, forever divided. The Gnomes, who had once revered Veldrin as a brilliant inventor, now see his legacy as both a cautionary tale and a symbol of how even the smallest mistake can alter the world.

The Common Thread: The Divine Cataclysm

While each race has a different interpretation of the event, there are several key elements that **remain constant** across all their stories:

1. **A Divine Force:** Whether the gods, the Starborn, or the powerful artifact, it is clear that a higher power—divine or cosmic—played a pivotal role in the **Shattering**.
 2. **Hubris or Greed:** Every race agrees that the **ambition** of mortals—whether humans seeking divine secrets, Dwarves mining too deep, or even Gnomes tampering with unknown powers—was a driving force behind the calamity.
 3. **The Abyss:** The idea of an **Abyss**, a void or dark force that consumed everything in its path, is prevalent in all the stories. Whether it's the punishment of gods, the dark unknown of the Heart of the Forge, or the consequence of disturbing the stars, the **Abyss** remains a constant and ominous presence in the aftermath.
 4. **The Rising of the Land:** All agree that the world was shattered, and the land was **forever lifted into the air**, broken into floating islands and isolated fragments. The world as it was before the Shattering no longer exists, and all races now live in the remnants of that broken earth.
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The Unknown Culprit

As for who or what caused the Shattering, no race can truly say. The **gods**, the **Starborn**, and the **Great Forge** are all seen as potential forces that may have triggered the event. Some even whisper that the event was not caused by mortal actions at all, but by a divine **wrath** too powerful for any race to understand. The truth, hidden in the fog of time, remains elusive.

What all races agree on is this: the world was once whole, and now it is shattered, drifting forever apart, and the secrets of what caused the Shattering may never be uncovered. Only the legends remain, passed down through generations, each race clinging to their version of the story—and each watching the skies, ever aware that the land could fall once more.

The land beneath the clouds

In the world of the sky, survival is not just a matter of strength, but of sheer will and constant vigilance. Peace is a dream that fades quickly, crushed beneath the ever-present weight of the **Vanishing**—a term that haunts the whispers of rulers and airship captains alike. For in this world, islands do not remain in the air forever. They rise and fall, sometimes drifting peacefully, but sometimes slipping unnoticed into the **Abyss**—a void of cold, darkness, and fear that lies far beneath the clouds.

The **Vanishing** is a part of the sky world's grim reality. It is not the dramatic fall of a single island, but a quiet, insidious thing—an island slowly losing its place in the sky. The clouds churn, the winds howl, and then... it's gone. No one knows what causes it, but there are those who claim to have witnessed the moment of descent—how the land cracks and trembles, how the air grows thinner and colder, and how the magic that sustains them begins to fail. Those who fall into the Abyss never return, their islands swallowed by the void, their cities and cultures lost forever.

Survival in the sky requires more than just the power of wealth and influence. It requires **resources**—and resources are growing scarcer by the day. The constant competition for the limited lands that float above the clouds drives the rulers of the various islands to war, to political maneuvering, and to desperate alliances that will break just as soon as the next storm rolls through. The **sky**, once seen as a place of freedom, is now a battleground for those vying for control of the floating islands that still remain, with each island's ruler knowing all too well that their piece of the sky could vanish without warning.

But what lies beneath the clouds? The Abyss, ever present and mysterious, is a place of darkness, death, and ruin. Those few who have dared to venture into the void speak of **hulking beasts**—massive, grotesque creatures that roam the depths, devouring anything that dares to fall.

Airships, once sturdy and proud, have been consumed whole by the Abyss, their crews never to be seen again. Some claim that these creatures are **UndterWyrms**, ancient, bestial creatures said to haunt the deep chasms of the world.

The **UndterWyrms** are creatures of myth, whispered about only in the darkest corners of taverns and royal halls. They are said to be great coiled serpents, capable of swallowing even the mightiest of dragons whole. When asked about them, the oldest of dragons—the few that still live after centuries of wisdom—will often fall silent, their eyes clouding with memories too old to speak of. But if one is patient enough, and perhaps fortunate enough to have the right drink in hand, a dragon might speak of what lies below: ancient creatures, massive and untamable, that feast on anything that falls into the Abyss.

It is said that they are not just beasts, but part of the very fabric of the **Abyss** itself. They have no purpose other than to consume, to ensure that the lands that fall are devoured, leaving no trace of what once existed. Legends tell of the **UndterWyrms** rising up from the deep to **claim** the very airships that descend, their massive jaws closing around entire crews before they even have a chance to scream. Those few survivors, if they exist at all, speak only of a rushing wind—a sudden, terrifying force—and a glimpse of something vast and coiled, disappearing into the depths with a scream of wind and lightning.

The rulers of the sky know of the **Vanishing**, and they have begun to whisper of the **UndterWyrms**, but none will speak openly of it. The threat beneath is too great, too consuming. The idea that any island could vanish in the blink of an eye, consumed by the great beasts that lurk below, is too terrible to contemplate. And yet, the skies continue to be a battlefield, with each ruler, each kingdom, each city-state desperately clinging to their land. In this world, the fight for survival is constant. There is no time for peace, for the abyss beckons, and none can say what fate lies in wait for those who slip too far from the sky.

All that is certain is this: **there is no safe place in the sky**, and the **UndterWyrms** wait patiently beneath the clouds, ever hungry for those who fall into their domain.

The UndterWyrms and the Beasts of the Abyss

The UndterWyrms are not the only horrors that lurk beneath the clouds, in the cold, damp, and lightless depths of the Abyss. For those brave—or foolish—enough to venture near the edge of this void, there are many terrifying creatures that rule the realms where the sun cannot reach. The abyssal depths are not simply a place of darkness; they are a place where the very fabric of reality twists and warps, giving rise to creatures that are as monstrous as they are strange. These beasts thrive in the ever-present gloom, hunting those who fall, consuming what they can, and always waiting for the next unwary soul to slip past the precipice.

1. The Abyssal Maw

Appearance: A gigantic, gelatinous, black mass that seems to have no discernible form except for a massive gaping mouth filled with rows of jagged, obsidian teeth. It moves slowly, seemingly dormant, but when prey comes near, it can stretch to an enormous size in a blink, ready to consume anything it touches.

Abilities:

Swallow Whole: The Abyssal Maw can unhinge its jaw and consume an airship whole. The ship disappears into its depths, and the Maw's digestive acids immediately begin to break it down, leaving no trace behind.

Void Pull: The Maw has the ability to create an invisible gravity well that pulls objects toward it, making it nearly impossible for ships to escape once they get within its reach.

Abyssal Corruption: The Maw exudes a slow, creeping decay that causes magic to fail and technology to corrode. Any weaponry or magical items within a certain range of the Maw begin to rust, lose power, or break down entirely.

Danger: The Abyssal Maw lurks in the deepest pits of the Abyss, where it is nearly impossible to see it coming. Its vastness means that it can be nearly impossible to escape once trapped, and its ability to weaken magical and technological objects renders even the most advanced airships helpless.

2. Shadowwing Leviathan

Appearance: A massive, shadowy leviathan with wings that span hundreds of feet. Its body is long and serpentine, covered in leathery, pitch-black skin. Its wings are translucent but shimmer like dark glass, allowing it to soar through the Abyss, casting dark, eerie shadows across the land below.

Abilities:

Dark Gale: The Shadowwing Leviathan can flap its wings to summon a massive wind that can easily push airships off course or even tear them apart. The winds it creates are cold and biting, sapping the heat and warmth from anything caught within them.

Void Screech: A deafening cry that emanates from the Leviathan's throat. It can disorient and temporarily stun anyone within a large radius, leaving airships and their crews vulnerable to further attacks.

Abyssal Flight: The Shadowwing Leviathan is able to fly at incredible speeds through the Abyss, using its ability to blend with the shadows of the void to remain almost invisible. Its presence is often not detected until it is too late.

Danger: Its ability to create powerful winds, along with its stealthy nature, makes it a formidable hunter. Those caught in the Leviathan's screech often lose control of their vessels,

leading to crashes or even destruction. Even the most experienced sky captains often fall prey to its ambushes.

3. Sable Tendrils

Appearance: Sable Tendrils are long, serpentine creatures made of black, twisting vines that extend from the void. Their bodies are made of a dark, elastic material, capable of stretching and weaving through the air like massive tendrils of darkness. At the end of each tendril is a bulbous, maw-like mouth that gnashes hungrily.

Abilities:

Grasp of the Abyss: The Sable Tendrils can extend their bodies over incredible distances, ensnaring airships or anything that comes too close. Once caught, their powerful tendrils will crush or drag the victim down into the Abyss.

Poisonous Kiss: The mouths at the end of the tendrils release a venomous fluid that can paralyze creatures. Even if an airship is not physically caught, a direct hit can disable parts of the ship or cause the crew to lose control.

Regeneration: As long as one tendril remains intact, the Sable Tendrils can regenerate. This makes them incredibly difficult to kill, as even when struck down, their severed limbs can continue to attack.

Danger: The Sable Tendrils are relentless and can reach out from places where they are not visible, making them a serious threat. Their poison and crushing strength, combined with their ability to regenerate, makes them a persistent danger to anything that flies into their grasp.

4. The Blackclaw

Appearance: A giant, arachnid creature, the Blackclaw stands nearly as tall as a building, its body covered in chitinous armor of deep black. It has six spindly legs, each tipped with razor-sharp talons. Its eyes are a sickly, glowing green, and it moves with unnerving speed despite its size.

Abilities:

Web of the Void: The Blackclaw can spin webs made from a substance that is a mix of thick, ethereal darkness and physical silk. These webs are incredibly strong and nearly impossible to cut through, often trapping airships and their crews. The webs themselves can drain energy from anything caught in them, making escape even harder.

Claws of Fate: Its claws are capable of slicing through metal with ease. The Blackclaw can launch itself into the air to bring its full weight down on an airship, dealing massive damage.

Abyssal Poison: The Blackclaw's venom is one of the deadliest in the Abyss, capable of causing paralysis and hallucinations in those who are bitten or scratched. If not treated quickly, the poison can kill within hours.

Danger: The Blackclaw is incredibly powerful, capable of disabling entire airships with its webbing and claws. It is also fast and incredibly hard to avoid in the dense darkness of the Abyss, where its glowing eyes are often the only warning of its presence.

5. Nightmare Hound

Appearance: A monstrous canine-like creature, the Nightmare Hound is covered in fur that seems to absorb the light around it, leaving only its glowing red eyes visible in the Abyss. Its maw is filled with rows of jagged teeth that are perpetually covered in a dark mist that swirls around its body.

Abilities:

Howl of the Void: The Nightmare Hound's howl can send waves of psychic energy into the minds of those nearby, inducing terrifying hallucinations or madness. It has the ability to project its voice over vast distances, causing confusion and panic.

Phantasmal Pursuit: When it locks onto a target, the Nightmare Hound can phase between the material world and the Abyss, briefly disappearing into the void before reappearing closer to its prey.

Soul Devour: Upon tearing into its prey, the Nightmare Hound absorbs part of the soul, leaving the victim weakened and unable to heal naturally. Their body becomes a mere shell, slowly decaying without the vitality it once had.

Danger: The Nightmare Hound can strike fear into even the most hardened of captains, capable of warping reality around it with its howl. Once it locks onto its prey, it becomes relentless, shifting between planes to chase down its victims.

6. Gloomrider

Appearance: The Gloomrider is a terrifying creature, part beast and part humanoid, with elongated limbs, leathery wings, and a face that looks like a twisted mockery of a person. Its skin is a sickly gray, and its eyes burn with an unnatural red glow. It rides a steed that is equally terrifying—a massive, twisted beast with shadowy, ethereal features.

Abilities:

Shadow Cloak: The Gloomrider can merge with the shadows, making itself nearly invisible to the naked eye. This ability allows it to stalk its prey without being detected until it is ready to strike.

Cursed Arrow: The Gloomrider is a skilled archer, able to shoot arrows that are laced with dark magic. These arrows do not just wound; they curse the victim, causing sickness, confusion, and eventually death if left untreated.

Dark Steed's Charge: The Gloomrider's steed can charge through the sky, its hooves leaving streaks of dark energy in the air. This charge can knock ships off course and send them plummeting toward the Abyss.

Danger: The Gloomrider is a deadly hunter, both in the air and on the ground. It can track and kill with precision, its cursed arrows ensuring that its victims suffer before dying. Its ability to cloak in shadows makes it almost impossible to escape once it has locked onto its prey.

Creatures of the air

Sheffels

Small Beast, Neutral

Armor Class: 12

Hit Points: 4 (1d6+1)

Speed: 10 ft., fly 30 ft. (hover)

STR: 8 (-1)

DEX: 14 (+2)

CON: 12 (+1)

INT: 3 (-4)

WIS: 10 (+0)

CHA: 12 (+1)

Skills: Perception +2, Animal Handling +3

Senses: Passive Perception 12

Languages: Understands Common but cannot speak

Challenge: 1/4 (50 XP)

Proficiency Bonus: +2

Traits

- **Hovering Flight:** Sheffels float gently through the air, moving in an almost ethereal way. They cannot gain altitude but can hover in place and maintain their position with minimal effort. They cannot be knocked prone while in the air, and their movement is not impeded by difficult terrain.
 - **Magical Wool:** The wool of a Sheffel is highly valued for its magical properties. When harvested, the wool can be spun into fine linens and fabrics, which have minor enchantments of warmth and comfort. However, harvesting the wool requires patience and care, as it takes half a year for their wool to mature. The wool, when collected, can be used to craft items worth 5-10 gp per wool bundle, depending on the quality.
 - **Gentle Nature:** Sheffels are peaceful and docile creatures, known for their docile temperament. They will never attack unless directly threatened or in self-defense. Shepherds often rely on Sheffels for their wool production, as they are easy to herd and take care of.
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Actions

- **Ram:** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +2 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 4 (1d6+1) bludgeoning damage. This attack is used in self-defense or if they are startled by something.
 - **Bubble Drift** (Recharge 5-6): The Sheffel can create a small burst of magical energy within its body that pushes it upward in a gentle, floating motion. This effect allows the Sheffel to drift up to 20 feet in a vertical direction and then hover in place for 5 rounds. While floating, the Sheffel is immune to any ground-based effects (such as terrain or difficult ground) and can avoid any melee attacks that rely on being in close proximity to the ground.
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Environment and Herding

Sheffels are commonly found in open fields and rolling hills, where the winds are gentle and the skies are open. They are often herded by **shepherds** or **farmers**, as they are valuable for their

wool, which is sought after for its unique properties. These creatures typically travel in groups of 5-10 and will follow the lead of their shepherds.

While generally not a threat to adventurers, Sheffels can be startled or spooked by loud noises, large predators, or sudden movements. They are most often encountered in **peaceful** surroundings and serve as an important part of agricultural life in the world of the sky, particularly in farming communities on floating islands or airships.

Ecological Role

Sheffels have a symbiotic relationship with the environment around them. Their wool, besides being harvested for cloth, naturally attracts small insects and helps enrich the ground with nutrients as it falls. They are often used in farming and textile production, making them valuable creatures, even if their temperament is that of a simple, peaceful animal.

Skyflayer

Large Beast, Chaotic Evil

Armor Class: 14 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 67 (9d10+18)

Speed: 40 ft., fly 60 ft. (hover)

STR: 18 (+4)

DEX: 16 (+3)

CON: 15 (+2)

INT: 6 (-2)

WIS: 12 (+1)

CHA: 8 (-1)

Skills: Perception +4, Stealth +5

Senses: Darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 14

Languages: Understands Common but cannot speak

Challenge: 3 (700 XP)

Proficiency Bonus: +2

Traits

- **Terrifying Presence:** The Skyflyer exudes an aura of hunger and ferocity. All creatures within 30 feet of it that can see it must succeed on a DC 13 Wisdom saving throw or become frightened for 5 rounds. A creature can repeat the saving throw at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on itself on a success. If a creature's saving throw is successful or the effect ends for it, the creature is immune to the Skyflyer's *Terrifying Presence* for the next 24 hours.
 - **Ambush Predator:** The Skyflyer is a patient hunter, often waiting in the clouds above its prey. It can use its **Stealth** skill to remain hidden in the sky, gaining advantage on its attack rolls against creatures that have not noticed it. This advantage lasts until the Skyflyer attacks or is detected.
 - **Aerial Acrobat:** The Skyflyer's nimble wings and body allow it to perform acrobatic maneuvers in the air. It has advantage on all Acrobatics checks while flying, and it can take the **Dodge** action as a bonus action while flying.
 - **Devouring Hunger:** The Skyflyer is a terrifying predator that lives to feed. Whenever it reduces a creature to 0 hit points, it can use its reaction to feast on the fallen creature. The Skyflyer regains hit points equal to half the creature's hit point maximum (rounded down). It can only do this once per turn.
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Actions

- **Multiattack:** The Skyflyer makes two attacks: one with its **Claws** and one with its **Bite**.
- **Claws:** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 12 (2d6+4) slashing damage.
- **Bite:** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 14 (2d8+4) piercing damage.
- **Tornado Lash** (Recharge 5-6): The Skyflyer beats its wings with tremendous force, creating a gust of wind that can knock opponents off balance. Each creature within a 15-foot cone must make a DC 14 Strength saving throw or be knocked prone and pushed 10 feet away from the Skyflyer. A creature that succeeds on the saving throw is not knocked prone but is still pushed 5 feet away.

- **Ravage:** The Skyflayer dives at its prey with terrifying speed, attacking with both claws and bite. If it has advantage on the attack roll (such as from *Ambush Predator*), it can immediately use **Devouring Hunger** as a reaction to restore hit points.
-

Legend and Behavior

The **Skyflayer** is a savage, predatory creature that hunts primarily the **Sheffels** and other small air creatures, preying on those who are weak or unwary in the skies. It is a solitary beast that drifts in the highest clouds, often unseen until it strikes. They are known for their fearsome appearance, with massive, hooked claws and a terrifying, gaping maw, always hungry for its next meal.

It uses the cover of mist and clouds to stay hidden while it stalks its prey, taking advantage of its ability to remain concealed from view. Once it has spotted its target—often a herd of Sheffels—it will wait until they are far enough from their shepherds before launching a lightning-fast attack, striking with its claws and bite. Its aerial agility allows it to quickly retreat back into the clouds after a successful hunt.

Ecological Role

Skyflayers are apex predators of the skies, and while they are dangerous to creatures like the Sheffels, they play an important role in maintaining balance in the sky's ecosystem. Their hunting keeps populations of weaker aerial creatures in check, preventing overpopulation and helping to regulate the food chain. However, their sheer hunger and viciousness often bring them into conflict with any creature they consider prey. Shepherds and farmers who rely on the gentle Sheffels for wool and other resources must take extra care to guard their flocks from these relentless hunters.

Skyflayers are feared across the sky world, often depicted in tales as the terrifying beasts that haunt the clouds, preying on any creature that wanders too far into the open air. Adventurers and air captains know well that the Skyflayer is always watching, waiting for the opportunity to strike.

Skywhale (Young)

Huge Beast, Unaligned

Armor Class: 16 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 85 (10d12+20)

Speed: 30 ft., fly 60 ft. (hover)

STR: 22 (+6)

DEX: 14 (+2)

CON: 18 (+4)

INT: 5 (-3)

WIS: 14 (+2)

CHA: 12 (+1)

Skills: Perception +6, Survival +4

Senses: Passive Perception 16, Darkvision 60 ft.

Languages: Understands Aquan and Celestial but cannot speak

Challenge: 6 (2,300 XP)

Proficiency Bonus: +3

Traits

- **Hovering:** The Skywhale can hover with great skill, moving through the air with ease, even in turbulent weather. It cannot be knocked prone while hovering.
 - **Massive Presence:** Due to its massive size, the Skywhale can affect the environment around it. When it flies over creatures smaller than it, those creatures must succeed on a DC 14 Strength saving throw or be knocked prone as the air pressure shifts and turbulent winds swirl.
 - **Whale Song:** The young Skywhale can emit a deep, melodious sound that carries over great distances. All creatures within a 300-foot radius must succeed on a DC 14 Wisdom saving throw or be charmed for 5 rounds. While charmed, the creatures are fascinated and unaware of anything happening around them. This ability can only be used once per short rest.
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Actions

- **Multiattack:** The Skywhale makes two attacks: one with its **Tail Slam** and one with its **Bite**.
 - **Tail Slam:** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +8 to hit, reach 15 ft., one target. *Hit:* 22 (3d8+6) bludgeoning damage.
 - **Bite:** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +8 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 17 (2d10+6) piercing damage.
 - **Gust of Wind (Recharge 5-6):** The Skywhale can beat its massive tail and create a powerful gust of wind in a 30-foot cone. Each creature in the area must make a DC 16 Strength saving throw or be pushed 20 feet away and knocked prone. On a successful save, the creature takes half damage and is not knocked prone.
-

Skywhale (Adult)

Gargantuan Beast, Unaligned

Armor Class: 18 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 225 (18d12+108)

Speed: 40 ft., fly 80 ft. (hover)

STR: 28 (+9)

DEX: 16 (+3)

CON: 24 (+7)

INT: 6 (-2)

WIS: 18 (+4)

CHA: 14 (+2)

Skills: Perception +9, Survival +7

Senses: Passive Perception 19, Darkvision 120 ft.

Languages: Understands Aquan and Celestial but cannot speak

Challenge: 12 (8,400 XP)

Proficiency Bonus: +4

Traits

- **Hovering Mastery:** The Skywhale is an expert at controlling its movements in the air. It has advantage on all Acrobatics checks made while flying and can move through difficult terrain with ease.
- **Tidal Call:** The adult Skywhale can unleash an ear-splitting call that resonates across the sky, filling creatures within a 600-foot radius with dread. Each creature must make a DC 17 Wisdom saving throw or be frightened for 5 rounds. A creature can repeat the saving throw at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on itself on a success. Once a creature has succeeded on its saving throw, it is immune to this ability for 24 hours.
- **Great Behemoth:** The sheer size and mass of the Skywhale makes it nearly impossible to move or incapacitate. It has advantage on Strength saving throws and checks, and creatures that attempt to grapple it are at disadvantage.

Actions

- **Multiattack:** The Skywhale makes three attacks: one with its **Tail Slam**, one with its **Bite**, and one with its **Wing Buffet**.
- **Tail Slam:** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +12 to hit, reach 20 ft., one target. *Hit:* 34 (4d10+9) bludgeoning damage.
- **Bite:** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +12 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 27 (3d10+9) piercing damage.
- **Wing Buffet:** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +12 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 22 (2d12+9) bludgeoning damage. The target must succeed on a DC 17 Strength saving throw or be knocked prone and pushed 100 feet away.
- **Tsunami Surge** (Recharge 5-6): The Skywhale creates a massive wave of air and water (if near the ocean) that surges in a 60-foot line, 15 feet wide. Each creature in the line must make a DC 18 Strength saving throw or take 42 (8d10) bludgeoning damage and be pushed 20 feet away. On a successful save, the creature takes half damage and is not pushed.

Skywhale (Elder)

Colossal Beast, Unaligned

Armor Class: 20 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 495 (30d12+240)

Speed: 50 ft., fly 120 ft. (hover)

STR: 32 (+11)

DEX: 18 (+4)

CON: 30 (+10)

INT: 8 (-1)

WIS: 24 (+7)

CHA: 20 (+5)

Skills: Perception +14, Survival +12

Senses: Passive Perception 24, Darkvision 150 ft.

Languages: Understands Aquan and Celestial but cannot speak

Challenge: 22 (41,000 XP)

Proficiency Bonus: +6

Traits

- **Elder's Presence:** The Elder Skywhale emanates an aura of ancient wisdom and power. All creatures within 500 feet of it must make a DC 21 Wisdom saving throw or be charmed for 1 hour. Creatures that succeed on the saving throw are immune to this effect for 24 hours.
 - **Legendary Resistance (3/Day):** If the Elder Skywhale fails a saving throw, it can choose to succeed instead.
 - **Massive Form:** The Elder Skywhale's immense size grants it unparalleled durability. It has resistance to all damage except force and psychic damage.
-

Actions

- **Multiattack:** The Elder Skywhale makes four attacks: two with its **Tail Slam**, one with its **Bite**, and one with its **Wing Buffet**.

- **Tail Slam:** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +18 to hit, reach 30 ft., one target. *Hit:* 45 (6d10+11) bludgeoning damage.
 - **Bite:** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +18 to hit, reach 15 ft., one target. *Hit:* 38 (4d10+11) piercing damage.
 - **Wing Buffet:** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +18 to hit, reach 15 ft., one target. *Hit:* 36 (4d8+11) bludgeoning damage. The target must succeed on a DC 21 Strength saving throw or be knocked prone and pushed 15 feet away.
 - **Tsunami Surge** (Recharge 5-6): The Elder Skywhale can summon a massive, world-shaking surge of air and water (if near the ocean) in a 100-foot line, 30 feet wide. Each creature in the line must make a DC 22 Strength saving throw or take 85 (10d12) bludgeoning damage and be pushed 40 feet away. On a successful save, the creature takes half damage and is not pushed.
 - **Whale Song (Legendary Action, 2/Day):** The Elder Skywhale releases a deep, mournful song that affects all creatures within a 1-mile radius. All creatures must make a DC 21 Wisdom saving throw or fall into a trance, becoming incapacitated for 5 rounds. The effect ends early if the creature takes damage.
-

Ecology and Role

The **Skywhale** is an ancient and majestic creature of the sky, revered in many cultures as a symbol of the vast, untamed wilderness of the aerial realms. The young Skywhales are typically seen soaring through the skies in herds, while adult Skywhales are solitary, wise, and incredibly powerful. The elder Skywhales, with their ancient knowledge and great strength, are considered living legends, and their songs are said to carry the wisdom of the ages.

Skywhales are peaceful, and though they will fight to protect themselves, they are rarely aggressive. They are often seen as benevolent beings by many, guiding travelers and adventurers through the turbulent skies. However, their size and power can make them dangerous if provoked, and their destructive ability is feared by all.

Skywhales are a rare and awe-inspiring sight in the sky world. They are not merely beasts, but living monuments to the vastness of the skies and the mysteries that lie within them. The young Skywhales, with their playful and curious nature, are often seen drifting among the clouds in herds. Their presence is a comforting one to many, symbolizing the beauty and wonder of the open sky. They are often the subject of songs, stories, and myths, and are deeply revered by cultures that call the sky their home.

The **adult Skywhales** are creatures of great wisdom and strength. Known to travel alone, they are often sought by sages and scholars for their ability to understand the rhythms of the sky. It is believed by some that these creatures have seen the world in its entirety, from the shattered

continents to the vast abyss below. Their migrations are considered sacred by certain skyfaring cultures, and their songs are believed to hold the secrets of the ancient world.

The **elder Skywhales**, with their immense size and legendary status, are considered the most powerful and revered of all Skywhales. Their long lives have made them the keepers of countless secrets, and their songs resonate with the power of the ages. These majestic beings are often seen as the guardians of the skies, watching over the balance between the air and the abyss below. Their presence is said to bring calm and stability to the turbulent winds, and they are known to intervene in times of great need, guiding lost ships or travelers to safety. The sheer size and power of these ancient beings make them awe-inspiring to behold, and they are often regarded as celestial protectors by those who dwell in the sky.

While Skywhales are not inherently aggressive, they are still creatures of immense power, and their actions can have far-reaching consequences. Young Skywhales may be more playful, but adult and elder Skywhales possess the ability to reshape the environment around them, creating powerful gusts of wind, summoning violent storms, or even triggering tidal waves if near bodies of water. These creatures are a reminder that, while the skies are vast and free, they are also wild and untamable.

Predator and Prey:

In the grand tapestry of the sky's ecosystem, Skywhales fill a unique role as gentle giants that are not natural predators, but their sheer size and presence have a significant impact on the food chain. They are often the target of predation by more dangerous creatures, such as the **Skyflayer** or **Voracious Abyssal Beasts**, who see the Skywhales' immense size as a challenge to overcome. While Skywhales may not actively hunt, their vulnerability lies in their size and the inevitable dangers posed by other creatures in the skies.

Though Skywhales are generally peaceful and majestic, the survival of their species is not guaranteed. They rely on the protection of the other skyfaring races, who help ensure that the balance of the aerial world is maintained. The ecosystems in which Skywhales live, from the lowest clouds to the highest peaks, are fragile, and the disappearance of these creatures from the skies would be a sign of a much larger, catastrophic disruption in the air world's natural order.

Cultural Significance

Skywhales have deep cultural significance for many of the races that dwell in the sky. They are seen as symbols of peace, hope, and endurance. Cultures that have a deep connection to the air, such as the **Aarakocra**, **Air Genasi**, or certain **Celestial** beings, often hold these creatures in the highest esteem. Rituals and ceremonies are often held in their honor, and their songs are thought to carry blessings from the divine.

In some cultures, the Skywhales are seen as celestial travelers who bridge the gap between the mortal world and the heavens. Some believe that the Skywhales are emissaries of the gods, carrying their will to the skies. Pilgrimages to see a Skywhale, or to listen to its song, are considered an important spiritual journey for many.

On the other hand, there are races, like the **Draconic** kind, that view the Skywhales with suspicion, seeing their connection to the celestial and elemental powers as something unnatural or pretentious. There are even whispers among certain draconic factions that the Skywhales are not native to the sky at all, but were placed there by higher powers to balance the natural order—forces of air against forces of earth and fire. These draconic factions tend to view the Skywhales as creatures to be hunted, studying their anatomy and behavior to uncover their true purpose.

Conservation and Threats

While not a species in immediate danger of extinction, the Skywhales are still vulnerable due to the ever-present threats to their environment. The rapid expansion of aerial technology, particularly in the form of airships, and the increasing exploitation of the sky's resources, such as floating islands or valuable minerals, has begun to threaten the habitats where Skywhales breed and live. In many places, the Skywhales are seen as omens of balance—signifying that the sky is still alive and healthy. However, as these habitats are encroached upon, there is a growing concern that the Skywhales might begin to disappear.

Efforts to protect them have been taken by many, including skyfarers, scholars, and powerful organizations. Some factions have begun to create safe havens, floating sanctuaries where the Skywhales can roam freely, away from the encroaching forces of industrial expansion. These efforts are critical to preserving the balance in the skies and ensuring that the Skywhales continue to thrive.

Aerial Parasite: Sky Maw

Description:

The **Sky Maw** is a parasitic creature that dwells in the air, often attaching itself to ships or other flying creatures to feed off their vital energies. These creatures have evolved to survive in the harsh environment of the sky, relying on a mix of stealth and parasitism to feed off the life force of larger creatures. While they are most commonly encountered on ships or large flying beasts, they have been known to latch onto anything that can fly, drawing sustenance from the energy or magic flowing through their hosts.

Small Sky Maw

Size Category: Tiny

Armor Class: 13 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 14 (4d4 + 2)

Speed: 10 ft., fly 40 ft. (hover)

STR: 7 (-2)

DEX: 15 (+2)

CON: 13 (+1)

INT: 4 (-3)

WIS: 10 (+0)

CHA: 6 (-2)

Skills: Stealth +4

Damage Immunities: Psychic

Senses: Darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 10

Languages: Understands Draconic but cannot speak

Challenge: 1/4 (50 XP)

Traits:

- **Stealthy Parasite:** The Sky Maw has advantage on Stealth checks made to hide in or around flying creatures or airships.
- **Life Siphon:** The Sky Maw can drain 1d6 hit points from a creature it is attached to each turn. The creature must succeed on a DC 12 Constitution saving throw or lose additional permanent hit points equal to (2).
- **Evasive Maneuver:** The Sky Maw has disadvantage on any attack rolls made against it while hovering or attached to a creature.

Actions:

- **Bite:** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) piercing damage. If the Sky Maw is attached to a creature, this damage increases by 2 and the creature must make a DC 12 Constitution saving throw or suffer from **Life Siphon**.

Normal Sky Maw

Size Category: Medium

Armor Class: 14 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 45 (6d8 + 18)

Speed: 20 ft., fly 60 ft.

STR: 10 (+0)

DEX: 17 (+3)

CON: 16 (+3)

INT: 6 (-2)

WIS: 12 (+1)

CHA: 8 (-1)

Skills: Stealth +7

Damage Immunities: Psychic

Senses: Darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 11

Languages: Understands Draconic but cannot speak

Challenge: 2 (450 XP)

Traits:

- **Stealthy Parasite:** The Sky Maw has advantage on Stealth checks made to hide in or around flying creatures or airships.
- **Life Siphon:** The Sky Maw can drain 2d6 hit points from a creature it is attached to each turn. The creature must succeed on a DC 14 Constitution saving throw or lose additional permanent hit points equal to (3).
- **Magical Absorption:** If the Sky Maw attaches to a magical vessel (e.g., airship or flying mount), it absorbs magic from the vessel, giving the Sky Maw resistance to the next spell cast on it within the next hour.
- **Evasive Maneuver:** The Sky Maw has disadvantage on any attack rolls made against it while hovering or attached to a creature.

Actions:

- **Bite:** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (1d8 + 3) piercing damage. If the Sky Maw is attached to a creature, this damage increases by 3 and the creature must make a DC 14 Constitution saving throw or suffer from **Life Siphon**.
- **Spinal Constriction (Recharge 5-6):** The Sky Maw constricts its victim, draining its life force. A creature within 5 feet of the Sky Maw must make a DC 14 Strength saving throw or be restrained as the creature's spine is crushed. While restrained in this way, the creature takes 3d6 piercing damage at the start of the Sky Maw's turn.

Huge Sky Maw

Size Category: Huge

Armor Class: 17 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 120 (12d12 + 48)

Speed: 40 ft., fly 80 ft.

STR: 24 (+7)

DEX: 16 (+3)

CON: 22 (+6)

INT: 8 (-1)

WIS: 14 (+2)

CHA: 12 (+1)

Skills: Stealth +9, Athletics +12

Damage Immunities: Psychic, Necrotic

Senses: Darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 14

Languages: Understands Draconic but cannot speak

Challenge: 8 (3,900 XP)

Traits:

- **Stealthy Parasite:** The Sky Maw has advantage on Stealth checks made to hide in or around flying creatures or airships.
- **Life Siphon:** The Sky Maw can drain 3d6 hit points from a creature it is attached to each turn. The creature must succeed on a DC 17 Constitution saving throw or lose additional permanent hit points equal to (6).
- **Magical Absorption:** If the Sky Maw attaches to a magical vessel (e.g., airship or flying mount), it absorbs magic from the vessel, giving the Sky Maw advantage on saving throws against spells for the next hour.
- **Evasive Maneuver:** The Sky Maw has disadvantage on any attack rolls made against it while hovering or attached to a creature.
- **Powerful Siphon:** The Sky Maw gains hit points equal to half the damage dealt by its **Life Siphon**.

Actions:

- **Bite:** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +10 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 12 (2d8 + 7) piercing damage. If the Sky Maw is attached to a creature, this damage increases by 6, and the creature must make a DC 17 Constitution saving throw or suffer from **Life Siphon**.
- **Spinal Constriction (Recharge 5-6):** The Sky Maw constricts its victim, draining its life force. A creature within 10 feet of the Sky Maw must make a DC 18 Strength saving throw or be restrained as the creature's spine is crushed. While restrained in this way, the creature takes 5d6 piercing damage at the start of the Sky Maw's turn.
- **Skydevour (Recharge 6):** The Sky Maw makes a massive sucking sound and attempts to pull in any nearby flying creatures or ships within 30 feet. All creatures in that range

must make a DC 18 Strength saving throw or be pulled towards the Sky Maw's maw and take 3d6 bludgeoning damage. Creatures that fail the saving throw also fall prone and suffer disadvantage on their next attack.

Ecology:

Sky Maws are the embodiment of parasitism, thriving off the power of their hosts. While they typically attack smaller creatures, they are known to gravitate toward powerful magical entities, often bringing destruction to anything they latch onto. Sky Maws have a high survival rate, evolving to blend into the natural environments of the sky. They feed on life energy, often draining the magic or vitality of any flying ship or creature they attach to, weakening them over time.

These creatures, while dangerous, serve a unique role in the ecosystem, thinning out the weaker or overextended airships, mounts, and other flying entities. Though some cultures consider them pests, others revere them as enigmatic creatures that help maintain the balance between nature and the arcane forces above the clouds.

Despite their parasitic nature, **Sky Maws** are integral to the broader ecosystem of the sky world. In a way, they serve as natural "cleaners," removing weaker or unstable flying creatures, which prevents overpopulation or unchecked magical energy from accumulating. Their life cycle has evolved around the concept of balance—attaching to larger creatures, weakening them over time, and ensuring that only the fittest and most resilient remain in the skies. However, this also means that they are often feared and avoided, especially by those who rely heavily on magic and powerful flying ships or mounts.

In the wild, the Sky Maw is often the apex of parasitic life. It will sometimes attach itself to floating islands or even large air currents, where it can siphon energy from the magical and elemental forces that sustain these flying objects. These creatures are not indiscriminate in their attacks, preferring targets that can sustain them for long periods. This makes them a menace to long-term travelers in the skies, such as airship captains or skyfaring merchants who rely on extended voyages to transport goods.

In some regions, **Sky Maw infestations** are a real threat, particularly in areas where magical energies run rampant or in regions of the sky where airships are most heavily concentrated. An infestation of these parasites can weaken an entire fleet of ships, draining the energy from the vessels and sometimes even causing them to crash into the abyss below. To combat this, some airship fleets have specially trained "Parasite Hunters" who specialize in identifying and removing Sky Maws from their vessels before too much damage is done.

Despite their status as predators, **Sky Maws** can sometimes be used strategically in certain cultures. For instance, in regions where magical power is a scarce resource, these parasites might be captured and kept in controlled environments, used to siphon magic or energy from other, less valuable sources. This practice is risky, as it requires great skill to keep the creatures under control, but the potential rewards are significant. Some wizard societies even train Sky Maws to feed on the magic of captured spells, harnessing their parasitic properties for magical research or experimentation.

It is rare but there are recorded instances of wayfarers trapped in magicless areas following Sky Maws to areas of normal magic flow.

Behavior and Social Structure

Sky Maws are solitary creatures, rarely interacting with others of their kind outside of mating seasons. Their natural instinct is to seek out large flying creatures or magical objects, attach themselves to their prey, and drain them of their life force over a long period. During mating season, however, **Sky Maws** are known to form temporary swarms. These swarms can be especially dangerous, as multiple Sky Maws acting together are capable of overwhelming even the most formidable of airships.

In such swarms, the Sky Maws often communicate through a combination of eerie, high-pitched calls and subtle movements. While they do not speak in the traditional sense, these sounds and movements serve to coordinate their attacks, ensuring that they overwhelm their targets. It is during these swarming behaviors that the true danger of a **Sky Maw infestation** becomes evident, as entire air fleets or floating islands can be drained in a matter of days by a large enough swarm.

While the parasitic nature of Sky Maws may seem purely destructive, they have a certain respect within the natural order. In some cultures, particularly those that live on the floating islands, the Sky Maw is viewed as a symbol of nature's way of ensuring balance. Some even say that the Sky Maw's draining of energy helps to maintain harmony between the various floating islands and air currents, preventing the world of the sky from becoming too chaotic.

Combat Tactics

In combat, the **Sky Maw** is a patient and opportunistic predator. It rarely engages in direct confrontation unless it feels certain that its prey is vulnerable. Instead, it waits for the perfect opportunity to latch onto a target and begin draining it of life force.

- **Ambush Tactics:** Sky Maws are often found lying in wait within the clouds, using their Stealthy Parasite ability to blend in with the surrounding environment. When a flying ship or creature passes by, the Sky Maw will swoop down and attach itself to the weakest point of the target, typically the hull of an airship or the side of a flying mount. Once attached, the Sky Maw begins its life siphon, draining the target of vital energy and weakening it over time.
 - **Swarming and Coordinated Strikes:** When in groups, **Sky Maws** become much more aggressive. A swarm of Sky Maws will work together to overwhelm a single target, using their combined strength and speed to attach to different points on the target and rapidly drain its energy. This tactic is especially deadly to airships, as the crew may not be able to defend all points at once.
 - **Magical Disruption:** The Sky Maw has a unique advantage in that it can disrupt magical fields. If it attaches to a magical vessel, it absorbs some of the magic that powers the ship, temporarily weakening its magical defenses or causing spells to fail. This makes the Sky Maw particularly dangerous to mages or those who rely heavily on magical airships.
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Sky Maw Variants

Though the **Sky Maw** is most commonly known for its parasitic relationship with flying creatures, there are several known variants, some more dangerous than others:

1. **Cloud Maw:** This variant is more ethereal and transparent, blending perfectly with the sky. It feeds off the elemental magic that sustains the sky itself and can even cause air currents to shift around it. This version of the Sky Maw is less physically dangerous but is harder to detect and combat.
 2. **Tempest Maw:** A much larger and more aggressive variant, the Tempest Maw feeds off storms and violent weather. It thrives in areas where magic and air currents create intense turbulence, and it often causes storms to grow larger as it feeds. The Tempest Maw is capable of unleashing devastating electrical pulses as it drains its prey.
 3. **Abyss Maw:** The most dangerous variant, the Abyss Maw is an enormous version of the Sky Maw that dwells in the boundary between the sky and the abyss. This creature is capable of siphoning massive amounts of energy, draining entire ships of their magic and life force in an instant. It is a rare, but deadly predator that many consider a harbinger of doom.
-

The **Sky Maw** is a deadly and mysterious predator that has evolved to live in the skies, feeding off the life energy of larger flying creatures and airships. While it serves a natural role in balancing the ecosystems of the sky, its parasitic nature makes it a feared and dangerous entity.

Whether as a solitary hunter or as part of a swarm, the Sky Maw remains a potent threat to those who travel the skies, always lurking in the clouds, waiting for the perfect moment to strike.

Aerial Rabbit: Flufftrounce

Description:

The **Flufftrounce** is a small, energetic, and harmless aerial creature resembling a rabbit in both appearance and behavior. It flits and trounces through the sky, its fluffy body buoyed by soft, air-filled wings that allow it to float gracefully through the clouds. Though it may appear flighty and nervous, the Flufftrounce is completely non-aggressive, preferring to hop from one floating island to another or dart about in the air for short bursts of speed, often chased by excited children or curious explorers. Known for its delicate fur and wide, expressive eyes, the Flufftrounce is a favorite among those who admire the lighter, more whimsical aspects of life in the sky.

Flufftrounce Stats

Size Category: Tiny

Armor Class: 13 (natural fur)

Hit Points: 5 (2d4)

Speed: 30 ft., fly 40 ft. (hover)

STR: 6 (-2)

DEX: 16 (+3)

CON: 10 (+0)

INT: 4 (-3)

WIS: 12 (+1)

CHA: 14 (+2)

Skills: Acrobatics +5, Stealth +5

Senses: Darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 11

Languages: None

Challenge: 1/8 (25 XP)

Traits:

- **Fluttering Movement:** The Flufftrounce's wings allow it to hover gracefully. It has advantage on all Acrobatics checks to avoid falling and is immune to effects that would knock it prone.
 - **Hyperactive:** The Flufftrounce can take the Dash or Disengage action as a bonus action. Its speed increases by 10 feet while doing so.
 - **Fluff Cloud:** The Flufftrounce's fur is soft and puffy, exuding tiny floating particles that create a light, cloud-like trail behind it as it flies. Creatures that track it may have disadvantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks to track its movements, as the cloud confuses their senses.
 - **Harmless Flit:** The Flufftrounce has disadvantage on all attack rolls, but it can use its **Harmless Flit** ability to slip away when in danger. Once per day, it can take the **Dodge** action as a reaction.
-

Actions:

- **Trousers of Joy:** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 1 piercing damage. On a hit, the target must succeed on a DC 10 Dexterity saving throw or be knocked prone by the sudden, startled hop of the Flufftrounce.
 - **Hop and Flit (Recharge 5-6):** The Flufftrounce moves up to its flying speed in any direction without provoking opportunity attacks, leaving behind a faint cloud of fluff. This ability is used to escape predators or evade capture, and can be triggered only once per short or long rest.
-

Ecology and Behavior:

The **Flufftrounce** is a creature of the gentle skies, favoring the upper clouds and hovering near the soft winds that sweep through floating islands and ships. These creatures feed on airborne plants, such as fluffy mosses and cloud-grown fruits, and occasionally nibble on small insects or magical spores that float through the atmosphere. Their soft fur is highly coveted by those seeking materials for delicate crafts, but these creatures are too swift to be easily captured.

Flufftrounces are commonly seen in small herds, hopping and flitting across open skies. They communicate with a series of chirps, trills, and high-pitched squeaks, especially when startled. Despite their nervous demeanor, they are completely harmless and often sought after by adventurers or families as companions during long flights.

The Flufftrounce plays a crucial role in its ecosystem by aiding in the dispersal of airborne seeds and spores, effectively helping plant life spread across the floating islands and ships. Some say

that where the Flufftrounces are seen, new plant life soon follows, growing in the wake of their cheerful flittings. Though they are fragile creatures, their charm and their utility in the ecosystem make them beloved by those who understand the delicate balance of the sky world.

1. Aetherhawk

Small Beast, Unaligned

Armor Class: 15 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 9 (2d6 + 2)

Speed: 10 ft., fly 50 ft. (hover)

STR: 8 (-1)

DEX: 16 (+3)

CON: 12 (+1)

INT: 4 (-3)

WIS: 14 (+2)

CHA: 10 (+0)

Skills: Acrobatics +5, Stealth +5

Senses: Darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 12

Languages: Understands Common but cannot speak

Challenge: 1/4 (50 XP)

Traits:

- **Elemental Wind:** The Aetherhawk can manipulate air currents. Once per short rest, it can increase its flying speed by 30 feet for 5 rounds.
- **Speed Dive:** When the Aetherhawk dives at least 20 feet toward a creature, it can deal an additional 2d6 piercing damage with its talons on a successful attack.
- **Aerial Mastery:** The Aetherhawk has advantage on Acrobatics checks and saving throws to avoid falling or being knocked prone while flying.

Actions:

- **Beak:** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 3) piercing damage.
- **Talons:** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 4 (1d4 + 3) slashing damage.

2. Storm Eagle

Small Beast, Unaligned

Armor Class: 14 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 18 (4d6)

Speed: 10 ft., fly 60 ft.

STR: 10 (+0)

DEX: 16 (+3)

CON: 14 (+2)

INT: 5 (-3)

WIS: 14 (+2)

CHA: 8 (-1)

Skills: Perception +4

Senses: Darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 14

Languages: Understands Common but cannot speak

Challenge: 1/2 (100 XP)

Traits:

- **Thunderous Talons:** The Storm Eagle's talons crackle with electricity. On a successful hit, the target must make a DC 13 Constitution saving throw or be stunned until the end of its next turn.
 - **Tempest Roar:** Once per day, the Storm Eagle can release a deafening cry in a 20-foot radius. Creatures in that area must make a DC 12 Wisdom saving throw or be frightened for 5 rounds.
 - **Wind Channeler:** The Storm Eagle can absorb ambient winds, healing itself for 1d6 hit points as a reaction when it is within a storm or high winds.
-

Actions:

- **Beak:** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d6 + 3) piercing damage.
- **Talons:** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 4 (1d4 + 3) slashing damage, plus the effects of **Thunderous Talons**.

3. Sky Vulture

Small Beast, Unaligned

Armor Class: 12 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 15 (4d6)

Speed: 20 ft., fly 40 ft.

STR: 8 (-1)

DEX: 14 (+2)

CON: 12 (+1)

INT: 4 (-3)

WIS: 16 (+3)

CHA: 10 (+0)

Skills: Perception +5

Senses: Darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 15

Languages: Understands Common but cannot speak

Challenge: 1/2 (100 XP)

Traits:

- **Scavenger's Instinct:** The Sky Vulture can sense the scent of blood or decay within 500 feet and is always aware of any creature within that range that is weakened, injured, or dying.
- **Mighty Beak:** The Sky Vulture can use its beak to deal 1d8 piercing damage. If the creature is at or below half hit points, the damage increases to 2d8.
- **Eternal Circles:** The Sky Vulture needs only 2 hours of rest in a 24-hour period to fly continuously.

Actions:

- **Beak:** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d8 + 2) piercing damage, or 10 (2d8 + 2) if the target is below half HP.
- **Talons:** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 4 (1d4 + 2) slashing damage.

4. Skywurm

Small Dragon, Unaligned

Armor Class: 14 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 16 (3d6 + 3)

Speed: 30 ft., fly 50 ft.

STR: 12 (+1)

DEX: 14 (+2)

CON: 15 (+2)

INT: 6 (-2)

WIS: 16 (+3)

CHA: 10 (+0)

Skills: Acrobatics +4, Perception +5

Senses: Darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 15

Languages: Understands Draconic but cannot speak

Challenge: 1/2 (100 XP)

Traits:

- **Serpentine Flight:** The Skywurm has advantage on Acrobatics checks to avoid falling or being knocked prone while flying.
- **Draconic Wrath:** Once per day, the Skywurm can release a 15-foot cone of lightning breath. Creatures within the cone must make a DC 13 Dexterity saving throw, taking 2d8 lightning damage on a failed save, or half as much on a successful one.
- **Feathered Cunning:** The Skywurm can cast **Pass Without Trace** once per day.

Actions:

- **Bite:** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) piercing damage.
- **Claw:** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 4 (1d4 + 2) slashing damage.

Fauna of the sky

Aerial Flora of the Sky World

In the high, cloud-scraped reaches of the sky world, plant life has adapted in extraordinary ways to thrive in an environment with limited ground. These plants float naturally, each with unique characteristics, capabilities, and purposes, ranging from natural buoyancy to magical properties that allow them to survive the challenges of a sky-bound existence.

1. Alga Bubbles

Plant Type: Floating Algae

Size: Small to Medium

Environment: Air pockets in the upper atmosphere, floating clusters

Color: Transparent, with a faint greenish hue

Description:

Alga Bubbles are an air-dwelling form of algae that float on the winds, often seen drifting in clusters like translucent balloons. These spherical masses contain a gas-like substance within them, allowing them to remain buoyant despite their heavy, greenish mass. They grow best in regions of thick cloud cover where moisture is abundant.

Uses:

- **Medicinal:** When dried and ground into powder, Alga Bubbles are used in healing potions that restore stamina and alleviate exhaustion.
- **Energy Source:** They are a low-grade energy source, used to produce a mild form of magical energy when exposed to certain types of light.
- **Food:** The inner fluid, when extracted, can be consumed as a nutrient-rich paste.

Dangers:

- The air currents in which they float can carry them into regions where they're difficult to retrieve. If popped “prematurely”, their magical energy bursts can release a toxic gas that can cause temporary paralysis. A properly aged algebra has a slight purplish oily Sheen to its exterior. While a pre ripe bubble has two bright a green
-

2. Sky Wheat Balls

Plant Type: Floating Grass

Size: Small to Medium

Environment: High-altitude plains, floating on upper wind currents

Color: Golden with a hint of silver shimmer

Description:

Sky Wheat Balls are spherical formations of floating grasses that resemble puffballs of wheat. These plants are clustered together and are often mistaken for clouds due to their fluffy appearance. Their unique characteristic is the ability to form large airborne clusters, which can roll with the wind, sometimes spanning several miles. The wheat is resilient, growing even in the lightest and driest of conditions.

Uses:

- **Food:** Sky Wheat Balls can be harvested for their grain, which is ground into a flour suitable for baking, producing a soft, airy bread. A staple in many sky-dwelling communities.
- **Crafting:** The outer shells of the wheat balls are used to make light yet sturdy materials for construction and airship sails.
- **Potion Ingredient:** The grains are also used in potions that enhance dexterity and agility, prized by skyfarers and adventurers.

Dangers:

- The seeds of Sky Wheat Balls are delicate and can be easily disturbed by storms, causing them to break apart in the air, scattering their contents and creating potential hazards in the sky if not carefully managed.
-

3. Bundle Blooms

Plant Type: Climbing Vine

Size: Medium to Large

Environment: Clusters on rock outcroppings, cliff edges, and floating islands

Color: Pale purple with veins of gold

Description:

Bundle Blooms are hanging vines that grow in clusters, with each plant sporting clusters of beautiful, bell-shaped flowers that are highly fragrant. Their most fascinating feature is their ability to attach to nearly any surface and send their roots into the air, where they capture

moisture and nutrients. The clusters of flowers release spores that float on the air and help the plant reproduce. There are many subspecies of bundle blooms, some of which hover in the air freely. Wiring only the most tenuous attachment to the ground. They're floating objects. Well, the most virulent varieties cover any nearby terrain in the most virulent of vines.

Uses:

- **Healing:** Bundle Blooms' flowers are often brewed into powerful potions that aid in the regeneration of limbs or accelerate healing for those wounded in the skies.
- **Perfume:** The flowers' scent is used in perfumes and incense, highly sought after by high-born nobles and travelers for its calming effects.
- **Crafting:** The vines are incredibly durable and are often woven into ropes or used as building material for floating structures.

Dangers:

- While beautiful, the flowers are highly addictive when inhaled too much, causing a dreamy stupor in individuals, which can make it difficult for them to remain focused or even perform basic tasks.

1. Celestial Bundle Bloom

Description:

- Pale purple with golden veins glowing faintly at night.
- Flowers float freely in the air, connected by nearly invisible thread-like roots.
- Found on high-altitude floating islands or drifting in wind currents.

Characteristics:

- Edible and healing.
- The nectar is sweet, with a faint citrus tang, and is used in high-tier regenerative potions.
- When brewed, the petals form a golden liquid that accelerates healing and soothes pain.

Dangers:

- Overharvesting destabilizes the plant's delicate ecosystems, causing environmental collapse in floating areas.

2. Dreamweaver Bundle Bloom

Description:

- Deep purple flowers with veins of shifting gold and silver.
- Grows along the edges of cliffs, creating dense, fragrant curtains.

Characteristics:

- Ideal for perfumes and incense.
- Its scent is calming but can be dangerously hypnotic in enclosed spaces.

Dangers:

- Prolonged exposure causes hallucinations and dependency, leaving victims in a trance-like state.
-

3. Goldenstrangle Bloom (*Toxic/Invasive*)

Description:

- Bright yellow with gold veins and thorny vines that grow aggressively.
- Covers entire landscapes if left unchecked, choking out other plant life.

Characteristics:

- Highly invasive, quickly overrunning ecosystems.
- Produces toxic spores that cause skin irritation and respiratory distress.
- Only useful as a source of durable fiber for crafting, but harvesting is perilous.

Dangers:

- Extended exposure can lead to paralysis or death from toxin buildup.
-

4. Driftshade Bloom (*Floating Variety*)

Description:

- Light lavender with faded golden veins, faintly glowing in moonlight.
- Roots absorb moisture from the air, allowing it to hover slightly above ground or water.

Characteristics:

- A staple food for sky-dwelling fauna and some humanoids.
- Its petals can be brewed into teas that induce restful sleep and ease anxiety.

Dangers:

- Consuming large quantities can result in permanent sleep or coma.
-

5. Virulent Bloom (*Deadly Variety*)**Description:**

- Crimson flowers with veins that glow menacingly in darkness.
- Grows rapidly, blanketing entire regions with dense, choking vines.

Characteristics:

- Spores are highly toxic, causing immediate respiratory failure in those who inhale them.
- The vines secrete a sticky sap that traps prey, slowly digesting it to feed the plant.

Dangers:

- Known to destroy settlements by overtaking entire structures and landscapes.
 - Removing it requires fire, which risks spreading the spores further.
-

6. Everbloom Vine (*Hybrid/Useful Variety*)**Description:**

- Pale purple with veins that shift between gold and green.
- Slow-growing, with strong vines that weave into elegant patterns.

Characteristics:

- Durable and flexible, the vines are prized for crafting ropes and reinforcing floating structures.
- Flowers have mild healing properties but are not addictive or hypnotic.

Dangers:

- None directly, but the hybrid variety is less resistant to pests, which can spread to other crops.
-

7. Lurelight Bloom (Predatory/Deceptive)

Description:

- Bioluminescent pale gold flowers, glowing steadily in low light, with long tendrils that shimmer faintly as if alive.
- Found on isolated cliffs, abandoned ruins, or deep crevices, often near colonies of carnivorous plants that benefit from its deceptive nature.

Characteristics:

- Emits a gentle, pulsing light that mimics the glow of magical artifacts or rare sky crystals, luring unsuspecting creatures closer.
- The scent of the bloom is sweet and faintly metallic, enticing creatures to investigate or rest near it.
- Its tendrils produce a sticky, mildly numbing sap that can entangle smaller creatures or disorient larger ones.
- Nearby carnivorous plants thrive on the prey attracted by the Lurelight's glow, often forming symbiotic relationships with the vine.

Dangers:

- The sap contains neurotoxins that dull reflexes and induce a dreamy state, making escape difficult.
- If burned or damaged, it releases a cloud of spores that attract other predatory creatures in the area, creating further peril.
- Prolonged exposure to the light and scent can cause hallucinations, leading explorers to become lost or venture into dangerous terrain.

Uses:

- Carefully harvested sap can be diluted into a paralytic agent used in hunting or combat.
- The light-emitting flowers are highly prized for decorative purposes, though harvesting them is perilous.
- Adventurers occasionally use the plant strategically to lure predators or creatures into traps, though the risks are significant.

4. Timber Hearts

Plant Type: Floating Tree

Size: Large

Environment: Floating forests or isolated islands in the sky

Color: Deep green with golden veins, radiant when in bloom

Description:

Timber Hearts are towering trees that float majestically in the sky, their trunks thick and covered with smooth bark. The trees' hearts (the central part of the trunk) emit a faint, warm glow, resembling the beating pulse of a heart. Their roots extend downward into the air, which helps anchor them in place while still allowing them to drift and sway with the wind. The Timber Heart is known for being one of the most resilient plants in the sky, surviving harsh winds and magical disturbances.

Uses:

- **Woodworking:** The wood of the Timber Heart is prized for its strength and is commonly used in the construction of airships, sky fortresses, and even bridges between floating islands.
- **Magical Component:** The heartwood, when harvested during the tree's blooming season, is a powerful magical material, often used in enchantments that protect ships from falling into the Abyss.
- **Medicinal:** The sap from the Timber Heart is a highly potent restorative and is used in both healing salves and as an elixir for longevity.

Dangers:

- The Timber Heart tree is fiercely protective of its territory. The seeds are carried by the wind, and any intrusion into its space triggers aggressive magical defenses, which can range from the growth of thorny brambles to violent windstorms.
- The radiant glow of the heart can also attract dangerous aerial predators, making it a risky place for harvesting unless handled carefully.

Sub Breeds

1. Aurora Timber Heart

Description:

- Radiates an ethereal glow with shifting colors resembling an aurora.
- Found in high-altitude floating forests where magical energy is abundant.

Characteristics:

- Heartwood is infused with elemental magic, making it a favored material for crafting staves and wands.
- Sap glows faintly in the dark and has rejuvenating properties, particularly effective in countering magical exhaustion.
- The tree's leaves emit a soft chiming sound when wind passes through them, often described as "nature's lullaby."

Dangers:

- Highly territorial, it creates illusions to disorient intruders and guard its core.
 - The shifting glow can attract sky elementals, which often nest in its branches, posing additional risks to harvesters.
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2. Ironbark Timber Heart

Description:

- Dark green leaves with metallic silver veins, and bark as hard as steel.
- Found in storm-prone regions, anchoring floating isles against strong winds.

Characteristics:

- Wood is extremely dense and resistant to fire and lightning, ideal for crafting armor, reinforced airships, and weapons.
- Sap contains trace minerals that promote physical resilience and accelerated bone healing.

Dangers:

- The tree generates electromagnetic pulses during storms, interfering with navigation equipment and magical devices.
 - Its roots secrete an acidic sap that can corrode tools if mishandled.
-

3. Twilight Timber Heart

Description:

- A hauntingly beautiful tree with dark, nearly black leaves and veins that glow a deep violet at night.
- Thrives in shadowed regions of the sky, often growing near ruins or magical ley lines.

Characteristics:

- Heartwood contains necrotic energy, making it a sought-after material for crafting items related to shadow magic or necromancy.
- Sap is used in rare rituals to preserve the body and extend life, though the effects are controversial and unpredictable.
- The tree absorbs ambient magical energy, creating an aura of stillness in its vicinity.

Dangers:

- Its presence attracts undead creatures and shadowy entities.
 - The heart emits pulses of dark energy to repel intruders, draining vitality from anyone nearby.
-

4. Sundrop Timber Heart**Description:**

- Bright golden leaves with radiant veins that shimmer like liquid sunlight.
- Found in sun-drenched floating isles, often among other vibrant flora.

Characteristics:

- Heartwood emits a constant, soft light, often used to illuminate sky ships and floating settlements.
- Sap has powerful healing properties, especially effective against burns and sun-related ailments.
- Leaves can be brewed into a tea that provides warmth and boosts morale in cold or dark environments.

Dangers:

- The bright glow attracts predators such as sky drakes and other light-seeking creatures.
 - Prolonged exposure to its light without protection can cause sunburn or heatstroke.
-

5. Verdant Timber Heart**Description:**

- Deep green foliage with golden veins that expand during blooming seasons, creating a dense canopy.
- Found in dense floating groves, often forming natural bridges between smaller islands.

Characteristics:

- Heartwood is incredibly flexible yet durable, used in crafting tools and weapons with spring-like qualities.
- Sap promotes rapid plant growth and is used by sky farmers for cultivating crops on floating islands.
- Its dense canopy provides shelter for many sky creatures, forming a unique ecosystem.

Dangers:

- Rapid root growth can overtake nearby structures, damaging floating settlements or airship docks.
- The tree secretes a pheromone during blooming season that attracts aggressive herbivores and territorial beasts.

5. Windweaver Ferns

Plant Type: Floating Fern

Size: Small to Medium

Environment: Cliff faces and the undersides of larger floating islands

Color: Pale blue-green, luminescent

Description:

Windweaver Ferns are delicate floating plants that have long, slender fronds that catch the wind like sails, giving them the ability to float for long distances. The fronds are covered in a fine, silk-like material that helps trap air currents, allowing the fern to glide through the sky. When disturbed, the fern releases spores that act as a distraction to any predators or threats nearby.

Uses:

- **Wind Magic:** The ferns are often harvested by wind mages to create enchanted scrolls or spells that manipulate air currents or control flight paths.
- **Dyes:** The sap from the fern is used to produce a vibrant dye that is often used in clothing for sky travelers.

- **Fabrics:** The soft silk-like material woven from the fern's fronds is highly prized for its softness and used to make garments and lightweight blankets.

Dangers:

- Windweaver Ferns are highly sensitive to any changes in wind direction, and tampering with them can cause an explosive release of spores that can disorient creatures or cause a mild hallucinogenic effect.

Sub Breeds

1. Silverveil Fern

Description:

- Fronds are pale silver with a shimmering, reflective surface that glints in sunlight.
- Typically found on the highest, windiest floating islands, thriving in strong air currents.

Characteristics:

- The silk-like fibers are exceptionally lightweight and reflective, often used to craft cloaks and garments for camouflage or light deflection.
- The spores are known to create brief but powerful gusts of wind when released, aiding in self-propulsion or scattering predators.
- Highly sought after by skyfarers for crafting wind-resistant sails.

Dangers:

- The reflective nature of the plant can attract predators like sky serpents or other light-sensitive creatures.
 - The spores, if inhaled, can cause temporary blindness or light sensitivity in unwary harvesters.
-

2. Shadowlace Fern

Description:

- Deep blue fronds with faint luminescence, resembling lace patterns under moonlight.
- Found in shadowed crevices or on the undersides of floating islands with minimal light exposure.

Characteristics:

- Its sap produces a deep, long-lasting dye used for stealth garments and skyfarer insignias.
- The silk is unusually strong for its thinness and is often used in crafting nets and lightweight armor.
- Spores create a dense, shadow-like fog upon release, making it useful for escape or ambush situations.

Dangers:

- Prolonged exposure to the fog causes confusion and vertigo, making it dangerous to work with in enclosed spaces.
 - The plant has a symbiotic relationship with nocturnal sky predators that often nest nearby, making harvesting risky.
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3. Stormtide Fern

Description:

- Fronds are a vibrant teal with streaks of pale yellow resembling lightning bolts.
- Found on the edges of floating islands prone to frequent storms.

Characteristics:

- The silk-like fibers are slightly conductive and used in crafting equipment resistant to electrical surges.
- The spores, when released, generate static electricity that can repel small predators or lightly shock intruders.
- Popular among storm mages for creating enchanted items that harness wind and lightning magic.

Dangers:

- Harvesting during a storm is perilous as the plant can amplify nearby electrical activity.
 - The spores can cause a tingling sensation or mild shocks if inhaled or absorbed through the skin.
-

4. Glowglide Fern

Description:

- Fronds are pale green with glowing tips that radiate soft, golden light.

- Commonly found on floating islands with heavy vegetation, often in symbiosis with other glowing plants.

Characteristics:

- Its glow is soothing and used in skyfarer lanterns or as natural ambient lighting in floating settlements.
- The silk fibers are prized for creating luminescent fabrics that retain their glow for years.
- Spores emit a calming pheromone that reduces aggression in nearby creatures, making it useful for pacifying livestock or calming tense situations.

Dangers:

- Overexposure to the spores can cause lethargy and a lack of focus, making it risky for adventurers in dangerous areas.
 - The plant's glow attracts insects and small predators, which can overwhelm harvesters if unprepared.
-

5. Hearthfern**Description:**

- Fronds are deep green with warm, amber-colored veins.
- Found in temperate floating islands near settlements or abandoned ruins.

Characteristics:

- The silk material is fire-resistant, making it ideal for crafting protective clothing or heatproof sails.
- The sap can be brewed into a tonic that warms the body and wards off cold-related ailments, popular among skyfarers venturing into frigid regions.
- Spores release a faint heat wave, making it a natural deterrent for frost-based predators.

Dangers:

- The heat emitted by the spores can attract fire elementals or ignite volatile materials nearby.
- Harvesting during its blooming phase can trigger a defensive burst of heat that scorches unprotected skin.

6. Sky Thistle

Plant Type: Floating Cactus

Size: Small

Environment: High cliffs, drifting near the edges of floating islands

Color: Pale grayish-blue with purple flowers

Description:

The Sky Thistle is a small, thorny plant with the ability to float on the air currents. Its thorny exterior helps it collect moisture from the clouds, and it thrives in areas with frequent lightning storms. The plant's purple flowers are a rare sight, but they bloom only when there's a significant amount of ambient magical energy in the air.

Uses:

- **Potion Ingredient:** The flowers of the Sky Thistle, when brewed, can create potions of lightning resistance.
- **Defense:** The thorns of the plant are incredibly sharp and are often used in the creation of traps or weapons.
- **Storm Catalyst:** The plant can store electrical energy, making it a key ingredient in crafting lightning-based magic items.

Dangers:

- The thorns are extremely dangerous if handled improperly, capable of delivering a magical shock on contact.
- The plant also draws in magical energy during storms, making it a potential hazard during periods of heavy lightning activity.

Summary of Aerial Plants

These floating plants are vital to the ecosystem of the sky world, each playing a unique role in sustaining life and providing resources for the inhabitants. From the humble, nutrient-rich Alga Bubbles to the powerful Timber Hearts, the plants of the skies offer both beauty and danger, as well as an incredible diversity of magical, medicinal, and practical uses. Whether they're used in crafting, potion-making, or as energy sources, these airborne flora are essential to life in the floating world.

Fungus

Fungus Implant Diseases for Land and Air Fauna

Fungal diseases, whether affecting the land or air fauna of the sky world, are deadly and pervasive, capable of altering the very nature of their hosts. Some are airborne, spreading through spores, while others burrow deep into flesh, taking root in the creatures they infect. Here are a number of these dangerous and disturbing fungal diseases:

1. Sporeblight

Type: Airborne Fungus

Host: Land-based and air fauna (creatures with respiratory systems, such as humans, dragons, and large air creatures like Skywhales)

Transmission: Airborne spores

Description:

Sporeblight is one of the most common and widespread fungal infections. It is transmitted through airborne spores released by the fungus, which can float on wind currents for miles. Once inhaled, the spores take root in the lungs, rapidly growing and expanding, cutting off oxygen to the host. The fungus thrives on moist, dense cloud banks, often attaching to floating plants or fog-covered areas.

Symptoms:

- Coughing fits
- Shortness of breath
- Fungal growth around the throat and mouth (visible as a gray, speckled rash)
- Exhaustion and a decrease in physical strength
- In advanced stages, the host's respiratory system begins to collapse as the fungus spreads through the bloodstream.

Treatment:

Requires strong purging spells or medicinal herbs that counteract fungal growth. It can be prevented by wearing respiratory filters or magical wards in areas prone to spore outbreaks.

2. Skyfungus Growth

Type: Parasitic Fungus

Host: Airborne creatures, such as Sheffels, Skywhales, and other flying fauna

Transmission: Contact with contaminated objects, such as floating debris or other infected creatures

Description:

Skyfungus Growth is a slow-growing fungus that attaches itself to the skin of flying creatures, often starting at the wings or other exposed areas. It feeds on the host's blood, and as it spreads, it causes a thick, fungal growth that impairs movement and causes considerable pain. Unlike other fungal diseases, Skyfungus Growth spreads with incredible efficiency when the affected creature comes into contact with others of its kind.

Symptoms:

- Reddening and swelling around the area of the infection
- The gradual formation of hard, lumpy fungal masses
- A sticky, sap-like secretion from the infected area
- Weakness in the affected limbs, such as wings or claws, reducing flying ability
- Respiratory problems in severe cases when the fungus spreads internally

Treatment:

Skyfungus Growth requires a mix of surgical removal of fungal masses and potent anti-fungal salves or magic to halt its spread. The growths often need to be carefully cut away, making the infection extremely dangerous if not treated early.

3. Undercloud Rot

Type: Necrotic Fungus

Host: Land-based creatures (primarily herbivores)

Transmission: Ingestion of infected plant matter

Description:

Undercloud Rot is a rare but deadly fungal infection that thrives in the cloud-covered depths of the sky. The fungus takes root in the plants that grow in these regions, particularly near floating islands and drifting clouds. When herbivores consume these plants, the fungus enters their digestive system, slowly spreading through their internal organs. It's particularly dangerous for large creatures that graze in the lower floating islands or near the edges of the Abyss, where the fungus is more prevalent.

Symptoms:

- Abdominal pain and bloating
- Blackened, decayed tissues visible at the mouth and other exit points
- Rapid loss of weight and energy
- Fever and delirium as the fungus spreads
- Visible necrosis in the fur or skin around the abdomen

Treatment:

While Undercloud Rot is nearly impossible to treat once it has spread to the bloodstream, early intervention with herbal remedies and magical healing can stop the decay in its tracks. In extreme cases, the affected parts may need to be amputated before the infection can spread further.

4. Aerial Mycosis

Type: Symbiotic Fungus

Host: Airborne creatures like Skycaptains' mounts, Sheffels, and other small sky creatures

Transmission: Contact with fungal patches in the environment (commonly found on floating islands or in abandoned airships)

Description:

Aerial Mycosis is a symbiotic fungus that infects airborne creatures in the sky world, creating a mutualistic relationship between the fungus and its host. While the fungus helps the creature absorb nutrients from the air by extending its tendrils through the creature's skin, it also subtly controls the host's behavior. Infected creatures tend to exhibit erratic movements or prolonged periods of lethargy, and may even become more aggressive if the fungus is threatened.

Symptoms:

- Small tendrils of fungus visible growing from the skin or feathers
- Behavioral changes: restlessness or sudden aggression
- Reduced cognitive abilities (disorientation or forgetfulness)
- The creation of small fungal spores from the body, which can spread to other creatures and environments

Treatment:

Once Aerial Mycosis has taken hold, it requires careful, long-term treatment using both magical and herbal remedies to sever the connection between the host and the fungus. Removal of the

infected tissues and careful monitoring of the creature's behavior are often necessary for recovery.

5. Haze Cap Disease

Type: Hallucinogenic Fungus

Host: Airborne and land creatures

Transmission: Inhalation of spores, contact with infected surfaces

Description:

Haze Cap Disease is caused by a type of hallucinogenic fungus that infects both air and land creatures. The fungus grows primarily in high-altitude areas, particularly where magical energy is strong. Its spores, when inhaled, have a powerful effect on the mind of the infected creature, causing vivid hallucinations and a sense of euphoria. The fungus can control the creature's behavior, often driving it into reckless action.

Symptoms:

- Sudden onset of hallucinations, including visual and auditory distortions
- Euphoria or intense paranoia
- Aggressive behavior or self-destructive tendencies
- Loss of physical coordination
- Unusual growth of fungal caps around the skin or head

Treatment:

While the symptoms of Haze Cap Disease can sometimes be alleviated by administering calming potions or magical anti-hallucinogenics, complete recovery may require a spiritual healing ritual or purification process. If left untreated, the hallucinations can cause permanent brain damage or even death.

6. Siphon Fungus

Type: Blood-sucking Fungus

Host: Airborne and land creatures (especially larger animals)

Transmission: Direct contact with fungal spores embedded in the ground or air

Description:

Siphon Fungus is a parasitic fungus that attaches itself to its host through spores that burrow into the skin. Once the fungus has established itself, it feeds off the creature's blood, often weakening its host severely before allowing it to drop from the air or collapse to the ground. Over time, the fungus grows like roots through the veins of the creature, eventually consuming the host entirely.

Symptoms:

- Small, round fungal growths on the skin or wings
- Fever and intense thirst (due to blood loss)
- Rapid weight loss and weakness
- Bleeding from small openings as the fungus slowly takes over the bloodstream
- The fungus creates a "siphoning" sound when feeding

Treatment:

The Siphon Fungus is very difficult to remove once it has fully taken hold, requiring both magical purges and physical extractions of the fungus. In extreme cases, the infected limbs or organs must be removed before the fungus can be eradicated. Blood replenishing potions are often used to assist with recovery.

Diseases

Diseases of the Land: Livestock and Populace

The land in the sky world is home to a variety of diseases, some of which affect livestock and domesticated creatures, while others spread through the general population. These diseases can be both magical and mundane, and are often linked to the land's limited resources, harsh climates, and the perilous conditions of the floating islands.

1. Cloud Fever

Type: Viral, Infectious Disease

Hosts: Humans, Elves, Dwarves, Gnomes

Transmission: Airborne droplets, contact with infected surfaces

Description:

Cloud Fever is a highly contagious disease that primarily affects the humanoid races. It begins with flu-like symptoms and rapidly escalates, causing high fevers, body aches, and delirium. The disease is especially dangerous when cloud banks are thick, as the fever worsens in the damp, cool air.

Symptoms:

- Fever, chills, and sweating
- Severe muscle and joint pain
- Headaches and dizziness
- Hallucinations and confusion in advanced stages
- Severe coughing and respiratory distress
- Fatigue and weakness that lasts for weeks after recovery

Treatment:

Antiviral medicines and fever-reducing potions help in the initial stages. Healing magic is necessary for advanced cases, and physical rest is crucial for recovery. In some extreme cases, the disease can cause brain damage or permanent weakness.

2. Windblight

Type: Fungal, Respiratory Disease

Hosts: Livestock (especially herbivores), Humans, Elves

Transmission: Airborne spores, consumption of contaminated plant matter

Description:

Windblight is a dangerous fungal infection that affects both livestock and humanoid populations, particularly in areas with high winds and dense fogs. The fungus thrives in the damp environments where vegetation and animals are at risk. It infects the lungs of the host, causing respiratory failure if left untreated.

Symptoms:

- Persistent cough and wheezing
- Difficulty breathing
- Blue lips and fingertips (due to lack of oxygen)
- A gritty, metallic taste in the mouth
- Visible fungal growth around the nose and mouth in advanced stages

Treatment:

Windblight can be treated with fungal-curing potions and respiratory aids. Powerful clerics and mages may be able to purify the body with divine magic, but in rural areas, it often requires herbal remedies and isolation from infected areas.

3. Skyfall Wasting

Type: Parasitic Infection

Hosts: Livestock (especially large animals, such as cattle and flying mounts), Humans

Transmission: Direct contact with infected animals, contaminated food

Description:

Skyfall Wasting is a parasitic disease that slowly degrades the physical health of both livestock and humanoids. It spreads through direct contact or the consumption of infected food or water. The parasite enters the body, where it feeds off the host's nutrients, causing gradual muscle atrophy and organ failure. It is known for affecting the larger creatures that roam the floating islands.

Symptoms:

- Extreme fatigue and weakness
- Severe muscle wasting and atrophy
- Loss of appetite and weight
- Yellowing of the skin (jaundice)
- Swollen limbs and joints
- Slow, uneven breathing

Treatment:

There is no definitive cure for Skyfall Wasting, but supportive care, such as hydration, nutrient-rich foods, and restorative potions, can help slow the progression. Powerful healing magic may be required for a full recovery, though the parasite often leaves lasting damage.

4. Draconic Pox

Type: Viral Disease

Hosts: Humans, Elves, Dwarves, Gnomes, and Dragons

Transmission: Direct contact, bites, or scratches from infected animals, particularly dragonkin

Description:

Draconic Pox is a viral disease that can be transmitted by any dragonkin, including drakes and wyverns, as well as some smaller dragon-like creatures. While rare, it is especially dangerous when contracted from dragon-related creatures, causing severe rashes and blisters all over the body, particularly on the face and limbs.

Symptoms:

- Fever and fatigue
- Painful blisters that erupt into rashes
- Extreme itching, followed by skin damage and scarring
- Swollen lymph nodes
- Respiratory issues if the pox spreads to the lungs

Treatment:

The disease can be treated with antiviral potions and magical salves that reduce the severity of the rashes. Strong healing magic can clear the infection more quickly, though scarring remains a common result.

5. Rotroot Disease

Type: Bacterial Infection

Hosts: Livestock (primarily herbivores like cattle, goats, and sheep)

Transmission: Ingestion of contaminated soil, roots, or water

Description:

Rotroot Disease is caused by bacteria that infects the roots of plants that livestock consume. It enters the animals' digestive system, leading to severe intestinal distress and organ failure. It is often spread in areas where the soil is tainted with this particular bacterial strain, commonly found in regions near the Abyss or at the base of floating islands.

Symptoms:

- Severe bloating and stomach pain
- Vomiting and diarrhea
- Loss of appetite and lethargy
- Dark, foul-smelling feces
- Weakness and dehydration

Treatment:

Antibiotics and gut-healing potions are required to treat Rotroot Disease. In some cases, the infection can be so severe that the infected animals must be put down to prevent further contamination to other herds. Clean grazing areas and proper feeding practices can help prevent the spread.

6. Gloom Taint

Type: Magical Curse/Fungal Hybrid

Hosts: Humans, Elves, Dwarves, and animals (particularly herd animals like goats or pigs)

Transmission: Exposure to cursed or magical environments, ingestion of contaminated food or water

Description:

Gloom Taint is a hybrid disease that combines the magical essence of dark curses and fungal growths. Often, it originates from ancient sites or cursed land where powerful arcane energies have altered the local environment. The disease manifests with a grayish-blue aura that encircles

the affected creature's body, gradually spreading outward. The curse brings with it debilitating fatigue and a slow decay of life force.

Symptoms:

- A gradual dulling of the senses (sight, hearing, taste)
- A faint, grayish aura that surrounds the body
- Increased sensitivity to cold and light
- Physical weakness and malaise
- Depletion of magical energy in those who use it
- Progressive loss of muscle control and mobility

Treatment:

Healing this disease requires potent magical cures, often needing a priest or mage to remove the curse and purify the fungal elements. Herbalists may try to alleviate the symptoms, but the disease is only fully eradicated through magic. Infected creatures are often quarantined until a cure is found.

7. Marshmaggot Rot

Type: Parasitic Infestation

Hosts: Livestock (especially those grazing near marshes or in humid climates)

Transmission: Contact with infected water or contaminated plant matter

Description:

Marshmaggot Rot is a parasitic infestation that affects grazing animals, especially those living in wet, marshy environments. The larvae of the maggots invade the animal's flesh, burrowing into the body and feeding on the tissues. The parasites grow rapidly, causing inflammation and a foul-smelling discharge that oozes from the wounds.

Symptoms:

- Swelling and tenderness around the infection site
- Fever and chills as the body reacts to the parasitic infestation
- Lethargy and loss of appetite
- Open sores with pus or maggot-filled pockets
- Distorted movement due to painful swelling

Treatment:

The infected area must be surgically cleaned, with the maggots removed and destroyed. Anti-parasitic potions and healing salves can reduce infection, but care must be taken to prevent the spread to other animals. Preventative measures include using protective sprays or keeping livestock away from marshy, stagnant waters.

Random aerial encounters

Small Aerial Encounter Table

This table provides a set of minor encounters that travelers in the sky world might come across while soaring through the clouds or drifting between floating islands. These encounters can be found near minor rocks, ruins, or wreckage, providing some intrigue or danger to the journey.

Roll (d12)	Encounter Description
1	Skyfall Rock: A small floating rock draped in moss and vines, constantly shifting in the wind. It's rumored to be cursed—anything left here disappears without a trace. A single broken statue of an ancient god lies at its center.
2	Wreck of the Sky Strider: The half-destroyed remains of an airship, its sails torn and burned. A few still-alive crew members wander around in a delirious state, warning of a shadowy predator lurking nearby.
3	Timberheart Grove: A cluster of small floating trees, their timber-like bark twisted and gnarled. The trees produce a sweet scent that lures small creatures, making it a common stop for hunters. The air is thick with bees.
4	Floating Obelisk: A towering, cracked stone obelisk covered in arcane runes. Despite the damage, it still pulses with faint energy. Several broken magical devices are scattered around it, some still operational.
5	The Crystal Drift: A large chunk of floating crystal, shimmering in multiple colors. Small gems embedded within are prized by adventurers, though a deadly windstorm periodically sweeps through the area, pushing the rock farther away.
6	The Lost Aerie: A series of stone ruins, likely a long-forgotten sky temple. Tattered banners flutter in the wind, and the sound of a distant gong can be heard faintly echoing from within. Ghostly figures walk through the ruins at night.
7	Lighthouse of the Fallen: A single tower, broken at the top, with a glowing light that sometimes flickers, though no one has ever seen it maintained. Legend says it was the beacon for ships that flew too close to the edge of the abyss.
8	The Feathered Nest: A small floating island with an enormous nest of large, predatory birds. Their feathers are highly prized for crafting and armor. If approached, the birds may either attack or offer a trade—if the party is lucky.

- 9 **Glimmerstone Isle:** A tiny rock island with natural glowing stones embedded in the ground. It creates a stunning light show at night. However, explorers beware: some stones are actually venomous mushrooms in disguise.
- 10 **The Shattered Sundial:** The remains of a massive sundial, its stone and metal parts scattered across a floating plateau. Time seems to work differently here, as the sun rarely rises or sets, and shadows seem to stretch unnaturally.
- 11 **The Echoing Cavern:** A small, hollowed-out stone island with a network of tunnels. The cavern hums with an odd resonance, causing strange vibrations in the air. Some say the tunnels lead to forgotten vaults, though few return.
- 12 **The Whispering Ruins:** Remains of an old settlement, now only a pile of stones and forgotten ironwork. Strange whispers can be heard on the wind—some say it's the souls of the past inhabitants, cursed to linger in the clouds forever.
-

Advanced and Dangerous Aerial Encounter Table

This table provides more significant and perilous encounters, designed for those traveling at greater altitudes or closer to the dangerous regions of the sky world. These encounters involve ancient remnants, aggressive creatures, or hostile forces that can pose serious threats to airships and adventurers.

Roll (d12)	Encounter Description
1	The Roaring Wyrn: A massive dragon-like creature, its body an amalgamation of stone and living flesh, so large it partially blocks the sun. Its roar causes the wind to churn and shatter nearby clouds. It has hoarded treasure from dozens of fallen airships over centuries.
2	Sky Leviathan's Wake: The aftermath of an encounter with an enormous sky leviathan. The air is filled with debris, and the smell of decay lingers in the sky. Large, mutated fish-like creatures, once its prey, now circle the wreckage, hungry for new food.

- 3 **The Abyssal Rift:** A tear in the clouds where gravity seems to distort. Small islands float precariously near the rift, while below, the air grows cold, and the light dim. Those who fall in are lost forever, but strange magical energy can be harnessed near its edge—if one dares.
- 4 **The Bloodwind Marauders:** A sky pirate fleet, marked by their red sails and blackened flags. These ruthless raiders are known to ambush lone travelers, using magical harpoons and wind-based spells to board their ships and take what they can.
- 5 **The Steel Tempest:** A massive storm of magical lightning and raging winds, so powerful it can rip apart airships. The storm carries a living entity at its heart, a thunderbird or storm giant, whose flapping wings cause the fury of the skies. Only the bravest pilots dare to navigate through it.
- 6 **Fallen Star:** A flaming chunk of celestial rock falls from the sky, sending shockwaves through the surrounding air. The crash site is a battleground, as creatures from both the sky and beneath the clouds descend to scavenge the fallen star's valuable, otherworldly resources.
- 7 **The Aether Wraiths:** Ethereal, ghostly beings made of swirling mist and aether. They are drawn to powerful, magical auras, often seeking to possess or drain the life force of any living being that crosses their path. Ships caught in their wake are slowly drained of their vitality.
- 8 **The Chain of Fate:** A vast, tangle of enchanted chains hanging from the clouds, suspended by a long-dead celestial force. These chains lead to an ancient and nearly forgotten city, now inhabited by corrupted, winged beasts that guard its treasures fiercely.
- 9 **The Blackthorn Fleet:** A fleet of airships that operate under the banner of an ancient, cursed kingdom. Their ships are crafted from darkwood and reinforced with cursed metal, making them nearly impervious to magic and conventional weapons. Their crew is a mix of undead and dark mages, hell-bent on reclaiming a lost artifact.
- 10 **The Bloodfog:** A dense, crimson fog that clings to the air and stinks of decay. It rolls across the sky like a living thing, consuming everything in its path. Within the fog, aberrant creatures with nightmarish features prowl, preying on anything that ventures too far inside its deadly embrace.
- 11 **The Voidquake:** A rumbling disturbance beneath the clouds shakes the sky itself. This catastrophic event sends ripples of destructive force that twist the environment,

destabilizing floating islands and causing massive rifts to form. The cause is unknown, but many speculate it is linked to the dangerous forces beneath the Abyss.

- 12 **The Celestial Herald:**** A colossal creature, said to be one of the first beings created by the gods, it emerges from a tear in the sky. Its massive, glowing wings spread across the horizon, and its presence distorts the very fabric of magic. Some say it is a harbinger of divine judgment, while others believe it is a messenger of doom.

Environmental hazards

Roll (d12)	Encounter Description	DC Check	Effect
1	Lightning Storm: A violent electrical storm that can strike without warning. The air is thick with static, and bolts of lightning crackle through the sky. Airships may suffer lightning strikes, causing damage to their sails and equipment.	DC 15 (Pilot's Dexterity or Intelligence check)	Failure causes 2d10 lightning damage to the airship or passengers, plus damage to sails or equipment.
2	Turbulent Winds: Strong, unpredictable wind currents cause rough, erratic flying conditions. Pilots must make difficult maneuvering checks to avoid being thrown off course or crashing into nearby obstacles.	DC 13 (Pilot's Dexterity or Wisdom check)	Failure results in the airship being knocked off course or a 20-foot drop in altitude, causing 1d6 bludgeoning damage.
3	Toxic Fog: A thick, poisonous fog that makes navigation nearly impossible. The air is laced with harmful vapors that can cause dizziness and confusion. Prolonged exposure leads to nausea, poison damage, or unconsciousness.	DC 14 (Constitution or Wisdom save)	Failure causes the affected creature to suffer the poisoned condition for 1d6 hours and take 1d6 poison damage each hour.

4	Gravity Anomaly: A sudden shift in gravity causes the area to become unstable. Airships and creatures may find themselves being pulled in unexpected directions, potentially leading to crashes or falling into the abyss below.	DC 16 (Strength or Dexterity saving throw)	Failure results in the ship or creatures being pulled in a random direction, causing 2d10 damage upon impact or falling.
5	Skyquakes: Violent tremors that shake the very air, making it difficult to maintain control of an airship. Minor Floating islands may shift or even break apart, creating dangerous debris storms.	DC 15 (Pilot's Dexterity or Constitution check)	Failure causes the ship to lose altitude or control, taking 3d6 bludgeoning damage from debris.
6	Magical Null Zone: A patch of the sky where magic simply doesn't work. Spells and magical devices fail, leaving adventurers without the use of their arcane powers, and airships lose their propulsion if relying on magical means of flight.	DC 18 (Arcana or Intelligence check)	Failure causes all magic to fail within the zone for 1 hour, forcing airships to rely on non-magical flight or crash.
7	Solar Flare: A burst of solar radiation that disrupts both natural and magical energy. This intense heat causes airships to overheat, possibly starting fires or damaging delicate equipment. Navigation becomes difficult as the sun's glare blinds pilots.	DC 14 (Pilot's Constitution or Wisdom save)	Failure causes 2d6 fire damage to the ship, and a disadvantage on navigation rolls for 1 hour.
8	Raging Winds of the Abyss: Winds that flow violently toward the edges of the abyss, creating a forceful current that threatens to drag airships off course. Airships must make an opposing check to avoid being swept into the dangerous lower clouds.	DC 17 (Pilot's Strength or Dexterity check)	Failure causes the ship to be pulled off course, taking 3d10 damage from collisions with lower clouds or debris.

9	Mystic Rain: A rare and unpredictable rain that can be either acidic or magical in nature. The rain corrodes metal and weakens structures, potentially damaging the hulls of airships. Magical creatures may be drawn to the rain's aura.	DC 12 (Constitution or Wisdom save)	Failure causes 1d6 acid damage to the airship's hull, and any exposed magical equipment suffers a permanent loss of 1d4 charges.
10	Tornado of the Skies: A massive rotating funnel of wind, debris, and magical energy that cuts through the air like a blade. Airships must evade its path or risk being pulled into the vortex and shredded by flying debris.	DC 18 (Pilot's Dexterity or Wisdom check)	Failure results in being pulled into the tornado, suffering 4d6 bludgeoning damage and being thrown up to 100 feet.
11	Whispering Winds: Strange winds that carry disorienting whispers, causing confusion and hallucinations. Travelers and pilots may experience a sense of vertigo or misinterpret the path ahead, making navigation hazardous.	DC 15 (Wisdom saving throw)	Failure causes the pilot or travelers to become confused for 1d6 rounds, making them unable to take any action besides moving in random directions.
12	Sky Miasma: An area of thick, dark clouds that saps the energy of anything that passes through it. Ships and creatures become sluggish, and health begins to deteriorate as the air becomes toxic. Prolonged exposure causes slow, debilitating effects.	DC 16 (Constitution saving throw)	Failure causes 1 level of exhaustion for each hour of exposure, with disadvantage on all checks after 2 hours.

Minor Aerial Navigational Hazards Table

Roll (d12)	Encounter Description	Required Skill Check	Difficulty (DC)
1	Updraft Gust: A sudden updraft of wind threatens to carry the airship higher than desired. Pilots must react quickly to stabilize the ship.	Pilot's Check (Dexterity)	DC 12
2	Thermal Sink: A patch of cold air causes the ship to lose altitude rapidly. The crew must correct the fall before hitting the ground or other obstacles.	Pilot's Check (Dexterity)	DC 14
3	Cloud Vortex: A whirling pocket of turbulent clouds makes it hard to see and control the ship. Navigators must read the sky and keep the ship from being sucked in.	Navigation (Intelligence)	DC 13
4	Fog Bank: A dense patch of fog reduces visibility to a mere few feet. It's hard to avoid obstacles and potential collisions.	Perception (Wisdom)	DC 12
5	Wind Shear: A sudden, violent change in wind direction that causes the ship to veer off course. The crew must react to regain control.	Pilot's Check (Dexterity)	DC 15
6	Wandering Debris: A piece of wreckage from a distant ship drifts into the airship's path. A collision could damage the hull or sails.	Perception (Wisdom)	DC 13
7	Lightning Strike: A bolt of lightning strikes nearby, momentarily disabling some of the ship's equipment or threatening to start a fire.	Arcana or Tinkering (Intelligence)	DC 15
8	Turbulent Winds: Unpredictable gusts of wind throw the airship off balance, threatening to cause damage or instability.	Pilot's Check (Dexterity)	DC 16
9	Skyfall Dust: A swirling dust cloud is drifting through the air, causing limited visibility and hindering precise navigation.	Perception (Wisdom)	DC 12

10	Sudden Sinkhole: A sudden drop in altitude that feels like a sinkhole beneath the ship, threatening a freefall unless corrected.	Pilot's Check (Dexterity)	DC 14
11	Glinting Sun: The sun's reflection off a nearby sky crystal creates a blinding glare, temporarily blinding the crew and disorienting the ship's course.	Constitution Saving Throw	DC 13
12	Crosswinds: A sudden intersection of opposing wind currents causes erratic movement, making it hard to keep a steady heading.	Pilot's Check (Dexterity)	DC 14

Key Mechanics for the Table:

- **Pilot's Check (Dexterity):** A skill check based on the pilot's ability to maintain control of the airship. This would often involve maneuvering the ship to counteract the effects of the hazard.
- **Navigation (Intelligence):** A skill check based on the navigator's ability to read and interpret the weather patterns or geography of the sky in order to avoid or mitigate the hazard.
- **Perception (Wisdom):** A skill check to detect hazards in the surroundings, like debris or low visibility, before they become serious problems.
- **Arcana or Tinkering (Intelligence):** Used when dealing with magical or mechanical malfunctions, such as lightning strikes affecting the ship's enchanted systems.
- **Constitution Saving Throw:** Represents the crew's ability to handle environmental stress, such as the blinding glare of the sun.

Encounter Locations: Whispering Web Hub Support Structures

The support structures of the Whispering Web network provide a rich variety of encounter locations. These sites, integral to the maintenance and operation of the magical communication network, are as diverse as the environments and societies they serve. Below are several detailed encounter locations, each with its own unique challenges, features, and potential story hooks.

1. The Skyward Spire (High-Mountain Relay Hub)

Description:

A towering structure built atop a craggy mountain peak, the Skyward Spire is a key relay point connecting remote regions. The hub's main structure is an intricate lattice of enchanted stone and crystal, its apex crowned by a glowing arcane crystal pulsating with energy. The surrounding area is battered by high winds and swirling clouds, adding an air of isolation and danger.

Encounters:

- **Sabotage at the Summit:** A group of bandits or mercenaries has taken control of the Spire, demanding ransom from nearby towns to restore communication. The party must ascend the treacherous mountain path, avoiding traps and ambushes, to reclaim the hub.
- **Elemental Intrusion:** The hub's resonance crystal has drawn the attention of air elementals, which now inhabit the Spire and disrupt its operations. The party must negotiate with or banish the elementals while protecting the delicate machinery.
- **Environmental Hazard:** Sudden storms or avalanches threaten the Spire, and the party is tasked with fortifying its structure or escorting maintenance workers to safety.

Unique Features:

- **High Winds:** Combatants must make Strength (Athletics) checks to avoid being pushed off narrow walkways.
 - **Enchanted Elevator Platforms:** Magical platforms provide quick access to various levels but require solving rune-based puzzles to operate.
-

2. Verdant Nexus (Forest Relay Hub)

Description:

Nestled within an ancient forest, the Verdant Nexus is camouflaged by trees and overgrown with moss. Its design seamlessly integrates with the surrounding nature, with vines and roots winding through its structure. At its heart lies a crystalline node that hums softly, resonating with the energy of the forest.

Encounters:

- **Druidic Discontent:** A circle of druids opposes the Nexus, claiming it disrupts the natural balance. They've summoned forest creatures to attack the hub, and the party must decide whether to protect the Nexus or side with the druids.
- **Fey Mischief:** A mischievous fey court has moved into the Nexus, causing erratic communications. The party must navigate their labyrinthine games and riddles to restore order.

- **Corrupted Growth:** A blight has infected the Nexus, corrupting the surrounding forest and threatening its operation. The party must cleanse the area while fighting off corrupted beasts and plant monsters.

Unique Features:

- **Living Architecture:** The hub's structure reacts to the presence of intruders, with roots forming barriers or paths shifting unexpectedly.
 - **Nature Magic Interference:** Spells involving fire or necrotic energy may provoke the forest's wrath, summoning additional enemies or environmental hazards.
-

3. Azure Watchtower (Coastal Relay Hub)

Description:

This Relay Hub is perched on a cliff overlooking the sea, its base carved into the rock and its tower stretching skyward. The structure is fortified against salt air and storms, with crystalline conduits running through its walls. Below, a hidden dock allows maintenance ships to access the hub during high tide.

Encounters:

- **Pirate Raid:** A crew of sky pirates or seafaring marauders has landed at the tower, seeking to steal valuable crystals. The party must defend the hub while battling on treacherous cliffs.
- **Sea Monster Siege:** A kraken or giant sea serpent, disturbed by the hub's magical energy, attacks the structure. The party must repel the creature while keeping the tower from collapsing.
- **Underwater Expedition:** A vital component has fallen into the sea, and the party must dive into underwater caverns teeming with dangerous marine life and retrieve it.

Unique Features:

- **Storm Hazard:** Sudden squalls can disrupt combat and travel, forcing Dexterity saves to maintain footing on slippery surfaces.
 - **Tide-Activated Mechanisms:** The hidden dock's access points only function during high tide, adding a time-sensitive element to missions.
-

4. Emberforge Bastion (Volcanic Relay Hub)

Description:

Built into the side of a dormant volcano, the Emberforge Bastion harnesses geothermal energy to power its resonance crystals. Its interior is a labyrinth of metal walkways, magma channels, and arcane machinery. The air is thick with heat and the glow of molten rock.

Encounters:

- **Magma Elemental Uprising:** A group of magma elementals has risen from the volcano, threatening to overwhelm the hub. The party must contain the elementals while repairing damage to the structure.
- **Sabotage by Rivals:** A rival faction seeks to disrupt the hub by overloading its geothermal systems. The party must navigate the labyrinth and disarm explosive runes before the volcano erupts.
- **Volcanic Awakening:** The dormant volcano begins to rumble, and the party must decide whether to evacuate or stabilize the hub using an ancient artifact.

Unique Features:

- **Geothermal Hazards:** Pools of magma and steam vents create environmental dangers, forcing players to plan their movements carefully.
 - **Energy Overload:** Combat near the hub's power conduits may cause surges, dealing damage to creatures within range but also empowering spells.
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5. Shadowspire Crypt (Underground Relay Hub)

Description:

Hidden deep within the Underdark, this hub serves as a vital link for subterranean communication. Carved into an ancient crypt, its walls are covered in glowing runes that pulse with eerie light. Shadowy corridors stretch in every direction, some sealed by magical wards.

Encounters:

- **Underdark Invaders:** Drow or duergar forces seek to claim the crypt, threatening the hub's operation. The party must hold the line against waves of attackers.
- **Necromantic Interference:** The crypt's ancient wards are failing, allowing undead to rise and wreak havoc. The party must re-establish the wards while fending off the undead.
- **Crystal Theft:** A mind flayer coven seeks to extract the resonance crystal to power their experiments. The party must delve deeper into the crypt to recover it before the hub fails.

Unique Features:

- **Darkness and Shadows:** The crypt's corridors are cloaked in magical darkness, requiring creative use of light sources or spells to navigate.
 - **Warding Glyphs:** Some areas are protected by glyphs that trigger traps or summon guardians, adding a layer of danger to exploration.
-

These locations offer a wide array of storytelling opportunities, from environmental hazards to moral dilemmas and combat challenges. Each hub provides a unique flavor to encounters, tying them closely to the world's magical infrastructure.

The Gambler's Folly

Description:

The Gambler's Folly is a mysterious, ancient deck of cards known for its unpredictable nature. Each card drawn has a 50/50 chance of blessing its user with a minor boon or cursing them with a mischievous twist of fate. The deck radiates faint arcane energy, pulsing with chaotic magic that seems to revel in uncertainty. Its cards are exquisitely designed, with gilded edges and intricate illustrations that shimmer and shift depending on the light. However, there's an eerie sense of foreboding to them—their beauty hides the risk they carry. There's an intricately made Leather and wood carrying case with a detailed clock face on the front, And a slip of leather on the back as if to fit on a belt loop.

Backstory:

Long ago, there was a charismatic gambler and con artist named **Veskan Faltreux**, infamous across the realms for his audacious wagers and impossible victories. Veskan had an uncanny ability to turn any situation in his favor, whether through wit, trickery, or sheer luck. He lived by a single creed: *"The greatest games are played with everything on the line."*

One fateful night, Veskan wandered into a mysterious tavern known only as *The Edge of Fortune*. The patrons there were as peculiar as the establishment itself—silent figures cloaked in shadows, with eyes that gleamed like stars. It was there that Veskan encountered an enigmatic

figure, a being calling themselves the **Keeper of Chances**. The Keeper challenged Veskan to a game unlike any other: a game of pure luck with no tricks or deceptions allowed.

The stakes? Veskan's soul.

The game was played with an unusual deck of cards that Veskan had never seen before. Each card he drew either brought him a stroke of extraordinary fortune or an equally devastating calamity. For the first time in his life, Veskan's confidence faltered. Though he fought hard, he ultimately lost, drawing a cursed card that sealed his fate. As punishment, the Keeper bound Veskan's essence to the very deck they had played with, transforming it into *The Gambler's Folly*.

The deck was scattered across the world, with its cards rumored to bring both great fortune and terrible ruin to anyone daring enough to draw from it. Some say Veskan's voice can be heard faintly when a card is drawn, laughing or groaning depending on the effect.

Details and Traits:

- **Physical Appearance:**

The back of each card is adorned with an intricate design of a swirling coin, half golden and half tarnished black, symbolizing its dual nature. The faces of the cards are elaborately illustrated, with suits reflecting their respective themes:

- Hearts are adorned with radiant light or shadowed with cracks.
- Diamonds shimmer with crystalline brilliance or appear fractured and dull.
- Clubs show mighty weapons or broken staves.
- Spades display shimmering runes or fading glyphs.

- **Magical Aura:**

Detect Magic reveals a chaotic blend of transmutation and enchantment magic. The deck cannot be destroyed by normal means and seems to reform if torn or scattered.

- **Mechanics:**

When a card is drawn, roll a d20:

- On an even number, the card's boon activates (positive effect).
 - On an odd number, the card's curse activates (negative effect).
-

Legends Surrounding the Deck:

1. **Veskan's Whisper:** Those who draw from the deck often report hearing faint whispers just before the magic takes effect. Some hear Veskan laughing mockingly, while others hear him curse his eternal imprisonment.
2. **A Game of Redemption:** It is rumored that if someone draws every card from the deck in a single sitting, surviving both the boons and the curses, they might earn a chance to meet the Keeper of Chances. What the Keeper offers—a reward or a punishment—depends on the courage and luck of the individual.
3. **A Deck with a Mind:** Some claim that the deck "chooses" its owner, appearing mysteriously in a gambler's belongings or as part of a merchant's wares. It's said to vanish without a trace once it deems its work done.

Rules of The Gambler's Folly: The Vanishing Cards

The Gambler's Folly has an enigmatic nature, and its rules for remaining with a holder are just as unpredictable as its effects. These rules ensure the deck does not stay idle for too long, encouraging its user to embrace the risk—or lose it entirely.

1. The Rule of Use:

The deck requires active participation. If at least one card is not drawn within **2 to 12 days** (the exact time is randomly determined from 2d6 by the dm each time a card is drawn), the deck will vanish from its current holder's possession.

2. The Warning Glow:

On the final day before vanishing, the deck emits a faint, otherworldly glow. This glow grows stronger as the deadline approaches, a sign that the cards demand to be played. The carrying case the cards come in has an intricately carved clock face that counts down and resets with each card drawn.

3. The Rule of the Vanish:

When the time runs out, the deck disappears from the holder's inventory—whether in a pocket, pouch, or even under magical protection—and teleports to a random location in the world.

4. The New Destination:

The deck seeks out a new owner or hides itself in a place where it will eventually be found. Potential destinations include:

- A gambler's den or tavern.
- An ancient ruin or treasure chest.
- The belongings of a random traveler, adventurer, or merchant.

5. The Rule of Drawn Cards:

Any cards already drawn from the deck remain with the original holder, but they lose all

magical properties unless returned to the deck. The incomplete deck cannot activate until reassembled.

6. The Keeper's Watch:

If the cards vanish, the previous holder may occasionally hear Veskan's mocking voice:

- *"Too slow, my friend! Someone else will now take their chance!"*
- *"You squandered your opportunity. The deck has no patience for cowards."*

7. The Rule of Exception:

If the deck's magic is suppressed (e.g., by an antimagic field), the timer pauses until the suppression ends. However, the deck becomes restless once free, requiring a card to be drawn within 24 hours or it vanishes immediately.

8. The Rule of Retrieval:

A vanished deck can sometimes be traced through faint magical signatures for 7 days after disappearing. A DC 15 Arcana check or the use of divination magic can help locate its new position, though the result may lead to dangerous or remote locations.

9. The Rule of Reformation:

The Gambler's Folly refuses to be separated for long. If any of its cards or the deck's case are apart from one another for more than **24 hours**, they will magically teleport back together to reform the complete deck, regardless of distance or barriers.

- **Effect Activation:**

- The reformation occurs even within antimagic areas. Observers may witness a faint shimmer or ripple as the cards vanish and reappear in their proper place.
- Those nearby may hear a faint, sardonic voice saying, *"That's not how it works."* This phrase seems to carry a tone of mild amusement, as though mocking the futility of trying to separate the deck.

- **Forced Reformation:**

- If multiple individuals are holding separate cards or the case, the deck will prioritize reforming in the possession of the individual who last drew a card.

- **Failure to Separate:**

- Any attempt to intentionally destroy or scatter the deck pieces is met with futility. Cards thrown into a fire or lost to the abyss will still reform with the rest of the deck, appearing clean and undamaged.
- A DC 18 Arcana check will reveal that this magical reformation is an intrinsic property of the deck's chaotic enchantment.

FOLLY(bad)

Hearts (Emotional Strain and Vulnerability)

1. **Ace of Hearts:** Lose 1 hit point immediately (cannot reduce below 1).
 2. **2 of Hearts:** You automatically fail your next saving throw against being charmed.
 3. **3 of Hearts:** You lose 3 temporary hit points if you have any.
 4. **4 of Hearts:** You feel overwhelming sorrow, giving you disadvantage on Charisma checks for 1 hour.
 5. **5 of Hearts:** You regain 1 fewer hit point from healing spells for the next 10 minutes.
 6. **6 of Hearts:** The next time you're reduced to 0 hit points, you fail 1 death saving throw automatically.
 7. **7 of Hearts:** You are unable to stabilize dying creatures for the next hour.
 8. **8 of Hearts:** Your heart races, causing disadvantage on saving throws against fear for 1 hour.
 9. **9 of Hearts:** You are poisoned for 5 rounds unless you succeed on a DC 10 Constitution saving throw.
 10. **10 of Hearts:** You develop a distrust of allies, giving you disadvantage on Insight checks for 10 minutes.
 11. **Jack of Hearts:** The next time you use the *Help* action, the ally suffers a -1 penalty to their roll instead of gaining advantage.
 12. **Queen of Hearts:** Your next saving throw against a condition (e.g., frightened, paralyzed) is made with disadvantage.
 13. **King of Hearts:** You cannot benefit from advantage on attack rolls for the next hour.
-

Diamonds (Loss and Misfortune)

1. **Ace of Diamonds:** You lose 1 gold coin (or a similar valuable item) if you have one.
2. **2 of Diamonds:** You gain disadvantage on your next ability check using a skill you're proficient in.
3. **3 of Diamonds:** For the next 10 minutes, you are cursed to misplace small items (anything you put down seems to "disappear").
4. **4 of Diamonds:** An object you're carrying develops an unsightly blemish or crack, reducing its value by half.
5. **5 of Diamonds:** The next NPC you interact with is instinctively distrustful of you.
6. **6 of Diamonds:** You are cursed to lose track of time, making it difficult to estimate durations (roleplay effect for 1 hour).
7. **7 of Diamonds:** You have disadvantage on Sleight of Hand checks for 1 hour.

8. **8 of Diamonds:** The next time you receive payment for something, you lose 5% of the total to unforeseen circumstances.
 9. **9 of Diamonds:** You lose track of one small item in your inventory for 5 rounds, finding it only after a search.
 10. **10 of Diamonds:** For the next hour, merchants seem to charge you 10% more for goods.
 11. **Jack of Diamonds:** You automatically lose your next bet or gambling roll.
 12. **Queen of Diamonds:** You believe an object you're holding is worth more than it actually is, causing you to overvalue it.
 13. **King of Diamonds:** The next item you sell fetches only half its actual value.
-

Clubs (Weakness and Misfortune in Combat)

1. **Ace of Clubs:** Your next melee weapon attack deals 1 less damage.
 2. **2 of Clubs:** You gain disadvantage on your next Athletics check.
 3. **3 of Clubs:** You lose 3 temporary hit points, if any.
 4. **4 of Clubs:** Your next unarmed strike deals 1 less damage.
 5. **5 of Clubs:** The next time you Shove a creature, you slip and fall prone instead.
 6. **6 of Clubs:** For 5 rounds, your melee reach is reduced by 5 feet.
 7. **7 of Clubs:** Your next melee weapon attack misses automatically.
 8. **8 of Clubs:** You gain vulnerability to bludgeoning damage for 5 rounds.
 9. **9 of Clubs:** When grappling, you automatically fail your next contested roll.
 10. **10 of Clubs:** Your next weapon attack deals no damage.
 11. **Jack of Clubs:** You take 1d4 damage the next time you attack.
 12. **Queen of Clubs:** Enemies have advantage on their first attack roll against you this round.
 13. **King of Clubs:** Your next melee attack roll has disadvantage.
-

Spades (Missteps in Magic and Stealth)

1. **Ace of Spades:** Disadvantage on your next Stealth check.
2. **2 of Spades:** A small flame within 10 feet of you flares briefly, revealing your location.
3. **3 of Spades:** Your vision is slightly blurry, giving disadvantage on Perception checks for 1 hour.
4. **4 of Spades:** Your next spell attack roll suffers a -1 penalty.
5. **5 of Spades:** You are cursed to stumble over small obstacles, halving your movement for 1 round.
6. **6 of Spades:** The next illusion you cast fails automatically.
7. **7 of Spades:** You become frightened of the next enemy you see for 1 round unless you succeed on a DC 10 Wisdom saving throw.

8. **8 of Spades:** Your next ranged attack roll suffers a -1 penalty.
9. **9 of Spades:** You become visible to invisible creatures within 10 feet for 5 rounds.
10. **10 of Spades:** You take 1 psychic damage as a whispering voice distracts you momentarily.
11. **Jack of Spades:** Enemies have advantage on Perception checks to detect you for 5 rounds.
12. **Queen of Spades:** For the next hour, your spells are affected by half cover as though it were three-quarters cover.
13. **King of Spades:** The next time you attempt to teleport or move magically, you are instead moved 5 feet in a random direction.

FOOL(good)

Hearts (Healing and Support)

1. **Ace of Hearts:** Regain 1 hit point immediately.
2. **2 of Hearts:** The next time you roll a natural 1 on a saving throw, reroll it.
3. **3 of Hearts:** You gain temporary hit points equal to 3 for 1 hour.
4. **4 of Hearts:** You can cast *Spare the Dying* once within the next hour.
5. **5 of Hearts:** You or an ally within 10 feet regains 1 hit point.
6. **6 of Hearts:** Gain a +1 bonus to death saving throws for 1 hour.
7. **7 of Hearts:** You can stabilize a dying creature with a touch (no roll required) once.
8. **8 of Hearts:** Reduce the next healing spell's roll against you by 1, but you still heal +3 extra HP.
9. **9 of Hearts:** Gain resistance to poison damage for 10 minutes.
10. **10 of Hearts:** Increase the range of touch spells by 10 feet for 5 rounds.
11. **Jack of Hearts:** Your next use of the *Help* action grants an additional +1 bonus.
12. **Queen of Hearts:** For the next 10 minutes, your allies within 10 feet gain a +1 bonus to saving throws.
13. **King of Hearts:** You can use your reaction to give an ally advantage on their next attack roll within 30 feet.

Diamonds (Wealth and Resourcefulness)

1. **Ace of Diamonds:** Summon a gold coin to your hand.
2. **2 of Diamonds:** Gain proficiency in a skill of your choice for 1 hour.
3. **3 of Diamonds:** For the next 10 minutes, you can detect the presence of precious metals within 30 feet.
4. **4 of Diamonds:** A small object you touch becomes valuable-looking (illusion) for 1 hour.

5. **5 of Diamonds:** Gain advantage on your next ability check involving Persuasion or Deception.
 6. **6 of Diamonds:** Create a minor illusion of gemstones for 5 rounds.
 7. **7 of Diamonds:** When searching an area, you automatically find small hidden valuables, if any exist.
 8. **8 of Diamonds:** Your next transaction gives you a discount of 5%.
 9. **9 of Diamonds:** Gain advantage on Sleight of Hand checks for 10 minutes.
 10. **10 of Diamonds:** You can summon a harmless trinket worth 1 gp (e.g., a ring, coin, or charm).
 11. **Jack of Diamonds:** Your coin tosses or gambling rolls are influenced to always land as you choose (advantage for 10 minutes).
 12. **Queen of Diamonds:** You gain insight into the value of an item you touch.
 13. **King of Diamonds:** A small, magical light shines over your coin purse or hidden wealth for 1 hour, only visible to you.
-

Clubs (Combat and Strength)

1. **Ace of Clubs:** Your next melee weapon attack deals an additional 1 damage.
 2. **2 of Clubs:** Gain advantage on your next Athletics check.
 3. **3 of Clubs:** Gain 3 temporary hit points for 5 rounds.
 4. **4 of Clubs:** Your unarmed strikes deal 1 additional damage for 5 rounds.
 5. **5 of Clubs:** You can Shove a creature 5 feet farther than normal.
 6. **6 of Clubs:** For 5 rounds, your melee reach increases by 5 feet.
 7. **7 of Clubs:** Your next melee attack scores a critical hit on a roll of 19 or 20.
 8. **8 of Clubs:** Gain resistance to bludgeoning damage for 5 rounds.
 9. **9 of Clubs:** When grappling, you have advantage for 5 rounds.
 10. **10 of Clubs:** Your next attack deals an additional 1d4 damage.
 11. **Jack of Clubs:** Once in the next 10 minutes, you can add 1d4 to a damage roll.
 12. **Queen of Clubs:** Enemies attacking you with melee weapons have disadvantage on the first attack roll they make against you this round.
 13. **King of Clubs:** Your next melee weapon attack has advantage.
-

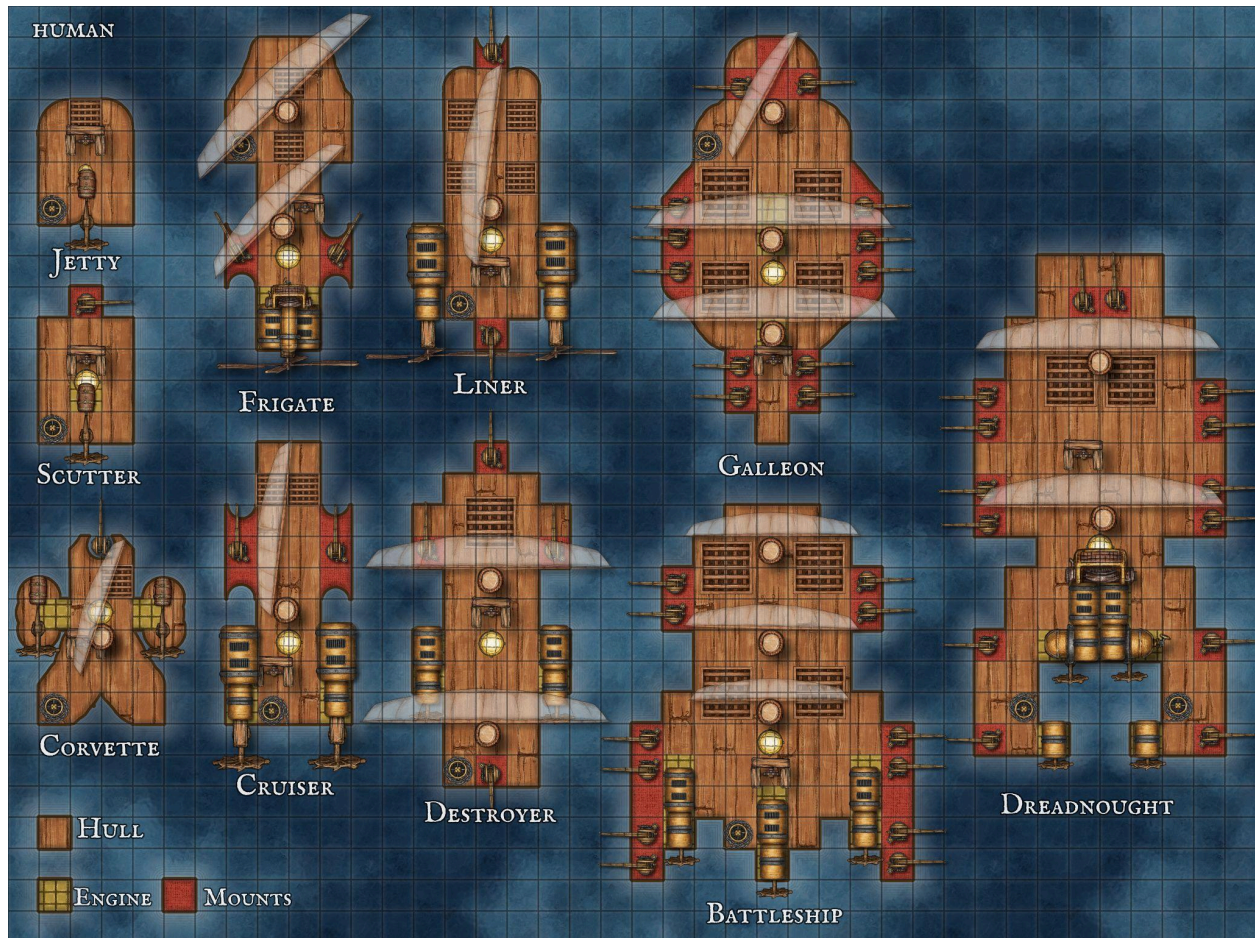
Spades (Stealth and Magic)

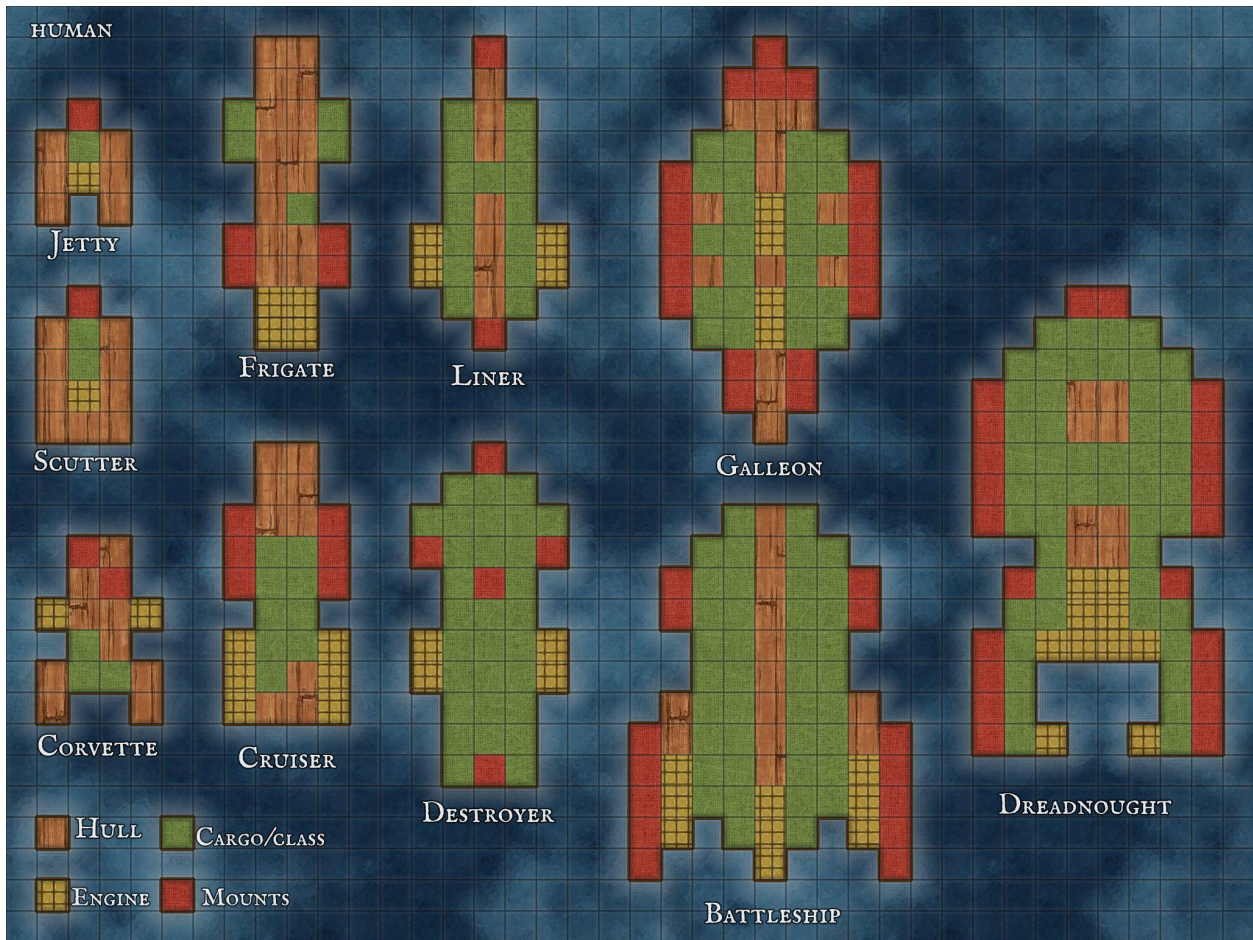
1. **Ace of Spades:** Gain advantage on your next Stealth check.
2. **2 of Spades:** You can extinguish a small flame within 10 feet.
3. **3 of Spades:** Gain darkvision for 30 feet for 1 hour.
4. **4 of Spades:** Your next spell attack roll gains a +1 bonus.

5. **5 of Spades:** You can move through nonmagical difficult terrain as if it were normal for 5 rounds.
 6. **6 of Spades:** You can cast *Minor Illusion* once within the next 10 minutes.
 7. **7 of Spades:** Gain advantage on saving throws against being frightened for 5 rounds.
 8. **8 of Spades:** Your next ranged attack roll gains +1 to hit.
 9. **9 of Spades:** You can sense invisible creatures within 5 feet for 5 rounds.
 10. **10 of Spades:** Gain resistance to psychic damage for 10 minutes.
 11. **Jack of Spades:** Enemies have disadvantage on Perception checks to detect you for 5 rounds.
 12. **Queen of Spades:** For the next 10 minutes, your spells ignore half cover.
 13. **King of Spades:** You can teleport up to 10 feet to an unoccupied space you can see.
-

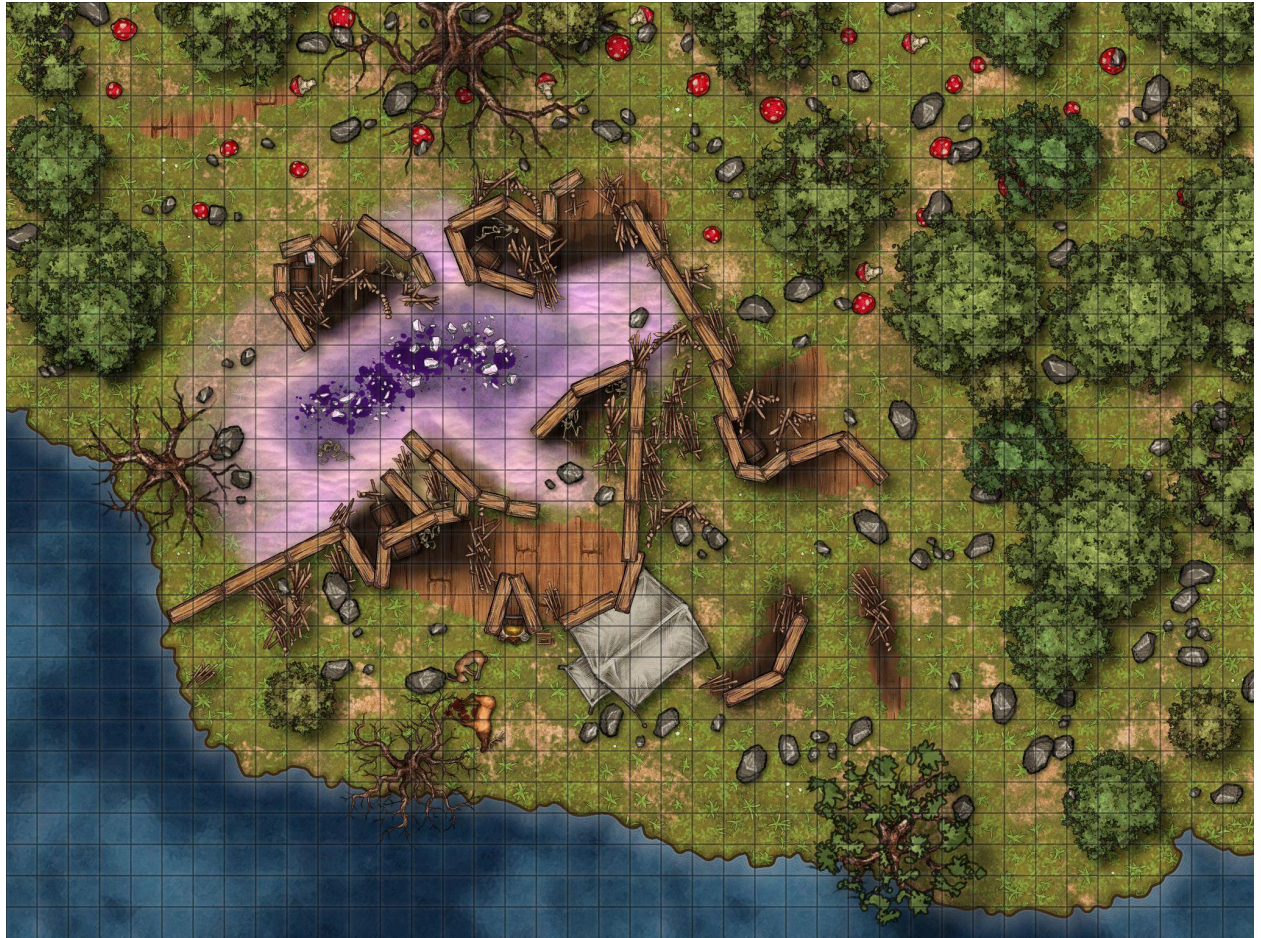
Official Maps

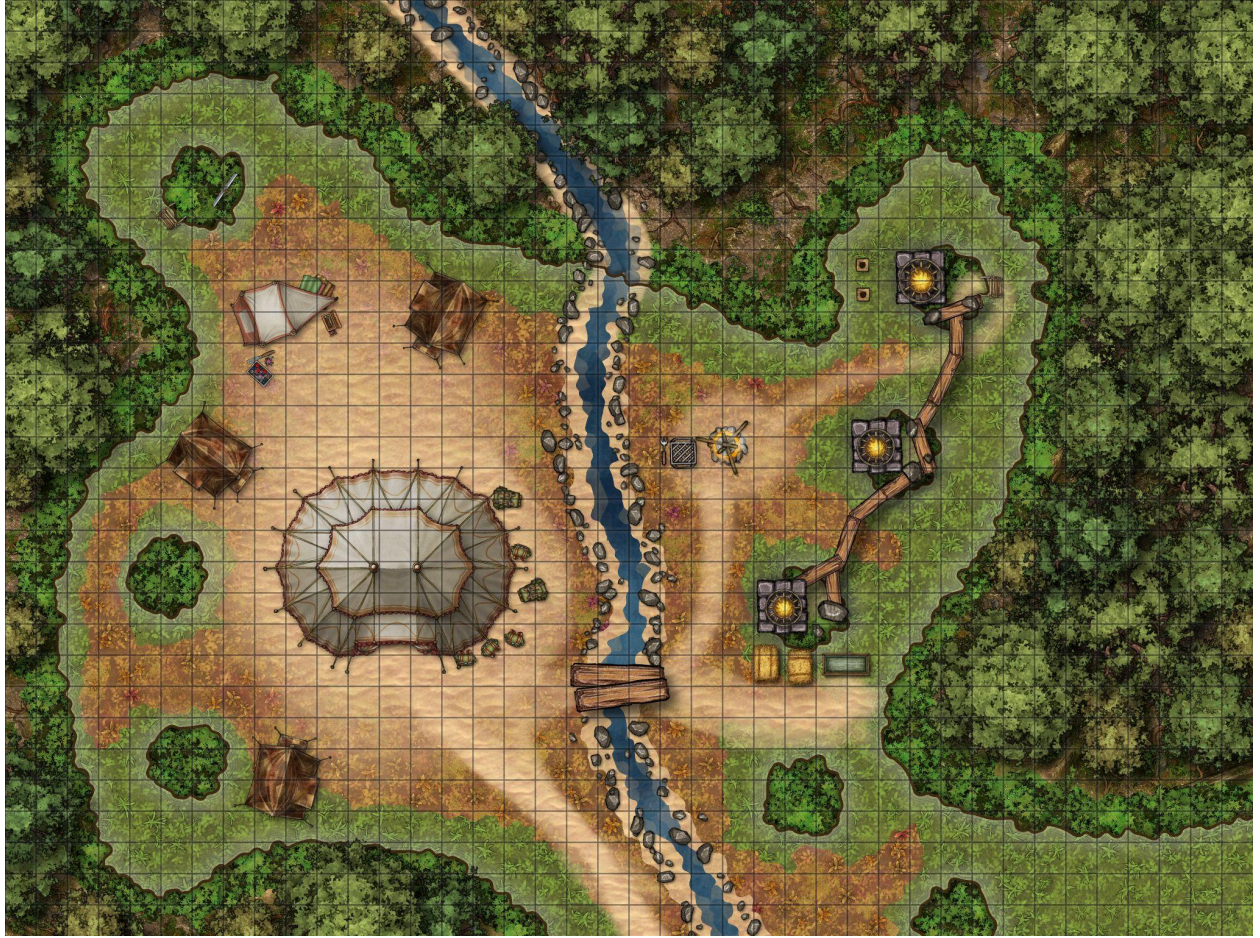






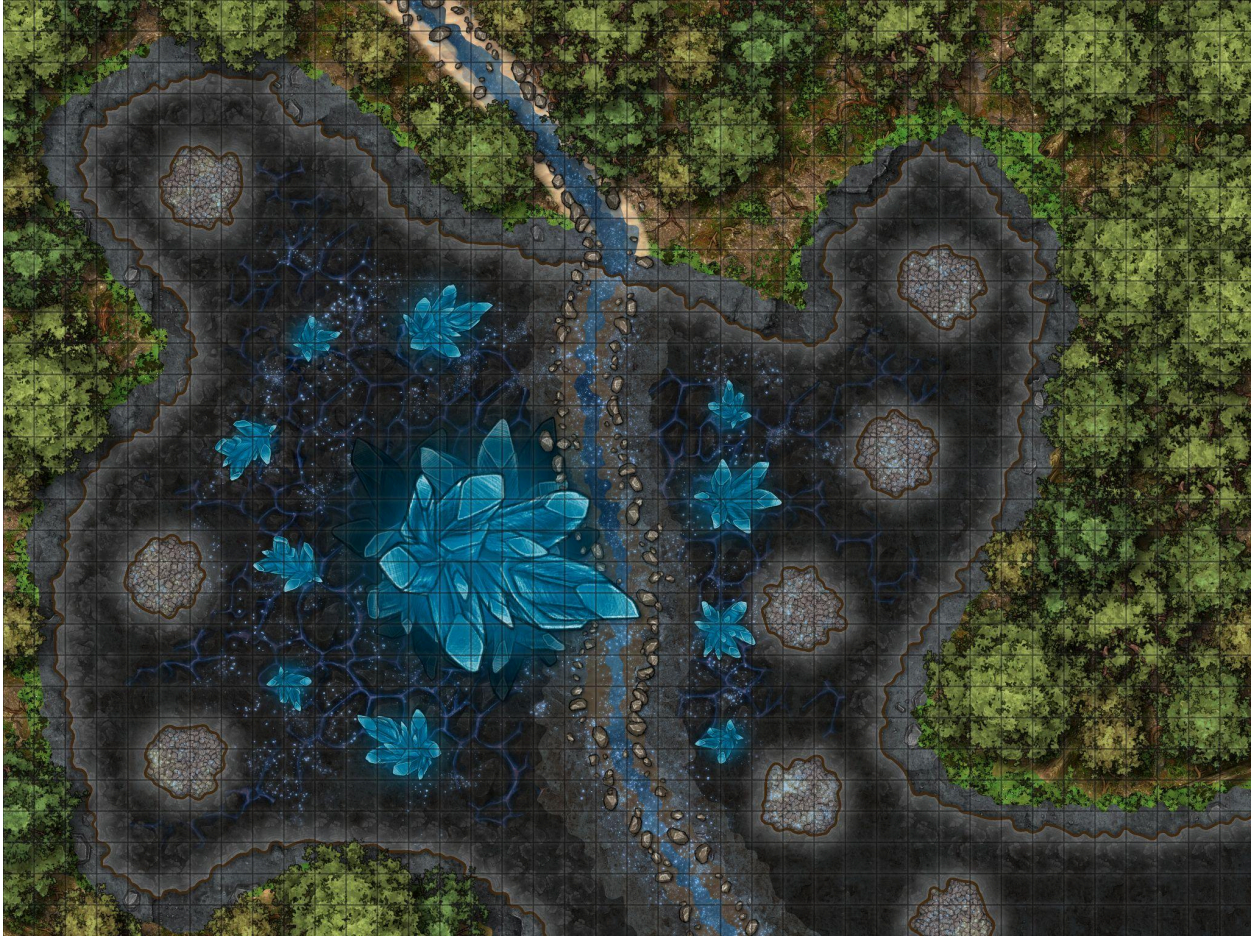


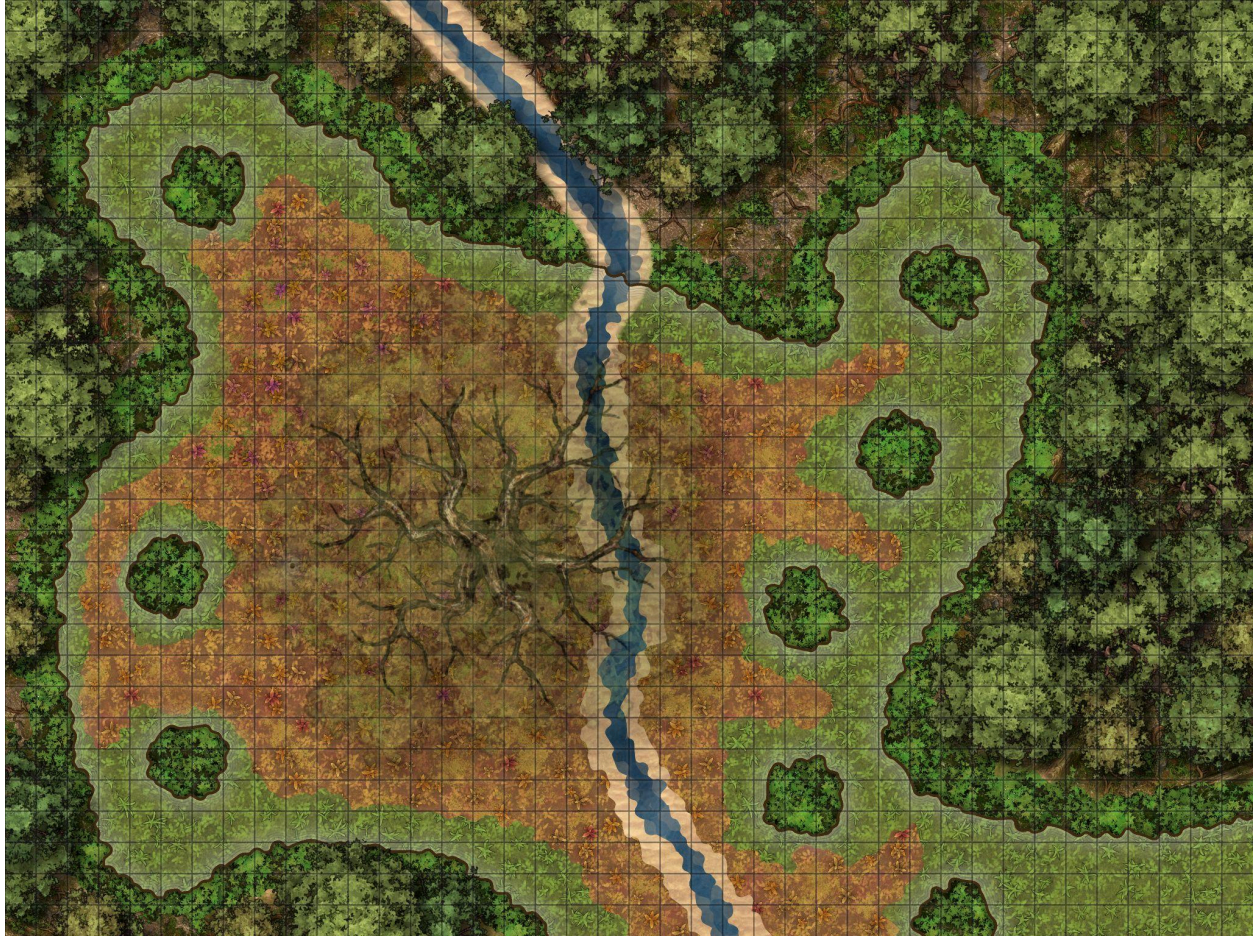












Start Location info

Dunhallow Roost

A remote sky island struggling to recover after the latest draconic tithe.

Overview

Dunhallow Roost is a small, windswept island located on the outskirts of a Dragon Lord's dominion, just beyond the main trade lanes. Known for its hardy homesteaders, wind-carved cliffs, and vast fields of skygrain, the town serves as a minor agricultural hub, producing food for larger settlements in exchange for tools, textiles, and the occasional luxury. However, the recent **Draconic Tithe Fleet** has just departed, leaving the town reeling from its demands.

Population & Society

- **Population:** ~200 residents, mostly humans, halflings, and a few dwarves.
- **Leadership:** Mayor **Elvira Caelwind**, a pragmatic ex-merchant who took charge after the last mayor vanished under suspicious circumstances.
- **Economy:** Farming (skygrain, airfruits, sheffel wool), wind-mill grain processing, and limited trade with passing airships.
- **Defenses:** A small militia of about 20 poorly equipped volunteers.

Recent Events

The **tithe collectors**, agents of **Dragon Lord Zevrikor the Ash-Talon**, arrived a week ago, extracting **food, coin, and livestock** as tribute. Though the town was expecting a heavy toll, this year's tithe was **particularly brutal**, stripping them of nearly all surplus food and wealth.

- **The Town is near Starving:** The draconic agents took a larger portion than expected, leaving **many families without enough food to last the season**. Desperation is creeping in.
- **Tensions are High:** Rumors spread that someone **shorted the tithe** or tried to hide goods, prompting fears of a second collection or draconic retaliation.
- **A Group of Bandits is Circling:** Word has reached town that a small sky-pirate crew, perhaps a rogue band of the **Black Fleet**, is eyeing the weakened settlement as an easy target.

Notable NPCs

- **Mayor Elvira Caelwind (Human, 48, LN)** – Once a shrewd trader, now struggling to hold the town together. Secretly negotiating with smugglers to bring in food.
- **Harbormaster Ryn Goldfenn (Halfling, 52, CG)** – Manages the tiny floating docks where passing airships land. Knows everyone's business and enjoys gossip.
- **Brother Varic (Dwarf, 105, LG)** – Priest of the Skyward and former adventurer. Offers spiritual guidance but is increasingly vocal about resisting the tithes.
- **Jakrin "The Weasel" (Human, 36, CN)** – A known smuggler who has just arrived, promising "alternative" ways to get food—likely illegal.

Adventure Hooks

- **A Hidden Cache:** Someone in town **hid supplies from the tithe**. Can the party uncover the stash before Zevrikor's enforcers return?
- **Pirate Raid Incoming:** A sky-pirate crew, seeing the town's weakness, **plans to strike within the next few nights**. Will the town stand and fight, flee, or bargain?
- **An Unpaid Debt:** The last mayor made **a deal with a dangerous group** to cover past tithes. Now, that debt is due. Who is coming to collect, and what happens if they don't get paid?

Hollow's End Tavern

A cozy but rugged tavern perched on the edge of civilization, where the fire is warm, the drinks flow freely, and weary travelers find a moment of peace before braving the skies once more.

Overview

Hollow's End is a **weathered yet welcoming** tavern built on the edge of the drifting island of Dunhallows Roost, positioned along one of the lesser-used air routes between the floating continents. It is one of the **safer** before venturing into the wilder, untamed reaches of the sky. The establishment consists of a **stone-and-wood tavern**, **three small lodging huts**, and a **firelit common area** for travelers to rest and exchange stories.

Despite its remoteness, Hollow's End is a neutral ground. No one wants to ruin one of the few places where a hot meal, a stiff drink, and a warm bed can still be found. For most anyone who wants one, though exactly how the bartender **Killain** wrangled this is unknown.

Notable Features

- **Cozy Hearth & Firepit:** A massive stone fireplace dominates the main hall, offering warmth and comfort against the chill winds of the high altitudes. The fire is said to be **magically sustained**, never fully going out, even in the windiest storms.
- **Charging Station for Sending Stones:** A reinforced table near the bar houses **several enchanted crystal docks**, where travelers can recharge their **sending stones** for a small fee. This makes Hollow's End a vital communication hub for those passing through.
- **Applewood Cellar:** A deep, magically cooled storage space beneath the tavern holds an **impressive stockpile of alcohol**, particularly **Killain's famous apple brandy**, brewed from the rare high-altitude **sky-apples** that grow only on certain drifting islands.
- **Three Lodging Huts:** Small but sturdy, these **wooden huts** provide a **private space** for visitors to rest. One is the deluxe room with a king size bed. One is the standard room with two comfortable single person beds. The third is the economy bunks 6 plank beds. All have a chest to store goods and belongings.

Staff NPCs

- **Killain "Red" O'Mara (Human, 42, LG) – The Tavernkeeper**
A tall, broad-shouldered man with a **shock of red hair and a thick beard**, Killain is a **former airship crewman** who settled down after losing his ship to a storm. He runs Hollow's End with a firm but fair hand, ensuring that troublemakers don't ruin the one peaceful spot in these lawless skies.
 - Signature Drink: **"Red's Ember Brandy"** – A smooth, cinnamon-apple liquor that **warms the belly and sharpens the mind** (mechanically, advantage on the next Wisdom check within an hour).

- Secret: **He keeps a hidden cache of skyship repair materials** in the cellar—only offered to those who truly need them.
- **Zara (Half-Elf, 29, CN) – The Waitress**
Zara is a **quick-witted, sharp-tongued** waitress who has worked at Hollow's End for several years. She **knows more secrets than most**, thanks to the **loose lips of drunken patrons**. Despite her playful demeanor, she is **surprisingly resourceful in a fight**, and her dagger is always within reach.
 - Flirtatious and fun-loving, but **fiercely loyal** to Killain and the bar.
 - Secret: She used to be part of the **Whisper Web** and still **carries a secret enchanted coin** that allows her to send discreet, one-word messages to an unknown contact.

Notable Regular Patrons & Visitors

- **Old Marrok (Dwarf, 180, NG) – A retired mercenary** who spends his days drinking and offering **half-true war stories** in exchange for free rounds.
- **Serka the Wanderer (Dragonborn, 36, LN) – A bounty hunter between jobs**, always watching from the corner, rarely speaking unless approached.
- **The Tattered Captain (Unknown, ??, ??) – A mysterious hooded figure who appears once a month**, pays in **gems**, and never removes their gloves. Their voice is **heavily distorted**, as if speaking through magic.

Adventure Hooks

- **A Suspicious Patron:** A traveler has been **charging their sending stone for an unusual amount of time**—Killain and Zara suspect they're plotting something, but against who?
- **Smugglers in the Cellar:** A band of **sky smugglers** want to use Hollow's End as a storage hub. Killain refuses, but they aren't taking "no" for an answer.
- **Lost in the Abyss:** A ship recently **crashed off the island's edge**, and survivors **may still be clinging to floating wreckage** below. Will anyone risk a rescue?

Hollow's End remains a **beacon of warmth in a world of uncertainty**, but even here, the skies **bring danger**.

The truth behind the friendly faces

Killain "Red" O'Mara – The Tavernkeeper of Hollow's End

Race: Human

Age: 42

Alignment: Lawful Good

Location: Hollow's End Tavern, Dunhallow

A Life at Sea—and Sky

Killain O'Mara, known to most as **"Red"** due to his once-fiery hair (now streaked with silver), has lived more lives than most men see in a lifetime. Born in **Dunhallow**, a Middle of nowhere skyport straddling the borders of competing powers, Red was raised among dockworkers, farmers, and sailors, hearing tales of great adventures. The son of a shipwright, he learned early the value of hard work and the ever-turning tides of fortune.

At seventeen, seeking adventure and a way to support his family, he signed on with the **Draconic Tithe Fleet**, a faction responsible for collecting the tribute owed to the mighty Dragon Lords. This was no simple courier service—many skyports resisted the tithe, and Killain saw his share of **raids, blockades, and high-altitude skirmishes**. He proved himself a skilled negotiator, preferring words to blades when possible, but never shying from a fight when needed. During this time, he earned the respect of captains, sky-knights, and even a few dragons themselves, one of whom—**Valthyrian the Bronze**—taught him the value of **oaths and honor**, a lesson he carried for life.

After nearly **twelve years**, disillusioned by the Tithe Fleet's growing **brutality and political games**, he left, seeking a new path.

A Brief Life Among Rogues

For a time, Red wandered, taking contracts as a **deckhand, navigator, and sometimes enforcer** aboard various vessels. Eventually, he fell in with **The Black Fleet**, the notorious pirate faction under Sky Captain **Verek Drakemoor**. Though he never fully embraced piracy, he found a certain **brotherhood and freedom** among the rogues—many of whom had been wronged by the very empires he once served.

He spent **two years aboard The Shadow Gale**, a swift raiding vessel specializing in reconnaissance and high-risk heists. During this time, he participated in **audacious raids, desperate battles, and moonlit escapes**, but found himself increasingly at odds with the fleet's **ruthless tactics**. Red had always followed a **code of honor**, and while some pirates upheld their own form of morality, others reveled in chaos and destruction.

His departure from the Black Fleet was neither easy nor clean. Rather than being executed for desertion, he **brokered a deal with Verek Drakemoor himself**, offering **valuable intelligence**

on the **Draconic Empire's fleet movements** in exchange for his freedom. Though some within the fleet saw him as a traitor, others respected him for his **cunning and loyalty to his own principles**.

Return to Dunhallow – The Hollow's End Pact

With **blood on his hands and a lifetime of skyfaring behind him**, Red returned to **Dunhallow**, weary and ready for something new. Using his **savings, favors owed, and a few whispered threats**, he purchased and renovated an old, crumbling tavern—**Hollow's End**. It became more than just a drinking hole—it was a **refuge**, a place where sky-sailors, merchants, bounty hunters, and even criminals could drink without fear of violence.

Red, drawing on his past affiliations, **negotiated an unspoken truce between the warring factions**—a rarity in the skyfaring world. He made it clear: **any blood spilled in Hollow's End would bring the wrath of every side upon the offender**. To enforce this, he brokered an **oath-bound agreement**:

1. **The Black Fleet**: Pirates honor Hollow's End as a **neutral ground**, knowing that breaking the truce would **incite retribution** from both Red's old allies and the wider bounty hunter community.
2. **The Bounty Hunter's Guild**: They can **gather intelligence** here but may not **apprehend targets on-site**.
3. **The Draconic Empire**: Agents and soldiers may **drink, talk, and gather news**, but may not **conduct official business** within its walls.

Above the **reinforced oak doors of Hollow's End**, a **small, intricately carved sigil** is embedded—a **stylized ouroboros entwined with a ship's wheel**. To the average citizen, it is just decoration. But to those who know? It **marks the tavern as neutral ground**, a place where even sworn enemies must lay down their blades.

Despite the tensions that often brew within its walls, **Hollow's End remains a rare place of uneasy peace** in the turbulent skies of Kaysender.

And at the bar, Red O'Mara **watches, listens, and pours another drink**—a man who has seen too much, lived too many lives, and yet, still finds solace in a **well-aged bottle and a well-told tale**.

Zara – The Waitress of Hollow's End

Race: Half-Elf

Age: 29

Alignment: Chaotic Neutral

Occupation: Waitress at Hollow's End Tavern

The Illusion of Zara's Past

Zara is a **striking woman** with sharp, angular features, a faint touch of elven grace in her movements, and eyes that seem to always be calculating, even when she's smiling and serving drinks. Her **silver-streaked auburn hair** is always pulled back in a loose braid, and she dresses in a simple, form-fitting tavern uniform, but her demeanor exudes an air of **confidence** that one might expect of someone with a **far more dangerous past** than her current occupation suggests.

To the casual observer, Zara is the **charming, if occasionally aloof, waitress** at Hollow's End. She is quick with a **witty remark** and has a talent for reading people, making her a favorite among regulars. However, she is much more than the casual observer realizes.

For years, Zara has maintained a carefully crafted **facade** of having once been a member of the **Whisper Web's support staff**—the communication network known for sending **magical messages** through the skies. She claims she worked as part of their **administrative division**, facilitating the complex routing of information and organizing covert operations from the shadows. This cover story allows her to maintain an **air of mystery and importance**, especially among those who frequent Hollow's End, many of whom have ties to organizations like the **Black Fleet** or **bounty hunters' guilds**. Zara enjoys playing this role, feeding on the power her perceived past gives her among the tavern's more **suspicious clientele**.

However, the truth is far darker and more intricate.

Zara's True Allegiance: Draconic Empire Intelligence

In reality, Zara is a **high-ranking operative** of the **Draconic Empire's intelligence network**, a well-placed spy who operates in **near-complete secrecy**. Her role as a waitress at Hollow's End is part of a broader **intelligence operation** that allows the **Empire** to keep a close watch on the activities of pirates, bounty hunters, and rival powers, all while allowing the **Draconic Empire to maintain a veneer of neutrality** in Kaysender's often-chaotic political landscape.

Zara was **recruited** into the Empire's secret intelligence division at a young age, thanks to her **half-elf heritage**, which granted her both the **elven resilience to magic** and the **human adaptability** to work in the field. Trained in the subtle arts of **covert observation**, **information extraction**, and **espionage**, Zara quickly rose through the ranks, becoming a trusted agent of the Empire's inner circles. Her **charisma** and **ability to manipulate people's perceptions** made her an ideal candidate for high-level **infiltration missions**.

She spent years working in the **shadows** of various powerful factions, gathering intelligence on the **Black Fleet**, **bounty hunters**, and even the **Draconic Empire's own allies**. But over time,

she grew restless. The **Empire's strict command structure**, with its emphasis on **order and control**, began to wear on her. Zara was never one to be boxed in by rules, and her **chaotic neutral nature** sought freedom and flexibility.

The Tavern's True Purpose – Zara's Role in the Neutral Ground Agreement

When Killain "Red" O'Mara established Hollow's End as a **neutral ground**, a sanctuary for pirates, bounty hunters, and even the Draconic Empire itself, he unknowingly paved the way for **Zara's placement**. The **Empire** knew that to truly keep an eye on the **Black Fleet** and **outlaws** that frequented Dunhallow, they needed someone **inside** the tavern—someone with enough influence to stay close to the action, without raising suspicion. Zara was the perfect candidate.

Her **position as a waitress** allows her to move freely among the tavern's most dangerous patrons, while her **charming personality** and **wit** keep her in their good graces. She has become **Red's trusted ally**, a **quiet informant**, and a **spy** in plain sight. Most patrons have no idea that the woman serving their drinks is one of the **Empire's most skilled intelligence agents**—they just see her as a mysterious, charming figure with a **past shrouded in intrigue**.

Her true role here is not just to monitor the comings and goings of **pirates** and **bounty hunters**, but to also keep a careful watch on **Red O'Mara** himself. The Draconic Empire has **tolerated** Red's neutral ground agreement largely because of Zara's influence. If things ever got out of hand or Red became a liability, Zara would be able to **remove him** quietly. However, for now, her **personal loyalty** to Red and her affection for the **peace he's created** has kept her from doing anything that would compromise the delicate balance of power.

Zara's Motivations and Personality

Zara's motivations are complex. On the one hand, she is still loyal to the **Draconic Empire**, carrying out her duties with precision and efficiency. On the other, she has begun to see the **value** of the **neutral ground** Red has created at Hollow's End and the **freedom** it offers. As someone who has always operated on the edge of the law, Zara is **drawn to the chaos** of the tavern's clientele—the **pirates**, **smugglers**, and **rogues** who, in her mind, represent a **freedom** that the Empire cannot provide.

Her **chaotic neutral nature** makes her unpredictable. She is not bound by the **Empire's laws** in the same way other agents are. In fact, she often finds herself subtly working against the very empire she serves, letting a few pirates escape or feeding them misinformation just to see how things play out. She's not a villain, but she's also not entirely a hero. She is driven by **curiosity**, **freedom**, and a **desire for personal gain**.

Zara has also developed a **deep bond with Killain O'Mara** over the years. She recognizes that he is a man of **honor** and **code**, despite his rough past. Whether she respects him for his **integrity** or sees him as a **useful ally** in maintaining the balance of power in Dunhallow, Zara remains loyal to him—for now.

The Symbol Above the Door – Zara's Silent Power

The **symbol above the door** of Hollow's End—a **stylized ouroboros entwined with a ship's wheel**—is more than a mere mark of neutral ground. It represents a subtle agreement that maintains a delicate balance of power within the tavern. While this symbol signals to all that the tavern is a sanctuary, free from open conflict, it also serves as a reminder that Zara, in her role as an operative of the **Draconic Empire**, is always watching.

Zara is not the **upholder of the neutral ground**, but she is most certainly its **observer**. Her presence in the tavern is part of a broader agreement that allows the **Draconic Empire** to tolerate Hollow's End as a place of sanctuary for pirates, bounty hunters, and even Empire agents. The symbol signifies the **Empire's tacit approval** of the peace Killain O'Mara has created, but it also means that Zara, ever vigilant, is there to keep an eye on the **delicate truce**.

Her **watchful eye** is an **unspoken element** of the agreement, ensuring that those who enter Hollow's End know that **any disturbance**—be it from pirates, bounty hunters, or rival factions—will be reported back to the Empire. While she does not enforce the neutrality herself, her **observation** ensures that the balance is maintained. Anyone who disturbs that balance risks drawing the attention of the **Empire**, and none want to do so under her careful scrutiny.

Zara's role is one of **quiet power**, as she observes without intervention, watching over the tavern with the knowledge that any conflict will have far-reaching consequences beyond the walls of Hollow's End. This silent authority grants her an influence that none in Dunhallow take lightly, even if most remain unaware of her true purpose.

The Neutral Ground Mark – The Ouroboros and Ship's Wheel

The **symbol of the ouroboros entwined with a ship's wheel**, while prominently displayed above the door of Hollow's End, is far from unique. This symbol is used in many locations across Kaysender where the concept of **neutral ground** is agreed upon by various factions—be it **criminal syndicates**, agents of the **Draconic Empire**, or representatives from several **nations**. Its presence signifies a commitment to **non-interference**, a mutual understanding that violence, open conflict, and aggression will be set aside within these sacred spaces.

However, while the symbol itself is a widely recognized **mark of truce**, it is **rarely enforced in a formal sense**. The true power of the neutral ground agreement lies in the **unspoken understanding** that **someone**—from one of the factions involved—will always be **watching**, ensuring the neutrality is respected. That someone could be anyone: an **agent of the Empire**, a

pirate with hidden allegiances, or even a **mercenary hired for the task**. The key detail is that the factions know someone will be there, quietly observing, but rarely is the **exact identity of that person known**.

This ambiguity plays a significant role in maintaining the balance. The **knowledge that someone from any faction could be present at any time** keeps tensions in check, as no one wants to risk disturbing the fragile peace that the neutral ground promises. While the **mark** is commonly used, the enforcers of neutrality operate in the **shadows**, making the symbol a powerful deterrent without the need for overt enforcement.

Those who come to such places, whether for **business or refuge**, are aware of the **silent watch**. They know that while they may find temporary peace under the neutral ground, they will not find it if they break the agreement—**someone will notice**, and there will be consequences, though the consequences are often left unspoken until they occur.

In this way, the neutral ground mark is not about visible enforcement, but about **trust and vigilance**, reminding all who enter that the truce is upheld not just by the symbol itself, but by the **ever-present, though unseen, eyes of those who ensure the peace is kept**.

Neutral Ground Locations – Strategic Spaces for Factions

Neutral ground locations marked with the **ouroboros entwined with a ship's wheel** often hold **strategic importance** to the factions that agree to them. These locations are not chosen at random, but rather for their **inherent value** to the groups involved—whether for **trade**, **diplomacy**, or **simple convenience** in negotiations.

1. Vital Trade Locations:

Many neutral grounds are established in places where **trade routes intersect**, making them crucial for factions with interests in commerce and resource exchanges. These locations often sit on key maritime paths or high-traffic sky routes, where goods from various regions pass through. For factions like the **Skyweaver Consortium** or **The Free Flotilla**, these locations are ideal for maintaining their **market dominance** and ensuring that their trade agreements are honored by other parties. Such places act as **meeting points** for merchant guilds, providing a location for **informal negotiations**, and offering a **sense of safety** to both parties involved. For some, the neutral ground agreement is less about peace and more about ensuring that critical goods and services continue to flow without interference from hostile factions.

2. Convenient Negotiation Spaces:

Some neutral grounds are established for **diplomatic convenience**. These locations may be strategically located near the **border regions** between two factions or on the fringes of contested territories. They offer a **neutral space** for **high-level talks**, where representatives from opposing factions can meet without fear of ambush or sabotage. These places are often **out of the direct control of any one faction**, but their significance is **recognized by all parties** involved. Here, the **laws of neutrality** allow for **informal agreements** or **behind-the-scenes diplomacy**, away from the eyes of the

general public. Such locations are often associated with groups like **The Whisper Web** or **The Black Tide**, who rely on discreet conversations to broker deals, swap information, or avoid the political spotlight.

3. **Factions' Interests and Symbolic Value:**

While these locations are neutral, they are often **important to one faction more than another**. For example, a neutral ground located near the **fabled ruins of an ancient empire** may hold **cultural or strategic importance** to the **Draconic Empire**. Likewise, **pirate dens** or **hidden coves** may be especially valued by the **Black Fleet** as locations that provide shelter and secrecy. The **symbol of neutrality** might be adopted in such places to maintain appearances while the factions negotiate, share information, or make deals that benefit them in the long run. These neutral grounds act as a **shield** to protect the interests of the dominant faction, even as they remain a **safe haven** for other groups.

4. **Convenience of Access and Territory:**

At times, neutral ground locations are simply chosen for **their geographic convenience**—situated in areas that are **equally accessible** to the involved factions. Such spaces often exist near **natural boundaries**, like islands in contested waters or near **famous landmarks** that are **regarded by all as significant**. Their location makes them **ideal spots** for quick, informal meetings or to **offload resources** when tensions with neighboring areas are high. Some neutral grounds are deliberately chosen for **ease of travel**, meaning they are places **frequented by multiple factions** at different times, offering **easier access** to agents of various organizations. These locations are typically **off-the-beaten-path**, where the regular rules of society might be more easily bent.

Legends

The Dwarven Lecture on Airflight

The warm glow of the forge flickered in the corners of the workshop, casting long shadows over rows of mechanical parts and unfinished projects. The air was thick with the scent of oil and molten metal. A tall, broad-shouldered **dwarf** named **Garrick Stonefist** stood at a cluttered workbench, his thick fingers stained with soot and grease as he carefully adjusted a complex gear mechanism.

At the far end of the room, **Liam Greystone**, a young human engineer with a quick smile and eager eyes, watched in fascination. Liam had come to Garrick seeking knowledge about airships—specifically, the legendary dwarven methods of flight. He'd heard rumors of how dwarves could craft ships that could defy the laws of nature itself, and he was eager to learn the secret.

“So, Garrick,” Liam said, leaning against a wooden beam, his voice full of admiration, “I’ve heard that your people have the best airships. What’s your secret? How do you make them fly so reliably?”

Garrick’s bushy beard twitched, and he let out a deep, rumbling chuckle. He wiped his hands on a rag before turning to face Liam, his eyes gleaming with the sharp, no-nonsense wisdom that only a dwarf could have.

“Ah, lad, humans, always in a rush to get it all wrong,” he said with a smirk. “Let me tell ya somethin’. You see, most of ya think you’ve got the whole idea of flight figured out, but yer methods—bah, yer methods are more *wishful thinking* than engineering!”

Liam blinked, taken aback. “What do you mean, ‘wishful thinking’? Humans have made huge strides with aetheric engines and steam power. We can fly huge ships, traverse vast distances…”

“Steaming and aethering, that’s what you do,” Garrick interrupted, wagging a finger. “Aye, ye’ve got big engines, fancy arcane doodads, and a lot of *fire*, but none of it’s built for *endurance*. Yer ships are like kites caught in a thunderstorm—sure, they’ll *glide* for a while, but when the winds turn sour, they’re all but useless.”

He snorted as he picked up a heavy bronze cog from the workbench, rolling it between his hands like a stress ball. “Ya see, flight ain’t just about speed and big booms, no. Flight’s about *stability*—about precision. We don’t rely on whimsy. We build our ships to endure, to weather storms, to *stay up* when the world’s tryin’ to knock ‘em down.”

Liam crossed his arms, intrigued. “But we *do* have stability in our ships. Our aetheric engines are built to balance power and weight, and our steam turbines provide consistent thrust.”

“Aye, but that’s where ye miss the point,” Garrick said with a grunt, setting the cog down and moving to a nearby shelf to pull out a set of intricately designed **runestones**. “Look here, lad, at these runestones. They’re the heart of any dwarven airship. They’re carved with ancient runic magic—magic that aligns the gravitational field around the ship, holding it in the air with precision.”

He held up one of the stones, and Liam could feel the faint hum of power emanating from it. “These runes don’t just lift a ship into the air; they *bind it* to the sky, using the very essence of the earth’s stability. Dwarven ships aren’t ‘floating,’ lad. They’re *anchored*—rooted in the very currents of the world, like mountains themselves.”

Liam frowned. “But doesn’t that make the ships slower? Wouldn’t aetheric power let you control the ship more dynamically?”

“Aye, but control comes from structure, not *wild energy*,” Garrick replied, his voice firm. “Humans love to tinker with volatile forces, arcane power that can explode if you look at it wrong. You’ve got yer aether engines and sails that *react* to wind and magic, but they’re unpredictable. They need constant adjustment, constant maintenance.”

He stepped over to a massive blueprints table, covered with the layout for a new **dwarven airship**. “Look at this, Liam. This here is a design for a new **Gilded Skycrusher**. It’s built from the strongest materials in the world—mithril plating, reinforced with runic sigils to prevent wear and tear. The engines run on a precise system of steam-driven turbines, but it’s the balance of *weight, precision, and stability* that allows it to cut through the skies without so much as a wobble.”

Liam leaned in, studying the plans. The ship’s design was sleek but sturdy, built like a fortress that happened to fly. Every curve and gear seemed carefully considered, a masterpiece of dwarven engineering.

“So, you’re saying your ships are *safer* than ours?”

“Not just safer,” Garrick said with a satisfied grin. “*Reliable*. When a storm hits, when a hundred winds howl at ye, our ships don’t flinch. They’ve got the *muscle* to ride through the roughest skies. They’ve been built to outlast the whims of magic.”

Liam’s mind was racing. He had always admired the dazzling magic of aetheric engines, but what Garrick said made sense. Humans were always chasing the next big thing, trying to control forces beyond their comprehension. The dwarves, however, approached flight like they approached everything else—methodically, precisely, with a deep understanding of the **fundamentals**.

“I see what you mean,” Liam said thoughtfully. “It’s not about pushing power to the limit, but about building something that *lasts*. That’s... that’s brilliant.”

Garrick chuckled again, his deep voice echoing through the workshop. “Aye, lad. It’s all about knowing the *limits* and respecting ‘em. Now, if ye want to fly like a dwarf, ye’ve got a lot to learn.”

Liam grinned. “Then teach me, Garrick. I’m ready.”

Garrick slapped him on the back, nearly knocking him off his feet. “I’ll teach ye, boy, but be warned. There’s more than just building airships. There’s a whole art to keeping ‘em in the skies. And yer not careful, one wrong turn could send ye plummeting right back to the ground.”

The two of them turned back to the blueprints, ready to begin the next step in their journey—a journey that would blend the best of both worlds: the ancient stability of the dwarves and the bold ambition of the humans.

The Legend of Aelric Skywarden: The First Protector of the Light

Long before the skies were dotted with floating cities and the great airships soared across the heavens, there was a time when the **Abyss**, a yawning void of endless nothingness, threatened all who dared to venture too close. It was said that those who fell into the Abyss would be lost forever, their souls scattered to oblivion, their bodies consumed by the unyielding darkness.

In the early ages of the world, when magic was raw and the threads of fate still unraveled with uncertainty, a **mage and cleric** named **Aelric Skywarden** rose from the humblest of beginnings. He was born in the clouds of the Highmist Peaks, where the winds howled louder than the voices of men, and where the Abyss could be glimpsed on the horizon—its dark expanse ever looming.

Aelric was not like other spellcasters. While many sought to harness the forces of nature for power, or wield magic for personal gain, Aelric's heart was always drawn to the suffering of those who were caught in the winds of fate, the ones who fell, or risked falling, into the eternal Abyss. His dedication to saving the lives of those who teetered on the edge of the void led him to study both **divine magic** and **arcane knowledge**, blending the arts of the **cleric** and **mage** in ways that had never been seen before.

He became known as the **Skywarden**, the protector of those who would fall.

The first test of his newfound powers came when **King Aldric of the Skyrealm**, a great ruler and pioneer of air travel, set out on a perilous journey across the untamed skies. During his expedition, a storm of unnatural strength swept across the airship, sending it into a spiraling descent toward the Abyss. The ship's crew was helpless, and all hope seemed lost.

At the last moment, as the ship plummeted toward the darkness, a great flash of blinding light appeared—Aelric Skywarden, standing upon the wing of the royal airship, his staff raised high. In that instant, the sky itself seemed to bend, the winds shifting and swirling in a magical frenzy. Aelric spoke the ancient words of the **Light**, the power of divine intervention, and the ship was wrenched from its fall. With a mighty push of celestial magic, he caught the King and his ship in an invisible force, sending them safely back to the sky.

The people of the Skyrealm hailed Aelric as a hero. His deeds became legend, and the story of how he saved King Aldric from the Abyss spread far and wide. Those who had witnessed the event saw a great **light** descend upon Aelric, a divine symbol that became known as the **Aegis of Light**—a radiant shield that would protect those who lived in the sky from the terrors of the Abyss.

In time, Aelric established the **Order of the Skywardens**, a group dedicated to keeping the skies safe from the fall into the Abyss. The followers of this new order began to worship the Light, believing that it was the guiding force that kept them safe, an unbreakable beacon in the void.

However, this legend did not go unchallenged. **Draconic kind**, the ancient and proud creatures that ruled the skies long before humans and other races dared to take flight, looked upon Aelric's actions with disdain. They believed that the Abyss was not something to be feared, but something to be embraced—a natural balance of existence. The dragons, ancient and wise, scoffed at the tale of Aelric's intervention, calling it **false** and **blasphemous**.

The dragons claimed that Aelric's actions had disrupted the natural order, that his so-called "Light" was a fabrication, a deceit meant to rob the skies of their rightful guardianship. They argued that no mortal should dare to tamper with the Abyss, for it was the place where the end of all things lay—a necessary darkness in the fabric of existence.

Despite the dragon's accusations, Aelric's influence grew. His teachings spread, and the worship of the Light continued to thrive, for it was seen as the only way to prevent those who were about to fall into the Abyss from being lost forever.

In the years that followed, Aelric's followers became the first Skywardens, traveling the heavens and using their divine magic to rescue those on the brink of falling into the Abyss. They served as protectors, healers, and guides, dedicated to ensuring that no one would be swallowed by the void.

The **Aegis of Light** remained a powerful symbol, and though many knew it as a symbol of hope, the dragons still whispered in the shadows, forever calling the story of Aelric Skywarden a **lie**—a tale spun by those who feared the natural order of the world and sought to alter fate itself.

But for the Skywardens, the legend lived on. For them, Aelric's actions would always be remembered as the **first act of salvation**, and the Light would continue to shine, guiding all those who needed protection from the Abyss.

And so, the **worship of the Light** was born, and with it, the duty to protect those on the edge of the void—forever linking Aelric Skywarden to the skies, the heavens, and the ever-present threat of the Abyss.

The Origin of the Neutral Ground Symbol – The Legacy of Captain Daeron "Ironheart" Veld

The **symbol of the ouroboros entwined with a ship's wheel**—now a widely recognized mark of neutral ground—was not always a symbol of peace. It originates from the **noble sacrifice** of a man who, in the **heat of battle**, made the ultimate act of heroism to save the lives of many.

This man was **Captain Daeron "Ironheart" Veld**, a figure whose death and legacy would shape the very fabric of Kaysender's understanding of neutrality and honor.

The Battle of the Shattered Skies

Captain Veld was leading a **coalition fleet** that included forces from the **Draconic Empire**, **Valeria**, and **The Free Flotilla**. The three factions had been forced into an uneasy alliance to combat a massive **pirate armada** led by a ruthless faction of the **Black Fleet**. The battle was fierce, and many ships were caught in the tumultuous winds and dangerous skies over the **Shattered Isles**—a region known for its violent skystorms and unstable currents.

As the battle raged on, Captain Veld's ship, the "**Seawind's Fury**", found itself at the mercy of a terrible **tempest** that threatened to tear it apart. The enemy forces closed in, and with the ship's helm damaged beyond repair, the **Seawind's Fury** was doomed to crash into the jagged cliffs of a nearby island. Captain Veld, seeing no way to navigate the ship to safety, made the fateful decision to **tie himself to the wheel** of the ship, using ropes to secure himself in place and manually hold the wheel steady against the tempest's fury. The act was nothing short of **legendary bravery**.

Despite his courage, the ship was lost, and Captain Veld perished in the storm. His body, still tied to the wheel, was found the next morning—a **hero's sacrifice**, holding the vessel on course long enough for his crew to escape to safety. His actions, which saved dozens of lives, became a symbol of **selflessness** and **dedication** to the greater good. His death was felt across the sky, as even those who fought against him could not help but respect the magnitude of his sacrifice.

The Legacy of Captain Veld

Captain Veld was revered by many factions, not just for his bravery but for the way he had earned their trust throughout the years. He had been a **diplomat** and **leader** who sought peace even in the most chaotic of times. While he was a respected officer in the **Draconic Empire**, he had also formed friendships with figures from **Valeria**, **The Free Flotilla**, and even former **Black Fleet** pirates who had turned away from their criminal ways. His ability to unite such disparate factions in a time of crisis was a testament to his **honor** and **integrity**.

His funeral, held in the aftermath of the Battle of the Shattered Skies, was a **state affair** attended by representatives from all the factions involved. It took place on the **neutral grounds** of a remote **island sanctuary**, chosen specifically for its **symbolic significance**—a place where even enemies could gather in peace to honor one of the greatest men Kaysender had ever known. The ceremony was somber and grand, with each faction offering a **tribute** to the man who had brought them together, despite their differences.

During the funeral, as part of the **honoring ceremony**, Captain Veld's ship's wheel—now weathered and battered—was placed at the head of his tombstone, symbolizing his undying commitment to those under his command. It was here, in the presence of both allies and enemies, that the **first neutral ground symbol** was used: a rope-woven wheel, signifying the

sacrifice of one man who held firm to his beliefs despite the cost, and the peace that could be achieved when factions put aside their differences to remember such a noble act.

The Symbol's Adoption

The symbol of the **ouroboros entwined with a ship's wheel** quickly became a **widely recognized marker of neutral ground**. Captain Veld's legacy—his **sacrifice**, his **honor**, and his **vision of peace**—continued to inspire leaders across Kaysender. The idea of creating spaces where conflicting factions could negotiate, trade, or simply exist without the threat of violence grew from his death, and soon the symbol was adopted in locations across the world.

Captain Daeron "Ironheart" Veld's legacy lives on, not only in the memories of those who knew him but in the **very symbol that continues to maintain a fragile peace** across the skies. The **neutral ground** is not merely a place for diplomacy but a reminder of the **selflessness** and **sacrifice** that make it possible for opposing forces to find common ground, even in the darkest of times.

The Lost Tomb of Captain Daeron "Ironheart" Veld – The Resting Place Among the Clouds

In the **Shattered Skies**, where the winds howl and the clouds swirl in endless chaos, there is said to lie the **lost resting place** of Captain **Daeron "Ironheart" Veld**. His final burial, on a **deserted isle**, was meant to be a **solemn tribute** to a hero whose sacrifice saved many. However, over time, the **exact location** of this **sacred ground** has been obscured by the very forces that took his life—the **tempests** and **turbulent skies** that rage over the area. While many believe the island where he was laid to rest has been swallowed by the endless storms, **whispers of his tomb's location** persist, passed down through the generations like a ghostly trail of breadcrumbs.

The Legend of the Lost Tomb

The legend tells of a small, **shrouded isle**—a place where no ships could safely approach and where no sails could find purchase in the tempest. It is said that on this island, among the jagged cliffs and the haunting winds, lies a **stone monument**—a **ship's wheel**, weathered by time but still intact, marking the spot where Captain Veld's body was laid to rest. Above it, the **rope-woven ouroboros** is etched in the stone, a **final testament** to his **sacrifice**.

The legend states that on rare occasions, when the **storms are at their fiercest**, the skies clear just long enough for those who are brave—or foolish—enough to **catch a fleeting glimpse** of the island. Sailors and sky captains who have dared to venture into the heart of the storm have returned, wide-eyed and shaken, claiming that they have seen **glimmers of the island's silhouette**, barely visible through the swirling clouds, and have heard faint echoes of a **ghostly crew**, perhaps the lost souls of those who died with Veld on that fateful day.

Some believe the island is cursed, hidden from all but the **most worthy**, or that it can only be found by those who have the **heart of a true hero**. There are stories of **ancient maps**—lost or stolen from secret libraries—detailing the island’s location, though they are often incomplete or torn. Those who have claimed to possess the full map have either disappeared or been driven mad by the **storms** that seem to guard it.

The Seekers of Veld’s Tomb

Despite the **mystery** and danger, there are those who still search for the **lost tomb**. Adventurers, treasure hunters, and sometimes even members of the **Draconic Empire** or **Black Fleet** have been known to make a quest for the site. The **promise of finding Captain Veld's tomb** is a **powerful allure**, for those who believe that it could bring not only wealth but great **favor** from the factions that revere him. The **treasures** rumored to lie in the tomb are said to include **artifacts of immense power**, possibly linked to the very forces of the tempest that claimed Veld’s life. Some even say that the Captain’s **mighty wheel** could possess mystical properties, capable of guiding ships through the most violent storms or granting **unseen protection** to those who dare to wield it.

Yet, as much as the legend endures, no one has ever returned from an expedition claiming to have found the tomb. Those who have ventured out and come back are often either **lost forever** or return to speak of being led astray by the **storms**, or of hearing whispers on the wind telling them that the tomb was never meant to be found.

A Final Resting Place, Lost to Time

The **truth** behind the legend of Captain Daeron Veld’s resting place is as shrouded in mystery as the **tempests** themselves. Is the tomb truly out there, hidden by the whims of fate, waiting to be discovered? Or is it simply a myth, designed to protect the sanctity of a hero’s final resting place?

No one knows for sure. But every so often, a **brave soul** or **reckless adventurer** claims to have found the island, or to have glimpsed the **ancient wheel** through the clouds. And in those moments, the legend of **Captain Daeron "Ironheart" Veld** is renewed—alive in the hearts of those who believe in the **greatness** of his sacrifice and the power of his **memory**. Perhaps, someday, the tomb will be found again, not by treasure hunters, but by those who are worthy of the **legacy** he left behind.

The Ghost Ship of the Draconic Armada – The *Ashen Phoenix*

Long ago, in the **era of the great Dragon Lords**, there sailed a vessel of such magnificent scale and grandeur that it was feared and revered across the skies of Kaysender. This ship, known as the ***Ashen Phoenix***, was one of the **crown jewels** of the **Draconic Armada**—a massive airship crafted from enchanted obsidian and gilded scales, its sails as black as night,

and its hull shimmering with the essence of forgotten magic. It was said to carry treasures **beyond imagination**, bound for the private hoard of **Dragon Lord Vraxion**, a ruthless and powerful leader among the Draconic Lords.

But that was **long ago**. The stories say that in the **great conflict** between the Dragon Lords and the other factions, the **Ashen Phoenix** and its fleet were tasked with delivering a legendary hoard—a **fortune in gold**, ancient artifacts, and magical relics of untold power. But as fate would have it, the **Ashen Phoenix** was caught in the **clash of warring skies**, battered by storms and assaulted by treachery. In the end, **Vraxion** was **defeated**, his power shattered, and his **prized ship** lost to the winds of time.

The ship's **crew perished**, their bodies scattered to the wind, and the **Ashen Phoenix** was said to have sailed **without a helmsman**, a **phantom ship** destined to drift in the sky, **laden with treasure**, but with no purpose or captain to guide it. With **no crew** to steer it, and **no destination**, it wandered the skies aimlessly, its once-great sails now tattered, yet still holding the vessel aloft. It was said to be cursed—its bounty a **silent, gilded temptation**, lost forever to all but the winds.

The legend has it that the **Ashen Phoenix** disappeared **mysteriously** from all records, and **no one knows** the exact date of its disappearance. Some claim it was over **a hundred years ago**, while others say it was much more recent, in the midst of a **great naval battle**. **Seasons turned to years, then decades**, and still, the ship's whereabouts remained unknown, swallowed up by the treacherous skies.

But **recently**, whispers have emerged once more, spreading among the **pirate fleets, bounty hunters, and adventurers** brave enough to listen. There are **rumors** of the **Ashen Phoenix** sighted once again—**off the northern coasts**, where the winds are cold, and the skies are often dark and turbulent. The sightings are few and far between, and no one can **confirm** the ship's existence, but every so often, a ship captain or crew member comes back with wild stories of a **massive, ghostly vessel** drifting silently through the fog, its gold and treasures visible from afar, yet always **just out of reach**. Those who have dared approach say that the ship's hull glows faintly, a dull radiance that flickers like the last embers of a dying flame. And others have claimed to hear the soft echo of distant voices, or the faint clang of **gold coins** rolling along the deck—**tempting, but unattainable**.

The sighting of the **Ashen Phoenix** has become something of a legend—a **dream** or a **curse**, depending on who tells the tale. Some say it is a test of fate, that whoever can find the ship may claim its wealth for themselves, but others believe the ship is nothing more than an **illusion**, a **phantom** sent to lure adventurers to their doom.

In the northern coasts, the **pirates, mercenaries, and adventurers** speak in hushed tones, fearful yet entranced by the myth. They say that if you sail too close to the storm's edge, you might just see the **Ashen Phoenix**—**lost, adrift, and waiting** for someone to claim the treasure that it once carried. But there's a warning in their voices, a fear that even the **golden riches** on

board are not enough to bring back the ship's fateful crew, and that **Vraxion's curse** will forever tie the **Ashen Phoenix** to the winds, its wealth **forever beyond reach**.

The Legend of the Frozen Glaciers and the Cursed Airways

In the farthest, **most remote** reaches of the north, where the winds are cold enough to freeze the very breath in your lungs, there lies a place that sailors dare not speak of in **quiet company**. It is the **realm of the Frozen Glaciers**—a vast expanse of floating ice, jagged and sharp, stretching across the sky like the skeletal remains of a **frozen leviathan**. These glaciers are **more than just ice**. They are haunted, cursed by an ancient force that no sailor fully understands.

The legend begins in the **Age of Frost**, when it is said that an ancient civilization of sky-faring people built their floating cities upon these very glaciers. They were a **people of great power**, believed to have harnessed the magic of ice and storms, able to command the winds to carry them across the skies. However, the cost of such power was **high**—they made a pact with the spirits of the sky, promising their loyalty to the frozen gods in exchange for control over the winds.

For many years, the civilization thrived. Their cities shimmered like ice palaces, and their ships glided gracefully through the freezing skies. But **greed**, as it so often does, corrupted them. The people sought more power, more control over the winds, and in their arrogance, they demanded that the spirits grant them dominion over the very essence of the frozen elements.

The spirits, angered by their insolence, cursed the land. **The glaciers** that once served as the foundation of the cities were **transformed into prisons**, their beauty twisted into something far more terrifying. The floating ice became a labyrinth of **sharp, dangerous spires**, where the winds howled in maddening fury, and the air was thick with frost. The civilization, now reduced to nothing more than a **memory**, vanished into the icy tombs, their ships lost to the cold void.

To this day, the **Frozen Glaciers** remain a place of doom. Sailors speak of their eerie beauty—**vast sheets of ice**, floating in the air like forgotten islands, shimmering under a pale, cold sun. But there is no warmth here, no safety. The ice is said to be **alive**, moving and shifting with a mind of its own. Ships that venture too close become trapped in the **glacier's grasp**, their hulls pierced by the jagged spires, their crews lost to the howling winds.

It is the **Cursed Airways**—the narrow, treacherous paths through the glaciers—that sailors fear the most. These ice-choked ways are **narrow** and **confusing**, a maze of glistening spires and freezing winds that can change direction without warning. **Few ships** have passed through them, and of those who have, only the **bravest** or **most foolish** dare try again.

There are stories of ships that entered the frozen passageways, **never to return**, their crews lost to the storms that whip through the icy corridors. Some say the ships are **pulled into the**

ice, their sails torn apart by unseen forces. Others believe that the spirits of the ancient civilization still haunt the airways, seeking to claim the souls of those who venture too close to the cursed ice. It is whispered that on still nights, when the winds are calm, the ghostly echoes of lost sailors can be heard, their voices carried on the wind, forever trapped in the cold embrace of the glaciers.

The most terrifying part of the legend is that the **curse** of the Frozen Glaciers has spread. The once-clear skies above the glaciers are now filled with **frozen mists**, making it nearly impossible to navigate. Those who are brave enough to try and sail through the **Cursed Airways** risk becoming **lost to time**, their ships left to drift aimlessly through the eternal ice, their names forgotten by all but the wind.

But even the bravest sailors know better than to ignore the warning: **Never sail too close to the Frozen Glaciers**, for once you enter the Cursed Airways, you may never find your way back, and you may join the many **lost souls** who haunt the **endless ice**.

The Undead Acropolis and the Watchers of the Frozen Skies

Beyond the **Frozen Glaciers**, in the deepest heart of the **frozen north**, there lies a place so cursed that even the bravest air sailors speak of it only in hushed whispers—the **Undead Acropolis**.

It is said to be a **vast, crumbling city** suspended in the sky, its towering spires carved from ancient stone and covered in frost and ice. The city is the remains of an **ancient civilization**, a people who once commanded the skies and the wind, much like the lost empire of the Frozen Glaciers. But unlike those ice-bound ruins, the Undead Acropolis still holds **life**—or something like it. The people who once lived there are long gone, their bodies reduced to **skeletons and wraiths**, bound to the city by some dark force that prevents them from passing into the afterlife. The **Acropolis** is not a place of rest but of restless **undead souls**, bound to a place they can never leave, tasked with an eternal duty.

These **undead air sailors** patrol the **haunted airways** that wind through the ruins, their ships **made of bone and shadow**, with sails that flutter as if alive. The ships glide effortlessly through the freezing winds, as though the chill does not touch them. The air sailors are often **clad in tattered, ancient garb**, their eyes glowing faintly with an eerie, unearthly light. They are the **guardians** of the Acropolis, bound by a curse to sail these skies for eternity, preventing anyone from entering or leaving the cursed city. It is said that the sailors' ships are imbued with the magic of the ancient city, and their very presence **warms** the cold air, making their passage through the skies both haunting and hypnotic.

The **undead air sailors** are not mindless, however. They are **craftsmen** and **warriors**, skilled in the ways of **natural magic**—the ancient craft that once allowed their people to bend the forces of nature to their will. They know how to manipulate the winds, to summon storms, and to call

upon the **spirits of the earth and sky**. It is said that their ships can glide through the toughest of weather, making them formidable foes to any who dare challenge them. These ships, crafted from **bone, ice, and frost**, are a terrifying sight—some say they can even **pass through the solid ice** of the Frozen Glaciers, leaving no trace of their passage.

The legend speaks of **three** such **undead air sailor captains**, each a figure from the past whose soul was bound to the Acropolis during the final battle that saw the civilization's destruction. These captains are the **lords** of the undead fleet, each wielding an **ancient artifact** of immense power, allowing them to control the **forces of nature** that sustain their ships. These captains are eternal, their **skeletal frames** wrapped in **mystical armor**, their eyes glimmering with the remnants of their past life, and their voices now little more than a hollow echo of commands whispered across the winds. Their ships, powerful and cursed, are said to be capable of **summoning storms, shaping winds**, and even **turning the sky to ice** itself.

The **undead air sailors** patrol the **airways**, guarding the gates of the Undead Acropolis against any intruders. If they spot a ship approaching the ruins, they will **launch a pursuit**—drifting silently through the fog, their ships eerily glowing in the twilight. These guardians do not speak, but their presence is **felt** in the air, a growing pressure that makes the very sky seem to close in.

Many sailors have tried to **chart the airways**, to navigate through the frozen skies and into the Acropolis, but few have returned. Those who have are often **mad** from the experience, their minds shattered by the endless cold, the haunting sight of the undead air sailors, and the knowledge that they have glimpsed the **afterlife**—and survived.

The Undead Acropolis and its **watchful, eternal sailors** remain a **legend**, an ominous reminder that not all things in the skies are **meant to be explored**. It is said that those who **stumble upon the Acropolis**—either by fate or misfortune—are doomed to never leave. The spirits of the **undead air sailors** are bound to the city forever, a dark reminder of the civilization that once was, and a warning to all who dare sail too close to the frozen ruins. The airways that lead to the Acropolis are a **dangerous labyrinth** of ice, storm, and dark magic, and those who seek to brave it may find themselves lost in **eternal pursuit**, sailing with the undead for **all eternity**, never able to escape the cold grasp of the haunted air.

And so, the story endures, carried on the wind: **the undying sailors of the Frozen North, eternally watching, eternally guarding their cursed city**, never to find peace.

The Lost Continent of Azh'Thanar

Far beyond the western horizons, where the sea stretches endlessly into the unknown, lies a land long erased from the tongues of men, dwarves, and even dragons. Azh'Thanar—the Unbroken Continent. Its name is a whisper in the forgotten tongues of the eldest elven scribes, a riddle found only in mold-ridden scrolls and crumbling dwarven vaults, sealed for centuries against the decay of time.

The legends speak of an age before the nations of Kaysender, before the rise of the Dragon Lords, before even the first stone was laid in Valeria's ancient halls. They tell of a world untouched by the hands of mortals, where vast jungles sprawled across the land, rivers carved canyons as deep as the heavens, and mountains clawed at the sky with peaks that dwarfed even the spires of the Skyweaver Consortium's tallest citadels.

Here, the land was ruled not by men, elves, or dwarves, but by titans of flesh and bone—massive lizard beasts, their footfalls shaking the earth, their roars splitting the heavens. Some strode upon two powerful limbs, swift and cunning, hunters of colossal might. Others lumbered upon four, great behemoths whose backs bore forests, their tails like battering rams of flesh and sinew. Among them walked creatures swathed in thick woolen hides, like the elephants of Faelenor's jungles but greater in size, their tusks curving like scythes against the sky.

But the most chilling whispers are not of the beasts that roamed, but of the civilization that came before.

Beneath the vine-choked ruins and shattered roadways, remnants of a lost empire slumber in silence. Their cities, built not for mortals, loom as impossible constructs—great towers wider than castles, their windows rising high enough that a dragon might perch within. Doors vast enough for the largest wyrm to walk unbowed. And the bones...

Skulls as wide as banquet halls, their empty sockets deep enough for a man to stand within. Ribcages forming caverns, spines arching like the frames of bridges long crumbled. These are not the remains of dragons, nor of any beast known to the scholars of today. They are relics of a race lost to time, beings who strode the world before the first rune was etched, before the first starship sailed the sky.

The elves, long-lived and keepers of lore, murmur that the last written accounts of Azh'Thanar vanished when the western winds carried fire across the waves. The dwarves, ever distrustful of the untamed past, sealed their records in vaults buried beneath mountains, unwilling to speak of what they had once traded with—what they had once feared. And the dragons, eldest of all, grow silent when the name is spoken, their golden eyes clouding with memories long buried beneath the weight of ages.

What fate befell the giants of Azh'Thanar? Did they fall to war, to calamity, or to some force beyond the reckoning of the mortal mind? No answer remains, only the ruins. Only the bones. Only the endless whisper of the wind through the empty, broken cities of the land that time itself forgot.

And so the waves crash against the unbroken continent, and the legend of Azh'Thanar remains, waiting in the dark corners of lost tomes, hidden in the hush of the oldest tongues, a riddle with no answer—only a terrible, lingering silence.
